

Living Latin (1880 – c. 2000): ideology and identity

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Abstract

The thesis explores the so-called *Living Latin* movement, which believes that Latin should recover at least some of its communicational function and that the active use of it in communication and in teaching is worthwhile. The beginning of this ongoing movement is seen in the end of the 19th century, when the first general-purpose journals advocating for Latin as an international language appeared. The cultural roots of the value of speaking Latin are explored from the Renaissance, revealing an ever-present tension in the Latin tradition where on the one hand the language was used for many communicational aims, but on the other hand the authority of the classical models and the concern for the purity of the language encouraged a caution in the use of the language. The cultural and historical contexts giving rise to this movement are explored. In case of the end of the 19th century, one of the primary factors was the ever-present discussion of the international language question; among the other factors, the contemporary movement for reforming the teaching of the (modern) languages away from the grammar-translation method also played a role. In the Interwar period the different cultural environments are explored, concentrating on the case of Fascist Italy, which had an ambition to restore the international use of Latin. In the post-World War II Europe, the emerging new world order and the European integration movement contributed to another attempt of Latin universalism, when official organisations were formed aiming to make Latin an international language: *Vita Latina* and *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*. After exploring some of their internal politics and the changing position of Latin in the world, I turn to the so-called Enthusiast Latin movement, which, while the institutional positions of Latin were deteriorating worldwide, has been persevering in using Latin as an alternative supranational language and expanding its use to new fields (e.g., immersive summer schools; radio news; today the Internet). Taken together, these movements embody a particular conviction in the continuing vitality and universality of Latin, presenting themselves as an authentic continuation of the perennial Latin tradition reconciled with modernity. The study shows that the Living Latin movement has been both a product of the times (starting from the particular milieu of the end of the 19th century) and a continuation of certain tendencies in the Latin tradition since the Renaissance, all driven by a conviction in the universality of Latin capable of uniting the learned of today both between themselves and with the thinkers of the past.

Declaration

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*The history of these campaigns still has to be written and [this] analysis ⟨...⟩ is just a first step into a very wide field, in which almost no research has been done until now.*¹



*Satis est nunc eorum nomina nos tantum attulisse, nam de uniuscuiusque ortu, cursu, obitu disputare res longius est quam haec disquisitio patitur.*²



*Linguae Latinae mira quaedam vis inest ad jungendas nationes.*³

*Umbrae exsanguis et pallidae inspirare nixus sum vitam viresque ei infundere et sanguinem. Ne vocetur amplius, mecum dixi, lingua mortuorum. Sit lingua recens, lingua nostri saeculi, lingua quae inserviat nostro diei; sit denique lingua viventium. Vivere eam volui. Vivere eam jussi. Vivere eam jubere ausus sum.*⁴



*Die-nocturne hoc mecum volvo, verum utrum unquam sim par tantis mediis comparandis, divinare nequeo. Id quod ego habeo sunt: animus (quamcunque tenuis), voluntas & vita; hæc Musis Latinis paratus immolo.*⁵

*Si Romani nos Latine loquentes audirent, si scirent nos suam linguam vivam nunquam audivisse, cum laude, non cum vituperio exciperent.*⁶

1 IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 52-53)

2 Jiménez Delgado (1956, 198)

3 Karl Heinrich Ulrichs, *Alaudae* Aug. 1889 No. 5 p. 33

4 Karl Heinrich Ulrichs, *Alaudae* Apr. 1890 No. 11 p. 82

5 Arcadius Avellanus, *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1896 Vol. II No. 7 p. 8

6 Arcadius Avellanus, *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 9 p. 195

1 Introduction

1.1 Historical introduction

Latin functioned as Europe's uniting language ever since the disintegration of the Roman empire. After a millennium of being the primary language for handwritten communication in the medieval period, its ascendancy continued after the invention of the printing press, when the rate of new texts appearing in Latin continued growing sharply and it did not give way to the also growing vernacular languages: it was ubiquitous in the early modern Europe (15th-17th centuries) in the Church, legal system and all kinds of written discourse, resulting in a virtual bilingualism of educated circles. By the 19th century Latin was superseded in its communicative role by nation-state supported vernacular languages, but it still held its ground firmly as a ubiquitous subject in schools and as an educational ideal. "The stubbornness with which Latin clung to its position as a language of the educated population all over the world while its importance as a world language dwindled is astonishing"⁷ – even if the communicational function was for the most part gone, the symbolic value of Latin endured.

The transition in the Latin-centred educational curriculum from the now-obsolete communicational aims to the grammatical analysis of Latin and the general study of Antiquity (*Altertumswissenschaften*) made Latin relevant in the 19th century as a tool for training the students' mind and forming their character, not speaking of the various other roles Latin played in the society as a symbols.⁸ However, the memory of Latin's communicative universality was tenacious. One of its consequences was that Latin, no longer used for international communication, inspired various people to long for its former role and to bring Latin back to an active use in areas it had already given up. This sentiment first becomes a loosely organised movement (as opposed to occasional expressions and unconnected individual proponents) in the end of the 19th century, when technological advances in printing and communication (postal system, railway, steamships, telegraph) made it feasible for a numerically small but geographically widespread set of enthusiasts of the restoration of Latin to form a community united by common projects: (from the 1890s) journals written in Latin, (1903; 1933; especially after 1956) conferences conducted in Latin, (especially after 1956) official organisations, (from the 1970s) immersive summer schools. The present thesis calls it the *Living Latin* movement.

⁷ Leonhardt (2013, 265)

⁸ This shift and its cultural implications are amply discussed by Waquet (2001) and Leonhardt (2013).

Reconstructing this movement from scattered sources and showing its continuity is challenging. The general lack of scholarship in this field may be connected with some of the broader problems in the Latin language tradition.

Learning Latin usually means focusing on the “best” and most consequential authors, centred around the classical canon of the Golden age of Roman literature exemplified by Cicero and Virgil, and this is something that has (nearly) always put the more recent and contemporary Latin in a shade.

This colouring is reflected by the usual periodisation of Latin, which has historically (since the 15th century at least) been conceptualised according to the biological metaphors of birth, growth, culmination and decay, alternatively expressed through the quasi-Hesiodic metallic ages like *gold* or *silver*, implying common metals coming after these precious ones.⁹ However, it seems that in addition to this biological model of decline and death there was also a hope for a *rebirth*, which has been most forcefully expounded by the Renaissance. Already Petrarch in the 14th century dismissed the whole time period after the fall of Rome as “darkness” (*tenebrae*),¹⁰ and expressed hope that the “ancient pure radiance” (*purum priscumque iubar*) would return. The contemporaries in the Renaissance and the following centuries felt that this had indeed happened and that a *rebirth*¹¹ had been effected in Latin. The Latin had seemingly been cleansed of its “impurities” and brought back to the classical age, enabling the *recentiores* to compete with the *antiqui* on an equal ground and to become themselves objects of admiration and imitation. The time-line of Latin came to be understood as the classical age, followed by the (post-classical, Christian, medieval) authors of impure Latinity valuable for their contents rather than their style, and the reborn Latin of the Humanists. The criterion of the classical purity of Latin as the most important element alienated a whole era of Latin heritage and created the concept of Middle ages.

9 Farrell (2001, 92 ff.) explores this “biometallic” metaphorical system and how entrenched it is. “By referring to the “biometallic” model I am not alluding simply to Hesiod’s myth of gold and silver “races.” The “myth of ages” has for much of the modern period been read as part of a larger pattern that involves modelling the history of latinity on the life cycle of higher organisms. The preferred exemplar is, of course, the human species. No metaphor packs quite so much intuitive conviction or perceived explanatory power as the biological fallacy. Sometimes couched in terms of “rise and fall” that (barely) conceal their origins, such models frequently elaborate the biological sources of their symbolic language to the point of self-deconstruction.”

10 Mommsen (1942, 240) cites lines IX.451-457 from the ending of Petrarch’s Latin epic *Africa* and provides an English translation: “Michi degere vitam / Impositum varia rerum turbante procella. / At tibi fortassis, si – quod mens sperat et optat – / Es post me victura diu, meliora supersunt / Secula: non omnes veniet Letheus in annos / Iste sopor! Poterunt discussis forte tenebris / Ad purum priscumque iubar remeare nepotes.” (*My fate is to live amid varied and confusing storms. But for you perhaps, if as I hope and wish you will live long after me, there will follow a better age. This sleep of forgetfulness will not last for ever. When the darkness has been dispersed, our descendants can come again in the former pure radiance*). Note: Mommsen’s footnote has *inbar*, a typographical error.

11 Or *renatae litterae* in Latin, *rinascimento* in Italian, *renaissance* in French. The concept of Renaissance as a particular all-encompassing historical era crystallises only in the 19th century in the works of Jakob Burckhardt, but the renewal of letters and of Latin was felt and discussed already by Humanists themselves and by the contemporaries of this era.

However, the prominence of the last part of this scheme, namely the rebirth of Latin, became lesser in the 18th century. Latin came to be understood as having a clear role distinct from the vernacular and in competition with it; the once nearly-exclusive focus on Latin lessened. The vernacular languages started to take communicative functions from Latin, and, more importantly, the European nations increasingly saw the literary heritage written in their own vernacular languages as something much more of their own than the Latin writings. Native vernacular languages, as a consequence of the Enlightenment and Romanticism, were seen as expressing the true spirit of the people, while Latin increasingly came to be seen as something secondary, a dry and ultimately futile learned exercise reflecting neither the times nor the nature of the people. This had consequences both for the contemporary use of Latin and for the appreciation of the Latin of previous centuries, which was de-emphasised and gradually fell into oblivion, while the old written heritage of the national vernacular languages was being searched for, catalogued, studied and taught.

The re-conceptualisation of Latin as a scientific¹² object of study, coinciding with the birth of classical philology, made it more relevant in the 19th century both as an object of research and as a discipline to be taught in schools. The renewed focus on the classical Roman antiquity further sidelined Neo-Latin – due to the newly found critical and grammatical knowledge it was no longer appreciated as having reached parity with the ancients, reducing its exemplary value, and the vernacular writings were preferred for illustrating the more recent times. So the research of Latin both as a language and as a literature was incredibly productive, with new critical editions of all Classical authors appearing, but “[i]n an era in which textual criticism flourished, Neo-Latin texts lay unedited”.¹³ This is another factor why Neo-Latin heritage increasingly faded to obscurity.

“The history of Latin literature thus seems to resemble an uninterrupted chain of breaking points, forever at pains to deny its own chronological continuity. The difference with literatures in other languages consists of the fact that, for Latin, the breaking point usually represents an attempt to revive a distant literary past.”¹⁴ These aspects of the nature of Latin – the centrality of the classical canon, the series of “rebirths” followed by oblivion of the preceding stages – are very relevant to the present study.

12 In modern English usage the word *science* is usually restricted to the natural sciences, computer science and mathematics, which is a 19th century development (Roelli 2021, 25) not shared with other European languages – French *science* or German *Wissenschaft* have a broader meaning applying to various fields of studies. The proper English term “scholarship”, distinct from *science*, misses the association the contemporaries would have made between classical philology / *Altertumswissenschaften* and the rapidly developing natural sciences of the time, both of which were processes of rational exploration.

13 Hendrickson (2018). Celenza (2006, 15): “In their systematizing impulse to create corpora of inscriptions, to form series of texts, in short to develop a “scientific” philology, most nineteenth-century humanistic scholars did not deem the Latin literary production of the Renaissance worthy of sustained attention.”.

14 Verbaal (2007, 8)

They go some way towards explaining why the *Living Latin* movement rarely gets scholarly attention – if the centrality of the classical period results in a tendency to overlook the whole Neo-Latin tradition, how much more does it affect the much smaller and later one? Moreover, Latin in the preceding centuries was central in the Western culture, making its role and influence, which was historically consequential, worthwhile to study, meanwhile *Living Latin* forms a sort of an afterword to this centrality. The value of the *Living Latin* movement for scholarship today lies not in its influence to the society or its cultural pre-eminence (Latin, contrary to the hopes expressed by some of its advocates, never again became a widespread worldwide language of communication), but rather in the sociocultural context and the rich connections it provides: tracing the history of this movement teaches us something about what Latin meant to people and what it was, what place it occupied in the culture. And, because Latin forms a part of the more broad field of ancient heritage and its reception, these attitudes are instructive in understanding the changing cultural environment and trends of the time.

The same difficulty in understanding the continuity of Latin tradition is also present in what is called here the *Living Latin* movement. It is a decentralised branching phenomenon consisting of many individual groups and “submovements” which often were not much aware of the other contemporary branches and usually had only a vague idea of the preceding ones. This does not prevent the functioning of the language – Latin has its authorities in the written tradition, it is not necessary to know one’s contemporaries and immediate predecessors in order to learn the language and to be converted to the cause of promoting its use. This idea of *Living Latin* contains many variations and attitudes, the branches are separated geographically and ideologically; the idea itself has been invented independently multiple times. It is decentralised: for example, everyone has equal rights to come up with neologisms and to promote them to the best of his or her ability (in this hypereducated community there is no shortage of language experts), and, since the ultimate authority is in the distant past, there is no central language-controlling organisation with an authority that would have to be followed (even if there always was a certain longing for one). Everyone is free to suggest and use one’s own solutions, while the old proposals might fade into obscurity – in this way Latin is like a whiteboard which one can always supplement with or wipe clean of new creations and thus to return to the classical standard of various degrees of purity.

Therefore, just like the general Latin tradition, *Living Latin* is full of branches and breaking points, making it challenging to trace the continuity of the phenomenon of *Living Latin*. These words, meant by Wim Verbaal to apply to the whole of *Latinitas perennis*, are very much applicable to this thesis about *Living Latin* of the last century-and-a-half:

It will concentrate on the idea of continuity within this strange phenomenon which is the history of Latin literature. How might we approach its peculiar history, which consists of an almost uninterrupted continuity by way of breaking points, breaches and revivals? Is it possible to deduce any recognizable continuous strains, certain recurrent elements perhaps, which prevent Latin literature from falling apart into distinct literatures which would have nothing in common but their language – which in itself seems a contradiction in terms?¹⁵

1.2 Definition of Living Latin

The present work examines the different conceptions people have had regarding Latin in different times and places and the phenomena arising from them: discussions, controversies, activism, projects, communities and traditions. In particular, it focuses on the perspective of a set of defenders of Latin who form the movement for *Living Latin*. What does this notion mean? I am investigating through my thesis as a whole what this *Living Latin* to be defended meant for different proponents in different contexts. But we have to start from a general definition. Wilfried Stroh, himself a prominent activist of *Living Latin*, gives¹⁶ us such a one in the *Living Latin* entry of the *New Pauly* encyclopedia. After outlining the historical reign and decline of Latin, he continues:

Thus, since the end of the 19th century,¹⁷ the term Living Latin is often used wherever, bucking the general trend, the language of Cicero and Virgil is practised and cultivated or even employed as a (often international) means of communication¹⁸ by Latin speakers¹⁹ who may also operate outside of schools, universities and Church. Perhaps the term²⁰ was first coined in 1924 by the educator Georg

15 Verbaal (2007, 10)

16 Originally in German (print edition Stroh (2001), available electronically as Stroh (2006a)), later published in English (online edition Stroh (2006b)). Throughout the citation, I note some differences in nuance of the English version from the original German: “Wo nun, gegen diesen Zug der allgemeinen Entwicklung, seit Ende des 19. Jahrhunderts, auch durch Lateiner außerhalb von Schule, Universität und Kirche, die Sprache Ciceros und Vergils praktisch geübt und kultiviert, ja als (oft internationales) Kommunikationsmittel genutzt und dabei besonders auch gesprochen wird, bezeichnet man dies (mit einer vielleicht zuerst 1924 von dem Lateinsprechen fordernden Pädagogen Georg Rosenthal gebrauchten Fügung) gerne als „lebendiges Latein“ (seit dem Kongress von Avignon 1956 häufig auch als „latin vivant“, daneben „living Latin“ und besonders *Latinitas viva*). Grundsätzlich kann dabei zwar zwischen traditionell überkommenen Erscheinungsformen, wie etwa lateinischen Ehrenurkunden, und reformerischen Neuansätzen, wie lateinischen Rundfunknachrichten, unterschieden werden (danach ist im Folgenden versuchsweise gegliedert); doch entziehen sich die einzelnen Phänomene und Personen naturgemäß oft der eindeutigen Zuordnung. Gemeinsam ist allen Bestrebungen die Faszination durch eine, eben weil sie tot ist, unsterbliche Sprache: Sie ermöglicht es, wie global über die Räume, so besonders auch diachron über die Zeiten hinweg zu kommunizieren. Je deutlicher diese Absicht gefühlt wird, um so stärker muss auch der sprachlich-stilistische Anspruch sein.”

17 The sentence means “The term *Living Latin* is often used where Latin has been used since the end of the 19th century wherever ⟨...⟩”. The German original does not imply that term was used in the end of the 19th century.

18 In German *and is also even spoken (und dabei besonders auch gesprochen wird)* is added.

19 The German has *Latinists (Lateiner)* with no implication that the users of the Latin language are *speakers* – producing the language in only the written form is also possible.

Rosenthal, who called for a spoken Latin.²¹ Since the Congress of Avignon in 1956 it is also often referred to as *latin vivant* and especially as *Latinitas viva*. However, a fundamental distinction must²² be drawn between traditional forms, such as honorary certificates in Latin, and reforming approaches, such as Latin radio news. What follows is²³ structured according to this distinction, but the various phenomena and personalities naturally often elude any clear classification. What all of these efforts share in common is the fascination with a language that is eternal precisely because it is dead.²⁴ The claim is made that it enables communication that is diachronic across the ages, just as it is global across space. The more clearly this intention is felt, the higher the linguistic-stylistic standard must be.

Stroh's definition is a good starting point. Indeed it seems that the main cause of the proliferation today of the term *Living Latin* arises²⁵ from a set of congresses celebrated since 1956, when Jean Capelle organised the *First International Congress for Living Latin* (*Premier congrès international pour le Latin Vivant*) in Avignon and this particular designation of the concept was disseminated in the further activities of the new *Vita Latina* movement. The declared goal of these congresses was to make Latin a functioning international language once again. Through this the term *Living Latin* was connected both with the expansion of the communicational use of Latin and with the modernisation it was supposed to undergo in order to assume this role.

However, the concept does not refer only to this goal of Latin as a world language, but it also has a strong component relating to the pedagogy of Latin, which may have been the first widespread use of the term *Living Latin*.²⁶ This term has been used in pedagogical literature for denoting the teaching of Latin through various inductive methods considered more “living” than the formal grammar-translation one and incorporating the active use of the language in the classroom.

20 Namely the German term *Lebendiges Latein*. The adjective *lebendiges* is used instead of *lebendes* (living) to provide an additional emphasis of lively or vivid. Fritsch (2005) also treats this concept.

21 Who promoted the speaking of Latin (von dem Lateinsprechen fordernden Pädagogen).

22 The German is a bit more careful: *Grundsätzlich kann dabei zwar zwischen <...> unterschieden werden (In principle, a distinction can be made between <...>)*

23 In German *versuchsweise* (tentatively) is inserted here.

24 See also footnote 63 for Stroh's conception of the vitality inherent in the “death” of Latin.

25 Tunberg (2012, 96): “Inde ab eo tempore copia hominum, qui aut Latine loquuntur, aut Latine loqui cupiunt, mirum in modum (et fortasse praeter expectationem) tam in Europa quam in America Septentrionali est aucta. Quorum permulti vocabulum e conventus Avennionensis inscriptione fortasse mutuati dicunt se Latinitati ‘vivae’ studere.”; Minkova and Tunberg (2012, 119); Minkova and Tunberg (2021, 129). Those who posit the beginning of the real Living Latin movement in the Avignon congress also imply the spread of the concept from this point. An example of this 1956 beginning of the movement itself is provided by Licoppe (2014a, 17): “Academiae historia intellegi non potest, nisi eius praehistoria primum attente inspicatur; radices enim habet in motu Latinitatis Vivae, quem Avennionem in Francogallia anno 1956 induxit primus « Viventis linguae Latinae causa Conventus Universus ».”.

26 Before this, in English the phrase *living Latin* would occasionally appear in various contexts – for the (original?) pronunciation of Latin (*Living Latin; an Essay in verse and prose on the pronunciation of Latin, in which the genuine powers of the Roman letters are proved from ancient authorities*. 1847), the Latin language of Romans themselves, for the aliveness of medieval Latin in comparison to the purified Renaissance idiom, for the Latin of Erasmus (“flexible, familiar, and, as it were, living Latin of his Colloquies” *American Monthly Review* Oct. 1833 Vol. IV No. 4 p. 332), the Latin of the Hungarian parliament, the Latin of the Church, the Latin living on as part of the English language.

The Reform Movement of the 1880s and the 1890s promoted such methods for teaching modern languages, which in the 19th century used to be taught in similar ways as the classical ones (just as the classical languages, the modern ones had also become tools for training the mind),²⁷ and developed a great variety of methods and names for them (apparently more than twenty (!), including the *Living method*).²⁸ From these variations of the New Method the designation *Direct method* gradually became prevalent in the English speaking world for naming the inductive ways of modern language teaching.²⁹ These methods also spread to Latin and Greek. It is important to note the efforts of W. H. D. Rouse (1863-1950), the headmaster of the Perse school in Cambridge (1902-1928), and of his followers, who have been using and actively promoting the *Direct Method* for teaching Latin and Greek,³⁰ consolidating the use of the term also for the classical language teaching.

Since the late 1920s instructional materials named after *Living Latin* started to appear in many languages of Europe: *lebendiges Latein* in German³¹ (Georg Rosenthal with his eponymous book published in 1924 seems to be the first one³² to have used this term), *Living Latin* in English,³³

27 Modern languages were taught in schools through a heavily philological, grammatical and literary method reminiscent of the treatment of Latin – in fact, the modern foreign languages managed to get included in English school and university curricula (Bayley 1998, 39) as respectable subjects precisely “by capitalizing on their similarity to the classics as subjects with complex linguistic textures and rich literatures” – and so they could be taught in a serious and learned way like the classics and so would also provide a comparable mental discipline. “They were taught as cultural acquisitions rather than useful tools of communication.” (*ibid.*). The idea that the foreign languages should be tools for training the mind is roughly contemporaneous (the turn of the 18th century) to the prevalence of this idea in the teaching of Latin (McLelland (2017, 97): “In the neohumanist curricula of the *Gymnasien* now being set up as the state took control of the school education system in Germany [...], beginning with Prussia in 1794, modern languages were now valued less as practical communicative tools than as a means of “mental training”, part of the overarching aim of education to develop pupils’ intellectual rigour”). Oral methods, namely the teaching of languages through conversation, did not have prestige: they were generally thought to be superficial and were “associated in the public mind with light chatter on trivial topics” (Bayley 1998, 42) and so they were not fit for the formal education.

28 Jespersen (1904, 2) in a memorable passage cited by the historians of the Reform Movement and of the Direct method (Hawkins (1987, 130; 306); Bayley (1998, 42); Wingate (2013, 497)) lists in jest 19 different names of the methods proposed by the reformers. The list is by no means exhaustive, a 20th name can be easily added: the *Living method*, considering that it is attested (e.g., Kroeh (1892) is titled “The living method for learning how to think in German”) and that Jespersen concluded his book with the words that the good method “becomes in the deepest and best sense of the word really *living*.”, an indication taken by the later readers (the three sources in the beginning of this note) that Jespersen preferred to name the perfect reformed method the *Living method*. The *Natural method* and *Nature’s method*, terms which are present both in Jespersen’s list (it includes the *natural method*) and in use today (e.g., Hans Henning Ørberg’s *Lingua Latina per se illustrata* was originally published by the *Nature Method Institute* and named *Lingua Latina secundum naturae rationem explicata* (Ørberg 1954)) were introduced and described already by Blackie (1845, 176), as noted by Howatt (1984, 196). See also footnote 399.

29 Hawkins (1987, 124-125)

30 Stray (1992); Stray (2004); Stray (2011); Miraglia (2009, 13-16).

31 Rosenthal (1924); Günther (1937); Thieme (1937).

32 Stroh (2001), see footnote 16: “einer vielleicht zuerst 1924 von dem Lateinsprechen fordernden Pädagogen Georg Rosenthal [...] gebrauchten Fügung”. This work is treated by Fritsch (1990, 53 ff.). Tantalisingly, the 1924 French *Who’s who* (Qui êtes-vous 1924, s.v. Marouzeau) attributes a work called “*Le Latin vivant* (1922)” to the French Latinist Jules Marouzeau (1878-1964), but I could not find it in any library catalogue I consulted.

33 Thursby and Kyne (1928); Thursby and Kyne (1929). Carr and Hadzsits (1933) and Carr, Hadzsits and Wedeck (1934) do not include the precise term “Living Latin” in the title, but seem to use the same metaphor in the title, a similar approach and rationale: “Because Latin is thus spoken and heard, and because Latin is made to live for

latin vivant in French,³⁴ *latino vivente* in Italian,³⁵ *żywa łacina* in Polish.³⁶ And so *Living Latin* (even if not universally) became a general term for an inductive method of teaching Latin that would include the active use of language in the classroom. In this meaning *Living Latin* was discussed in the scholarly literature – rarely in English,³⁷ but very often in French, where by the end of the 1930s *latin vivant* seems to have become (the?) dominant term for this concept.³⁸ It was said to be a slogan “on everyone’s lips”,³⁹ it was stated that “a veritable crusade was happening in favour of *latin vivant*”,⁴⁰ references were made to the “method(s)” and “partisans” of *latin vivant*,⁴¹ discussions about its validity took place,⁴² this term was used for referring to the inductive methods used for

pupils in familiar English words and in the growth of their own English vocabulary from each day’s study, the book is called “The Living Language.”” (J. A. S. 1933).

34 Lablénie (1934a,b,c); Lablénie (1935a,b); Lablénie (1936); Lablénie (1938). See also footnote 461: Jacques Tasset referred to *latin vivant* already in 1899.

35 Bernini (1937); Levi and Bini (1937).

36 Juliusz Krzyżanowski promoted W. H. D. Rouse’s teaching methods in Poland under the name of *żywa łacina* instead of translating the term *Direct method*: Krzyżanowski (1936); Krzyżanowski (1937a,b). His efforts have been treated by Loch (2013); Loch (2015); Domagała, Loch and Ochman (2021).

37 References to *Living Latin* in this period as a teaching method are few; one of the unambiguous ones is *Latin Notes* Oct. 1928 Vol. VI No. 1 p. 7, where “Annabel Cathcart, Oxford, Ohio”, a “student in a class for the training of Latin instructors” writes “I think applying Latin to English is one of the biggest differences between the older formal type of teaching and modern ‘living Latin’.” In the English-language literature of this period *Direct method* predominates as a term when discussing the teaching methods. However, the metaphor of a living language is often used and in this literature *living Latin* can be understood as the use of the language in the classroom: “That this process may have its greatest efficacy, it demands that the pupil constantly hear living Latin, and form the habit of expecting Latin, and trying to understand it as Latin, and to the greatest possible degree expressing himself in Latin. <...> The fundamental aim then of the Direct Method is to train the pupil in the living use of a living language, to establish in him a linguistically normal and right attitude of mind and habit of approach toward Latin.” (Chickering and Hoadley 1914, xiv), “Bear in mind that you are teaching the Direct Method, not an abstract, mechanical method, and remember that Latin is a living, human vehicle for conveying living, human thought.” (*ibid.*, xxxi), “as always, teach the Latin as a living language” (*ibid.*, xcvi).

38 Michaud (1936, 454) provides a possible cause: “Profitant de l’impulsion donnée au *Latin vivant* par M. Gastinel et de la faveur dont jouit cette méthode, trois petits volumes viennent de paraître simultanément.”. Indeed, Georges Gastinel (1869-1951), the *Inspecteur général de l’instruction publique, enseignement secondaire, lettres* of the time (1917-1936), is described as a “Spécialiste de l’enseignement du latin, partisan du latin vivant et parlé, il organise des expositions dans ce sens au Musée pédagogique.” (Caplat 1997, 291) and could have influenced the growth of *Living Latin* in schools.

39 Marouzeau (1939, 35): “L’apprentissage de la latinité pose une dernière question que l’on formule souvent aujourd’hui par recours à un slogan. C’est le slogan du « latin vivant ». Le mot est aujourd’hui dans toutes les bouches.”.

40 Cousin (1939, 51): “Précisément, depuis quelques années, on assiste à une véritable croisade en faveur du « latin vivant ». Rajeunissement de la pédagogie en premier lieu; diminution des leçons de grammaire à apprendre par cœur, <...> on suggère même au professeur d’essayer dans de courtes phrases de parler latin avec ses élèves.”.

41 Perret (1947, 45): “Les très modernes partisans du *Latin vivant*”; Pelorson (1940, 94): “que l’enseignement du Latin lui-même peut être revivifié (cf. certaines méthodes nouvelles de « Latin Vivant »);” Soufflet and Soufflet-Groix (1936): “« Le latin vivant »... : ces mots définissent une méthode d’acquisition des tours de phrase usuels, mais aussi l’esprit de tout un enseignement.”; Rott (1938, xxix): “D’ailleurs sa méthode pour le faire apprendre n’est-elle pas très proche de notre « méthode du latin vivant » ?”; Petit-Dutaillis (1938, 45): “les partisans du « latin vivant »”.

42 According to *Bulletin de l’Université et de l’Académie de Toulouse* 1937 Vol. 45 p. 237, the periodical *Les Humanités. Classes de grammaire, revue mensuelle* published in 1937 the following discussion: “R. Gautier: Contre le latin vivant (janvier); L. <sic!> Marouzeau: Le latin vivant (mars); <...> A. Guillemin: Pour le latin vivant (mai); R. Gautier: Contre le latin dit vivant <...> (juin)”.

teaching Latin outside of France.⁴³ Moreover, this term was also occasionally used for referring to the promotion of the active use of Latin as a modern international language.⁴⁴ So it is reasonable to conclude from this already established French tradition of denoting both the inductive teaching methods and the active use of Latin by the term *latin vivant* (with the former meaning predominating, as the term had originated from the wider movement of Latin teaching reform) that the slogan of *latin vivant* or *Living Latin* promoted and further proliferated by the 1956 Avignon congress was not a new invention, but rather an organic continuation of a Europe-wide Interwar tradition.

So this is one strand where *Living Latin* appeared and was propagated as a term. However, the notion of livingness and the equivalents of the term *Living Latin* itself have also been present in the texts of the Latin movement long before this period. The term *Latinitas viva* and synonymous ones (*sermo Latinus vivus*, *lingua Latina viva*) are well attested in the writings of Arcadius Avellanus (1851-1935),⁴⁵ a prolific promoter of the Latin teaching reform and of the use of the language who was active at the turn of the 19th century. He uses this concept in a broad manner corresponding to much of what has been referenced above. He contrasts *Living Latin* with the *Dead Latin* of the usual grammar books and schooling methods,⁴⁶ *Living Latin* is the colloquial method of

43 Peeters (1932, 317) describes the teaching of Latin in the United States and notes the growing use of *latin vivant* (“l’emploi généralisé de recettes pédagogiques, la tendance à utiliser de plus en plus le « latin vivant »”).

44 Marouzeau (1933, 301): “l’initiative de M. I. Wieniewski en faveur d’une utilisation du latin comme langue internationale <...> Mais je dois dire aussi qu’en France même la remise en honneur du latin vivant ne manque pas de propagandistes”. As Lurz (1949, 16-18) notes, Jules Marouzeau reports all these events in his journal, but does not believe in Latin’s potential as a lingua franca today: “Marouzeau berichtet als getreuer Chronist alle diese Vorgänge in der von ihm gegründeten Zeitschrift »Revue des Etudes latines«, weist aber immer auf seinen bereits bekannten Standpunkt hin; <...> Nach Marouzeau hat also Latein als Verkehrssprache seine Rolle ausgespielt; Latein als Verkehrssprache gehört und gehöre der Vergangenheit an!”.

45 So for example *Præco Latinus* Nov. 1895 Vol. II No. 2 p. 1: “sermonem Latinum vivum, ut sit lingua gentium universa”. Noted by Slednikov (2019a, 62).

46 *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1900 Vol. VI No. 7 p. 163: “gladium Latinitatis vivæ strinxeramus, ut Latinitatem elinguem iugularem, libellos mutos e medio tolleremus”; Mai. 1900 Vol. VI No. 8 p. 185: “libellorum quidem, qui philosophiam l. Lñæ in libris mortuæ in perpetuum recoquant et dapinant, nullus est numerus, at qui l. Lñam ut vivam tractet, quique sermonem vivum doceat, adhuc nullum vidimus”. The readers of *Præco Latinus* elaborated on the theme. Hilary Doswald (1877-1951), the future Prior General of the Carmelite Order, writes in Mai. 1901 Vol. VII No. 8 p. 197: “Id vero quam maxime doleo atque horreo, quod tot literarum ephebea et collegia, contempta viva lingua Latina, mortuam docere malint”. Albin Putzker (1845-1923), professor of German in the University of California, formulated the same thought: “Obluctaturi, ne l. Lñæ viva doceatur, soli semperque ii erunt quibus facultas sic docendi non inest, quippe quibus lingua Litteræque Lñæ cadaver nonnisi est discernendum, nec nisi trans personam alterius linguæ sunt eis cognitæ.” (Nov. 1898 Vol. V No. 2 p. 31).

teaching the language,⁴⁷ it is the Latin language in the international⁴⁸ or general⁴⁹ use – all of these aspects are related and constitute parts of one unitary project of restored Latin. However, even if Avellanus used the term and the concept, it was not the slogan for his project as such, even if he was once reported in the American press as “popularizing “living” Latin”;⁵⁰ his use of the term, even if very similar to that of today, was most probably forgotten afterwards and is certainly not the cause of its use today. In the Interwar years, the movement for the use of Latin was referred to by the contemporary chroniclers predominantly as the “(modern) Latin movement”⁵¹ or the “Neolatin movement”.⁵² But in the 1930s, terms like *Latinum vivum* or *lingua Latina viva* also start to be occasionally used in a general way to denote the movement.⁵³

In the decades after the 1956 Avignon congress the slogan *Living Latin* (and its equivalents in other languages) becomes a much more widespread term. In English the term *Living Latin* (including the use of names borrowed from French and Latin: *latin vivant*, *Latinitas viva*, *Vita Latina*) was used when discussing the official *Vita Latina* movement, its congresses and aims, and occasionally the use of communicative pedagogical approaches of teaching the language;⁵⁴ it

47 The teaching *sermone vivo* seems to be quite synonymous with the teaching *viva voce*. *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1896 Vol. II No. 7 p. 1: “I. Lñam ad usum quotidianum vivo sermone tradendo. Vanum enim est iactare methodo moderna “Classicos legi,” sermone vivo autem idem non fieri.”. Dec. 1896 Vol. III No. 3 p. 1: “Florentiæ quoque, clara urbe Italiæ, floret vindex sermonis Lñi vivi, Mgr. scil. doctissimus, FELIX RAMORINUS. Auctor noster narrat Mgrum laudatum sermonem Lñum viva voce docere, Lñe disserere”.

48 Dec. 1899 Vol. VI No. 3 p. 72: “intendamus vires, ut ludi, adoptata methodo colloquendi, I. Lñam vivam in usum quotidianum, saltem inter doctos, in vitam revocent, qua gentium universam. Nec ullo opus est decreto, satis est voluntas Mgrorum I. Lñam viva voce docendi. <...> I. Lñam vivam germanitates condendo propagare, atque eandem in ludis arte et marte inculcare.”; Oct. 1896 Vol. III No. 1 p. 1: “PAX & concordia inter gentes sic nonnisi alentur si litteræ Lñæ colantur, colentur autem si abrogatis chimæris, Gubernacula gentium culturarum sermonem Lñum vivum suscitent.”.

49 Sept. 1901 Vol. VII No. 12 p. 275: “Præiudicia eorum, apud quos Latinitas viva iam pridem oblivione interiit, nec eam nisi ex operibus Classicorum noverunt, immania et inutilia obstacula nobis obvolvunt.”; Mart. 1901 Vol. VII No. 6 p. 132: “Latinitas viva est vinculum et solum verum firmamentum Cœtus Romani”.

50 *The Fortnightly Review*. By Arthur Preuss 15 Sept. 1914 Vol. XXI No. 18 pp. 561-562: “LATIN AS A LIVING TONGUE // Our old friend, Dr. Arcadius Avellanus, of “Praeco Latinus” fame, is still alive, and engaged in his favorite occupation of popularizing “living” Latin. Recently he has translated into Latin Ruskin’s “The King of the Golden River” <...> Latin here is a living tongue, and if the age of Cicero, or of Ulpian, or even of St. Isidore of Seville, knew no word for coal, it is for us to invent one – observing, as far as possible, the rules of the game, and, if necessary, adding a footnote of justification.”.

51 Lurz (1949): the title has “Die moderne Lateinbewegung”.

52 Wagner (1941a): the title has “a neolatin mozgalom” in Hungarian, “de Neolatino qui dicitur motu” in Latin.

53 Alexey Slednikov (in Latin: Slednikov (2016a, 6), in Russian: Slednikov (2016b, 371)) indicates where the terms appear in the 1936-1937 issues of *Societas Latina*, the Interwar Munich Latin journal. Slednikov (2016a, 6): “Sed mea quidem sententia lingua Latina viva haud serius quam extremo sæculo XIX^o quo prima exstarent conata de usu Latinitatis in Europa restituendo, orta est. Iam enim annis prioris sæculi 30^{is} in commentariis periodicis illius ætatis locationes ‘lebendiges Latein (i.e. lingua Latina viva)’ (*Soc. Lat.* 4, 71), ‘Latinum vivum’ (*Soc. Lat.* 5, 46), ‘Latino vivente’ (*Soc. Lat.* 7, 16-17), ‘die moderne Lateinbewegung’ (*Soc. Lat.* 1, 13; 15; 15, 1; 16, 1; 17, 1; 18, 1) oculis occurrunt.”. This was paralleled by the Budapest Latin journal *Iuventus* – see page 168 and footnote 755.

54 So, for example, Beach (1964); Lenard and Drake (1967); Kobler (1965, 1): “The institute will further undertake two practical projects to promote living Latin: the formulation of standard Latin terms for words of modern origin and the development of textbooks (appropriately called the “Veterum Sapientia Series”) for schools following the pedagogical principles elaborated by *Veterum Sapientia* and its directives.”; *Unesco Chronicle* 1959 Vol. 5 p. 308: “inspired by new methods, enlivened with tricks of presentation, provided with illustrations, inspired by the idea of what is called ‘living Latin’.”; Morot-Sir (1962, 1): “the same pedagogical method should be applied to Latin as is

became an influential, possibly predominant term by the end of the 20th century to describe both the use of the Latin language and the communicative teaching of it.⁵⁵ The Latin term *Latinitas Viva* has been prolifically used by such promoters of Latin as the Benedictine monk Caelestis Eichenseer (1924-2008), who used it for naming all of his projects, summer schools and publications;⁵⁶ it became a general self-designation. The term *Living Latin* (and its cognates) has been used up to this day for naming organizations concerned with the promotion both of the use of Latin and of the communicational methods for teaching it;⁵⁷ events (seminars, summer schools, conferences), regular university courses and instructional material often bear this name,⁵⁸ not mentioning the excessive use of the term in the content of journals published in Latin⁵⁹ and in various online content.

So today the notion of *Living Latin* might mean both the educational strategy of incorporating more active language methodology in teaching it (speaking, writing exercises, conversation)⁶⁰ and the idea of Latin as a language of international communication. It can be used both as a slogan of the movement and as a general term for this wide concept. Likewise the

applied to any other language. This idea constitutes the basis of the present-day movement in favor of “latin vivant” (living Latin) – which signifies making efforts towards regaining a level of linguistic knowledge which has been gradually sinking for a century.”.

- 55 From a preliminary book and scholarly paper survey (date-bracketed Google Books and JSTOR searches, among others), it seems that the term *Living Latin* became more general in English towards the end of the 20th century, in the 1990s. In 1997, the newly established association *SALVI* (see footnote 57) proclaims in its website that it is “propagating an active approach to the language known as *Latinitas Viva*, Living Latin.” (<https://web.archive.org/web/19970626014837/http://www.latin.org/english/naills/about.html>, also in O’Neill (1998, 88)). Thus *Living Latin* movement seems to have gradually cemented into a generally used concept. For example, the 2008 *CAMWS* conference had a panel titled “The Living Latin Movement in the 21st Century” (<https://web.archive.org/web/20090505042713/http://www.camws.org/meeting/2008/program/abstracts/11d1-5.Llewellyn.Soter.PatrickR.McGowan.Engelsing.html>).
- 56 The series of seminars started by Eichenseer in 1973 bear this name up to this day. An early example: in the periodical edited by Eichenseer (*Vox Latina* 1977 Vol. 13 No. 49 pp. 248-249) in a section called “Seminaria Latinitatis Vivae anno 1978° futura” the University of Leeds announces “A short course on SPOKEN LATIN (LATINITAS VIVA) 10-14 April 1978”. Eichenseer also published a book series titled *Latinitas Viva* (e.g., Eichenseer (1982)).
- 57 Several examples: *Vita Latina* (founded in France in 1958), *LVPA* = *Latinitati Vivae Provehendae Associatio* (founded in Germany in 1987), *SALVI* = *Septentrionale Americanum Latinitatis Vivae Institutum* = *North American Institute for Living Latin Studies* (founded in USA in 1996).
- 58 So, for example, *Paideia Institute for Humanistic Study, Inc.* (founded in 2010 in New York) has *Living Latin* for their online course and *Living Latin in Rome* for the Rome-based one. *CÆLVM* = *Cursus Aestivus Latinitatis Vivae Matritensis* has been happening since 2013 in Madrid and expanded the use of the term into Greek: ΟΥΠΑΝΟΣ (first time in 2019, continued after the Covid-19 pandemic in 2022) is subtitled “Curso de verano de Griego antiguo vivo”. In Poland (University of Poznań) *Schola Aestiva Latinitatis Graecitatisque Vivae Posnaniensis* (or *Letnia Szkoła Żywej Łaciny*) has been happening since 2001. The Polis Institute (Jerusalem) recently published a textbook *Forum: Lectiones Latinitatis Vivae* (Blanchard et al. 2018). The University of Manchester and Vilnius University have *Living Latin* as an elective course for undergraduates. This is a least exhaustive list – examples abound.
- 59 Especially *Vox Latina* (edited by Sigrid Albert and published by *Societas Latina* and the Saarland University) in Saarbrücken and *Melissa* (edited by Guy Licoppe and Françoise Deraedt, published by the *Melissa* foundation) in Brussels.
- 60 For example, Hunt (2023, 37) uses *Living Latin* to label a whole family of teaching approaches (reminiscent of the Interwar French sources): “The three main teaching approaches employed in the study of Latin can be broadly defined as the grammar-translation approach, the reading approach and the Living Latin approach.”.

scholarship also uses this notion often in a similarly broad way, alternating in the usage between the focus on the teaching method and the use of Latin.⁶¹

However, the term has not been unchallenged and without criticism. The term *Living Latin*, if taken literally, could be seen as an oxymoron causing misunderstandings. Latin is not the same as the living languages – it has no native speakers⁶² and is not evolving in the grammatical sense, its grammar and basic vocabulary being fixed to the norms of the literary canon that formed in the first century BC and the first century AD. So the truly natural “living language” phase of Latin occurred prior to most of its “life” as a functioning language – the question of Latin’s being “dead” or “alive” is a subtle one. Wilfried Stroh sees this linguistic fossilisation of the language as the “death” that would later ensure “eternal life and beauty” for Latin,⁶³ and so the afterlife after its *mors immortalis*⁶⁴ proves Latin’s vitality and makes the question of its deadness or aliveness irrelevant – the death of Latin itself is seen as full of vitality, its life and death are joined together in its immortality. On the other hand Jürgen Leonhardt, writing later, avoids the dichotomy between life and death and finds that this gradual transition of Latin from being a “normal” living language resulted in a “fixed language”,⁶⁵ “a historical culture language that was completely independent of its living language community”.⁶⁶ In this capacity it was “a living world language”⁶⁷ and “as long as

61 So, for example, Lloyd (2017) titles her doctoral thesis “Living Latin: exploring a communicative approach to Latin teaching through a sociocultural perspective on language learning” treating Living Latin as a teaching methodology, while Slednikov (2019a) titles his monograph (and also his doctoral thesis) “Reception of the Ancient heritage: the movement of “Living Latin” ” (*Рецепция античного наследия: движение «живой латыни»*) and surveys the movement for the use of Latin and discusses the linguistic aspects of adapting Latin to modern use.

62 Even if Latin had native speakers (the case of Michel de Montaigne and other cases of native Latin ability are treated in pages 43 ff.), they would not become an authority in language usage by the sole virtue of being native speakers, as the Latin language is ultimately defined by the written legacy rather than the living tradition. A comparison to the case of Esperanto is instructive: it does have about a thousand of native speakers, but they “do not enjoy prestige status in the speech community” and “do not provide the basis for linguistic correctness” (Fiedler 2012, 76).

63 Stroh (2008, 7): “optimo iure affirmo eam linguam non nunc, sed duo milia abhinc annorum vita defunctam esse, eam autem mortem, si mors omnino dicenda sit, quasi aeternae vitae ac pulchritudinis fuisse causam”; the “deaths” of Latin are also narrated in Stroh (2007). See also footnote 951, where Luigi Miraglia cites Wilfried Stroh approvingly. However, this idea might be much older; already in 1744 the German Lutheran church historian Johann Lorenz von Mosheim (1693-1755) connected Latin’s death with its beauty and immortality in a very similar fashion, contrasting its perennial youth with the living languages where due to the language change only the writings of the most recent generations retain a fresh appearance: “Alia longe ratio & fortuna est linguarum, quae in usu esse desierunt & mortuae appellantur. His ipsa mors immortalitatem parit: facit nempe, ut, communi lege solutae, formam, quam habent, constanter servant, nec amplius mutationis aliquid subeant. Cujus rei hic fructus est minime contemnendus, ut pulchra semper, grata, luculenta maneant, incertamque & mobilem rerum humanarum conditionem effugiant, quae illis semel scite & pulchre in litteras relata sunt.” (Noltenius and Mosheim 1744, 25).

64 Title of a chapter in Stroh (2008).

65 Leonhardt (2013, 19): “The term *fixed* is more precise in some important respects than the concept of *dead* language. Even more than the term *codification*, it leaves open what part of the language has become unchangeable. A fixed language is therefore not a language that is closed and can no longer develop but a language in which several core components remain unchangeable, while other parts continue to evolve as in any other normal language.”

66 Leonhardt (2013, 88)

67 Leonhardt (2013, 150)

it was in active use, this Latin “second language” remained a living language”.⁶⁸ Most recently Philipp Roelli, investigating the “Latin as a language of science and learning”, borrows this paradigm and, developing it further, notes that “Latin in the past one and a half millennia was not a dead language but (among other things) a living, although fixed, language of erudition”.⁶⁹ The search of a good metaphor for describing what Latin was during its long centuries of use is ongoing: even if Latin through most of its history can hardly be studied through the approaches of modern linguistics emphasising the authentic native and oral aspects of the language (which are lacking for a “dead” language), it clearly was a functioning and a (partially) developing language, even if its grammatical structure and basic vocabulary were *fixed* and its oral aspect always secondary and subordinated to the written one.

So considering this difference in the nature of the language, using the term *Living Latin* might be misleading – using seemingly the same label for Latin as for the “normal” living languages could imply that Latin is considered completely as one of them and could be treated as such.⁷⁰ Maybe that’s one of the reasons why several other terms have come into use recently (mostly to represent the teaching methodology): *Spoken Latin*,⁷¹ *Conversational Latin*,⁷² *Communicative Latin*,⁷³ *Oral Latin*,⁷⁴ *Active Latin*, *Perennial Latin*.⁷⁵ Out of these terms, *Active Latin* is trending and

68 Leonhardt (2013, 146)

69 Roelli (2021, 377), followed by an observation: “The linguistics of fixed languages is a field that has hardly been trodden as yet.”

70 Owens (2016, 508-510), a prominent Latin speaker himself, uses *active Latin* consistently and, taking the traditional hard linguistic distinction between “dead” and “living” languages, criticises the usage of the term *Living Latin*: “The term “living Latin” is itself misleading. Linguistically speaking, Latin is a dead language (i.e., it does not change in some significant ways) and has been dead for nearly two thousand years. This fact is not lost on the greatest proponents of spoken Latin.”. So, taking a cautious approach, Owens argues that if Latin were to be considered a living language and treated as such, this could overshadow the point of its greatest strength, namely, its stability and immutability (“If Latin were to come back from the dead, so to speak, it would immediately lose its greatest virtue: its substantial immutability.”), and this could encourage a negligent attitude to the language (“Since it is the standard literary language that classicists want students to learn, the project of active Latin is self-defeating when it gives rise to a barbarous dialect of Latin, which, in its most extreme form, is actually a new Romance dialect.”). This is one example of the possible lines of criticism. Later in this thesis it will be seen that similar caveats were in fact expressed many times historically – opinions of Heumann, Gesner, Eichstädt are treated in the section about the *civitas Latina* projects (chapter 2.2 and especially 2.2.2 from p. 48 and 2.2.5 from p. 65).

71 Kobler (1966); Gratiús Avitus (2018). An often used general term. See footnote 56 – in 1977 the term *Latinitas Viva* was translated as *Spoken Latin* for English speakers.

72 The Latin summer seminars organised by the University of Kentucky have been subtitled as *Conversational Latin* seminars (<https://web.archive.org/web/20150710211020/https://mcl.as.uky.edu/conventiculum-latinum>, Coffee (2012, 258))

73 Barrios-Lech (2022), p. 1: “a brief historical overview of the “Communicative” or “Active Latin” movement”, p. 4: “The term “Communicative Latin” means Latin taught in ways other than Grammar-Translation (GT). Some prefer “Active” Latin, without, of course, implying that other approaches are somehow not active. Neither label should be, but is often, confused with “Conversational Latin”, a term which conjures images of people talking about the weather, what pizza toppings to order, or birthday presents received.”

74 Minkova and Tunberg (2005)

75 Berard (2008) in naming the movement emphasises the continuity of Latin (“To those of us involved in the current Perennial Latin movement”) and introduces the concept of a *perennial language* (such as Latin or Sanskrit). The Latin equivalent of this term (*Latinitas Perennis*) is used by the Living Latin activists: e.g., the Latin periodical *Melissa* is subtitled “FOLIA PERENNI LATINITATI DICATA”.

is now probably the most influential competitor⁷⁶ to *Living Latin* for designating the method of teaching Latin in an *active* (as opposed to *passive*)⁷⁷ manner by *actively using the language*. The term is often used for presenting teaching methodologies involving an active use of Latin (listening, speaking, writing), for naming such courses and seminars or summer schools,⁷⁸ sometimes even for the movement of using Latin itself.⁷⁹ It is reasonable to concede that there exists no term agreed on by every practitioner of this family of pedagogical methods⁸⁰ – the extensive variety of terminology used is somewhat similar to the situation of the Reform Movement at the turn of the 19th century.

Notwithstanding the arguable conceptual issues (confusion with the living languages) and the existence of competing terms, I use the term *Living Latin* in this thesis consistently. The terms *Spoken*, *Conversational*, *Oral Latin* are meant primarily for oral communication – as such they are very suitable as a pedagogical label for designating a particular classroom experience, but they do not showcase the written aspect. Likewise, the terms *Communicative* and *Active Latin* are good functional descriptions of what is happening (namely, the communication in Latin and the active use of the language), but the terms are mostly related to the pedagogy of the language, while the

76 Lloyd and Hunt (2021, 1): “We were also aware of the various labels used in ancient language institutions in the US and Europe including ‘active’ and ‘living’ as descriptors of teaching approaches.” (the terms are on equal footing); Djinis (2023) notes the different terminology used in the Paideia Institute (quoting Jason Pedicone) and in the Jesus College of the University of Oxford (quoting Melinda Letts): *Living Latin* and *Active Latin*, respectively.

77 Already in 1984 Caelestis Eichenseer published a booklet “Latein aktiv” (Eichenseer 1984) and spoke there about the development of active skills in the language (*wo das aktive Sprechen des Lateinischen gefördert wird*). It seems that the real shift away from the term *Living Latin* started in the 2010s. While the term *Active Latin* was used in the language teaching scholarship of the earlier decades (for example, in Wills (1998); Neumann (2008)), the inflection point heralding the current widespread use of the term might be in the two influential papers published in 2012 which use the term *Active Latin* exclusively (Coffee (2012) and Minkova and Tunberg (2012)), as the number of papers using the term increase dramatically after this and they it starts getting used like a slogan. The opposition of *active* to *passive* learning is implicit in the term (it is explicitly noted by Minkova and Tunberg (2012, 113): “the primarily passive approach to learning and using Latin that is regarded today as the received approach is not in fact very old”), but often this implication is avoided evidently due to diplomatic reasons (Slocum Bailey (2019, 94): “The implied opposite would be *passive Latin*; as it is doubtful that teachers anywhere would define their courses or methods as passive, the term *active Latin* can sound like an indictment of some other approach to which no one actually subscribes.”; see also footnote 73).

78 In 2019 there was a conference panel “What Can ‘Active’ Latin Accomplish?” in the *Society for Classical Studies* Annual Meeting; throughout the five papers *Active Latin* is used consistently (Keeline (2019) is the first one in the issue); the term is often used by Lloyd and Hunt (2021). The website of the Jesus College of the University of Oxford notes “Since 2019 Jesus College has pioneered the use of Active Latin, that is the method of teaching Latin in Latin.” (<https://www.jesus.ox.ac.uk/study-here/undergraduate-studies/available-subjects/classics/>); *Oxford Latinitas* company uses the term in its advertisements: “At Oxford Latinitas we teach and study ancient languages using the Active Method.” (<https://www.oxfordlatinitas.org/language-courses-latin-ancient-greek-courses/>); the University of Kentucky: “The use of Active Latin is not merely a matter of pedagogy: it is a matter of forming and maintaining a close relationship with the Latin language.” (<https://mcl.as.uky.edu/latin-institute>, Lloyd (2016), Minkova and Tunberg (2021)).

79 Lloyd (2016, 47) quotes Terence Tunberg: “There was a Frenchman, Prof Jean Capelle, who put on a huge Active Latin conference in Avignon in 1956”. So the term *Active Latin* might sometimes even be applied retroactively to what was known to the contemporaries as the movement of *Living Latin* / *latin vivant*.

80 Ramsby (2020, 20) summarises a survey of Latin teachers: “Practitioners who apply these innovations are located all over the United States, and refer to this new phase in a number of ways. Comprehensible Input, Spoken Latin, Active Latin, Communicative Latin, Proficiency through Reading and Storytelling, and Latin Language Acquisition are some of the labels applied. Each label in that list involves nuances of methodology and practice, but it is safe to say that all of them place value on the practice of speaking the target language, Latin, in the classroom.”

term *Living Latin* does more: it seems to capture an essential *idea* the movement has been about – it strives to assert and demonstrate the *vitality* of Latin in opposition and reaction to its reputation as a *dead* and static language.

This notion encompasses both of the strands which can hardly be separated (they are often combined even in the same person), the first being the reform of the language pedagogy, and the second being the use, the possible modernisation of the language and the various imagined roles for it. In the first case, the *livingness* of Latin is contrasted with the teaching methods which are considered *dead*. In the second case, the *livingness* of Latin is presented as an antidote to the widespread consideration by the society of Latin as a *dead* language. In both cases the usage of the notion of *Living Latin* does not mean that the language is considered to be alive in the strict sense of a usual living language, but it indicates a desire to reassert the vitality of Latin in reaction to its perceived obsolescence and the lack of vitality both in its teaching and use.

Another alternative term, *Perennial Latin*, emphasises the evergreen tradition and continuity of Latin and so the meaning also comes close to the notion of *Living Latin*. It emphasises another important aspect seen in the movement: a widespread belief in the value of the continuity of Latin. *Living Latin* proponents tend not to restrict themselves to reading the highest canon of Classical Latin authors exemplified by Cicero and Virgil, but rather tend to consider the two thousand years of Latin tradition as a valuable whole,⁸¹ and intend to engage with it and continue it in an active way. It seems that it would be hard to find a *Living Latin* enthusiast who would not argue for an expansive reading of Latin authors outside the classical canon, taking them from the whole history by including the Late Antique, Medieval and Renaissance authors, and those who wrote in Latin in the recent centuries up to this day. Due to this tendency, Neo-Latinists, namely the scholars who study the Latin writings of the recent centuries, are well represented among the *Living Latin* proponents, in fact, one could argue that there is a certain degree of overlap between the both communities.⁸²

81 See footnote 894 for Jozef IJsewijn's desire to unite Latinists of all fields. In fact, he thought that *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* could become the perfect platform for this, as it was the only organisation that managed to consider the whole of Latin tradition as an organic whole and that had among its members scholars representing all of the time periods. Licoppe (2014a, 246) describes the minutes of the 1990 session of *ALF*: "Respondet IJsewijn singularitatem Academiae in eo esse, quod prae ceteris consociationibus studiis Latinis deditis ea spectat ad totam Latinitatem, classicam, mediævalem, humanisticam et modernam, quam habet ut fundamentum culturæ Europææ, quin etiam mundanæ.". His remarks could be interpreted that it is in fact the *Living Latin* that is singular in considering the whole Latin tradition as an organic whole – after all, *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* arose from and represented the broader movement.

82 This remark has been made by Hendrickson (2018): "This is not to say that Neo-Latin literature has been entirely ignored within the Academy. There has always been a small, though intellectually thriving, contingent of Neo-Latinists. (This group overlaps to some extent with the burgeoning spoken Latin movement, though the two are not coterminous.)". The 2017 Latin-only congress of one of the most prominent organisations connected with the *Living Latin* movement, *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* (*ALF*), has been described as containing mostly Neo-Latin material (Kuhner 2018); the 2022 *ALF* congress had a similar focus (see

Let us examine again Stroh's definition of Living Latin given in the beginning of this section. Stroh says 1) that the term is employed "wherever, *bucking the general trend*" of decline Latin language is used, 2) that the Living Latin activists may operate outside the traditional realms of surviving Latin (schools, universities and the Church), 3) that new phenomena like radio news in Latin should be distinguished from the "traditional forms" like the diplomas of honorary doctorates *honoris causa*. All of these taken together imply that some kind of intentionality was needed to break out of the general course of decline; and it shone through in innovative ways. So Stroh's definition already includes *intentionality* implicitly, but we can make this *intentionality* explicit in the definition of Living Latin used in this thesis.

The metaphor in the term *Living Latin* provides the criterion for separating the proper *Living Latin* movement from any generic surviving traditional use of Latin in the 20th century: it is *the conviction in the vitality of Latin and the intention to assert and demonstrate it*. This conviction provides the motivation for using Latin actively *in spite of* the general trend of its abandonment. Thus we can distinguish the writings of a Living Latin activist from, e.g., the numerous textbooks and lecture notes professors in the pontifical universities of Rome used to compose in Latin for the student use until the 1960s, even if this material is contemporary to the Living Latin one. Where the use of Latin persists naturally, it often becomes a formality or a practicality done without a second thought by its users, whereas the Living Latin movement is predicated on a constant and conscious reflection of the use of Latin and on its advocacy. Rather than just retaining the ongoing traditional use of Latin through inertia, the Living Latin movement is expansive – it searches for and fills new niches where Latin might never had been used before. The *intentionality* makes the Latin in marble plaques and in honorary doctorate ceremonies qualitatively different from the Latin used in new media such as radio news or podcasts.⁸³

So the Living Latin movement is composed of those who are convinced in the *vitality* of Latin and who choose to demonstrate it by actively using the language both inside and outside the classroom, thus returning the communicational aspect to the language and fighting the dominant reputation of Latin being a dead and obsolete language.

This does not mean that these activist defenders of Latin are united in how they view the language and how it should be treated. The emphasised value of Latin might be either centred in its

<https://academialatinitatifoendae.com/s/programma-conventus-ALF-Romani.pdf> and the conference proceedings De Mico et al. (2023a) and De Mico et al. (2023b)). These remarks apply to the current state of the movement; in the earlier decades, the Classical themes were seemingly more prominent in the Living Latin community, judging from the programmes of the congresses.

83 This is the distinction between the traditional and innovative forms of Latin Stroh also tried to delineate in his definition of Living Latin. This dividing line is necessarily a blurry one and in some cases can be a matter of discussion, but making this general distinction is very important for the thesis, enabling me to narrow the scope of investigations.

practicality or its cultural value. Some of the activists might be convinced that Latin should prove and demonstrate its suitability today for treating all modern topics and technical inventions, while others might be focusing on continuing the literary and cultural tradition of the use of Latin and using Latin primarily (or exclusively) for treating the respective topics. Likewise, some of them might dream about Latin becoming a practical general-topic international language once again, while others might prefer that this use would be restricted to topics relevant to the tradition. Some of them might be convinced of the need for Latin language to be “enriched” by modern terminology, while others might see this as an unnecessary (and possibly harmful) distraction. Some of them might be professional academics, others might be amateurs. Some might emphasise the existence of the modern Living Latin movement and their indebtedness to its pioneers, others might bypass this topic altogether and instead emphasise the unbroken continuity of the Latin tradition.

Nonetheless, this conventional umbrella term of *Living Latin* is able to encompass this variety, provided that the adjective *Living* is connected to the belief in Latin’s vitality and to the desire to demonstrate this rather than to Latin’s literal similarity to ordinary living languages. *Living Latin*, broadly defined, seems to capture an idea essential to the “movement” with its admittedly quite diverse proponents, enabling it to be analysed as a whole. Moreover, the term has already been applied to the phenomenon, making it both historically and conceptually suitable for the task.

This sort of belief in Latin’s vitality is a particular kind of reception of Antiquity that needs to be distinguished from other conceptions of the vitality of the Greco-Roman culture. So, for example, Classicism had a high regard of Classical Antiquity; but it aimed to draw ideas, images, forms, models, symbols from it, and to use them (e.g., in architecture) or depict them (e.g., as a statue depicting a mythological composition) in new creations. If any Latin or Greek was used in this context, it was a symbol rather than the medium of creation. But at the time of the early Living Latin movement – the late 19th and early 20th centuries – another movement was important, namely Modernism. It also saw the Classical heritage as something vital and as a material for creating something new; the difference being that it had a less literal view of what a borrowing or inspiration is and it enjoyed fragmentary allusions in its metaphors. In contrast, the humanistic-minded proponents of Latin saw the language and culture as something to be retained *whole*, it imagined a certain integrality and continuity.

This contrast in approaches can be seen in the collaboration of W. H. D. Rouse with Ezra Pound in discussing Rouse’s translations of the *Odyssey*.⁸⁴ Both men shared a very high regard of the Greeks, but had a different view of what following them means. For Rouse, who taught the

84 Described in Stray (1992, 61-68).

speaking of Ancient Greek in his classes as the gateway to the Greek culture, the text of the *Odyssey* itself was a living thing and a *direct* access to it was the objective; for Pound, the true approach to Homer was seeing the patterns *beyond* the text.⁸⁵ Rouse's tastes were different, distinctly antimodernist – when he saw some of Ezra's *Cantos*, he did not think that they were complete works of art rather than mere drafts: "I can only say that they seem to be materials for a work, but I want to see the work itself. It has no form yet, & without form it cannot charm".⁸⁶

In 2013 the difference between Living Latin and the Modernist programme was demonstrated by Ivano Dionigi in his inaugural speech as the first president of the *Pontifical Academy of Latin* (*Pontificia Academia Latinitatis*). Dionigi used T. S. Eliot's authority as an argument against Living Latin⁸⁷ and cited his words: "it is important that they (= *Latin and Greek*) are dead, because through their death we have come into our inheritance".⁸⁸ Dionigi asserts that the only meaningful reception of Classics is their "conquest" by transformation, implying that the Living Latin movement with its emphasis on the continued active use of Latin is a sterile anachronism uncritically copying the past. This exchange shows how polyvalent the semantics of life and death of Latin and Greek in the culture are and how the different concepts of Latin's *vitality* inform different approaches to the classical heritage. The Living Latin movement has always been aware of this tension between the ancient perennial language and modernity – the very use of Latin

85 Stray (1992, 61): "Where Rouse had tried to persuade his audience to listen directly to the words of the Greeks, Pound insisted that he must go through the text to the patterned energies beneath it. For Rouse's doctrine of the 'living word', he substituted that of the 'life beneath the words'. [...] It did not follow that their literary tastes were at all similar. Rouse was resolutely antimodernist, and the most recent author he really enjoyed reading seems to have been Charles Dickens."; *ibid.*, p. 62: "However different their tastes in literature were in some respects, for both men Greek symbolised a freshness and freedom which promised the release they sought from inert ideas and tired words."; p. 65: "A more serious problem was that, as I have mentioned, whereas Rouse saw the life of the story as contained in the text, for Pound the text was a manifestation of a pattern of energies existing at a deeper level."

86 Stray (1992, 62)

87 Dionigi (2013): "Fondamento. C'è una ricerca ossessiva delle radici e dell'identità che non piace e che non giova, propria dei sopravvissuti. Penso a certe *sodalitates* che sfidando il ridicolo e nuocendo alla causa pretendono di recuperare anacronisticamente e sterilmente il latino come lingua viva a tutti i costi. No; io sto con Eliot, grande ammiratore della classicità e in particolare della lingua di Virgilio, il quale amava dire che il latino è lingua morta, irrimediabilmente morta e fortunatamente morta, cosicché noi possiamo spartircene l'eredità; ma un'eredità da conquistare, non già un feticcio da ossequiare, secondo quanto ci ammoniva il Goethe del *Faust*: « ciò che hai ereditato dai padri, riconquistalo se vuoi possederlo davvero ».». Later he repeated his statement: "Io sto con Eliot: il latino è una lingua morta, fortunatamente morta così che possiamo spartircene l'eredità. Dobbiamo recuperare la cultura latina anche se non necessariamente dobbiamo parlare latino." (<https://it.aletia.org/2014/02/07/i-tweet-in-latino-di-franciscus-il-successo-di-una-lingua-morta/>, consulted 15.8.2023).

88 Eliot (1945, 28) and Eliot (1957, 67): "Nor, on one count or another, can we expect to find the proximate approach to the classic in *any* modern language. It is necessary to go to the two dead languages: it is important that they are dead, because through their death we have come into our inheritance – the fact that they are dead would in itself give them no value, apart from the fact that all the peoples of Europe are their beneficiaries.". The context of this quote is a discussion of the universality of Virgil as the universal classic of all Europe, so the *deadness* of the language here means its *pan-European neutrality* rather than, as Dionigi implies, a specific statement on the desirability of a particular way of its cultivation that would emphasise its "deadness" in contrast to "livingness". Speaking Latin does not make the language any less neutral or universal.

today is not simply an effortless anachronism rising from inertia, but rather a conscious struggle, conquest and transformation of the language and its heritage to make it one's own.

1.3 Scope of the thesis

In the thesis I concentrate on the proponents who argued for an expanded use and functions of Latin and who provided an example in the active use of it. The aims and the scope of this purported restoration were various, but all proponents were convinced that Latin has a certain vitality that needs to be explored. Taking them as representatives of a distinct movement of Living Latin, I detail their interaction with the (receptive? deaf?) world, and I place this in the relevant historical sociocultural context. I focus on the advocacy of Latin and on its applicability to the context of the times – the apologies for Latin can indicate where a particular society (e.g., the Interwar Italy) is going culturally and so can become an insightful tool relevant to the broader field of cultural studies.

Even if the *Living Latin* movement's focus on the use and vitality of Latin language is often closely related to the question of the use of the language in classroom, in this thesis I make no aim of covering the whole field of the teaching of Latin and the attempts to reform it. So the fortunes of W. H. D. Rouse's and his disciples' advocacy of the *Direct Method* as applied to Latin, or that of Hans Ørberg's Latin language textbook⁸⁹ are important for the movement of Living Latin, which today overlaps to a substantial degree⁹⁰ with the adoption of Ørberg's textbook, but ultimately they are fields of their own right.

I follow the definition of Living Latin with a distinction (initially introduced by Wilfried Stroh) between traditional and innovative forms of Latin. Therefore, in the present thesis I do not intend to detail the persistence or the decline of the use of Latin in various fields where it had traditionally been used: theological and ecclesiastical writings, species descriptions in botany, the use of Latin in prefaces to the critical editions of classical Roman writings. *Living Latin* is primarily concerned with the apologetics for the return of the use of Latin – and if a particular field simply continues to use Latin, this is probably not a matter to be connected with the Living Latin movement. So, for example, if the Catholic Church in mid-20th century is still publishing lecture notes in Latin for the use of students of pontifical universities in Rome, this phenomenon is not in direct scope of the present study. However, if enthusiasts of Latin located in the same Church have

89 First published as *Lingua Latina secundum naturae rationem explicata* (as presented in Ørberg (1960); first fascicle Ørberg (1954)), from 1990 as *Lingua Latina per se illustrata* (Ricucci 2015a, 65).

90 This symbiosis between the teaching reformers and the advocates of the modern international use of Latin has already been noticed by Guérard (1921, 58), who lists various contemporary Latin periodicals and continues: "Here may be noted a separate but parallel movement for teaching Latin in a more modern spirit and by more modern methods: "*Ora Maritima*," "*Sprechen Sie Lateinisch?*" etc."

founded and published a journal in Latin (*Latinitas*, 1953-), then it *is* a statement for promoting the usage of Latin and it falls under the scope of Living Latin and of the present study.

Likewise with the academia engaging with Latin: if an organisation is being formed by academic personnel for promoting Latin (*Vita Latina*, *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*, *Societas Latina*), it falls in the direct scope of Living Latin and of the thesis. However, if a journal traditionally accepts articles in Latin (for example, *Gnomon* still lists Latin as one of the five languages contributions may be written in)⁹¹ or critical editions of classical texts have Latin prefaces (e.g., *Bibliotheca Teubneriana* or *Oxford Classical texts / Scriptorum Classicorum Bibliotheca Oxoniensis*), they are not directly in scope of the thesis, even if they might provide a valuable piece of cultural context.

The focus on the advocacy/apologetics of Latin means that two other fields, while related to the phenomenon of Living Latin, are not treated exhaustively and are referenced only on a case-by-case basis. The first of them is the arguably continuous tradition of translating modern (often children's) literature to Latin for educational purposes in order to provide engaging supplemental reading material: instances of it can be found already in the latter half of the 18th century, while in the 20th and 21st the examples are too numerous to list⁹². The second field consists of the neologisms introduced in Latin as part of the project to make it suitable for modern use.⁹³ Focusing on the survey and analysis of these fields, even if it would be worthwhile, would move the thesis from its socio-cultural focus and greatly expand its scope. Nonetheless, both the translations and the neologisms are in fact statements for various uses of Latin, so they get covered when the need arises.

1.4 Structure and methodology of the thesis

This thesis aims to write a sociocultural history of the Living Latin movement. To understand Living Latin, we need to understand how its phenomena are interlinked, what conditions and influences they emerged in and what ideologies and figures drove them. I am studying Living Latin's development, its ideology and identity.

91 An extensive index of scholarly journals accepting submissions in Latin has recently been published by *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*: "Commentarii periodici, qui symbolas Latino sermone scriptas accipiunt, sunt e.g. Aevum, Arctos, Aristeas, Eos, commentarii Societatis Philologiae Polonorum, Eranos, Exemplaria Classica, Giornale Italiano di Filologia, Gnomon, Hermes, Hyperboreus, Latinitas, Latomus, Melissa, Museum Helveticum, Peitho: examina antiqua, Philologia Classica, Renascens, Rheinisches Museum für Philologie, Rhetorica, Symbolae Philologorum Posnanensium, Tyche, Vox Latina." (<https://academialatinitatifovendae.com/certamen-quirinale>, consulted 12.8.2023).

92 See Appendix A.1 for a brief overview of the history of the tradition of translating children's literature into Latin.

93 Neologisms form the focus of several recent studies of Living Latin: Loch (2012), Krukowska (2017), Slednikov (2019a).

The thesis is bound by the time period of the phenomenon, which is taken to begin in the end of the 19th century, when the first internationally distributed periodicals published in Latin and advocating for the return to Latin appeared, and continues until today. However, for the purposes of the thesis I limit the reasonable coverage of the phenomena to about 2000 and the last initiatives mentioned to about 2010. This is due to methodological and space constraints – I centre my thesis around organisations, paper-based periodicals and congresses, which used to leave a paper trail, meaning that the paper-based sources (complemented with living memory, interviews) are able to cover them reasonably well. However, in the last decade these traditional manifestations and veteran organisations of the Living Latin movement are no longer as central as they used to be: due to the expansion of Internet-based communication possibilities the phenomenon is now much more decentralised and, in order to take account of it, one would need to heavily rely on the research on quite ephemeral Internet-based communities and media, which would in turn require quite different working methodologies.

The thesis is structured on a chronological basis. The whole investigated time range from about 1880 to about 2000 is divided into three eras: 1) from 1880 to the First World War, 2) the Interwar period, 3) the period after the Second World War.⁹⁴ For every era, I survey the cultural environment, the movements ascribed to the Living Latin phenomenon, selecting prominent and representative defenders of Latin, who then I treat in more detail. They expounded their views on the restoration of the use of Latin and tried to achieve this aim. Their activities usually included publishing their own journals composed in Latin, proposing ways how the language (its style, vocabulary, teaching methods) would be adapted to its imagined role, rallying other supporters of the idea around them and aiming for or at least thinking about the legitimacy of the movement. I treat their biographies, writings, views, communities of Latin proponents who assembled around them, the context of time and place. A mosaic of these snapshots taken together with their cultural context aims to provide a reasonable view of what Latin was to its defenders in different eras and how the cultural environments shaped these aims.

The writings of these proponents and journals are my first point of reference. Getting access to this severely under-explored and well hidden Latin-language corpus and surveying it was my first objective and a true challenge. This extensive corpus was reduced by identifying writings treating Living Latin as a subject (e.g., discussing its aims, purpose, reception), providing information about the connections between the Living Latin proponents and their relationship with the outside world and the projects they were thinking about and were trying to achieve. Taken together with various

⁹⁴ Due to these factors the last 15 years or so (if the 2010 dividing line is taken) could be tentatively considered the fourth era separate from the preceding one.

other archival data and several interviews I have taken from the current defenders of Living Latin, they form the primary sources used. The backbone of the thesis consists from a close reading and analysis of selected writings, taken together with an examination of the rest of the corpus to provide contextual information and using secondary sources (newspaper articles, papers in scholarly journals) to provide additional information about the facts and attitudes.

Questions for each selected proponent and period include: To which degree in this context did Living Latin respond to a societal need? What was the historical background of the author's interest? How was Living Latin to be taught, how was this teaching officially institutionalised? Were there links between the teaching of modern languages and Latin?

For the earliest period of Living Latin (1880-1914) the main figures examined are Arcadius Avellanus (*Mogyoróssy Árkád*, 1851-1935) and George Henderson (1860-1911). Both of them are figures embodying the worldwide aspirations of the Living Latin movement. George Henderson, a scion of a British newspaper publisher family, was an ardent enthusiast of the international language question, participating in multiple artificial language movements (including Esperanto) and creating multiple languages of his own; for a while he put his hopes in Latin and so he became the first one to try to create a worldwide organisation aiming to make Latin *the* international language once again. Arcadius Avellanus, a Hungarian émigré in the USA, published Latin journals (*Præco Latinus* 1894-1902, *Tusculum* 1893-?), translated multiple books of modern fiction into Latin and authored Latin language textbooks; he desired to reform the teaching of Latin so that it would be taught as a living language, then to unite all Latinists in some authoritative organisation and finally to make Latin a worldwide language.

When treating the Interwar period, I primarily concentrate on Italy and on its Latin revival movements which had ties both with the Catholic Church and with the Fascist state. The Catholic side of the movement is represented by Giuseppe Fornari (1869-1942), while the state supported one is represented by Carlo Galassi Paluzzi (1893-1972). Giuseppe Fornari, a Catholic lawyer and Latinist performing various services for the Roman Curia, managed and edited two Latin journals (*Vox Urbis* 1898-1913, *Alma Roma* 1914-1942) published in close association with the Vatican. Carlo Galassi Paluzzi, the founder and head of the *Institute of Roman Studies* (*Istituto di studi romani*), campaigned to make his institute the centre of the worldwide movement of Living Latin by 1) planning an *authoritative* dictionary of modern scientific terms in Latin, 2) organising the translation into Latin of scientific and scholarly paper summaries, 3) trying to create a coordination centre for the activities of disparate national movements of Latin, 4) organising contests of Latin prose and poetry.

For the period after the Second World War, I concentrate on several different branches. The first grouping is the “official” Living Latin movement, which started in the 1956 Latin congress organised in Avignon by Jean Capelle (1909-1983), the rector of the University of Nancy; this movement continues until today in form of the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*, a learned society uniting prominent Latin-speaking scholars, and of its regular congresses.

The second grouping consists of individual activists arguing for the renewal of Latin and for the return of its practical aspects to the modern use. Caelestis Eichenseer (1924-2008), a Benedictine monk who edited the Latin journal *Vox Latina* (1965-), was a prolific author of numerous modern-Latin materials and the first one to organise immersive Latin courses (1973-2007, more than 100); his journal continues to be published by Sigrid Albert (1952-) under the auspices of Saarland university. Guy Licoppe (1931-), a radiologist by profession, is the publisher of the Latin journal *Melissa* (1984-) and a historian of the Living Latin movement; he argued for Latin to be recognised as an official language of the European Union, and so he represents the pan-European dimension of Living Latin.

As the third branch I survey the Italian humanist movement, which is very different in its rhetoric. It is represented by Luigi Miraglia (1965-) and Giancarlo Rossi (1944-). Luigi Miraglia is a tireless promoter of the Humanistic culture and the Latin teaching methodology where Hans Ørberg’s textbook *Lingua Latina per se illustrata* is used to teach classical Latin as a living language, and also the founder and head of *Vivarium Novum*, an academy where Latin and Greek are languages of ever-day communication, providing a permanent language immersion environment for the students. Giancarlo Rossi, an architect by profession, has been involved in all of the branches of the Latin movement since the 1970s – a member of *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*, he is well acquainted with Eichenseer, Licoppe, Miraglia, he has also been participating in the Latin projects of the Vatican, contributing to the *Latinitas* (1953-) journal and participating in the compilation of *Lexicon Recentis Latinitatis*,⁹⁵ the Vatican-issued dictionary of modern Latin.

Some notes about the text of the thesis. In the thesis body text I translate every non-English quote, but in the footnotes I provide the original text, generally without translation. The footnotes are often long, as in them I try to provide both the bibliographical references and extensive quotations illustrating the points made in the thesis. The scientific method is founded on the virtues of reproducibility and falsifiability of the research; so a thorough referencing and quoting of the sources provides similar advantages to scholarship, enabling the reader to assess the arguments, to form and his or her own judgement, even if that means a visual overburdening of the page. Also, many of the sources referenced are hard to access, making direct quoting even more valuable.

95 Egger (1992); Egger (1997).

2 Before 1880. Imagined communities and the beaten tracks of *Living Latin*

Before examining the data mosaic of Living Latin – viz., its time periods and groupings represented by their notable proponents – it is meaningful to consider the broader Latin tradition. Two historical phenomena can help trace the (possibly *imagined*) historical ancestry of the Living Latin movement: the (re)constitution of the ideal imagined *Republic of Letters* (*res publica litterarum*) and the institution of a Latin city-state (*civitas Latina*).

2.1 *Res publica litteraria* – the Republic of Letters

One of the most persistent images in the Living Latin movement is that of the *Republic of Letters* (*res publica litterarum* / *res publica litteraria*), the imagined universal community of intellectuals, transcending borders in space and time. This image is first attested in the beginning of the 15th century, when in 1417 the young Venetian humanist Francesco Barbaro (1390-1454) congratulated the veteran manuscript hunter Poggio Bracciolini (1380-1459) for his discoveries and praised him for having done a great service to the whole *respublica litteraria*, implying the community of learned humanists.⁹⁶ By the age of Erasmus in the beginning of the 16th century this image was already fully formed and frequently used, its relevance greatly strengthened by the invention of the printing press in the mid-15th century.⁹⁷

The Latin term *litterae*, used in the name, could be applied to the concept in the broadest possible sense, including these aspects: all sorts of learning (*bonae litterae* can mean basically any positive intellectual endeavour, especially studying and acquiring disciplined knowledge), general education and erudition (*vir litteratus*: an educated man), literature (a concept not yet clearly

96 The discovery and attribution of the first mention of the concept belongs to Eisenstein (1980, 137), who cites the English edition of Bracciolini's letters by Gordan (1974, 199). Influential treatments of this first mention and the history of the concept include Fumaroli (1988) and Fumaroli (2018). Barbaro writes: "Vos vero quid non estis consecuti, cum Oratores, Poetas, Historicos, Astronomos, Grammaticos, qui jam sine ulla dubitatione deleti erant, restituistis? Profecto non usitatus honor, aut pervulgatus vobis tribuendus est, sed novi singularesque debentur. Ignominia etiam notandi sunt illi Germani, qui clarissimos Viros, quorum vita ad omnem memoriam sibi commendata esse debuit, quantum in se fuit, vivos diuturno tempore sepultos tenuerunt. Quod si imprudenter factum est, quid negligentius? Si ex sententia, quid crudelius? An quisquam ita invidus erit, ut vos nimium exornari a me censeat? Quos autem orno? Eos nempe, *qui huic litterariae Reip. plurima adjumenta, atque ornamenta contulerunt*." The citation is taken from Barbarus (1743, 4-5), the recent critical edition is Barbaro (1999, 75); italics added for emphasis. The letter has also been discussed by Griggio (1996, 357-362), Poggio's response to this letter is treated by Marcellino (2017).

97 Cf. Miert, Hotson and Wallnig (2019, 26): "Likewise in Latin, alternative designations abounded in the early modern period, including *orbis eruditorum* ('the world of the learned'), the *sodalitas doctorum* ('the fraternity of the learned'), *mundus litterarius* ('the learned world'), *omnis litteratorum cohors* ('the cohort of all men of letters')." See also footnote 119.

defined or distinguished at the time), and the letters on the exchange of which the connections between the contemporaries were based. One became a citizen of this republic by learning Latin (and Greek), acquiring the humanist education, creating texts (both learned and artful) and communicating with like-minded people, forming learning-centred relationships – in other words, engaging in the shared quest for truth and advancement of knowledge, especially that relating to the classical tradition; the *res publica litteraria* was imagined as a fundamentally egalitarian and friendship-based community. So in the 16th century this concept was closely related to the idea of Latin as the key to universal knowledge and the worldwide community of the learned.

In mid-17th century, the first learned journals,⁹⁸ published by newly founded scientific societies, provided another channel for the exchange of knowledge, supplementing the correspondence of letters. At this time, alongside of Latin in its communicational role French appeared, and the image of the *Republic of Letters* passed also to the French designation *République des lettres*. This term (and its cognates in other languages of Europe – *Republic of Letters*, *Gelehrtenrepublik*) continued to be extensively used until the end of the 18th century, after which it rapidly disappeared.

How does one interpret the demise of this Republic of Letters? Does it mean that the phenomenon this designation represented, namely the scholarly universality and brotherhood, disappeared? The answer is not straightforward.⁹⁹ On the one hand, the ever-increasing specialisation into different fields of knowledge and the organisation of science and scholarship on national basis fragmented the universality both of knowledge and of the community. On the other hand, the knowledge production rate increased and did not show decline, with the readership also growing numerically due to the increase in literacy, so it is questionable to use the language of

98 Burke (2012, 396): “Journals such as the *Giornale de’ letterati* of Rome, *Nouvelles de la République des Lettres* of Rotterdam, *Bibliothèque Universelle et Historique* of Amsterdam, *Acta Eruditorum* of Leipzig, and so on, held the commonwealth together by offering news about the world of learning, including obituaries of scholars and, above all, reviews of new books.”. Note the imagery of erudite learning and of the Republic of Letters present in these titles; also, a number of the learned journals was published in Latin, and some of the vernacular ones were being translated into it (see, e.g., Waquet (2001, 86)).

99 Burke (2012, 397), while seeing a continuity after 1800, notes that the specialisation of the field of knowledge into individual disciplinary fields and fragmentation of the universal community into national ones contributed to the decline in the perception of the universality of learning; Burke (1999, 13) also adds to these two factors the decline of international Latin (and its imperfect replacement first by French, then by other languages). Simons (2014, 291) starts the treatment of this question by emphasising the continuity: “Die Frage nach dem Ende der frühneuzeitlichen *Respublica Litteraria* kann man unspektakulär beantworten: Sie wich offensichtlich der modernen *Scientific Community*.”; the term came to be associated with the “literary” rather than the “scientific” part of the *litterae*, and this “literary” field came to be fragmented along national lines, while the cooperation continued to happen in the natural sciences, which were not referred to as the *Republic of Letters*. These factors have also been given by Miert (2014, 278-279). Solleveld (2020), a study dedicated to the early 19th century, notes in the conclusions that it is quite misleading to associate “fragmentation with a process of slow demise, while the learned world itself was steadily growing. Accordingly, decline is not a widespread diagnosis among nineteenth-century scholars.”; even if the “community gathered in scholarly societies, maintaining a transnational correspondence network and filling learned journals” still existed, it would not be described as the Republic of Letters any more; this term, if still used at all, would usually be historical or ironical or a cliché (Solleveld 2020, 109-110).

decay. It can be argued that the fragmentation was a result of growth rather than stagnation; moreover, the international cooperation of scholars and scientists never went away, just as the sense that they share a certain boundaries-transcending brotherhood. However, it was not expressed through this metaphor any more. Maybe the Republic became simply the (learned) “public”.¹⁰⁰ The term already carried a lot of historical baggage and often was not taken seriously, maybe it had a colouring of the *ancien regime* and the shock of French revolution forced it out of fashion.¹⁰¹ Even if the causes are ambiguous, the eventual demise of the metaphor and maybe also of the concept is clear.

There are several important points in the evolution of the metaphor. Two mutually complementing axes can be distinguished in the humanist conception.¹⁰² In the synchronic sense the *Republic of Letters* means the contemporary community of learned Latin communicators united by the common language. In the diachronic sense the *Republic of Letters* expresses the universality of the authors who wrote in Latin and Greek, comprising both the luminaries of the classical antiquity and all those who came later, up to today, in this case the Renaissance. The Renaissance humanists emphasised both axes of the concept – both the synchronic one and the diachronic one – and elevated them to an almost sacred ideal. It was symbolically highly significant to them that the contemporaries are on equal footing with the ancients, who were for them heroes, a mine rich in discoveries for the present; Petrarch’s literary letters addressed to the long-dead Cicero are an expression of this intimacy. In the later centuries (the 17th and the 18th), the (now less Latin) *République des lettres* still implied a universality of the community of the learned, but now it was more abstract and impersonal (approaching the idea of a “learned public”)¹⁰³ and the synchronic

¹⁰⁰ Cf. footnote 103.

¹⁰¹ Brockliss (2013), as summarised by Solleveld (2020, 85): “Brockliss, at the end of an article on scholarly hierarchies in the late eighteenth century, suggests three explanations for the end of the Republic of Letters: *explosion* in the number of scholars, with increasing degrees of separation as the result; *implosion* through increasing specialization; and disruption caused by the French Revolution.”; Solleveld (2020, 115): “More often, reconceptualizations of the learned republic were not responding to a sense of slow decline but to a shock: the shock of the French Revolution and its aftermath.”

¹⁰² As Fumaroli (2018, 6) notes: “The humanist Renaissance, the *renovatio litterarum et artium* launched by Petrarch, was above all characterised by a change in the dialogic model dominant among men of letters. <...> Epistolary or conversational dialogue between two or more people, distanced from the *negotia* of the classical political forum or modern monarchical court, fell under the category of *otium operosum*, “studious leisure,” based on its practitioners’ uninterrupted *commercium* with the dead, authors of antiquity whose written works and effigies kept them alive, fertile, and generous. Epistolary exchanges between the living, and literary exchanges with the dead, two superior and intimate forms of dialogue, created a distinct social link among humanists in an invisible republic whose shared foundation was a classical heritage being reread, reinterpreted, and expanded continuously.”

¹⁰³ Miert (2013, 6-7): “The ‘Republic of Letters’ as a term was already in use in the early sixteenth century and it remained a vital concept in the self-conceptualization of the learned world until the beginning of the nineteenth century. The term itself a very stable one, but the reality behind it is described in different ways, depending on chronology and geography. In fact, the stability of the term obfuscates that this community of scholars changed over time, in their practices as well as in their ideals.”; Scholten (2022, 15-18) notes the difference between the humanist and Enlightenment images: “A somewhat different conception of a different Republic of the Letters gained traction at the end of the seventeenth century with the rise of literary journals <...> This period saw the rise of the idea of the Republic of Letters as an independent learned world filled with enlightened citizens. It was an

aspect was predominant: it was shared more with the contemporaries rather than with the classical past, which was no longer as central as it has been in the Renaissance.

It can be said that the Living Latin movement builds on this tradition. By advocating for the return to Latin as a language of communication, the proponents have before their eyes the past universality of Latin which is substantially expressed by the idea of *res publica litterarum* and the surviving eloquent descriptions of this ideal and its manifestations.

Barbaro and Erasmus bridged the time gap (the age of barbarity)¹⁰⁴ between their contemporaries and the ancients, and co-opted them to this community. Living Latin proponents perform a similar act with the humanists themselves. They see their own age, if not one of darkness, but still an age of division (the lack of an internationally neutral Latin is seen as symptomatic of this), while the age of communicational Latin, which was not too long ago, is seen as the golden age to which one could and should return. Probably every prominent defender of Living Latin is fond of reciting lists of figures who had used Latin successfully in writing influential literary or philosophical works and in communicating their scientific or learned discoveries.¹⁰⁵ These figures are taken as having lived in a world of Latin universality, and as a good proof for the return to it.

So the Living Latin proponents co-opt both the ancient and the more recent Latin-writing figures to the imagined reborn *res publica litteraria*, and thus make themselves citizens of this extended *res publica litteraria*, which is styled in a way more similar to that of the humanist Renaissance rather than that of the Enlightenment. They stress both the diachronic continuity, making these great minds of the past readily reachable, and the synchronic universality, the brotherhood of contemporary Latin speakers.

ideal learned world devoid of political and confessional obstacles where learned men and learned women could share knowledge.”; Fumaroli (1988, 136) writes about the Latin translation of Descartes’ *Discourse on Method*: “In the Latin translation by Étienne de Courcelles, published in 1644 with the approval of Descartes, the word “public” is translated by the Latin expression *Respublica literaria*.” (also in Fumaroli (2004, 3))

104 See footnote 96: Barbaro condemns Germans, the previous caretakers of the manuscripts, as barbarians who had for a long time unjustly buried the Roman classics in obscurity by not sharing them. This sentiment is similar to Petrarch’s *tenebrae* between himself and the classical authors of antiquity.

105 Arcadius Avellanus in *Præco Latinus* Mart. 1897 Vol. III No. 6 p. 2 enumerates Latin writers up to Leibnitz to prove that he is free to use non-Ciceronian vocabulary; Paulus Lukaszczyk, a reader of *Præco Latinus*, in Aug. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 11 p. 244 argues for a scientific Latin and lists the scientists who used it. Capelle and Quigley (1953, 38) adduces the Latin-writing scientists of the 17th-18th centuries (Kepler, Descartes, Newton, Leibniz, Bernoulli, Euler). Miraglia (2015, 20) alludes to the centuries of Latin communication as a wonderful age – “Fuit, fuit tempus, quo commentariis Latine conscriptis universi et singuli societatis eruditorum sodales inter sese quasi caritatis copula coniungebantur, sua inventa alii cum aliis communicabant, suas de variis atque diversis summi momenti rebus opiniones et placita aperire poterant.” – and brackets them with figures of Petrarch and Gauss (*ibid.*, p. 53: “recentioribus, qui de omnibus fere rebus Latinissime tractarunt a Petrarca ad Gauss usque”). See also footnote 947.

Many¹⁰⁶ of the studies about the Republic of Letters employ Benedict Anderson's concept of an *imagined community*,¹⁰⁷ and for a good reason: because of the difficulty to devise the general concept of a nation (on which Anderson concentrates), the resulting construct is sufficiently broad to describe not only nations, but basically any sort of wider community, especially the ideal and conceptual aspects of them. As Anderson writes: "In an anthropological spirit, then, I propose the following definition of the nation: it is an imagined political community – and imagined as both inherently limited and sovereign. It is *imagined* because the members of even the smallest nation will never know most of their fellow-members, meet them, or even hear of them, yet in the minds of each lives the image of their communion."¹⁰⁸ This process of *imagining* is inherent in any community¹⁰⁹ and this mental image shapes the limits and composition of the community itself. The Republic of Letters and Living Latin are not exceptions and can also be treated as imagined communities.

The imagined universality of Latin, the existence of an imagined community of illustrious ancestors being perpetually present together with the contemporaries (who are also connected together through the medium of Latin), makes any sort of encounter performed in Latin an exercise in universality. So, for example, even if only two people meet and speak Latin to each other, they can imagine themselves as being a part of a much greater whole, of continuity and universality transcending space and time. This imagined community prevents them from feeling insignificant and alone even when the number of practising contemporary Latin speakers might be low. If someone publishes a Latin text, a similar universality can be imagined¹¹⁰ as both the audience and the colleagues – the Republic of Letters is, after all, a community of equals,¹¹¹ where one's value is distributed according to merit.¹¹²

106 Some of the papers about the Republic of Letters using Anderson for conceptual framework, sorted chronologically: Burke (1999, 8); Mayhew (2004, 254); Eskildsen (2004, 421-422); Mayhew (2005, 76); Furey (2006, 12); Burke (2012, 395-396); Füssel (2014, 5-6); Aspaas (2014, 283); Miert et al. (2019, 28); Solleveld (2020, 84); Scholten (2022, 12-17); Solleveld (2022, 174-175). E.g., Mayhew (2004, 253-254): "For the republic of letters was an imagined community, in which all scholars were in theory connected despite the fact that they might never hear of each other, let alone meet and communicate. In Anderson's terms, the republic of letters, just like any other political community, was an imagined entity, held together by ties assumed and asserted through non-personal modes of interaction."

107 As introduced by Anderson (2006), "Imagined Communities. Reflections on the Origin and Spread of Nationalism". The book was originally published in 1983.

108 Anderson (2006, 5-6)

109 Anderson (2006, 6): "In fact, all communities larger than primordial villages of face-to-face contact (and perhaps even these) are imagined. Communities are to be distinguished, not by their falsity/genuineness, but by the style in which they are imagined."

110 Appendix A.11 shows that Alexander Lenard, the translator of *Winnie the Pooh* into Latin, imagined that the act of publishing this Latin book made him a citizen of the Republic of Letters.

111 Cf. Anderson (2006, 7): "Finally, it [the nation] is imagined as a *community*, because, regardless of the actual inequality and exploitation that may prevail in each, the nation is always conceived as a deep, horizontal comradeship."

112 This image of a just, global and meritocratic community was certainly also inherited by the modern scientific and scholarly community.

A parallel can be found in various nationalist movements (especially in the European Romantic nationalisms), many of which were also, at some point, merely small groups of intellectuals with a conviction of representing greater universalities, namely their respective nations. The parallel can be driven even further. These communities are not closed, but also not infinite – all of them have an imagined pool of proper candidates to the community. These national activists saw their “unredeemed” compatriots outside the activist circles as needing to become nationally conscious, thus recognising their own genuine essence, returning to it and becoming real members of the nation. For example, multiple national awakening movements in Europe, basing themselves on the proper ancestral language, wanted to spread it to the sections of their society unaccustomed of speaking it, justifying it as the rediscovery and return to their own true national essence.¹¹³

This *return* to the primeval essence and maybe also the metaphor of sleep¹¹⁴ inherent in the notion of *national awakening*, can be seen also in the case of Latin. It does not seem from the examined proponents of Living Latin that Latin is ever presented as a universal language for *everyone*, but, in the spirit and image of the *res publica litterarum*, it is presented as the natural language of the *learned (eruditi)*.¹¹⁵ They consist of scholars and scientists, maybe also of those who have university education; the vanguard is naturally formed by the teachers and scholars of Latin, followed by those whose fields traditionally used to be dominated by Latin (e.g., priests, physicians). They are the imagined unredeemed nation which the Living Latin movement hopes to “awaken” and make conscious of the need to return to their own natural language after a period of sleep and neglect. They are the supposed audience to whom the apologetics of Living Latin are directed.

Therefore, whatever may be the historical factors contributing to the emergence of particular Living Latin movements – the first wave of globalisation in the late 19th century, the rise of the international language question in the same era, the Italian state and the Catholic Church leaning on

113 Anderson (2006, 196) brings out the paradox that these activists used to be “literate people often *unaccustomed* to using these vernaculars” (of course, not necessarily all of them were unaccustomed – Anderson might be overgeneralising here), so the metaphor of sleep “permitted those intelligentsias and bourgeoisies who were becoming conscious of themselves as Czechs, Hungarians, or Finns to figure their study of Czech, Magyar, or Finnish languages, folklores, and musics as ‘rediscovering’ something deep-down always known”. Also in the case of Latin some of the most active promoters of Latin as a communicational language were not accustomed to using it – Carlo Galassi Paluzzi and Jean Capelle come into mind – but they nonetheless held Latin to be *the* natural language for learned communication.

114 *Alaudae* Oct. 1889 No. 7 p. 56 “*Vindobonâ* egregia haec verba mihi scripsit dominus Aloisius Gruber: // » Laetabundus percepi, confluere lectores, desiderio flagrantes, ut reviviscat <*sic*> usus linguae latinae. In memoriam mihi venit verbum biblicum: // *Puella non est mortua; puella dormit.* // Expergefata e somno diuturno, optimos cujusvis nationis, pulchritudine sua attractos, fraterno quodam vinculo conjunget et familiaritatem inter eos constituet spirituale.» ”

115 Cf. Laes (2022a, 309): “The unifying force of the Latin language, creating a community with the past in general and the Roman cultural heritage in particular, is another standard argument in defence of (spoken) Latin”, “and a sense of community with the intellectual élites all over the world – a community founded in the common classical heritage of Greece and Rome” (*ibid.*, p. 295). These words are about Karl Heinrich Ulrichs’ *Alaudae* (1889-1895).

Latin heritage in Mussolini's Italy, the European integration movement arising after the Second World War – the imagined narrative has always been a perennial one, uniting itself with some variant of the *Res publica litteraria*, the universal community of the learned going back through centuries and, ideally, continuing into a limitless future.¹¹⁶ In this narrative the Latin language is intimately connected with *res publica litteraria*'s essence, while the retreat of Latin is identified with its disappearance.¹¹⁷

This constitutes the conceptual imagination of a community transcending space and time. How was it built in reality? The appearance of the Living Latin journals in the end of the 19th century is a key event in this. They strived to report everything done in the world in Latin and for the cause of Latin, and so to provide the sense that there is indeed a movement happening, that the individual actions are not happening *in vacuo*. When a set of things happening at the same time is juxtaposed in the page of a newspaper, this creates a sense of non-local simultaneity and of realness of the whole – whether it be a nation,¹¹⁸ the early modern Republic of Letters,¹¹⁹ or the modern Latin community. The communication media perform a key role in creating communities.

These journals used a variety of tactics to demonstrate the existence of a global community using and promoting Latin. Karl Heinrich Ulrichs (1825-1895) in his *Alaudae* (1889-1895) described the variety of his subscribers, addressed them, published some of their letters, underlined

116 Cf. Anderson (2006, 11-12) for a typical expression of national thinking: "If nation-states are widely conceded to be 'new' and 'historical,' the nations to which they give political expression always loom out of an immemorial past, and, still more important, glide into a limitless future."

117 The Latin *Vicipaedia* contains a brief article for the *Res publica litteraria* (it was written in 2010 by *Bruxellensis*, a pseudonymous author), which explicitly demonstrates this Latin-centric view, the identity of Latin with the concept of *Res publica litteraria* and universality itself. This is a verbatim copy of the whole article: "**Res publica litteraria**, aut *Res Publica Litterarum*, nomen est Rei publicae invisibilis sed vivax *<sic>* et strenua *<sic>* quae citra *<sic>* limites nationum et divisiones politicas patria communis fuit hominum eruditorum usque ad Seditionem Francogallicam. // Haec respublica communis fieri potuit propter usum communem linguae latinae. // Omnes docti huius reipublicae sese in communi patria vivere semper sensere. // **Res publica litteraria deleta** est propter Seditionem Francogallicam quae nationalismos et bella subsequencia suscitavit per duo saecula in Europa et quae, favens linguis nationalibus, abolivit *<sic>* usum linguae latinae ut nexum inter omnes eruditos." (https://la.wikipedia.org/wiki/Res_publica_litteraria, consulted 13.8.2023)

118 The effect of this perception to the realness of community is described by Anderson (2006, 26): "An American will never meet, or even know the names of more than a handful of his 240,000,000-odd fellow-Americans. He has no idea of what they are up to at any one time. But he has complete confidence in their steady, anonymous, simultaneous activity."

119 Burke (2012, 395-396) notes the effect of the press and of the learned journals for the Republic of Letters: "As in the case of the nation, what Anderson calls 'print-capitalism' assisted the rise of the community. It is surely significant that the phrase *respublica litterarum* only became widespread in the age of Erasmus, half a century after the invention of printing. Erasmus became the centre of a network of correspondents thanks to a reputation that was based on his published books. Anderson's argument may be carried a little further by observing that the learned journal was an invention of the later seventeenth century. Journals such as the *Giornale de' letterati* of Rome, *Nouvelles de la République des Lettres* of Rotterdam, *Bibliothèque Universelle et Historique* of Amsterdam, *Acta Eruditorum* of Leipzig, and so on, held the commonwealth together by offering news about the world of learning, including obituaries of scholars and, above all, reviews of new books. The simultaneity stressed by Anderson in the case of the nineteenth-century newspaper could be found in the seventeenth century among the learned readers of the *Nouvelles de la République des Lettres*, edited by a Frenchman in exile in the Netherlands and addressed to an international community of scholars."

their geographical spread,¹²⁰ thus adding weight to the argument of Latin being reborn; to this he added descriptions of Latin events happening throughout the world (e.g., Latin orations). Arcadius Avellanus in his *Præco Latinus* (1894-1902) pursued similar strategies; he additionally did book reviews, published the writings and biographies of his subscribers, praised them as being warriors for a common cause in a global movement. Carlo Galassi Paluzzi destined his journal *Per lo studio e l'uso del latino* (1939-1942) for a worldwide review of all organisations and projects for the revival of Latin, thus imagining that this journal would institute the central axis around which the community would turn. Some journals¹²¹ in the Interwar era included tables of contents of other contemporary Latin journals and so reinforced the idea of a global movement.

Therefore, the image of *res publica litteraria* as a conception of universality has been important for the rebirth of Latin ever since the 15th century and remains important today. But there is one innovation today that distinguishes the present meaning of the concept from its natural development: while the synchronic part of the *res publica litteraria* has evolved naturally from the original Renaissance concept of the community of all classically-focused humanists to the Enlightenment concept of a general educated audience (not necessarily even knowing Latin), the present meaning used by the movement focuses on the active users of Latin, mainly the community of Living Latin itself.

2.2 *Civitas Latina* – a Latin City State

2.2.1 The idea of a *civitas Latina* and the projects in the 17th-18th centuries

Some other community building aspects related to this Latin *res publica litterarum* are apparent in the idea of a *civitas Latina*,¹²² which is imagined as a physical place in which Latin would reside as the only permitted everyday language, thus enabling people to learn it in an efficient and natural way. The image of *res publica litteraria* functions as a largely uncontroversial

120 See Laes (2022a, 294) and footnotes 115; 259.

121 For example, *Societas Latina*, *Iuventus*, *Per lo studio e l'uso del latino*.

122 The idea has as many names as there were proponents of it – Eilhardus Lubinus (1614) decided to call it a *Romana Colonia*, Ioannes Amos Comenius (1657a) presented it as *Latium Redivivum* (discussed in Fritsch (2013), mentioned in Fritsch (2016)), Henricus Petiti (1660) wrote about *societates glotticae* or *societates coenobiopoliticae*, Christophorus Augustus Heumannus ([1718]) criticised the idea of a *Tulliopolis* and implied that it would rapidly become a *Barbaropolis* (cf. Sdzuj (2012) and Agosto (2019)), Christian Heinrich Gasser ([1720]) titled his work *Romaipolis* (Sdzuj (2012) demonstrated the existence of a tradition from Lubinus to Gasser, further discussed by Agosto (2019)), Carl Ferdinand Hommel (1773, 123) proposed naming it “*Romanula* oder *Latiolum*”, Miguel Maria Olmo (1816) called his project *Roma Tullia* (see footnote 177 for references), Avellanus Avellanus called it *Tusculaneum*, etc. The list is not exhaustive, more projects and proposals could be found in unexpected places. For example, Waquet (2001, 157-158) treats the theme and finds that in 1621 the creation of *une Colonie Latine* was suggested by Antoine de Laval to Louis XIII for education of the Dauphin (the heir to the French throne) and the rest of the nobility.

idea of a universalist community; meanwhile an analysis of the image of *civitas Latina* (a *Rhomaïopolis* or a *Tulliopolis*)¹²³ touches the nature of the language itself and exposes the tensions inherent in it. How formally should Latin language be learned in schools? How far can it reasonably approach the communicative functions and learning methods of the vernacular languages? Should it be confined to books and premeditated communication or should it approach the vernacular languages in the breadth and nature of its (often spontaneous) use? Different answers to these questions are implicit in the proposals of this idea and the reactions to them.

The idea of a Latin-speaking utopia has a strong connection with the ideas of language teaching reform¹²⁴ – the proponents of *civitates Latinae* invariably support inductive teaching methods – and is rooted in the perception of Latin being simultaneously both valuable and difficult. Latin is very valuable, but difficult to learn through the usual methods, so it would make sense to invest money and effort for creating a *civitas Latina* in order to enable people to learn Latin in the most efficient way.

The Humanist movement believed in the power of education, based on the classical Roman and Greek literature, to make man better.¹²⁵ Learning Latin was a prerequisite, but it was an undertaking that took a number of years of schooling and a shorter way to achieve this necessary skill would have been most helpful. As one of the ways to solve this, in the beginning of the 16th century some humanists, including Erasmus, entertained thoughts¹²⁶ about a possible introduction of

123 Out of the list of names in footnote 122, *Rhomaïopolis* (Ῥωμαίοπολις) and *Tulliopolis* seem to be the most unambiguous and transparent in meaning (*Tulliopolis* is used by Sdzuj (2012), followed by Agosto (2019)) to be used for the general concept.

124 Fritsch (2016, 318) sees in Comenius' proposal a precursor of the 19th century language teaching reform movement and of the direct method: "Was vielleicht zunächst fast skurril anmutet, ist jedoch im Grunde ein fortschrittlicher Gedanke. Man kann seinen mehrfach wiederholten Vorschlag als wichtigen Schritt auf dem Weg zu einer ganzheitlichen direkten Methode des Fremdsprachenlernens ansehen, die heute weitgehend selbstverständlich geworden ist (einschl. Schüleraustausch und Auslandsaufenthalte)."

125 E.g., Marino (1996, 88-90) discusses the humanist concept of *bonae litterae* and quotes Erasmus' formulation in *Querela Pacis* (1517), showing the significance of the *litterae*: "Bonæ literæ reddunt homines, philosophia plusquam homines, theologia reddit divos."

126 Erasmus notices in his *De pueris statim ac liberaliter instituendis* (Erasmus 1529, 25r f.) that young children have a wondrous ability of learning complicated and irregular vernacular languages, so learning Latin (a more regular language than French, which is described in unflattering terms) might be even easier: "Quod enim ad linguas attinet, tanta est illius ætatis docilitas, ut intra paucos menses puer Germanus discat gallice, idque insciens et aliud agens, nec unquam ea res succedit felicius quàm annis quàm maxime rudibus. Quod si id fit in lingua barbara et anormi, <sic – this is Erasmus' word – see Vredeveld (1988)> quæ aliud scribit quàm sonat quæque suos habet stridores et voces vix humanas, quanto id facilius fuerit in lingua Graeca seu Latina?"; later, after encouraging the learned to educate their offspring themselves (commending Thomas More for doing this), he notes that these children will learn the vernacular even if taught Latin first – no contradiction would arise between the Latin immersion and the acquisition of the proper vernacular language (pp. 27r f.): "Verum instituendi ratio fuit hoc nomine facilius priscis, quòd eadem esset lingua literas callentium, & imperitæ multitudinis, nisi quòd eruditi emendatius, elegantius, prudentius & copiosius dicebant. Fateor, ac plurimum compendii foret ad eruditionem, si idem maneret hodie. <...> Nec est periculum, ne populi linguam ignorent, eam perdiscent velint nolint hominum commercio." The English humanist Sir Thomas Elyot (c. 1496-1546) in his 1531 educational treatise *The Governor* recommends Latin immersion for small children: "[Book 1, Chapter] V. The order of learning that a nobleman should be trained in before he come to the age of seven years. <...> it shall be expedient that a nobleman's son, in his infancy, have with him continually only such as may accustom him by little and little to speak pure and

Latin to children at the earliest possible age by immersing them in the language continuously so they could learn it in a natural conversational way just as easily as they acquire the vernacular languages. The humanist context produced some interesting pedagogical experiments of this nature,¹²⁷ but the documentation of this informal phenomenon is sparse and the extent of it is impossible to determine; still, from time to time, especially through the 16th-17th centuries, reports surfaced of children (natively) speaking Latin.¹²⁸

The most famous case is the childhood of Michel de Montaigne (1533-1592).¹²⁹ His father, probably influenced by his humanist acquaintances, decided to raise his son as a native Latin speaker and so to give him a head start in life. Thus, from the age of two he was instructed by a learned tutor from Germany supported by two assistants, this team speaking only Latin, with parents and family servants also speaking to him in Latin, providing such a complete language environment that Michel could later claim¹³⁰ to have been ignorant of French at the age of six, when

elegant Latin. Semblably the nurses and other women about him, if it be possible, to do the same; or at the leastways, that they speak none English but that which is clean, polite, perfectly and articulately pronounced” (Elyot (1962, 17-18); modernised orthography). These sources are adduced as possible inspirations for the Latin childhood of Montaigne – Erasmus is cited by Trinquet (1972, 246) and Chenoweth (2016, 59), Elyot by Logan (1975, 615). As Montaigne was born in 1533, they are very much contemporary.

127 Perpetual colloquial Latin immersion was sometimes practised in humanist circles. For example, a poetic epistle by Jean Dorat, dated 1538, describes the household of the learned Parisian printer Robert Estienne (*Robertus Stephanus*, 1503-1559) as being completely Latin-speaking: “Quid tandem (ut unâ cuncta summâ colligam) / Lares beatos personat / Indesinenter, continenter, jugiter, / Et usquequaque & undique, / Intaminata quàm Latini puritas / Sermonis, & canus decor? / Nempe uxor, ancillæ, clientes, liberi, / (Non segnis examen domûs) / Quo Plautus ore, quo Terentius, solent / Quotidianè colloqui.” (verses 199-208, text in Demerson (1989)). Young children of the family indeed acquired Latin by immersion (Trinquet (1972, 343) and Considine (2008, 57-58) collect more testimonies). Once again, the childhood of Montaigne is contemporary.

128 See, for example, footnotes 148 and 150. The occasional practice of philologists introducing their children to Latin at an early age seems to have continued after the 17th century. For example, Johann Matthias Gesner (*Iohannes Matthias Gesnerus*, 1691-1761) in a 1723 letter addressed to Christoph August Heumann, who had sent to Gesner his essay about the impossibility of founding a Latin-speaking city, is proud to report that his own three years old son is already speaking good Latin, having been taught by himself and a resident student: “Non abs re fuerit, nec forte tibi iniucundum, narrare tibi, me parvulum Vtopiae civem domi alere, i.e. puerum meum, quartum iam annum agentem. Hic cum a matre adhuc rubens et consequenti omni tempore, a me et scholastico, quem ea de causa in convictu meo et contubernio habeo, nihil nisi Latina audisset, iam pariter Latinae et Germanicae linguae facultatem habet, ita ut etiam peccantes corrigat &c.” (Klotzius 1768, 40). Heumann congratulates Gesner, but is not convinced that this one example implies the project of a Latin-speaking *Tulliopolis* to be viable: “De filio Tibi tuo trienni, Latine iam loquenti, ex animo gratulor. Faxit Deus, ut is Tibi honori olim sit, reip. literatae decori. An vero is probare possit, consilium Morhofii de condenda Tulliopoli quadam non esse Vtopicum, dubito, Tuque ipse, ni fallor, id negabis.” (Klotzius 1768, 44-45). This fact about Gesner’s son is also noted by Schazius (1741, 109) who collects some more contemporary examples of Latin being successfully taught at a very young age.

129 Montaigne describes his childhood education in chapter 26 (“On educating children”) of book one of his *Essays*. The introduction shows the same motivation – concern with the time expended on languages and immersion presented as the easier way to acquire the language: “There is no doubt that Greek and Latin are fine and great accomplishments; but they are bought too dear. I will tell you a cheaper way of buying them: it was assayed on me. Anyone is welcome to use it. My late father, after having made all possible inquiries among the learned and the wise about the choicest form of education, was warned about the disadvantages of the current system: they told him that the length of time we spend learning languages, which cost the Ancients nothing, is the sole reason why we cannot attain to the greatness of mind and knowledge of those old Greeks and Romans.” (Montaigne 1993, 194). His Latin childhood is discussed by numerous scholars: Frame (1965), Trinquet (1972), Logan (1975), Screech (1993), Hoffmann (2016), Chenoweth (2016).

130 Hoffmann (2016, 41) doubts if young Michel’s isolation from the surrounding French environment could have been so complete.

he was sent off to a regular school. Probably due to his preschool education he managed to finish the school (*collège*) early, when only 13 years old.¹³¹ What were the long term results? Certainly not a failure, even if he did switch to French after the immersion period. After many years Montaigne confesses in his *Essays* that his active Latin skills of writing and speaking have deteriorated¹³² through forty years of disuse (he was a worldly gentleman and did not spend his time in Latin speaking environments), but he also praises the method and claims¹³³ to understand Latin better than French (through his life he continued to read Latin voluminously and the *Essays* themselves contain more than a thousand of Latin quotes) and that Latin, being his natural first language, resurfaces in moments of great emotion.¹³⁴ Montaigne's upbringing was exceptional and, out of other examples of small children speaking Latin, the best known one due to the fame and detail of his autobiographical writings – as such, it was referenced by the subsequent imagined projects of creating a *civitas Latina* where this kind of language learning through immersion would have become the norm.

In 1614, the German scholar Eilhardus Lubinus (1565-1621), professor in Rostock University, published a long letter about a better way to teach Latin. After a long complaint about the inefficacy of the methods of teaching Latin through grammar that were in use in schools and after suggestions for learning the language through visual examples and memorable short sentences,¹³⁵ he proposed a closed Latin boarding school (*coenobium*),¹³⁶ a *Romana colonia*, where everyone (including servants) would be obliged to speak the language all the time. Staying in this school and learning the language through conversation¹³⁷ and exercises¹³⁸ would have enabled the

131 Frame (1965, 40): “Michel’s brilliant Latin led him to skip immediately to an upper grade, probably sixth (he finished the twelve-year course in seven years), forced his teachers to give him special exercises turning, not French into Latin, but bad Latin into good, {...}”, cf. footnote 129 and Montaigne (1993, 195).

132 As indicated in Montaigne’s *Essays*, book two, chapter 16 (Montaigne 1993, 726) and book three, chapter 2 (Montaigne 1993, 914).

133 Montaigne’s *Essays*, book three, chapter 2 (Montaigne 1993, 914).

134 *Ibidem*.

135 Lubinus (1614) (the pages of the prefatory letter are unnumbered, but the typographical signatures are a2r-f4v for the whole letter and f2v-[f4r] for the *civitas Latina* part of it); as noted by Sdzuj (2012), which is the fundamental article on treatises about *civitas Latina* projects and their criticism spanning more than a century (from Lubinus (1614) to Fryksell (1739)). Lubinus’ suggestions are considered to be an important inspiration for *Orbis sensualium pictus* (1658), the famous illustrated textbook of Latin published by Comenius. But Lubinus recommends free conversation only after a grammatical and vocabulary build-up (p. e3r): “Neque enim pueri temerè ad Latinè suapte Marte loquendum & scribendum adigi debent, priusquam hujusmodi Latini sermonis usum, per illa quae dixi media, sibi comparaverint.”. Wheeler (2013, 67-70) treats Lubinus’ preface through the nearly contemporary English translation published by a friend of Comenius (Hartlib 1654).

136 Lubinus (1614, f3r): “Cœnobium, vel locum aliquem ad illam rem commodum constituere”. *Coenobium*, a word meaning a place for communal living and alluding to monastic communities, occurs in most of the works of this type.

137 Lubinus (1614, f3v): “Illud certè per Dei gratiam confido, & prorsus mihi persuasum habeo, si hujusmodi Romana, liceat mihi ita appellare, Colonia adornaretur, non minus cito, & forte etiam non minus certè & plenè Romanam linguam in illâ addisci posse, quam olim in mediâ Suburrâ aut Romano foro.”.

138 Lubinus (1614, [f4r]): “Illa autem omnia certis quibusdam ad hoc institutis exercitiis, in hujusmodi, quam dixi, Coloniâ, plenius uberiùsque addisci possent.”

pupils to learn the language much more quickly, saving their time for other subjects. For example, pupils who had already learned the basics of Latin through efficient inductive methods could spend a year or two in this place to complete their education.¹³⁹ Lubinus dedicated this plea to Philip II, the duke of Pomerania-Stettin.

In 1657, the great Moravian pedagogue Joannes Amos Comenius (1592-1670), famous for his inductive pedagogy of Latin, presented his project of a similar¹⁴⁰ *collegium Latinissimum* to the city of Amsterdam. This large (consisting of at least a thousand people)¹⁴¹ and remote from city *coenobium* was imagined as a small self-contained state with imitated sociological detail – for example, with Roman magistrates such as consuls, senators, tribunes, with courts, merchants, soldiers, workers – thus providing Latin learning material for all life situations. Once again, this was advertised as an efficient time-saving measure, teaching the language in a year or two.¹⁴² The continuity is notable: Comenius had read Lubinus’ essay and heard of Montaigne’s childhood, and had been thinking about the idea for a long time – two decades even – before publishing the proposal.¹⁴³ The theatre-like representation of society in schools can also be traced to the humanist tradition: for example, one famous mid-16th century humanistic school was organised in the image of the Roman republic, with roles and titles like *consul* or *censor* distributed among the pupils, employing the same analogy between the school and a little state.¹⁴⁴

139 Lubinus (1614, f3v): “Et optandum esset pueros illos, qui illâ, quam superius exposui, ratione jam Latini sermonis fundamentis ac principiis imbuti essent, mox ab hujusmodi cœnobio, in quô non nisi Latini & Romani sermonis usus esset purissimus, excipi, & in illo per annum unum & alterum exerceri.”

140 Comenius (1657a, col. 76): “Cùm verò excitare Populum Latinè loquentem, aut extruere novam Latinam Romam, non sit humanæ potestatis: optatur saltem id quod impossibile non est, *Collegium* seu *Cœnobium* (id est, Convictus) civitatulam quandam, ceu parvam Romam, repræsentans: ubi eundem finem assequi, hoc est, usu & consuetudine linguam Romanam addiscere liceat, æquè ut olim.”

141 Comenius (1657a, col. 77): “Ergò necessariò erunt tantò numerò, ut sustinendis tot diversarum functionum, vocationum, actionumque muniis sufficiant: ad minimum mille personarum.”

142 Comenius (1657a, col. 76): “non impensò tamen huc nisi uno & altero anno, vel ad summum trienniò.”

143 Fritsch (2013) collects testimonies in the Comenian corpus and shows (p. 92) that already in 1636 Comenius received a letter from his friend David Vecher (1594-1669), containing a dream of creating a certain place, a school surrounded with an extensive environment in which the pupils could experience their life completely in Latin; it is an idea of a *Latin college* or even a *Latin city*, even if it was already perceived as being hardly possible (“Idea hæc est, sed rudis, *Collegii*, sive, ut porrò etiam nugis nostris blandiri liceat, *Urbis Latinæ*. Et manebit etiam Idea, aut potius phantasma: hoc imprimis tempore, quò fœdissimâ Metamorphosi Musæ plerisque locis in mulas abeunt.”). When discussing proposals of this type in his 1649 work *Novissima linguarum methodus* (Comenius 1657b, col. 79-80) he cites Lubinus and Ianus Caecilius Frey (c. 1580-1631; Fritsch (2013, 92-93)), who had also outlined a similar project (with a twist – the children are supposed to start very young: “ubi à secundo ætatis anno pueri (NB) <sic: (NB) added by Comenius> habitent”) and supported it with Montaigne’s childhood: “Ne vana narrari putes, sic instructus est maximo reipublicæ literariæ commodo sapiens Gallus, Michael Montanus.”. Comenius takes the quote from Frey (1645, 432) or Frey (1674, 8), the work originally published in 1628 (Schumann 1878; Bender and Wilke 2017). Frey’s proposal is also discussed by Tunberg (2012, 15).

144 The parallel to Comenian proposal was noticed by Fritsch (2013, 91): “Praeclarus etiam est Valentinus Trotzendorf (1490-1556), sectator Lutheri (1483-1546) et Melanchthonis, qui erat rector scholæ Goldbergensis in Silesia et totam scholam suam ut rem publicam Romanam ordinavit et illam civitatulam a discipulis Latine loquentibus administrari iussit. Discipuli erant consules, censores, decuriones, iudices, qui orationes Latinas habentes iudicium fecerunt de condiscipulis maleficis, qui orationibus bene Latinis defendi et absolvi poterant.”. Trotzendorf’s emphasis on spoken Latin in his school in Goldberg (today Złotoryja in Poland), which he headed since 1531, is reflected in a praise in the Latin elegiacs carved on his tombstone in Liegnitz (today Legnica in Poland): “Atque ita

Later *civitates Latinae* further elaborated the sociological model and made these imagined educational institutions more similar to real states. In 1660 a certain Henricus Petiti¹⁴⁵ published a lengthy pamphlet where he proposed to all the rulers of Europe a method to create language-based societies of communal living (*societates glotticae, societates coenobiopoliticae*), modelled in exquisite sociological detail, with an elaborate class system. Speakers of the target language (e.g., Latin) are to be assigned to live together in one remote territory provided by the state, preferably together with their wives, and it is imagined that this closed community would survive in the long-term and become a real tightly-knit political entity, with inter-generational continuity provided by little children (e.g., orphans, abandoned infants) supplied to it by the state and with children being born on the premises.¹⁴⁶ A Latin school built in such an environment would provide ample possibilities for a full-fledged use of language. Petiti¹⁴⁷ acknowledged Lubinus as his predecessor, but considered himself to be the first one ever to propose not just a theoretical concept, but a real and detailed plan ready for execution.¹⁴⁷

German polymath Daniel Georg Morhof (1639-1691) expressed similar considerations in the chapter about language learning methods he wrote for his encyclopedia *Polyhistor litterarius* (1688): after discussing Latin-speaking child prodigies (including Montaigne) and thus showing

Romanam linguam transfudit in omnes, / Turpe ut haberetur Teutonico ore loqui; / Audisses famulos famulasque latina sonare, / Goldbergam in Latio crederes esse sitam.” (Pinzger (1825, 58); Payne (1892, 280)). If not a hyperbole, these verses might also reflect his success in instilling the perpetual use of Latin mandated by the school rules.

145 An unidentified, possibly pseudonymous figure – *Henricus Petiti Gallo-Celta*. The book (Petiti 1660) was published in London in 1660. The book seems to have vanished into obscurity soon; but it is referenced in the index of predecessors by Anonymous (1685, 2), a dialogue discussing the method of teaching Latin by use alone and its attested (often anecdotal) results, not omitting Montaigne’s childhood (pp. 60-61). This author is not treated by Sdzuj (2012).

146 The author himself admits that he is building a prison – the citizens and their progeny are imagined to be perfectly monolingual and to never go outside the colony’s borders, with any exceptions mandated by the senate – albeit a splendid one. This interface between utopia and dystopia is reflected by Petiti (1660, 29-35), especially pp. 31-32: “Neque enim nego conditionem communem Societatum à me delineatarum esse servilem de facto, quoniam alii reverà servorum officia praestabunt, alii pecunià erunt comparati in mancipia, alii societati traditi sub condicione perpetuæ servitutis, & omnes sub jugo satis severo tenebuntur vivere intrà ambitum sui claustrum, cujus septa transgredi nulli prorsus erit liberum. // Sed societatum à me designatarum fœlicitas tanta esse supponitur, ut illa facili absorbeat omnes alias considerationes cœnobarum, illorumque luctus, alioqui fortè justos, in totum abstergeat; illa enim est istiusmodi, ut jubeat illos omnes contemplari lineas illas angustas, quibus circum circà metata fuit illorum libertas, tanquam ultimos fœlicitatis humanæ terminos, extrà quorum ambitum quicquid vagatur, miserum atque servile est de facto, quamvis nobilioris libertatis speciem præ se ferat.”

147 Petiti (1660, 71-72): “Neque tandè in magnis hiscè cœptis alterius vestigia lego (Quamvis enim *Eilhardus Lubinus Rostockiensis*, tale genus methodi, longo antè me tempore laudaverit <...> Aliud tamen genus cœnobi indicavit, quod prorsus diversum est à meis inventis, cujusque simplex designatio, qualis ab illo fit, tot gravibus premitur incommodis, ut ejus possibilitatem maluerit nobis innuere, quàm completam ejusdem delineationem aggredi) sed primus omnium viam tero, ac publico non tam significo, quam delineo & explico per partes <...>”

that Latin could indeed be learned by use and conversation,¹⁴⁸ he approved¹⁴⁹ of creating a *Civitas Latina*, a plan about which he had recently read,¹⁵⁰ and briefly outlined how it should be done. According to Morhof, it is possible to create such a community, where every social class would speak Latin, in only 20 years through some (questionable) social engineering: by gathering six or seven good Latinists who would then teach Latin colloquially to children of the poor, who would afterwards be taught a trade and then inhabit the place, thus creating a supporting core for the future Latin society, consisting of the Latin language experts / teachers and the common people.

Christian Heinrich Gasser (1680-1753), a Lutheran pastor in Eastern Prussia, published an essay in 1720 where he bemoaned the inefficiency of the usual methods of learning Latin and proposed an immersive solution: creating a *Ῥωμαιόπολις* or a *civitas Latina*. The project was dedicated to the magnates of Danzig (today's Gdańsk).¹⁵¹ Gasser was well aware that he was participating in a tradition, citing the examples of Montaigne, Comenius, Morhof, and others.¹⁵² The plan starts from gathering a certain number of two or three year old children (12 boys and 12 girls)

148 Robert Gentili (1590-1655?), son of Alberico Gentili (1552-1608), the Regius professor of civil law in the University of Oxford, “septennis puer Latine, Gallice, Angliceque locutus dicitur” (Morhofius 1688, 416). Thus he surpassed the son of the philologist Tanaquillus Faber (*Tannequy Le Fèvre*, 1615-1672), who “14. demum anno Graecæ ac Latinæ linguæ auctores optime intelligere potuit” (*ibid.*, 421); the son died at 14 years of age (*ibid.*, 437) while his daughter Anne Dacier (née *Le Fèvre*) (1647-1720), who was likewise taught Latin and Greek by her father, went on to become an illustrious scholar, working on editions and French translations of Greek and Roman classics, most notably translating both the *Iliad* and the *Odyssey*: “filiam doctam habuit, quæ hodie libros scribit in gratiam Delphini; quæ & ipsa dicitur imitari Patrem” (*ibid.*, 298). Two examples of documented purely Latin upbringing are treated in more detail: the childhood of Michel de Montaigne and of an unnamed Latin speaking child in Paris (see footnote 150).

149 Morhofius (1688, 420-421). See also Sdzuj (2012) and Waquet (2001, 157-158).

150 Morhof found the plan in Anonymous (1669), an English translation of an anonymous essay published in 1668 in France, which among considerations about language teaching methods urges the king of France to create “a little *Latin Republic*” (p. 33). Cf. Sdzuj (2012, 604-605). This essay starts from presenting the case of a certain confident and “not yet *four* years” old child who was admired by the whole Paris and invited by the French king for an audience – the reason being that the child knew only the Latin language and spoke it quite perfectly. This admirable case was the inspiration for writing of the booklet. The boy was taught by two learned friends of his father, who later described their method and experience to the author (chapter 5, pp. 28-30). After the child learned enough Latin by conversation, two more children (younger than the first one) were added to this Latin environment and everyone used Latin for communication – even if the newcomers already knew French, they learned and switched to Latin very quickly, while the older boy “served in a manner for a third Master to the other two” (p. 29); the servants also spoke some Latin. This example and that of the childhood of Montaigne are employed for the argument of teaching little children Latin through use and conversation as their *first* language in (roughly) two years, after which the child would learn the proper mother tongue of the country.

151 Gasser ([1720]). The essay is discussed by Sdzuj (2012, 612-616), who seems to have examined a copy without the prefatory dedication to the Danzig magnates; in the *Google books* repository there are two copies available, one of them containing the dedication, the other not.

152 Gasser ([1720], 11-12). He cites Comenius' *Methodus studiorum* (most probably *Methodus linguarum novissima*), followed by examples of Caecilius Frey and Montaigne; however, Gasser may have only read Comenius – in the *Methodus* Comenius cites Frey citing Montaigne (see footnote 143). Later he quotes Joachim Pastorius (1610/1611-1681; Sdzuj (2012, 611-612)), a German (later a Polish citizen) physician, historian and pedagogue, who believed that the best way to learn Latin would be to have a place, *a kind of a Latium outside Italy (tale velut Latium extra Italiam)*, where children could learn Latin through everyday conversation (Pastorius (1653, 5-7): “Inter omnes verò modos non immeritò ille maximè placuerit, ut domus ejusmodi haberentur, ubi nullus habitantium, etiam famulorum, aliâ uteretur linguâ, quàm Latinâ. Sic enim, quemadmodum Gallicam, Anglicam, Polonicam, aliasque linguas discimus; ita intrâ breve tempus & sine negotio, imò & sensu penè, Latinam puer imbiberet.”; Pastorius (1654, 10-11)). Morhof also gets mentioned.

in a specially built small town, preferably in Eastern Prussia near the Baltic sea or near the Polish border.¹⁵³ The children would have as their teachers four or six youngsters coming from poor families and knowing decent Latin. The community would be supplemented by three students with a full-fledged Latin proficiency who would help others with the language and would enforce its use, and a teacher of philosophy, who would also be the (Lutheran) pastor of the community. Supporting (not Latin speaking) personnel would live outside the community. After 15 years, this community would have a natively Latin-speaking young adult population¹⁵⁴ and would start being profitable – it could accept at least fifty noble children in a year to be educated in a Latin-speaking environment. And, if this project is too ambitious, a Latin house (*domus Latina*) could be organised on similar principles.

Therefore, a certain pattern repeats in the *civitas Latina* tradition. The works tend to start from a statement of the necessity of the knowledge of Latin, a disenchantment with the usual Latin teaching methods, a desire for immersive ones, and to conclude with the need to create a permanently (and possibly natively) Latin-speaking environment in order to enable learning Latin in this way. This in turn requires (to various degrees utopian) society building, which gets outlined; the projects are dedicated to rulers assumed to be able to realise the project.

2.2.2 The critique of the *civitas Latina* projects in the 17th-18th centuries

What was the reception of these projects? The questions from the beginning of this section (p. 41) are relevant: multiple concerns and differences in opinion arose regarding the teaching methods of Latin, its communicational range, the blurring of lines between Latin and vernacular. The nature of Latin was at stake.

The critics were not convinced by the optimism about the projects' ease and usefulness characteristically exhibited by the "salesmen" advertising their own *civitas Latina* ideas; the recurring critique could be said to form a tradition parallel to the proposals. Aside from numerous brief condemnations in various treatises about Latin,¹⁵⁵ there are at least two stand-alone essays from the 18th century covering the subject. Both of them are written in Latin. In 1718, Christoph August Heumann (1681-1764), the professor of literary history in the University of Göttingen, had

153 Gasser ([1720], 12-13) notes that quite many Poles are able to converse in Latin, even if not in a perfect manner ("E Polonia autem commercia instituere possent illi, qui, si non accuratè, tamen rudiusculè latinè loquuntur, quod non infrequens est huic genti."). Such contacts are not a danger to the colony: since the Rhomaiopolitans would speak better and purer Latin, they would rather joke about the poor Latin style of Poles instead of themselves adopting their barbarities.

154 Also, a new generation of Latin-speaking children would come soon. Everyone could get educated in trades etc. abroad when needed, as the Latin colony composed by native speakers by that time would be stable enough not to fear other languages (Gasser [1720], 14). The contrast in attitude with Petitius' closed society (cf. footnote 146) is striking.

155 Sdzuj (2012) catalogues quite many examples.

a lecture titled *a programma in which Heumann investigates and rejects the dream of some persons to found a Latin city*;¹⁵⁶ some years later, in 1739, Matthias Fryksell (1716-1746), a student in Uppsala University, presented his thesis, named *an academic disputation outlining the plan for founding a Latin city*, under supervision of Petrus Ekerman (1696-1783), the professor of eloquence and a future rector of the university.¹⁵⁷



Heumann treats the project as one of the learned utopias (*Utopiae literatae*),¹⁵⁸ which are not unlike to how Plotinus reportedly requested the emperor Galienus to bring the republic of Plato to existence: they are things beautiful to contemplate, but not practicable in the real world. After outlining the proponents,¹⁵⁹ he argues that such a project of a *Tulliopolis* (Heumann coined this word after the example of Plotinus' *Platonopolis*) would be 1) impossible, 2) unnecessary if possible, 3) damaging if created. Thus, in the first part he doubts 1) if it would be possible to find Latin speaking women ready to enter such a project and to persuade them to raise children in the language, 2) if the children brought up in Latin and trained in the manual arts by, e.g., German tradesmen, could speak pure Latin – Morhof suspects that their language, due to the manual training, would be a barbarous mixture of German and Latin.

And if this city *could* be founded, why is it *necessary*? Children manage to learn foreign languages such as French or English without necessarily growing up speaking the language or migrating to these countries. It would be enough to change the teaching methods, eliminating the assumption that all children are future grammarians.

Heumann continues with arguments why this project would be damaging. Firstly, children participating in this Latin immersion project would not cultivate their own vernacular languages enough, which are, after all, more important than the active skills in Latin – the occasions where Latin has to be spoken or written are rare, it is enough for most people to just understand the language. Secondly, in order to be able to talk about all subjects, they would have to learn a lot of

156 Heumannus ([1718]), reprinted in Heumannus (1722, 94-103), abbreviated version published in Anonymus (1719, 345-347). Treated by Sdzuj (2012, 609-612) and Agosto (2019, 5-6; 9). The title in Latin: "PROGRAMMA quo somnium quorundam de CIVITATE LATINA condenda excutit atque explodit <...> Christophorus Augustus Heumannus".

157 Fryksell (1739). It is treated by Sdzuj (2012, 616-619), who also gives the biographical data. The title: "DISPUTATIO ACADEMICA, CONSILIIUM de CIVITATE LATINA CONDENDA Leviter adumbrans, Quam Permissu Ampliss. Facult. Philosoph. Upsaliensis, Præside viro celeberrimo, MAG. PETRO EKERMAN, Eloquent. Profess. Reg. & Ordin. Facult. Philosoph. h. t. Decano Publico examini modeste submittit MATTHIAS FRYKSELL, Wermelandus".

158 Heumannus (1722, 94) presents the essay as the first chapter of his future book *Utopiae literatae*. "Nec enim solus Thomus Morus effinxit Vtopiam. Habuit & resp. literata suos Moros vel potius Morosophos, hoc est, viros caetera sapientissimos, qui somnia sibi quaedam, suavia illa & ingeniosa, sed tamen somnia, finxerunt, ac tum demum perspectissime sibi sapere visi sunt, cum somniis illusi suis a via rectae rationis aberrarunt longissime."

159 Lubinus, the anonymous French author of the 1668 pamphlet *Examen...* (see footnote 150), Morhof, Pastorius (see footnote 152 for Pastorius). Heumann read Morhof and Lubinus directly, while the French author and Pastorius are referred through Morhof's *Polyhistor*.

Latin vocabulary unnecessary for reading the authors: herb names, kitchen terms, etc.¹⁶⁰ Finally, the Latin of this state would get contaminated by the surrounding languages and, just as every living language, it would change over time and this *Tulliopolis* would become a *Barbaropolis*; so even if this Latin city with all its citizens speaking perfect Latin could be founded, it would be “a thing of one lifetime only”.¹⁶¹

All three arguments about the damage caused relate to different aspects of Latin. The concern of not cultivating the “real vernacular language” signals the changing times – in the beginning of the 18th century the time spent on the classical languages already seemed to be competing with the time for cultivating the native language.

The concern about the “unnecessary vocabulary” shows that Latin was increasingly understood as something restricted to reading the authors and that the utilitarian aims of Latin learning were becoming superfluous. Heumann criticises various Latin aids teaching such vocabulary, taking Comenius’ picture encyclopedia *Orbis pictus* as an example, regarding them as “useful only for those who would like to enter that Latin city and to speak only Latin through all their lives”. It should suffice to simply consult a dictionary if any such terms occur when reading the authors; otherwise they are not necessary for a learned person.

The objection of a hypothetical perfectly Latin speaking city lasting only for one lifetime reflects the difference in nature between Latin and vernacular languages. They are fickle and ever-changing, while Latin remains stable through centuries and this is a core advantage of Latin; it is ensured by Latin being transmitted to new generations through books and an unchanging canon of authors, but if the language would have to be transmitted through an unreliable living usage, this is assumed to be a risky business that would put Latin in the same ever-changing territory.

The connection Heumann makes between the active usage of Latin and its corruption is a broader theme. The stricter grammatical wing of Latinists, especially the Ciceronian movement of the 16th century, had long been suspicious of spontaneous Latin speech. Erasmus noticed this trait and related a story that even he could not manage to strike up a Latin conversation with a certain

160 Heumannus ([1718], 8): “*Deinde* in urbe Tulliopolitana forent addiscenda & in numero habenda quam plurima vocabula, quae nunc ignorantes permulti inter viros Latine eloquentissimos nomen suum summo iure profitentur. Civibus enim illis in promptu *<sic>* deberent esse pleraque omnia *<sic>* nomina animantium, item herbarum, partium domus, instrumentorum eorum, quibus rustici, quibus opifices utuntur, pariterque utensilium in culina, in horto, in cella penuaria, in stabulis, alibique locorum occurrentium. Atque hunc in usum nonnulli aggressi sunt conscribere *Ianuas Scholasve Latinitatis, Orbes* item *pictos*, libros tantummodo iis usui futuros, qui aliquando in civitatem illam Latinam recipi, & per omnem vitam non nisi Latine loqui voluerint. Caeteri illorum nominum notitia carere, contentique esse possunt, si in *Plinio, Columella, Celso, Vitruvio* talia occurrant, adire Lexicon. Equidem liberaliter fateor, mihi pleraque piscium, herbarum, domesticorumque utensilium nomina Latina esse incognita: sed tantum abest, ut eius me rei pudeat, ut potius doctae, quam philosophi vocant, ignorantiae partem hanc non postremam esse arbitretur.”

161 Heumannus ([1718], 9): “adeoque, si vel maxime Latina illa civitas institui posset, in qua nemo non Latine loqueretur, ac vel Tullio palmam eloquentiae dubiam faceret, *res* tamen, quod de Romuli civitate masculina dixit *Florus*, futura est *unius aetatis*.”

Florentine humanist, otherwise an excellent Latin writer – he obstinately continued to speak Italian.¹⁶² The great Ciceronian Pietro Bembo (*Petrus Bembus*, 1470-1547) and his followers avoided speaking Latin without prior preparation, as they were sure that mistakes in spontaneous speech are inevitable and that they are detrimental to the cultivation of the language, which needs to aim for perfection;¹⁶³ therefore, they were critical of the (necessarily imperfect) speaking encouraged by the most teachers of Latin at the time and enforced by the internal rules of schools. This view is exemplified by the famous dicta of the Spanish philologist Franciscus Sanctius Brocensis (*Francisco Sánchez de las Brozas*, 1523-1600) found in his 1587 work *Minerva*: “who chatter in Latin, corrupt Latinity itself” and “one should never, at no age and at no occasion, speak Latin without premeditation”.¹⁶⁴ Probably because they depreciated the communicative function of Latin, they turned to vernacular: Bembo contributed greatly to the literary Tuscan dialect, while Sanctius preferred to use Spanish in his teaching role even in the cases when Latin was mandated. Following this argument, the skill of speaking Latin might not be something to be admired *per se* (even if it usually was),¹⁶⁵ it is not an art that can be perfected.¹⁶⁶ Errors and impurities are inevitable when speaking (especially when the speaker is still a student), and expressing or hearing them fortifies bad habits in language;¹⁶⁷ speaking and hearing such language is no substitute for a careful study and imitation of the best authors by absorbing their style and memorising classically attested

162 Erasmus (1532, 380): “Quod accurate factum velimus, raro faciendum est. Hac ratione duci videntur Itali quidam eruditi, qui licet pulchre calleant latine, tamen vix unquam adduci possunt ut in familiari congressu latine loquantur. At si quando compellit necessitas, dicunt exacte, quasque de scripto. Novi Venetiæ Bernardum Ocularium civem Florentinum, cuius historias si legisses, dixisses alterum Salustium, aut certe Salustii temporibus scriptas. Nunquam tamen ab homine impetrare licuit, ut mecum latine loqueretur. Subinde interpellabam, surdo loqueris vir præclare, vulgaris linguæ vestratis tam sum ignarus, quàm Indicæ. Verbum latinum nunquam quivi ab eo extundere.”. Sanctius himself cites this story (Sanctius Brocensis 1587, 269v f.), approving of this behaviour. The humanist in question is Bernardo Rucellai (*Bernardus Oricellarius / Ocularius*, 1448-1514), who was a good Latin stylist, e.g., writing in 1511 a work called *De bello Italico* about a recent campaign of Charles VIII of France into Italy “in a perfect Sallustian style” (Comanducci 2017).

163 Cf. Tunberg (2012, 49)

164 Sanctius concludes his *Minerva* (Sanctius Brocensis 1587) with a chapter named “Qui Latine garriunt corrumpunt ipsam Latinitatem” (p. 266v-271v), and the last sentence of his book is “Ego denique cum doctissimis (neminem excipio) viris teneo nulla aut ætate, aut tempore Latina lingua, nisi præmeditatè, esse loquendum.” (p. 271v). The form Sanctius originally used in 1578 before this final formulation in *Minerva* was even stricter: “the speaking of Latin corrupts Latinity itself” (*Latine loqui corrumpit ipsam Latinitatem*, Maestre Maestre (2006, 94)). The context of this proclamation and the ensuing dispute with the proponents of Latin speaking are treated by Maestre Maestre (2006, 94-100); Maestre Maestre (2007); Maestre Maestre (2008); Tunberg (2012, 34-36); Salor (2022).

165 Cf. footnote 171.

166 Sanctius Brocensis (1587, 267v): “sed Latine loquendi nulla est ars”. Iacobus Perizonius, the editor of the 1687 edition of *Minerva*, could not help noting in a footnote that this sort of artificial separation of speaking and writing, negating the organic unity of the language system, where writing is an art, but speaking is not, is absurd: “Ain’ tandem? <...> Quodsi loquendi Latine non est Ars; nec scribendi illa fuerit? Quid enim est scribere, nisi literis consignare, quae et voce proferre possis? <...> Aut, si linguae est observatio quaedam, num alia ista et loquendi recte, alia scribendi?? <sic!> <...> Piget vero, pugnare in tam manifesto errore arguendo, quem libidini datum, non rationi appareat.” (Sanctius 1687, 571).

167 This view (which was also not predominant at the time) is not supported by the modern language pedagogy – mistakes while learning the language are inevitable, but they are quickly corrected rather than remaining like some kind of an incurable wound.

expressions, which is the only way to the real knowledge of Latin; paradoxically, the use of the language becomes an obstacle to the learning of the language – so the methods employed for teaching Greek or Hebrew, incorporating no speaking, are preferable.¹⁶⁸ Nonetheless, at the time this exclusion of free speaking was not a dominant view. Sanctius was well aware that he was publishing his thesis against the prevalent orthodoxy of the time – that the active use of Latin is useful both in the learning process (in disputes, etc.) and as an instrument of communication. This orthodoxy held, illustrated by the fact that the later editions of Sanctius' *Minerva* distance themselves from Sanctius' inflexible stance and argumentation. In 1687, after a hundred years, the editor of a new edition, the Dutch philologist Jacobus Perizonius (*Jakob Voorbroek*, 1651-1715), leaves the controversial chapter for the judgement of the reader and notes that the international mission of universities is impossible without the teaching being performed in Latin, the international language of all learned; hence, one has to speak Latin both often and, frequently, without any prior preparation, i.e., *premeditation*. It is just that this extemporaneous skill has to be learned from the reading of authors and from style exercises rather than from a lax every-day use of Latin – in this regard he agreed with Sanctius.¹⁶⁹ This moderate stance was probably much more representative of the general consensus than the original statement by Sanctius.

Heumann has suspicions about the Latin employed in this Latin town, but another contemporaneous critic of *civitates Latinae*, the German philologist Jakob Burckhard (1681-1752), goes much further: “nothing else would be accomplished by such a *Latin city*, if such a one would be founded in our times, than the production of a multitude of those who would be considered by the common people to speak Latin, but who would run out of words when anything important would need to be said or any classical author would need to be explained”.¹⁷⁰ This reference to the “common people” seems to be a direct parallel to the words of Sanctius: “the foolish crowd which praises and admires the speakers of Latin”.¹⁷¹ These statements imply that the society generally

168 “At ego, apud quem pluris est rectæ rationis pondus, quam multorum præscriptum, assero nihil pestilentius posse iuveni linguæ Latinæ cupido evenire, quam aut verbis Latinis effutire cogitata, aut loquentium profluentiae interesse. Quicumque enim aliquando peritiam Latinæ linguæ est assequutus, Petrum Bembum dico, aut Osorium, aut nostrum Pincianum, non loquendo, sed scribendo, meditando, et imitatione id sunt assecuti. <...> Non discimus Hebræa, vel Græca, ut loquamur, sed ut docti efficiamur. Quur <sic> igitur in Latinis non idem efficiemus, quandoquidem iam nulla natio est, quæ Latinè aut Græcè loquatur? Stylus exercendus est diligenter, hic enim, ut M. Tullius ait, est egregius dicendi magister, hic verè nos docebit, communi sensu illos carere, qui linguam Latinam in plateis, aut etiam in gymnasiis miris modis conantur dilacerare.” (Sanctius Brocensis 1587, 266v-267r)

169 Sanctius (1687, 639-640). Cf. footnote 166.

170 Burckhard (1721, 588-589): “Nihil tamen profici amplius istiusmodi *Latina Civitate*, si talis institueretur nostra ætate, posse, arbitror, quam ut hominum, <...> *Latine loquentium*, sive *balbutientium*, prodiret inde *multitudo*, quos Latine loqui *populus putaret*, <...> sed quos, si res magna ageretur, una cum re verba statim deficerent; & qui, si Latinus scriptor, de veteribus unus, explicandus esset, hærent, ac ne sibi quidem, quid eorum quisque vellet, intelligerent, nedum quid ex iis cum aliis porro communicare possent.” (italics by the author; presented and cited by Sdzuj (2012, 610-611), used by Fryksell (1739, 19)).

171 “*Obiectio quinta*. // Si Latinè loqui non esset laudabile, non ita passim ab omnibus commendaretur: Et omnes Academiae legibus sanxerunt, ut & Latinè legatur, & disputetur. ¶ Responsio. Quasi vero quidquam tam sit valde,

tended to appreciate the oral fluency in Latin, but in the academic and especially philological circles wariness and suspicion about it increasingly prevailed.



Matthias Fryksell in his 1739 thesis, after reviewing various inductive methods of learning Latin and grouping the *civitas Latina* idea as one of them, reviews both the projects and their critics,¹⁷² especially Heumann, citing him heavily and adopting both his framework and his position. Fryksell notes that the boys from poor families, having now been educated in Latin, will not be content with their position as simple tradesmen in a Latin town, when they would rather use these prestigious skills (namely the fluency in Latin) for obtaining higher positions in the broader society; so there is an inherent social conflict between knowing Latin and being in the lower classes.¹⁷³ He mines Sanctius' *Minerva* for quotes supporting the idea that the skill of speaking spontaneously tends to correlate negatively with the learnedness, but moderates Sanctius' position, conceding that sometimes the speaking of Latin is required, citing Perizonius for the need of sourcing this ability from authors rather than chatter.¹⁷⁴ This statement, together with the scathing quote from Burckhard, forms the conclusion of the thesis: the desired *reborn Latium* (*Latium redivivum*) is already present in the schools, there is no need to create a new Utopian one.¹⁷⁵



The debate of the proposals and criticisms of *civitates Latinae* reflects deep differences in the opinions about the nature and use of Latin. The proponents saw the Latin language as something finite that could be readily acquired to a reasonable degree through inductive methods and then it would already be useful for its communicative aspects; the opponents saw Latin as an intellectual journey where a profound knowledge of the language, its style and authors was the goal and the journey, in its rigorous study and exercise, valuable in itself. In one case, the purity of the language was not a concern, as it was assumed to be sufficiently present even when the language was transmitted orally, while in the other case it *was* a matter of great concern, as it was assumed to be impossible to attain the purity of language without an assiduous reading of the classical authors.

quàm nihil sapere, vulgare: ut præclare 2. de Divinatione scripsit Cicero. Sed quoniam tu mihi stultorum turbam objicis, qui Latinè loquentes colunt & admirantur: ego tibi contrà doctissimorum iudicium et consensum opponam, qui huiusmodi pestem, sive loquentiam aversantur.” (Sanctius Brocensis 1587, 269r)

172 Proponents: Morhof, Pastorius, Lubinus, the anonymous author of the 1668 *Examen* (translated into English as Anonymous (1669)). Critics: Heumann, Johann Gottlieb Heinecke (1681–1741; Heineccius (1736, 266–267)).

173 Fryksell (1739, 8)

174 Fryksell (1739, 13–14) contains testimonies he collected from Sanctius: Suetonius, Erasmus (see footnote 168), Joachim Fortius. The conclusion of the chapter in pp. 15–16 is a paraphrased quote from Perizonius (cf. footnote 169).

175 Fryksell (1739, 19–20): “Gratulamur interim nobis, hodierno die, superesse Latium illud redivivum in Scholis, Gymnasiis & Academiis, ubi Latinam linguam cum reliquis studiis humanioribus, audiendo non tantum, legendo & scribendo, verum etiam perorando & disputando, addiscendi est facta juventuti copia & potestas: Heic, si unquam alibi, Romanas veneres inde a puero imbibere licebit non sordibus contaminatas, sed ex fontibus classicorum Auctorum purissimis haustas, & hauriendas.”

Thus Sanctius, having rejected much of the use of Latin because of this concern, represents one extreme, while the perpetual immersion and transmission of Latin through an eventually self-perpetuating oral tradition (as envisioned in the more Utopian aspects of the *civitas Latina*) can be considered its polar opposite. The general practice was somewhere in the middle, sometimes emphasising the grammatical training, sometimes focusing on the oral proficiency – for example, the Jesuit schools tended towards the latter.¹⁷⁶

In a way, these positions resemble the “utilitarians” and the “purists” seen in the 20th century debates around the Living Latin movement: in both cases there was an alternation between an enthusiasm for Latin as a great instrument of communication and a caution about the soundness and validity of the language employed. Thus the roots of these modern factions may be seen in the discussions of the 17th and 18th centuries about the *civitas Latina* concept, originating in turn from the 16th century positions regarding the purity, usage and teaching of Latin. It is a clash of two views of the nature of Latin: one where primarily the correct form of language and the philological knowledge are emphasised and attained through careful study, and the other where the language is seen as a useful instrument and the skill of speaking Latin that would be valuable both *per se* and for further studies of Latin itself is acquired in an immersive communicational environment.

¹⁷⁶ The Jesuit schools were representative of the spoken wing. *De Institutione grammatica libri tres*, the Latin grammar officially adopted by the Jesuit order (it was popular also outside the Catholic Europe, reaching hundreds of editions both inside and outside the Catholic education system) and written by the Portuguese Emmanuel Alvarus SJ (*Manuel Álvarez*, 1526-1582), advised the teachers to teach students to speak Latin even before formulating the rules: “Neque sit magister sollicitus de nominativi & verbi consensu: priusque, si fieri poterit, discipulos doceat bene Latine loqui, quam causas bene loquendi.” (Alvarus (1572, 16r), as noted and contrasted with Sanctius by Percival (1975, 259)). Weissius (1724, 98-100) notes that the Jesuits teach their pupils to speak Latin freely about everything and do not care much about the purity of their Latin, it is assumed to come by itself in due time. “Corrupte illos Lojolæ sectatores & iniquate admodum loqui, non negant: malunt tamen ita loqui suos, quam prorsus non loqui.” (p. 100). Thus the students used to reach an oral fluency in Latin often admired by people to such degree that even Protestants would consider the Jesuit educational system superior to their own. In fact, according to Gasser ([1720], 9-10), Protestant Germans would even send their children to Jesuit institutions; after deploring this fact, Gasser maintains that his own *civitas Latina* would successfully compete with the Jesuits by providing an even better and more correct fluency in Latin. Could this be the reason why the discussion of the *civitates Latinae* was attested mostly in the Protestant lands? Catholics already had the Jesuit order, which would impose a Latin speaking environment in its institutions; it would not be utopically perfect and all-encompassing, but it would provide the desired fluency reasonably well.

2.2.3 Michael Olmo's *Roma Tullia* (1817): a *civitas Latina* for the post-Napoleonic Europe

The most famous¹⁷⁷ representative of this tradition is Michael Olmo¹⁷⁸ / Miguel del Olmo (*Miguel María del Olmo y Herrera*, -1831?),¹⁷⁹ a Catholic priest from Spain living in France, and his lengthy Latin pamphlet¹⁸⁰ *Leisure hours in Villaudric, or a book about cultivation of the Latin language and foundation of a Latin city, addressed to the eight great princes in Vienna who established peace in the world in 1815 (Otia Villaudricensia...)* published in 1817.¹⁸¹ He proposed the foundation of *Roma Tullia*, a *civitas Latina* somewhere in Central Europe, in a dedicated territory not more than five miles from some rich and flourishing city.¹⁸² It is imagined as an international project: every nation of Europe would send four to ten young people of both sexes to the new city. An international council managing the whole project would select the candidates and assign them according to their birth and merits to one of the two classes,¹⁸³ namely to the citizens (*cives*) or to the nobles (*patricii sive nobiles*).¹⁸⁴ The colonists could then enter mixed-nation marriages¹⁸⁵ and form Latin speaking families. Males would be required to know Latin before applying, while the requirements for women would be less strict: after the application they could be taught basic colloquial Latin through specially-written dialogues – Olmo is thinking about the ones written by Joannes Ludovicus Vives (*Juan Luis Vives*, 1493-1540) as an example – and would then enter the Latin colony. Young people from poor families applying for roles of servants in *Roma*

177 IJsewijn and Sacré (1993) is the fundamental treatise on Olmo's proposal; see also Sacré (1990), IJsewijn (1990, 112-113), Sacré (1993), IJsewijn (1996, 47), Tournoy, Roegiers and Coppens (1993, 209-211), Waquet (2001, 158), Sylvos (2005), Sylvos (2008, 137 ff.), Stroh (2008, 293-294), Sdzuj (2012), Slednikov (2019a, 57-60), Deraedt (2022). IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 57) note that Olmo was most probably not aware of this tradition; it seemed for him that he invented the idea himself, and only later discovered a similar idea by Moreau de Maupertuis in his *Lettre sur le progrès des sciences* (1752); see footnote 187.

178 The Latin form of the name. There are many variations. In France he was known as Michel Olmo, abbé d'Olmo, Michael M. Olmo, etc.

179 IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 61-62) list the other Spanish and Latin publications by Olmo and note the Spanish name used (there are no doubts about the identity). The probable date of his death can be inferred from two sources: the Church archive of Seville contains Olmo's testament dated 1831 ("18. Testamento de don Miguel María del Olmo y Herrera, medio racionero (1831).", Rubio Merino (1987, 311)) and the yearbook of the Spanish Church (*Guia del Estado Ecclesiastico seglar y regular...*) does not list him in the issues released after 1831, where he used to be listed even when living in France. In the last entry (Sánchez de Haedo 1831, 137) he is listed as a canon in the Archdiocese of Seville of the lower rank (*racionero medio*): "Dr. D. Miguel María del Olmo y Herrera, condecorado con la Flor de Lis de Francia, y catedrático de lenguas hebrea y griega de la universidad literaria de esta ciudad". He bore this *condecorado* designation in the catalogue in 1829-1831.

180 Olmo (1816).

181 Olmo (1816, 136) contains a letter dated 5 Feb. 1817 (and published in *Hermes Romanus* March 1817 Vol. II No. 10 pp. 466-470), so the final version was published in 1817, even if the title page indicates 1816.

182 Olmo (1816, 123); IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 56).

183 These classes are reminiscent of the pre-revolutionary France.

184 Olmo (1816, 124): "§ XCVII. *De primis civitatis Latinæ civibus, ac de legibus linguæ.* Postquàm ergò edictis voluntas vestra innotuerit, de civitate Latinâ fundandâ, amplissimisque beneficiis colonis honorandis, concilium adibunt omnes, quiqui nomen suum dare voluerint, scripto Latino, ætatem, genus, vitæ conditionem exprimente; qui quidem si digni, ac benè morati erunt, in unam duarum classium, quarum altera patriciorum sive nobilium erit, altera verò civium cæterorum, pro illorum genere et meritis adscribentur."

185 Olmo alludes that the same international council would arrange them.

Tullia would similarly be taught Latin in advance through dialogues containing necessary phrases, and would receive full citizenship after marrying Latin-speaking wives. The same enforced diversity applies: the master and the servants must have different national origins in order to ensure a Latin speaking environment. Everyone would have the right to spend time outside the city, but would have to return by nightfall. The city would be filled with Latin-language signs containing useful phrases and dialogues; many objects would have signs inscribed with their Latin designations affixed to them. The learned citizens would work on new editions of Latin authors, correction of texts, and on Latin dictionaries, presumably those concerning modern terms.¹⁸⁶ This work would contribute to the return of the international Latin language.

This utopian scheme makes Olmo undoubtedly a part of the *civitas Latina* tradition, even if he believed to describe an invention wholly his own – he was barely aware of his precursors.¹⁸⁷ But there is a marked contrast: the earlier authors tended to be quite utilitarian in their purposes, their main declared concern being simply an efficient acquisition of a useful, important and necessary language, while Olmo is strongly ideological. In Olmo's time, Latin was increasingly a symbol of the past¹⁸⁸ and using Latin was no longer simply useful in a culturally relatively unmarked way. The

186 He was not the first one to propose this – Gasser ([1720], 17) believes that the local professor of *Rhomaïopolis* should work on Latin technical terminology and publish dictionaries of neologisms: “Hujus est: / (a) *Consulere studiosis*, si quidam termini technici ipsos supertugiant. Eo fine ipse libris subsidiariis instructus sit, necesse est, horasque subcisivas illi labori tribuat, ut quæritantibus satisfacere possit, constanterque ruminetur, ne vel vocola sit, quam non ipse satis genuinè reddere possit. Proindè & commercia litteraria foveat cum iis, quos novit pulchrum statuere, de latinæ linguæ cultura benè mereri. Non defuturos quoque credo, qui consummata Lexica terminorum technicorum, quæ adhuc desiderantur, juris publici facturi sint.”

187 After several months of the development of the scheme while still convinced of its complete originality, Olmo discovered (Olmo (1816, 120-121); cf. IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 57); Sacré (1990, 42-43); Sdzuj (2012, 606-607; 619)) that the French scientist Pierre Louis Moreau de Maupertuis (1698-1759) had already published a suggestion (Maupertuis 1752, 57-58) about the possibility and desirability of founding a Latin town (*ville latine*). Olmo later decided, as he tells the readers, that having an illustrious predecessor is a good thing for the inventor and that his own project is far superior – the citizens *Roma Tullia* would come from different nations, so enforcing Latin as an intermediary would be far more viable than if, as Maupertuis proposes, the Latin town would be (for instance) located in France and populated by French Latinists. Sdzuj (2012, 619) notes this break in tradition, Olmo's apparent ignorance of the previous proposals (*wie es scheint – in fast völliger Unkenntnis der hier skizzierten Phase*). The same observation might also apply to Maupertuis. Georg Christoph Pisanski (1710-1790) was surprised that Maupertuis proposed a well-known project and did not cite any predecessors, regarding his idea a new and original one (Pisanski (1886, 635): “Es ist daher zu bewundern, daß der Präsident der Berlinischen Academie der Wissenschaften *<sic>* Maupertuis in seinen zu Dresden 1752. 8. gedruckten *Lettres* diesen Vorschlag abermals gethan und ihn für einen neuen gehalten hat.”; this source is indicated by Sdzuj (2012, 613); the statement was first published in a 1886 edition, nearly 100 years after the death of its author). Maupertuis came up with this idea after a broader process of intellectual exploration of the international language question: “Doch ist MAUPERTUIS selbst nicht so ganz von der Unübertrefflichkeit seiner Muttersprache überzeugt, da er später ein radikales Project zur Vereinfachung aller Sprachen vorbringt, nämlich alle Declination und Flexion, alle Unregelmässigkeit, allen Geschlechtsunterschied zu beseitigen. *<...>* so haben wir bereits bei ihm die drei Hauptströmungen kennen gelernt, die auch heute noch bei Behandlung des Problems der Universalsprache neben einander herlaufen. Er empfiehlt neben einander die verbreitetste moderne Sprache, zweitens eine neue, auf die einfachsten Elemente reducirte *<sic>* Idealsprache und endlich das Latein.” (Diels 1899, 597-598). So Maupertuis first promoted French, then the idea of a simplified language, and finally Latin; accordingly, he can be considered as an early precursor of Henderson, who also went through phases of artificial language construction and of international Latin advocacy.

188 Cf. IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 52)

pamphlet was written immediately after the Vienna congress, during which the victorious European powers decided the future order of Europe after the defeat of Napoleon, and addressed to the “eight great princes who established peace in the world”. *Roma Tullia* would be founded as a perennial monument for this victorious peace. Olmo wholly identifies with the reactionary character of the new Europe of restored royal power and hopes that the great rulers would restore the ancient order, values and hierarchy;¹⁸⁹ his project imitates the laws of the Old Regime. He takes the Ancient side in the Quarrel of the Ancients and the Moderns (*Querelle des Anciens et des Modernes*): Olmo rails against the Enlightenment *philosophes*, blaming them with the destruction caused by the French Revolution and the Napoleonic wars, and hopes that their pestiferous doctrines would be banished.

However, it might be possible that the reactionary tone of our arch-conservative and seemingly anti-French author was a recent transformation or rather a mere pose dictated by the atmosphere of the Vienna congress rather than something revealing his own deep convictions. Surprisingly, several years ago Olmo, when still in Seville, belonged to the pro-French Bonapartist party and enthusiastically collaborated with the new French regime, becoming its ardent propagandist and taking political roles. In 1810 he was even selected to the delegation tasked for personally welcoming the new King of Spain Joseph I Bonaparte (brother of Napoleon) to Seville. Olmo also was one of the two editors of the official Bonapartist regime newspaper in Seville¹⁹⁰ and authored numerous pro-regime proclamations. For this, he was awarded a position of a canon in the archdiocese of Seville.¹⁹¹ That’s why we find him in France after the defeat of Napoleon – after the expulsion of the French occupation regime, Olmo, together with Alberto Lista, his co-editor, and the

189 Olmo (1816, 76-77)

190 Checa Godoy (2013): “La *Gazeta de Sevilla* la dirige Alberto Lista (Sevilla, 1775-1848), canónigo de la catedral hispalense, la redacta Miguel del Olmo, racionero de la misma, y en ella colabora asiduamente otro conocido sacerdote, Félix José Reynoso (Sevilla, 1772-Madrid, 1841). La presencia del clero es desde luego muy destacada en el caso de Andalucía”.

191 Barbastro Gil (2013, 188) writes about the enthusiasm of Olmo for the French cause and about him becoming an ardent propagandist for the Bonapartist regime: “Mucho más llamativo y sincero nos parece el comportamiento afrancesado de Miguel M^a del Olmo, joven clérigo gaditano afincado en Sevilla, cuya habilidad personal y pronta adhesión a la causa bonapartista llamaron la atención de las autoridades civiles y militares de la Sevilla ocupada. Miembro de la Sociedad Sevillana de Amigos del País y de la Real Academia de Bellas Letras desde 1805, formó parte de la delegación de personalidades que salió a recibir al rey José a su llegada a Sevilla, convirtiéndose en seguida en uno de los más fervientes propagandistas del nuevo régimen, a las órdenes de Soult. Redactor junto con Alberto Lista de la *Gaceta de Sevilla*, fue a su vez el autor de un escrito que se publicó en esta ciudad con el atractivo título de «Pragmática de los Papamoscas». Pero, sobre todo, a Miguel M^a del Olmo se debe un interesante e inflamado «Discurso de un eclesiástico a sus compatriotas», aparecido el 10 de julio de 1810, y que se ha atribuido erróneamente a Lista.”. According to Carbajosa Aguilera (2015, 246-247), these collaborationist services were the reason why Olmo was awarded with a position in the Seville cathedral chapter (“Gracias a sus servicios, fue premiado en abril de 1811 con una media ración en la Catedral”). This fact is also mentioned by Morange (2002, 156) who attributes this gift to the French general Jean-de-Dieu Soult: “También habría que mencionar a otros eclesiásticos e intelectuales sevillanos como los hermanos Roldán y Mármol o M. M. del Olmo, miembro de la Academia de Buenas Letras y, a partir de 1810, activo colaborador de Soult, quien le dio una prebenda de la catedral.”. Martín Riego (2010, 90) shows Olmo’s appointment in the context of a wider political reshuffle in the Seville cathedral chapter under the French rule.

other French-aligned canons of Seville,¹⁹² joined the other *afrancesados*, the collaborators of the Bonaparte regime, in seeking refuge in France.¹⁹³ So, paradoxically, our “reactionary” Olmo actually belonged to the liberal émigrés fleeing persecution of a vengeful conservative reign of the restored king Ferdinand VII. It remains an enigma how these political affiliations and the enthusiasm for a liberal French cause could be compatible with the reactionary views expressed in *Otia Villaudricensia*, where Olmo criticises the Enlightenment and the French Revolution.

Much space is given in the book to the superiority of Latin and the deficiencies of the vernacular languages; the universality of Latin is praised throughout.¹⁹⁴ The structure of Latin is judged to be much more perfect than that of the other languages, especially French.¹⁹⁵ If there have ever been great minds writing in vernacular languages, this happened not because these languages were particularly suited while Latin was deficient – it is just that these great minds have ennobled these languages by choosing to pander to popularity with the masses rather than striving for immortality by writing in Latin.¹⁹⁶ It is wrong to see Latin as a deficient language for modern subjects – if it lacks any terms, they have to be added; after all, every language had to come up with new terms once new things were encountered.¹⁹⁷

The teaching of Latin should be reformed: it should be taught in a more colloquial and less analytical way, for example, by means of dialogues. The active use of Latin should be re-established. Latin skills should become a requirement for people looking for a career (when applying for higher-up positions). It should become the default international language of scholars, thus transcending the national barriers and bringing all the learned world closer (and probably also

192 Dufour (1986, 172) informs that 8 out of 40 members of the Seville cathedral chapter went to an exile in France – which is not surprising, considering that quite many of them, like Olmo, had been installed by the Bonapartist regime.

193 The published list of Spanish clerics who fled to France (Dufour 1986, 190) contains a curious entry: “OLMEDO (Miguel del). Prebendado de Sevilla”. There is little doubt that this is only a misspelling of “OLMO”, and that the *prebendado* instead of *medio prebendado* was used because it is a more general term – Olmo also titles himself simply as *prebendado* in one of his own title pages (del Olmo y Herrera 1825)

194 Sylvos (2005, 107) sees in Olmo’s idealisation of Latin an elitist universalism: “Olmo invente une version catholique de l’idéal des Lumières et, à l’universel, préfère l’universalité de la langue latine. Il n’en appelle donc pas à la raison abstraite qui s’élève au-dessus des particularismes locaux et nationaux pour fonder les Droits de l’Homme et transcende les couches sociales, mais préconise l’usage du latin comme passeport linguistique susceptible d’unir les gens de bonne compagnie par-delà les frontières. De cette universalité sont partiellement exclues les femmes et la plèbe alors que sont concernés au premier chef les tenants d’un savoir classique perpétuant les traditions d’Ancien Régime et le pouvoir ecclésiastique.”

195 It is ironic that Olmo derides the claims of perfection of vernacular languages based on familiarity with them (pp. 23-25, § XIII: *Quòd linguæ non ex consuetudine, sed ex ratione judicari debeant*), but also judges his native Spanish to exceed in perfection all other living languages and to be in some ways (in composites and diminutives) even more perfect than Latin (p. 65).

196 Olmo (1816, 20-21)

197 Olmo (1816, 29-30)

separating them from their less learned compatriots).¹⁹⁸ The Latin *res publica litterarum* (composed by the *learned*) would once again constitute the global sphere of communication.

So Olmo's project is not simply a proposal of a Latin town, but also a critique of the times and a far-reaching utopian reform of the world, where the wholesale restoration of Latin happens together with the return to the old mores. Olmo continued his campaign for a number of years (at least until 1824),¹⁹⁹ writing letters and soliciting support for his project, presenting it to various officials and, in 1821, securing an audience with the French king Louis XVIII.²⁰⁰ He continued to develop his project in his mind and to think about different versions of it – its reactionary character got more moderate with time²⁰¹ and it seems that he later imagined it not so much as a town, but as a

198 Olmo (1816, 109-110): “§ LXXXVII. *De restaurandis scientiis auxilio linguae Latinae*. Quocirca invitandi essent honoribus Latinitatis studiosi, ut dictionaria corrigerent, atque complerent, magnumque hunc <sic> in rempublicam litterariam officium conferrent; potius quam in parum utilibus, ac inextricabilibus hujus, et aliarum linguarum originibus tanta emulatione <sic> perscrutandis operam abuterentur. Quod, si, uti credo, præstassent, atque juventutis magistri gratiâ vestrâ accensi, simul communi voluntate et utilitate permoti, dialogorum exercitationes præceptis necessariis adjungerent, ut laboris invidia magnâ ex parte sublevaretur, non dubito, quin, intrâ paucos annos, vobis ducibus, insignem quamdam restaurationem scientiarum, atque orbis terrarum mirabilem proximitatem, et conjunctionem miraremur. <sic> Pudet enim, uti diximus, homines ad societatem germanitate naturæ natos, tot discordantium laborum varietate disjungi.”; pp. 100-101: “§ LXXX. *De augendo in totâ Europâ studio Latinitatis, et de utilitate dialogorum*. E re ergo publicâ omnium populorum credo esse, ut statueretur, ne minores natu viginti annorum, post duos tresve, <sic> something seems to be missing from the sentence) ad ullum omnino honorem, munusve publicum civile aut militare admitti possent, neve cuiquam liceret artem aliquam docere aut scientiam, quin hanc saltem haberent litterarum Latinarum peritiam, quæ in omni fermè Europâ exigitur ab his qui theologiæ aut jurisprudentiæ dant operam; utque iste Latini sermonis amor etiam in ingenuis puellis <sic> girls also get educated in Latin) præmiis et honoribus foveretur, atque dialogorum exercitationibus in omnibus cujusque disciplinæ gymnasiis frequentissimè juvaretur. Nihil tam studia favet linguarum, quam de familiaribus rebus dialoga. <sic> Quamobrem jam sæpissimè miratus sum, istam optimam methodum tradendi cognitionem Latinitatis ab institutoribus negligi, nitique maximè, uti pueri ratiocinio potius et judicio, juxtâ aridorum præceptorum sensa, verba accommodent, quod repetitione et imitatione, faciliiori viâ consequeretur. Commodius enim est, pueris præsertim, memoriter discere, quam judicare et comparare. Quod quidem consilium, longo discendi atque docendi usu olim in Seminario Gaditano firmatum, nunc antem quotidiano trium annorum experimento, Parochus et catechizans comprobavi et comprobo, magna doctorum et indoctorum admiratione.”

199 In 1824, Olmo published a revised version of his *civitas Latina* project in Paris (IJsewijn and Sacré 1993, 65); and in November 1824 he was appointed as a professor of Hebrew in the University of Seville (García Blanco (2015, 290); Navarro Hinojosa (1991, 220)), later also as a professor of Greek. The return to his motherland and new responsibilities probably marked a natural end for his Latin campaign.

200 IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 57-58); his later French writings are analysed also by Sylvos (2005). Surprisingly, a letter from 1821, addressed by the *Latini socii ad restituendam Latinitatem* to the Royal Academy of Spain, is extant online (<https://patrimoniodigital.ucm.es/s/patrimonio/item/164624>, consulted 1.4.2024); copies of the same document are also present in the archives of the Catholic University of Louvain under the code of *BE A4006 CO 003-UE-17* and of the National Virgilian Academy of Mantua (*Accademia Nazionale Virgiliana di Mantova*) under Busta 19 Fasc. 1821 (Lorenzoni and Navarrini 2013, 295). Olmo here is inconspicuously present as one of the 10 *Latini* describing and promoting their campaign for the *fundatio Civitatulæ Latinæ*.

201 E.g., the 1824 French version of the proposal admits non-Catholics too (IJsewijn and Sacré 1993, 58). The 1821 petition of the *Latini socii* still uses the terms of *populus* and *patricii* (cf. footnote 184), but now it seems that the selection criteria would be more related to the level of knowledge of Latin rather than the noble origin: “Tunc pueri pauperrimi, sed probi, puellæque itidem circiter sexaginta, ex singulis nationibus Christianis asciti, in collegiis duobus ita latinè instituentur, ut ex quo pedem in ædes intulerint, nullas omnino, nisi latinas voces, nocteque <sic> dieque audire, nec ipsi loqui possint. Hos, probatos, Senatus, intra biennium, trienniumve (quod tempus ad ediscendam usu loquelæ linguam quamlibet, maximè vero latinam, sufficit), matrimoniis conjungent, <sic> hâc lege, uti inter se illi nubant, qui quamvis ejusdem religionis, tamen diversæ sint gentes. Domus illis ornata, ac prædiola à Senatu, fundatâ jam cum agro Civitatulâ, assignabuntur; sic populi classem, in eadem, formaturi. Nam patriciorum, sive superior ordo, ex aliis ingenuis litteratisque juvenibus adolescentibusque <sic> maximè coalescet, qui, utpotè vel parum divites et ipsi, vel gloriæ tracti cupidine, examinandos se Senatui offerent, novæ Civitatis candidati. Qui

great Latin school or university, thus harking back to the analogy between Latin schools and Latin city-states made already by Comenius in the 17th century.²⁰² He was thus a late, but the most pertinacious proponent of this tradition – no-one before him campaigned for the project of a *civitas Latina* with such intensity, this indeed was original.²⁰³

2.2.4 The early reception of Olmo's project

Olmo's activities did not go unnoticed – after all, in 1817 he met various ambassadors, in 1821 he secured an audience with the French king Louis XVIII,²⁰⁴ he campaigned by sending letters to universities and newspapers etc. – so, naturally, he was discussed and criticised by the French press.²⁰⁵ The reaction of *Hermes Romanus* and *Apis Romana*, two Latin literary periodicals published in France, was largely positive, admiring the idea, but also expressing doubts about the feasibility of *Roma Tullia*. Joseph-Nicolas Barbier-Vémars, the editor of *Hermes Romanus*, reacted in 1817 to Olmo's ideas just as Heumann, who had relegated the project of *civitas Latina* to *literary Utopias*. He alluded that Olmo himself ought to understand the beautiful, but Utopian character of his creation – just as More's *Utopia*, it is a beautiful thing to contemplate and discuss, but it is not realisable.²⁰⁶ *Apis Romana* published a poetic dialogue in Latin hexameters²⁰⁷ which was also quite sceptical – just as many of the earlier critiques, it pondered both the social conflict inherent in the

si digni, jamque Latini erunt, admitti, multo minori numero debebunt, domibusque, et fundis, valdè amplioribus, donari.”

202 Paumès (1909, 47): “Notre Courtaud était mis au courant par Muzac, principal de Brives, et peut être que cet Olmo passant par Cahors, un jour de mai 1821, s’entretint avec lui. L’idée était au moins ingénieuse. C’était une entreprise organisée par actions et la ville latine projetée, aurait pu devenir non pas une nouvelle Rome où l’on n’aurait parlé que latin, mais un grand établissement d’Instruction Publique, une sorte d’Université latine.”

203 Stroh (2008, 293) notes the newness of this earnestness: “Neu war auch die Ernsthaftigkeit [...]”.

204 IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 58). Genevray (1940, 519-520) provides a charming portrait of Olmo in France: “Don Michael Olmo, curé du village de Bessières, dans l’arrondissement de Toulouse, ancien chanoine de Séville, et docteur en théologie, était un prêtre excellent, et très cultivé. Ce grand homme « richement vêtu, face blême et allongée », « yeux étincelants », gestes « expressifs », parlait le grec et l’hébreu, le latin et le français, l’espagnol et l’italien. Il savait par cœur Horace et Virgile, commentait délicatement La Fontaine. Dans son presbytère rural, où il avait réuni « une immense bibliothèque », il rêvait la fondation d’une ville latine, qui « fût l’asile international de tous les amis des lettres antiques ». Sa fièvre de classicisme le mit en rapport avec les professeurs du Collège royal de Toulouse, et lui valut l’honneur de faire le voyage de Paris en compagnie de Mgr de Clermont-Tonnerre, qui devait le présenter à Louis XVIII.”. So Olmo was introduced to the King by the same archbishop of Toulouse to whom he had recently dedicated a Latin oration (Olmo 1820).

205 The echoes of Olmo's project in the press were numerous. Deraedt (2022, 9) summarises one of them. The second edition of Olmo's project received in 1824 a critical review from the Paris journal *Revue encyclopédique* (author was a certain B. J.): it stated that neologisms would disfigure the language and that Olmo did not understand the difference between a living and a dead language.

206 “Ut ad vera redeamus (nam nec te somnio tuo deludi arbitror), etsi urbs latina, his præsertim temporibus, condi non potest, placebit tamen libellus tuus, ut Mori *Utopia* placuit: plurima enim continet, quæ doctis et sapientibus utilia disputandi argumenta praebeant. De philologia saltem bene meritis, debitâ laude non carebis.” (Olmo 1816, 136). See Sacré (1987) for *Hermes Romanus*. Olmo had sent the first version of his *Otia Villaudricensia* to Barbier-Vémars, who wrote this review in *Hermes Romanus* that Olmo later included as an endorsing preface in the first public edition of his booklet.

207 Sacré (1993, 117) mentions this detail. A certain J. V. D. published the poem in *Apis Romana* June 1822 Vol. II No. 2 pp. 49-52. Sacré (2014) provides some information about the journal.

Latin speakers engaging in a low-prestige manual work and the dearth of Latin-speaking women to make this city realisable. It concluded with an incredulous endorsement of the proposal: “Even if hardly a believer, I long for this together with you. The wish remains: if only that city, destined for such a splendid fate, would arise!”²⁰⁸

The most important line of reception starts with an anonymous review of Olmo’s book published in June 1822 in the London *Classical Journal*.²⁰⁹ The sympathetic reviewer fondly remembers the times when Latin was the international academic language and the Oxford halls resounded with fervent disputations in Latin. He agrees with the advantages of the project²¹⁰ and faithfully summarises Olmo’s work, tracing his argumentation by providing several pages of quotes in small type. The reviewer’s conclusion is a subtle rejection: it is “a plan, which we consider as ingenious and plausible, but, we fear, visionary.”²¹¹ By presenting Olmo’s project in pages of a wide-circulation journal, the reviewer saved it for posterity: most of the reception can be traced to this article, while the original pamphlet laid unread and faded into obscurity.

Sometime during the same summer of 1822, Heinrich Karl Abraham Eichstädt (*Henricus Carolus Abrahamus Eichstadius*, 1771-1848), a well-noted classical philologist²¹² in the University of Jena, head of the *Societas Latina Ienensis*²¹³ and an experienced Latin orator,²¹⁴ received a fresh copy of the *Classical Journal*, read this review and decided that Olmo’s idea could become the topic for the oration he had to deliver in September announcing the Latin literary contest organised by the *Societas*. This Latin oration²¹⁵ was titled *About the new proposal by Michael Olmo of founding a Latin city* and was fundamentally about the proper role of Latin.

208 *Apis Romana* June 1822 Vol. II No. 2 p. 49-52: “Hæc tecum, quamvis, fateor, male credulus, opto. / Sed votum superest, magis omnibus utile votum / Urbs utinàm, quam fata manent tam splendida, surgat!”

209 Anonymous (1822)

210 Anonymous (1822, 281): “We fully agree with the author in estimating the advantages that would arise from his proposed arrangement. We shall give his plan in his own words: {...}”

211 Anonymous (1822, 284)

212 Officially the professor of Poetry and Eloquence and the head of the Philological seminar (Halm 1877).

213 *Societas Latina Jenensis* was a learned society founded in Jena in 1734 (formally as a part of the university) using Latin as its proper language (see Goetz (1931), Jaumann (2002)). H. K. A. Eichstädt became its head in 1800 and led it until his own death in 1848; it then disappeared.

214 Koch (1958, 140) indicates that Eichstädt, due to his well-noted eloquence, was titled the *Orator Europae* by the consistory of Weimar on his 50th birthday. Latin orations form a large proportion of his literary heritage.

215 Originally published as a booklet (Eichstadius 1822), reprinted as Eichstaedt (1840): “Dissertatio de novo Mich. Olmonis consilio civitatem Latinam fundandi”.

He believed that Latin should have remained the international language for diplomacy²¹⁶ and (at least the classical) scholarship;²¹⁷ that it would be desirable to continue teaching various subjects in Latin, where it had traditionally been used; he encouraged the students to read, write, dispute and deliver orations in Latin. However, Eichstädt was critical of the careless or incompetent teachers who encouraged their pupils to express themselves in Latin without supervising them and correcting their mistakes; this negligent use of Latin (and Greek) and the teaching in Latin by teachers who did not know it well enough might have been the reasons why these languages had been becoming (as he thought) quite corrupt.²¹⁸ Eichstädt would have agreed with some of Sanctius' criticisms regarding the use of Latin, summed up by the expression "who chatters in Latin, corrupts Latin". Eichstädt expressed his opinion mainly by quoting the German classicist luminaries of the Neohumanist movement (*Neuhumanismus*) and the emerging *Alttertumswissenschaften*: Johann Matthias Gesner (1691-1761),²¹⁹ Johann August Ernesti (1707-1781), Friedrich August Wolf (1759-

216 Eichstaedt (1840, 120): "Nam saepe in votis habuerunt viri prudentissimi, et nuper etiam vir maxima auctoritate optavit, ut, quae patrum memoria communis fuisset lingua eruditorum, apud nos adhiberetur rebus publicis, iis potissimum, quae a principum legatis essent obeundae, vel, ut planius dicam, ut lingua latina fieret diplomatica*. <...> Ceterum ne huic quidem saluberrimo consilio illam Romam Tulliam, qualem Hispanus informavit, multum profuturam spero. <...> * Quid quod etiam academiis sua quaedam vel ars vel disciplina diplomatica est. Quamobrem vehementer probamus consilium ac morem maiorum, qui, quicquid civibus academicis promulgandum putarent, latina lingua promulgaverunt."

217 Eichstaedt (1840, 107): "Quae quum ita sint, non caute satis et circumspecte agunt doctores academici, qui, dum patrium sermonem latino anteponunt, etiam iis in scholis, quibus res traduntur non alienae ab ingenio et scientia Romanorum, sed quae latina possint lingua perutiliter explicari, ac fortassis etiam debeant, magni Thomasii auctoritatem sequuntur."

218 Eichstaedt (1840, 105-106) quotes Gesnerus (1774, 102-103) about how Christian Thomasius became in 1687 the first one in Germany to teach in German language in a university. Reducing the use of Latin where its quality could not be maintained at a sufficiently high standard might actually have been an attempt to save the Latin itself. "Nam erant tum ea tempora, ubi quidem loquerentur doctores Latine, sed ita, ut melius fuisset loqui Germanice. Et fortasse, si lingua Latina non doctum fuisset in scholis et Academiis, illa non esset tam corrupta, ut Graeca adhuc pura est et integra: sed tum in omnibus scholis latine docebatur. Ergo causa mutationis fuit primo *Thomasii* ignorantia; deinde iustissima causa, ne forte plane perderetur lingua Latina. Hinc factum est, ut politi homines, qui scirent Latine, starent ab lingua Germanica, et hac in posterum docendum suaderent. Contra semibarbari pro ipsa latina propugnabant." (these words were added in the posthumous edition of Gesner's book by the editor who had transcribed his lectures; they are not present in the editions which were published during his life, e.g. Gesnerus (1760, 12), which contained only the theses discussed in the lectures rather than the lectures themselves). Cf. Gesnerus (1715, 77): "Latine loqui cum magistro vel eo praesente, utile est, absente magis plerumque noxium". Leonhardt (2013, 260): "Gesner placed a great deal of emphasis on the reading of classical writers. In particular, he was against spontaneously spoken Latin; thus he was critical of school rules, common since the Renaissance, that required students to speak Latin during breaks. Clearly, classical correctness was more important to Gesner than fluency." After this quote, Eichstaedt (1840, 106) adds that now another problem is brewing – the teachers are teaching children to speak Greek in the lessons and do not have enough competence to correct them, so Greek might also become corrupted through negligent use: "De corruptela, quae, Gesnero auctore, per imperitiam magistrorum in latinam linguam invecta est, nemo dubitabit, qui animadverterit, parem nostra aetate calamitatem linguae graecae inferri inscientia illorum, qui pueros, graece balbutientes in ludis litterariis, et graecas commentationes, orationes, carmina ostentantes, quum ipsi sint impares vitiis graecitatis corrigendis, totique ab Rostii nostri lexico pendeant, ita foveant laudibusque extollunt et despiciari latinae linguae exercitia docent, ut si imberbes Platones, Demosthenes, Homeri subselliis scholasticis insedissent." Here Eichstädt also seems to criticise the excessive Hellenocentrism then prevalent in the German Neohumanist schools, where Greeks used to be idealised at the expense of Romans.

219 See footnote 128 – Gesner knew about the *civitas Latina* projects and himself raised his son bilingual in Latin and German.

1824). All these men, including Eichstädt, wrote hundreds of pages in Latin, so they were not against the (careful) use of Latin, and they believed that conversation had a place in the learning of Latin, but for them the concern about the quality of Latin was more important than the fact of Latin being used all the time;²²⁰ they believed in a clear separation between the usage realms of vernacular (which also had to be cultivated) and of Latin. Eichstädt himself believed that modern subjects should be treated in vernacular, as the modernisation of Latin would be a tedious and pointless task.²²¹

In this context, Eichstädt introduces Olmo's proposal by quoting the whole article from the *Classical Journal* more-or-less verbatim, just translating the reviewer's notes to Latin. He finds two grave problems. First of all, he notes²²² that both Latin and vernacular have their own distinctive advantages and spheres of use, implying that this project perverts them. Secondly, there is a great danger of this Latin project losing its Latinity and becoming barbarous – as Eichstädt points out, Olmo himself demonstrates this by his own Latin, abounding with Spanish solecisms and barbarisms.²²³ Neither would this *Roma Tullia* be useful for re-establishing Latin as the diplomatic language.²²⁴ Eichstädt concludes that there is no need for a *Roma Tullia*, Latin can be learned and practised perfectly well in Jena through existing means.²²⁵ He instructs students to “accustom

220 Leonhardt (2013, 251): “Much like the Renaissance humanists, neohumanists believed that the person is shaped by the process of cultivating language. However, they no longer took it for granted that this schooling in language would eventuate in Latin fluency and use in daily life. Neohumanism played an important role in Germany in this split between Latin as the language of education and Latin as the language of communications.”

221 In the article about Olmo's proposal Eichstädt's opinion is implicit in the quotes, but in Eichstadius (1837) he is explicit; pp. 2-3: “absonum tamen est atque ineptum, Latinae linguae usum imperare aut adhibere in iis rebus, quae recentiore demum aevo vel inventae sunt vel ita perfectae, ut ad illarum novitatem ipsas adeo linguas, in ore hominum adhuc vigentes ideoque flexibiles, accommodari oporteat multisque modis inflecti. ⟨...⟩ quales sunt res physicae, chemicae, astronomicae, partim etiam philosophicae. Aut quis talia non multo malit sermone patrio dilucide exponi, quam longis peregrinae dictionis amfractibus ⟨sic⟩ atque circumscriptionibus obscurari? In his igitur rebus explicandis semper putavi abstinendum esse ab Latino sermone, eamque illarum artium peritis veniam dandam, ut vernacula lingua utantur”, pp. 6-7: “Nam non solum iureconsulti, verum etiam philosophi, et ipsi adeo theologi, scholasticorum sordibus inquinati, ita disserebant et scribebant Latine, ut dictio plerorumque mera esset barbaries, proximeque accederet ad eam, quam culinariae Latinitatis vocabulo notare solemus. Quod quum bene perspexisset Thomasius, quantam sibi poterat laudem, quantam institutioni academicae utilitatem parare, si disciplinis, quae vix commode et perspicue lingua Latina tradebantur, vindicasset usum sermonis patrii, ceterae autem quo modo abstersis vitiis, quae aetatis male loquentis consuetudo affricuisset, Latine possent, hoc est pure, dilucide et ad rerum dignitatem apte explicari, suo exemplo demonstravisset!”. The biographer Halm (1877) notes Eichstädt's inflexibility while discussing modern sciences in Latin.

222 By quoting Ernesti (1734, 9-11).

223 Eichstaedt (1840, 120-121): “Illud autem maxime cavendum est, ne, si quod novum Latium exoriatur, cives in illud irrepant barbari magis quam latini, et qui Olmonis nostri exemplum sequuti, Hispanis potius soloecismis quam romano sermone utantur*). ⟨...⟩ *) Novus noster Romae Tulliae civis quae barbare aut soloece scripsit, *cursivis litteris* notavimus.” Olmo's Latin indeed *was* problematic; see the number of “⟨sic⟩” notes in footnote 198 indicating grammatical errors.

224 See footnote 216.

225 Eichstaedt (1840, 121): “Ceterum acquiescamus in iis, quae nobis data sunt, et concessis bonis recte prudenterque utamur. Proinde colite societatem latinam, in hac academia natam, educatam, adultam: studium et industriam adhibete seminario philologico, quod latinae quoque linguae latinisque litteris inservit: nolite reformidare scholas, quibus res, quae capiunt latini sermonis elegantiam, latine traduntur: denique adiuti idoneis magistris, non impatientes laboris, crebrisque exercitationibus subacti, latine scribendo ac dicendo assuescite.” See also footnote 175 – Matthias Fryksell had concluded with a similar idea in 1739.

themselves through frequent exercises to write and speak in Latin”. However, the word used is *dicendo*, not *loquendo* – the endeavoured skill is expressed through (prepared) orations rather than through the fluency in spontaneous conversations. Sanctius had proclaimed already in 1587 that one should speak Latin only after a premeditation in order to ensure the quality of language, but was criticised for this view – however, in the 19th century the consensus of the learned has finally caught up with him. In this view, the spontaneous use of Latin had always been a dangerous compromise, a concession to practicality. Renaissance Humanists cleaned up the medieval Latin (which had been corrupted through negligent use) to the classical standard and now, after several more centuries of practical use of Latin, the language used should either get cleansed again from accumulated unclassical structures, or given up altogether. Continuing the argument, *no Latin* is arguably preferable to *bad Latin*; only those who manage to reach the classical standard should use the Latin language. Still, just as in the times of Sanctius, not every professional Latinist was of this opinion.

This is a collision between two views of the nature of Latin. Eichstädt comes from decades of cultivating Latin in the University of Jena, upholding the standards of its quality and purity. Meanwhile Olmo had a long practice of using Latin actively through his extensive background in the Church. He studied in the Cádiz seminary, later teaching there;²²⁶ at the time, the Catholic seminaries were a Latin-speaking environment, with much of the teaching happening in the language. When he left Spain for an exile in France in about 1813, he started using Latin every day “with great admiration of the learned and the unlearned”,²²⁷ so it could be said that his identity, when being abroad, was tied with the use of Latin. Moreover, Olmo was obviously a learned man, knowing numerous classical poets by heart.²²⁸ So why then Eichstädt condemns his Latinity? The answer might hide in the different approaches to Latin. The decades-long practice of analysis and

226 See footnote 227 and the title page of del Olmo y Herrera (1806): “Sr. Rector actual del Colegio Mayor de esta Ciudad, Catedrático que fué de Filosofía Moral en el Seminario Conciliar de Cadiz”; *esta ciudad* means Sevilla. Naveros Sánchez (1991, 48): “De nuevo se interrumpe la Academia no volviendo a reanudarse hasta el 10 de Enero de 1806, día en que fue nombrado Rector D. Miguel María del Olmo”. The title page of del Olmo y Herrera (1825) also lists his past positions.

227 Cf. footnote 198: “Quod quidem consilium, longo discendi atque docendi usu olim in Seminario Gaditano firmatum, nunc antem quotidiano trium annorum experimento, Parochus et catechizans comprobavi et comprobo, magna doctorum et indoctorum admiratione.”. *Trium annorum*, when counted back from 1816, nicely coincides with the defeat of Napoleon and the flight of the *afrancesados* to France. An observation by Paumès (1909, 46) that Olmo’s skills in French were very poor (“Il s’appelait Olmo et avait été chanoine de Séville. Il connaissait à peu près le français, mais savait fort bien le latin.”) also testifies to the fact that he might not have used French much while living in France, instead resorting to Latin. However, this testimony is at odds with the panegyrics in Genevray (1940, 519) (see footnote 204) and Paumès (1911, 133-134) (as quoted by IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 62)), where Olmo is said to know many languages equally fluently. Maybe the more adverse judgement is more realistic and it gives an additional focus to Latin: if his French was poor, the cause might be that he practised his Latin instead of French while in France.

228 Cf. footnote 204 and Paumès (1911, 133-134) as quoted by IJsewijn and Sacré (1993, 62): “Il sait par cœur Homère et Virgile, Térence et Molière, Yriarte et Lafontaine.”.

judgement enabled Eichstädt to instantly spot any unclassical usage in Olmo's writings, while Olmo's long habit of using Latin actively as an instrument might have engendered a more relaxed attitude to the language – fluency is sometimes achieved at the expense of accuracy²²⁹ and vice versa. The Church background might also have something to do with this.²³⁰ The style is indeed not very elegant, there are manifest errors,²³¹ but some of the critique arises from the strictness of standard used for judgement. Wilfried Stroh has characterised this exchange as the first split between the *professional Latinists* and the *Latin speaking non-philologists*.²³² This observation is certainly true, but the long tradition of the *civitas Latina* proposals and their critiques shows that a similar tension had always been present. The stricter cultivators of Latin had always felt a certain unease about the kind of Latin used for practical purposes, while for others the utilitarian view of language went hand-in-hand with a more relaxed attitude to classical purity and with more enthusiasm for immersive or inductive teaching methods. The *civitas Latina* proposals belong to a logical extreme endpoint of the latter tendency.

2.2.5 The reception of Olmo's project in the Living Latin movement

How was the *civitas Latina* debate reflected in the Living Latin discourse? Olmo is key. The earlier tradition of *civitates Latinae* vanished into oblivion, while the memory of *Roma Tullia*, the project of Miguel Olmo, continues until today.

The reception of Olmo in the “proper” movement of Living Latin has been quite different from Eichstädt. The publishers of the first Living Latin journals enthusiastically embraced his ideas, recognising a certain affinity with themselves. The London *Phaenix*, having received a copy of Olmo's booklet from a Parisian reader, published in June 1891 an article titled “Our proposal in year 1816”²³³ with excerpts where Olmo addressed the concerns of sceptics doubting the possibility of Latin successfully expressing modern concepts due to the lack of modern terms. He shows that Latin language had always been growing in its vocabulary: even the Romans have been borrowing words from the surrounding languages, adopting Greek words and coining their own neologisms.

229 Similar concerns can be seen in the critique of Jesuit oral practices (footnote 176) and in Burckhard's fear that the *civitas Latina* would produce only oral fluency rather than real knowledge (footnote 170).

230 For example, the Latin used in ecclesiastical books often used to have an unrefined flavour, as the authors were concerned with getting their point across rather than with searching for a way to do this in a good classical Latin. The papal encyclicals might shine in brilliant Latin, but that was not the case for many other ecclesiastical writings.

231 See, for example, the “<*sic*>” notes in footnote 198, indicating grammatical errors. Sacré (1990, 45) also notes the paradox of the simultaneous presence both of an infelicity of language and of an erudition of Latin literature.

232 Stroh (2008, 293-294): “Hier tut sich zum ersten Mal, wenn ich recht sehe, ein Graben auf zwischen Berufslateinern und nichtphilologischen Lateinsprechern. Mit derselben Herablassung wie damals Eichstädt behandeln noch heute viele Lateinprofessoren, ja auch Studienräte, diejenigen, die das tote Latein als lebendige Sprache betreiben – einen beachtlichen Unterschied macht, dass die Spötter von heute selber längst nicht so gut Latein können wie seinerzeit Eichstädt.”

233 *Phaenix* Kal. Iun. 1891 No. 3 pp. 18-19: “NOSTRUM PROPOSITUM ANNO 1816”

Not everything ends with Cicero, who himself was an innovator – the moderns also have a right to enrich the language. One should throw away the prevalent and vain superstition of purity, the desire to be more Latin than Latins themselves; there are so many Latin writings that in them one can surely find appropriate expressions, and if this is not sufficient, in order to really imitate the ancients, one should follow in their footsteps and renew the language.²³⁴ *Phœnix*, most probably its editor George Henderson, excerpted Olmo’s work well – these thoughts are very salient for the Living Latin program. But the foundation of the Latin city is cited only in the title, so the actual content of the proposal remained a mystery to the readers.

Karl Heinrich Ulrichs, the publisher of *Alaudae* (1889-1895), read this issue and desired to know more about what precisely Olmo had thought of. Ulrichs used this as an occasion to tell a story how he himself had once, when still an adolescent enthusiast of Latin, imagined a project of this sort.²³⁵ He dreamed of creating a new stock of Latin-speaking Romans in Rome. A certain number of adolescents would be selected from each nation, taught Latin, and sent to Rome to “create a new city and erect a new Capitol”. They would not be able to group along national lines in order to use their own national languages between themselves – they would have to mix, to communicate in Latin and so to create a new Latin-speaking nation. All of this Ulrichs wrote down without ever having seen Olmo’s proposal, but so many things coincide: the selection of young men from many nations in order to form a new community, etc. This was another occasion when the *civitas Latina* concept was independently reinvented. It shows that, with a certain frame of mind – with a belief in the vitality and potential of Latin – the idea of a *civitas Latina* comes naturally. Living Latin movement’s cast of mind has often produced such dreams. In fact, before having read about Olmo’s project in *Phœnix*, Ulrichs in his *Alaudae* had presented another dream of a Latin utopia – in a fictional narrative he described how beautifully the Austro-Hungarian empire would function with Latin as its official language; here, the Latin had an additional pacificatory function, enduring equality and harmony between all the national communities of the empire.²³⁶

The memory of Olmo’s proposal never disappeared in the Living Latin tradition. In 1908 *Scriptor Latinus*, a Latin journal in Bremerhaven, reprinted fragments from Eichstädt’s oration concerning Olmo (that is, the Latin translation of the review in *Classical Journal*), apparently

234 The last paragraph cited is from Olmo (1816, 109): “§ LXXXVI. *Quòd liceat antiquos imitare.* (sic) Quæ ergò vana isthæc (sic) superstitio puritatis hunc (sic) sæculum tenebit, uti castigatiores ac puriores, et, ut ità dicam, Latiniore Latinis ipsis haberi velimus, nec veteres illos, totque omnium ætatum viros doctissimos, qui postea de omni re, uti suprà memorabimus, (sic) tanta gloriâ scripserunt, exempla imitemus? Quorum tam multa, atque diversa extant opera, ut pauca admodum cogitari queant, quæ non jam Latinè dicta sint, nulla verò quæ non dici illorum imitatione possint.”

235 *Alaudae* 20 Aug. 1891 No. 20 pp. 168-169. Schmitzer (2021) and Laes (2022a, 296) analyse this segment.

236 Laes (2022a) analyses and contextualises this dream.

without commenting on the material.²³⁷ In 1941 the Munich *Societas Latina* discovered Eichstädt's oration and reprinted it strictly as a historical document about Latin's fortunes; the editor of the piece put multiple disclaimers that *Societas Latina* did not agree with this curious and almost absurd plan of founding a Latin city,²³⁸ because the return of Latin as an international diplomatic and learned language would be possible only through collective efforts of all classes.²³⁹ In 1976 Caelestis Eichenseer, the editor of the Saarbrücken *Vox Latina*, reprinted Comenius' proposal of *Latium redivivum* and a fragment of the *Societas Latina* publication about Olmo.²⁴⁰ *Melissa* of Brussels presented Olmo in 1985, in one of its first issues.²⁴¹ This line of transmission led Olmo to a proper scholarly attention.²⁴² The most recent article about Olmo's project in *Melissa* is from 2022.²⁴³ His memory seems to have survived to the Internet age – notices of Olmo's project are present even in *Wikipedia*.²⁴⁴

2.2.6 Implications for Living Latin

Olmo's and earlier *civitas Latina* projects proposed creating actual Latin towns. But if we look into the *civitas Latina* project through the polysemy of the original metaphor, it is clear that the motivation for these projects was provided by the problems of teaching Latin – the *civitas Latina* is fundamentally just a place where a pedagogically instructive perpetual immersion in Latin is achieved. It does not necessarily involve quasi-state entities. Originally the vision of a *coenobium Latinum* or a *civitas Latina* arose from the analogy between the school and the world (or a smaller version of it, e.g., a town) – both of them are simply places and communities where communication happens, as well as all sorts of life situations.

In this view, the later Living Latin movement also produced several proposals of Latin speaking institutions that could be assigned to the *civitas Latina* tradition.

237 Eichstaedtius (1908a); Eichstaedtius (1908b).

238 Holzer (1941, 3): "Supervacaneum videtur profiteri Societatem Latinam cum illius Hispani theologi consilio curioso, ne dicam absurdo minime consentire; sed ut cultus illius aetatis documentum id excudendum curavimus."

239 Holzer (1941, 7): "Non omnia possumus omnes. Quade causa <sic> omnes ordines suum conferant, ut linguae Latinae aeque antiquae ac venerabili et in re publica et in litteris is honos restituatur, quem diu obtinuit, ut lingua Latina tandem gentium et sermonum discrimine superato lingua et diplomatica et eruditorum fiat communis."

240 Comenius (1976); Holzer (1976).

241 Bergere (1985).

242 Sacré (1990), the first scholarly treatment of the topic, was also published in *Vox Latina*. The other sources are listed in footnote 177.

243 Deraedt (2022).

244 The English page for *Contemporary Latin* (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Contemporary_Latin, consulted 7.8.2023) since Jan. 2010 lists Olmo in a honourable place as the first precursor of the Living Latin movement, namely as one of the "attempts to counteract the decline and to revitalize the use of Latin for international communication". In the Latin *Vicipaedia*, Olmo has his own brief pages *Michaël Maria Olmus* (https://la.wikipedia.org/wiki/Micha%C3%ABl_Maria_Olmus, consulted 7.8.2023, originally written in 2013) and *Roma Tullia*, is mentioned in the articles for *Consilium Vindobonense* and *Villaudricum*.

In 1901 Arcadius Avellanus, the editor of *Præco Latinus* and a fierce promoter of Latin, proposed *Tusculaneum*, a great Latin-speaking school, which by its size would blur lines of between a school and a town just as Comenius' proposal does.²⁴⁵

Caelestis Eichenseer, the indefatigable teacher of immersive Living Latin seminars, provided a real Latin-speaking environment in his events – *scholae aestivae* could be imagined as temporally bounded *civitates Latinae*. In a 1998 article he remembers Olmo's proposal and himself proposes a *civitas Latina* where the Latin immersion would be permanent: a monastery that would help any guests wishing to speak Latin and that would provide some more services for the language.²⁴⁶

So the history of several centuries seems to have filtered away the exotic elements of the *civitas Latina* projects – the Latin-only marriages, small children speaking Latin as their only native language, fantastical engineering of societies – and returned them to their essence: the promotion of inductive and immersive language teaching methods, the conviction in the value of oral fluency in Latin as the best gateway to the mastery of the language. The *civitas Latina* projects contribute to the discussion about the nature of Latin, about its teaching methods and the general aims of education.

On these lines, the *civitas Latina* might already be present today in form of a Latin speaking school. The academy of *Vivarium Novum* in Frascati near Rome (in the original Latium!), directed by Luigi Miraglia, meets the main criterion of a perpetual Latin immersion both in the lectures and the free time. The composition of its students and teachers is international to encourage the use of Latin; it is located just outside the city (a common feature in these proposals); and, most importantly, everyone lives together, making it a true *coenobium* (a name and feature common to most of the projects).

Finally, the whole discussion about *civitas Latina* as a physical space dedicated to Latin is less relevant today in the digital age, when every digitally literate diaspora can communicate over the Internet. Now, both the *res publica litterarum* and *civitas Latina* can be seen as metaphors for different configurations of social networks located in the same abstract cyberspace.

A historical overview of the *civitas Latina* discussion with its changing emphases and contexts shows that the genesis of the *Living Latin* phenomenon with its enthusiasm for the quite free and active use of language, even if strongly linked to much more recent past (for example, to the circumstances of the late 19th century), can trace its roots to the Renaissance and to some of the trends in the attitudes to Latin apparent even then. Likewise, it would be a mistake to trace the

245 Avellanus' proposal is treated in page 118, chapter 3.4.6.3.

246 Eichenseer's proposal is treated in page 204, chapter 5.2.1.1.

converse of *Living Latin* (that could in principle be called the *Dead Latin*), consisting of a general avoidance of using Latin (especially spontaneously; or at least an overly careful attitude to using it) and a suspicion of the quality of Latin employed for practical purposes, only to the 19th century and to the contemporary development of philology and *Altertumswissenschaften*: such tendencies, even if they have not always been dominant, have been present ever since the same Renaissance. Analysis of the discourse around the idea of *civitas Latina* demonstrates this fault-line.

To repeat what has been said above,²⁴⁷ the parties in this discussion – both in the 1820s (the times of Olmo and Eichstädt) and in the earlier centuries – could be termed the *professional Latinists* and the *Latin speaking non-philologists*. It does not mean that these so-called *enthusiastic amateurs* are necessarily outside the academia or even philology – they might even be professors of Latin – but the enthusiastic stance they take about the use of the language correlates with a more flexible relationship with the language, a more relaxed attitude to the classical purity. These parties in the *civitas Latina* discussion prefigure the parties seen in the history of Living Latin – the tensions exposed are very similar – and throughout the whole of it one can find exchanges between Living Latin enthusiasts and professional academic philologists, between bold modernisers of Latin vocabulary and cautious custodians of classical Latin style.

The story Erasmus tells us of having been unable to start a conversation in Latin with Bernardo Rucellai (1448-1514), a Florentine humanist writing books in impeccable Latin, but refusing to speak it, can be seen as an archetypal situation.²⁴⁸ Erasmus was an enthusiast of speaking exclusively in Latin, maintaining a functional and eclectic style of Latin and making fun of the restrictive Ciceronian style in his dialogue *Ciceronianus*. Meanwhile Rucellai presumably belonged to the Ciceronian circles valuing the purity and the professional quality of Latin over its communicational functionality. This meeting in the beginning of the 16th century and the two parties in this attempted conversation foreshadowed the later evolution of Latin.

²⁴⁷ See footnote 232 and page 65.

²⁴⁸ See footnote 162.

3 The early period of *Living Latin* (1880-1914)

The end of the 19th century saw a curious phenomenon. Even though there was no institutional basis or support for it, new Latin-language journals dedicated to the cause of promoting Latin emerged one after another: *Alaudae* (1889-1895, L'Aquila), *Phoenix* (1890-1892, London), *Præco Latinus* (1894-1902, Philadelphia), *Vox Urbis* (1898-1913, Rome), *Civis Romanus* (1901-1917, Limbach/Bremerhaven).²⁴⁹ This nearly simultaneous appearance of multiple Latin journals with international readership and contributors can be interpreted as an indicator of the *Living Latin* community and movement already being born. The view that the end of the 19th century should be regarded as the beginning of the *Living Latin* movement is taken by a number of recent publications,²⁵⁰ although some others²⁵¹ do not treat it in great detail and prefer to consider it only a foreshadowing of the real *Living Latin* movement that was born after the Second World War.

These journals represented a wide spectrum of ideas about what the renewed Latin use should be about – from a utilitarian focus on Latin made as simple as possible for the sake of making it a practical world language (*Phoenix*) to a desire of preserving the great Latin tradition of the Catholic Church and Italy (*Vox Urbis*).

In this chapter, as in the thesis generally, I intend to concentrate on the more “radical” *Living Latin* proponents who desired to expand Latin outside its ever-shrinking traditional sphere of usage. The primary focus will be on *Phoenix* and *Præco Latinus* and on their originators – respectively, George J. Henderson (1860-1911) and Árkád Mogyoróssy (1851-1935), better known by his Latinised name Arcadius Avellanus. In the case of Avellanus, I also investigate his biography. Karl Heinrich Ulrichs and his *Alaudae* are reviewed only briefly, but *Alaudae* are very important for being the first internationally noted *Living Latin* journal. *Vox Urbis* is treated in the chapter about Interwar Latin, because it was still being published by the same team of editors and authors until 1942 under the name of *Alma Roma* (1914-1942).

249 Woldemar Lommatzsch (*Voldemarus Lommatius*, 1870-1959) published *Civis Romanus* from 1901 in “Limbach in Saxonia”, then from October 1903 in Bremerhaven. The periodical changed its name to *Scriptor Latinus* in 1910 and lasted till 1917. Bernd Plattdasch mentions the periodical in his *Pantoia* (Plattdasch 2019) and provides an index (Plattdasch 2023); see also Laes (2022b, 218) for connections with the Maltese Latin journal *Rosa Melitensis* (1908-1910) by Alfredo Bartoli (1872-1954). Fascinatingly, Lommatzsch is present in the 1889 Volapük yearbook (Kerckhoffs 1889, 121) as a certified teacher of Volapük, cementing the connection between the international language movement and *Living Latin* activism in this era even more: both of them were outlets for the same universalist convictions and proclivities.

250 Stroh (2004); Stroh (2008); Laes (2017); Slednikov (2019a).

251 Feye (2011); Licoppe (2014a).

3.1 The context of *Living Latin*

The end of the 19th century saw a number of conditions that enabled this early Living Latin movement and contributed to its relevance.

The first factor is the international language question. The interconnected world manifesting itself through rapid technological progress and contemporary globalisation – the period from 1870 to 1914 has been called the first wave of globalisation due to the great growth of commerce and communications – highlighted the need for a world language. This was particularly well seen in the exponentially multiplying international conferences.²⁵² No European language was a ready candidate, as none of them yet were clearly headed to an international dominance: French, the erstwhile language of diplomacy and high culture, was now challenged by German in science and by English in commerce,²⁵³ the languages of the minor nations were also coming into use. The discussions about the international language question were ubiquitous and often based on a belief that the question can be solved rationally by a worldwide agreement rather than only after a natural dominance achieved by a particular language. So it often seemed that it is only a matter of prevailing in the discussion and deciding on the language in some committee that would be authoritative worldwide; the end of the 19th century was not only the time of nationalism, but also of internationalism – numerous organisations for international cooperation were being formed²⁵⁴ and the societies harboured great hopes about them. Many believed that the best international language (that would be both nationally neutral and simple to learn) would have to be consciously created in order to be more rational and consequently easier to learn than natural languages; this superior rational solution would prevail in the rational discussion and would get adopted. These assumptions fuelled in quickly growing and far-reaching planned language movements, including Johann Martin Schleyer's *Volapük* (1879) and Ludwik Lejzer Zamenhof's *Esperanto* (1887), but no conclusion was reached in the debate, with more and more suggestions proposed. Latin also entered this debate.

Suggestions that it is Latin that should provide the solution (rather than the newly created languages) were based on the fact that Latin still held its ground firmly in education as a ubiquitous subject and an educational ideal. A fundamental belief was shared by the proponents that if the already ubiquitous Latin teaching would be reformed to incorporate speaking the language, Latin

252 Garvía (2015, 15): “the number of international conferences escalated from a mere 20 in the 1850s to 1,062 in the first decade of the twentieth century.”

253 Garvía (2015, 16)

254 Iriye (2002, 11): “It was against the background of these developments that international nongovernmental organizations began to be created in the second half of the nineteenth century. Although a small number – one survey mentions five – of such organizations may have existed prior to 1850, most studies agree that it was in the last decades of the century that many more (numbering about ten every year during the 1890s, for instance) were established.”. Also Sluga (2013, 13), Aray (2021, 129), Rasmussen (2001).

would become easier to learn and could fulfil the role of a universal language. Latin also satisfied neutrality, an essential criterion in the discussions about the international language question, and was free of the seemingly abhorrent artificiality inherent in any created language. Finally, if Latin were to become an international language once again, this would provide an additional value to the teaching of Latin – the proponents of practical education, criticising the classical subjects in schools for their uselessness, would be disarmed, as now the teaching of Latin would serve also a practical aim.

The second factor is the technological progress itself. The Latin-speaking *res publica litteraria* had always been a geographically very widespread, but a sociologically relatively thin stratum of society, mainly limited to the classically educated. Periodicals published in Latin were certainly not a new thing – already in the 17th century some of the first scientific journals were published in Latin (e.g., *Acta eruditorum* in Leipzig, 1682-1782). Even some general purpose journals and newspapers used to be published in the language; the last such general-purpose newspapers appeared in Austro-Hungary in the beginning of the 19th century (even twice a week!).²⁵⁵ They exploited a local particularity – in the society of Hungary, the stratum of accustomed Latin readers was thicker than elsewhere (it was still the official language of the state), making it reasonable to publish the news in Latin for a local audience and maybe even to make some profit from this. But the relative inefficiency in international communications²⁵⁶ meant that the audience was forced to be local (it is not clear if there was any international circulation), thus cutting off the main advantage of Latin, namely, its internationality, leaving only its role of the local *lingua franca*.

This changed in the latter half of the 19th century. The advent of railway and steamship transport made the postal service much faster; a complex network of bilateral postal treaties was streamlined into the Universal Postal Union, further reducing inefficiencies. Finally, the introduction of a telegraph service meant not only a faster exchange of information, but also the possibility of a telegraphic money transfer, making remote subscriptions to publications possible – now one could order a publication directly from the publisher and to pay for it instantaneously. These developments spurred a general growth of the press and meant that now the publication of a

²⁵⁵ One of the last of them, *Ephemerides Statistico-Politicae*, was published in 1804-1838 in Bratislava; see Sacré (2021a), Sacré (2021b), Sacré (2022a). The broader topic of Latin journalism in Hungary is surveyed by Balogh (2015).

²⁵⁶ Standage (1998, 147) illustrates the limits of journalism in the pre-telegraph era, these insights can be extended to the problem of distributing newspapers over long distances. “It was commonplace for foreign news to be weeks or months old by the time it appeared in print. The *Times* of London [...] But since the news traveled no faster than the ships that carried it, the January 9, 1845, edition of the *Times* included reports from Cape Town that were eight weeks old and news from Rio that was six weeks old. The delay for news from New York was four weeks, and for news from Berlin a week. And the *Times* was a newspaper that prided itself on getting the news by the fastest means possible.”

periodical with a worldwide distribution was realistic even for individuals without great resources. A worldwide Latin press was now possible. The historical nature of Latin – the fact that it was once a neutral international language and was still being taught widely – ensured that the new publications could have a strongly international readership.

The case of *Alaudae* (1899-1895), a periodical published in L'Aquila, a provincial town in Italy, is instructive for its global character – it was printed in Rome, its subscriptions were managed in L'Aquila, Leipzig, London²⁵⁷ and for a time even in Uppsala; subscribers were not numerous, numbering about 150-200,²⁵⁸ but they came from such unlikely and remote places as Madras, Mexico, New Zealand, Tashkent.²⁵⁹ This sort of network, which is rich and fascinating to analyse,²⁶⁰ was only possible due to the technological basis for it.²⁶¹ This revolution made the perception of a sort of a global *res publica litterarum* much more possible.

The third factor is related to education: Latin's place in it, the pressure for a reform of the curricula and the movement to reform the teaching of languages. As noted above,²⁶² in the 1880s there arose a broad Reform Movement in reaction to the modern languages being taught at the time through a heavily grammatical approach similar to the one used in teaching Greek and Latin. *Language teaching must start afresh! A contribution to the question of stress and overwork in schools*,²⁶³ the title of the arguably foundational 1882 pamphlet by Wilhelm Viëtor (writing under an eloquent pseudonym of *Quousque tandem*), is illustrative. This manifesto asserted the primacy of spoken instead of written language in teaching, the importance of correct pronunciation, the

257 David Nutt, the London publisher which also printed *Phœnix*, *Post Prandium*, managed subscriptions for *Præco Latinus* and sold Avellanus' Latin textbook *Palæstra*.

258 Laes (2022a, 294) lists the sources in *Alaudae*; see also *The Philadelphia Inquirer* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 29 Jul. 1889 p. 3: "Its circulation now is somewhat below 200, and Mr. Ulrichs acknowledges it." The number of subscribers was not too bad, it was comparable with the emerging Esperanto movement. In September 1889 the first Esperanto periodical *La Esperantisto* appeared in Nuremberg and had 113 subscribers by the end of the year (Privat 1923a, 45); the number of subscribers reached 544 by December 1892 and 596 by Dec. 1894 (Forster 1982, 21). So until sometime in 1890 *Alaudae* still had more subscribers than the main Esperanto journal; and even the later numbers are not dramatically different. It seems that *Alaudae* rapidly gained many subscribers – almost 200 in the first several months (*The Philadelphia Inquirer* reported this in July 1889, while the first fascicle of *Alaudae* was published in May) – but the growth apparently stagnated and in 1893 the disappointed Ulrichs admitted that there were just over 150 of them (*Alaudae* Feb. 1893 No. 26 p. 267 contains a fictional dialogue between the Larks (*Alaudae*) and Proserpina: "Quot autem lectores vobis sunt? Ad quam interrogationem lacrimae mihi obortae sunt. Cum gemitu confessa sum: CL vel paulo plus. Illa: At hoc nihil est. {...} templo CL columnae nimium, libellario parum. CL enim tuae columnae, fatere, fulcimen non est. Sese duplicent opus est.").

259 Laes (2022a, 294): "Throughout the issues, Ulrichs prides himself about his correspondence with readers from all over the world, pointing to the dissemination of the *Alaudae* over the five continents." Also footnote 115.

260 Schmitzer (2021, 263): "Eine Lektüre der *Alaudae* offenbart ein faszinierendes lateinisches Netzwerk vom Ende des 19. Jahrhunderts, das nicht nur durch Abonnements und briefliche Kontakte, sondern auch durch die Zusendung von lateinischen Büchern und Exemplaren lateinischer Zeitschriften getragen wurde."

261 Maybe also due to the attention the worldwide press paid to it – *Alaudae* were mentioned by many foreign newspapers.

262 Page 17.

263 In German: *Der Sprachunterricht muß umkehren! Ein Beitrag zur Überbürdungsfrage*. An English translation is accessible in an appendix in Howatt (1984) (second edition: Howatt and Widdowson (2004)).

preference for oral methodologies, for inductive rather than deductive grammar teaching, for connected texts rather than disconnected sentences.²⁶⁴ This was a scathing attack on the typical bilingual, grammar-based approach which Viëtor later (in 1902) named the *Grammar-Translation Method*.²⁶⁵ These suggestions were very influential to the teaching of modern languages and encouraged a similar shift in the classical languages. This new emphasis on the communicational function partly coincided with the methods used to teach Latin before the 19th century, when Latin instruction often had also a communicative aim, so the Latin teachers could present the need for change in two complementary narratives: both as a rational modernisation (harmonising with the teaching of the living languages) and as a return to the “real” tradition, the Humanist one. In fact, the academia was not entirely devoid of echoes of the humanist tradition – some humanistic-minded professors of the classical languages maintained the idea that Latin needs to be written and spoken in order to be learnt, and actively promoted the idea that this is not an innovation, but rather a continuation of the true Humanist tradition.²⁶⁶

Several examples of this shift are worth noting. In 1890, Eduard Johnson (*Georgius Capellanus*, 1840-1903), the Latin teacher of the Planau gymnasium in Germany, contributed a Latin manual of modern conversation to a popular series of phrasebooks;²⁶⁷ the reviews that appeared in the press welcomed this contribution to classroom use. In 1893 Arcadius Avellanus introduced his textbook series where the modern usage of Latin was considered pre-requisite to the study of classical authors, providing the Latin teaching with an additional relevance, as it now also provided a means for international communication. In 1902, W. H. D. Rouse (1863-1950), the new headmaster of the Perse school in Cambridge, introduced the *Direct Method* for teaching Latin and

264 Quoting Smith (2019), who summarises Howatt (1984, 171-173). Also Howatt and Smith (2014, 82-83): “To summarize his suggestions for classroom methodology, which were taken up virtually unchanged within the ensuing Reform Movement, Viëtor argues for a lesson design that puts exposure to the foreign language first – in his case in the form of a connected text. This text provides the basis for all the detailed classwork on pronunciation and the intensive question-and-answer oral work which lie at the heart of the approach. Grammar is dealt with ‘inductively’, that is, after the text study, and is very tightly restricted to the language in the text.”

265 Howatt and Smith (2014, 81). *Grammatik- und Übersetzungsmethode*. This is the origin of the today widely employed term.

266 This sentiment was particularly strong in Italy, where the *Vox Urbis / Alma Roma* movement gathered numerous professors of Latin cultivating the language actively: speaking, writing and teaching in it. But there were such examples also in the Transalpine Europe; for example, in the Netherlands this position was articulated by Jacobus Hohannes Hartmann (1851-1924), who believed that the speaking and writing in Latin (especially in verse) is the highest expression of the classical culture and who believed that Latin should be the world language of the learned (van Bommel 2020, 271-273).

267 *C. A. Koch's Verlag* in Leipzig had already published sixteen (as indicated by *Beilage zur Augsburger Postzeitung* 29 Apr. 1890 No. 22 p. 4) modern language conversation phrasebooks (*Sprachführer*) when Johnson contributed pseudonymously his Ancient Greek (Joannides 1889) and Latin (Capellanus 1890) volumes. *Sprechen Sie Lateinisch? Moderne Conversation in lateinischer Sprache* became very popular and is still in print: both in Germany, where it reached 11th edition in 1931, 17th in 1999, and in numerous translations, including *Latin can be fun: a modern conversational guide = Facetiae Latinae: sermo hodiernus antique redditus*, a 1975 translation to English by Peter Needham (1934-2021).

Greek;²⁶⁸ it was based on a classroom conversation in the target languages, but no language modernisation or explicitly modern topics for conversation were encouraged, Classics were the objective. Rouse was inspired by the Reform Movement and applied the Direct method to both the ancient and the modern languages taught in his school; he used a similar *direct* approach universally: various practical crafts and handiwork were added to the curriculum and natural science was taught experimentally rather than theoretically.²⁶⁹ This was a holistic vision where Classics and modernity were reconciled.

Even though from the above-mentioned examples Avellanus is the only one highly involved in the *Living Latin* movement, both Capellanus²⁷⁰ and Rouse²⁷¹ expressed support for the idea of Latin as a world language. Therefore, while the *Living Latin* and Latin language teaching reform movements remained separate, they had quite similar aims and a symbiotic relationship²⁷² – the Living Latin enthusiasts saw Latin teaching reform as the cornerstone of Latin’s future role as the international language, while the reformers of Latin teaching often had a favourable view of this possible use of Latin.

3.2 Karl Heinrich Ulrichs and *Alaudae*

Karl Heinrich Ulrichs (1825-1895), a German (Hanoverian) lawyer, jurist and the publisher of *Alaudae* (1889-1895; the title in English would be *Larks*),²⁷³ the first internationally known Living Latin periodical, is today probably the most famous proponent of Living Latin, receiving a great amount of scholarly attention. But it is not due to Latin:²⁷⁴ it has to do with the speech he gave

268 Stray (1992, 18 ff.); see also footnote 30.

269 Stray (1992, 20-21)

270 *Phaenix* Dec. 1890 No. 2 p. 13 contains a letter by Capellanus praising the idea of Latin as a neutral world language. A whole page is dedicated to an advertisement of his book (*Phaenix* Jul. 1890 No. 1 p. 7)

271 Rouse (1911) is a review called “Live Latin” of two books containing Latin orations delivered in universities of Oxford and Cambridge, concluding with: “These books help us understand how needless it was to invent Esperanto.”. The orations cover such a wide variety of topics (“Afternoon tea, the Eight Hours’ Bill, motorcars, current events of history, appear in faultless Latin.”) that they successfully demonstrate the flexibility of Latin for modern topics and communication. Rouse (1916) is a letter stating his support for Latin as a universal language: “I have read with interest the letter of Sir Lauder Brunton on Latin as a universal language. I sincerely hope the matter will not be allowed to drop. As a contribution, may I say that we have taught Latin here as a spoken language for fourteen years past, just as French and German are taught, and the result is eminently satisfactory.”. Rouse also contributed to *Scriptor Latinus*, a Latin periodical published in Bremerhaven, Germany: he is present in the contributors list in Sept. 1914 Vol. X No. 6 p. 96, a short story of his was published in Jul. 1912 Vol. IX No. 4 p. 54.

272 The symbiosis between the movements was noticed by the contemporaries – see, e.g., footnote 90.

273 A facsimile of *Alaudae* has been reprinted as Ulrichs (2004). The set of *Alaudae* preserved in the Princeton University and available online (<https://babel.hathitrust.org/cgi/pt?id=njp.32101040129064&seq=393>, consulted 2.11.2022), contains an additional 34th issue from July 1895, published just before the death of its author. It is not present in the published facsimile edition.

274 A scholarly bibliography of Ulrichs’ Latin activity is given by Laes (2022a, 291). See also Colapietra (1995) and Schmitzer (2021).

in the 1867 Congress of German Jurists where he denounced the criminalisation of homosexuality in the Prussian criminal code,²⁷⁵ and with the series of publications (1864-1879) where he developed a corresponding theory of sexualities.²⁷⁶ Accordingly, now he even has streets and squares named after him. However, when he perceived that his campaigning had no effect,²⁷⁷ in 1880 he migrated to Italy, in 1883 settling in L'Aquila.

Here, he dedicated himself to another lifelong passion of his: literature in general (publishing several booklets of poems and short stories in German) and Latin in particular, composing poetry in Latin.²⁷⁸ After some years, in 1889, he decided to publish a little Latin journal called *Alaudae* in order to publish his verses and prose;²⁷⁹ in the beginning it was just an alternative for publishing a book volume, but later this enterprise grew in its significance. The first issue was published in May 1889; by the fifth issue in August 1889 Ulrichs understood²⁸⁰ that *Latin has a certain wonderful power to connect nations (Linguae Latinae mira quaedam vis inest ad iungendas nationes)* and made this the slogan of his journal. As noted above (p. 73) the journal had about 150-

275 Ulrichs' native Hanover was annexed by Prussia in 1866, this is the reason why the Prussian criminal code applied. The patriotic Hanoverian protested the annexation and even went to prison for his activities (Kennedy 2002, 122). *Alaudae* Iul. 1894 No. 31 p. 350: "Nunc nihil est illud vexillum nisi sacra memoria. Et ne ea quidem nisi paucis. Ego vero, eversa patria, cosmopolita factus sum.". Ulrichs, before starting in 1864 his campaign of sexological publications, had published his own project for the unification of the greater (including Austria) Germany (Ulrichs 1862) and several works on the reform of the German post office monopoly (Ulrichs (1861a); Ulrichs (1861b)). Ulrichs had always been striving for greater universalities. The version of the project of the unification of Germany he proposed belongs to what the liberal side of the political spectrum hoped for at the time.

276 Kennedy (1997a); Kennedy (1997b); Kennedy (2002); Kennedy (2004); Lombardi-Nash (2008a); Lombardi-Nash (2008b); Setz (2000); Setz (2004); Pretsell (2020); Sigusch (2000) are just some of the works about Ulrichs' life and campaign. Ulrichs' terminology bears noting, because it testifies to his love of Greeks and Romans. He called the homosexual male an *Uranian* (*der Urning / Uranier*), the heterosexual one a *Dionian* (*der Dioning / Dionäer*), names he came up with when reading Plato's Symposium, where two loves or Aphrodites are present: the Heavenly one – the daughter of Uranus, the Common one – the daughter of Zeus and Dione. Of course, as noted by Stroh (2000), Ulrichs took some liberties in interpreting Plato.

277 Kennedy (2002, 219): "Ulrichs had expressed this complaint, when he was already living in Italy, in a 6 February 1892 letter to an acquaintance in Germany: '<...> That I had to leave my home and fatherland is false. No one forced me to leave Germany and I could return at any moment. The writings, it was the writings that brought me to beggary, since they brought no income. They should long since have enjoyed new editions. Instead of that – Oh! It was so difficult altogether for me to find booksellers for my works.'". The letter is also in Pretsell (2020, 260).

278 Ulrichs (1880); Ulrichs (1887) (included in Ulrichs (2004)). In his youth as a student of law in the University of Göttingen, he submitted a Latin essay (a survey of the doctrine of cross-litigation) to the university's literary contest and received a gold medal for it and its publication (Ulrichs 1846); in 1848, two years later, when studying in the University of Berlin, he also submitted a Latin essay about the effects of Peace of Westphalia to the religious sovereignty of states (*PAX WESTPHALICA quid constituerit de principum jure reformando religionisque exercitio subditorum?*) to the local contest and was judged to be worthy of victory, but was neither awarded the medal nor the work was published – this penalty was imposed because *both* of the contestants missed the deadline (Kennedy (2002, 22); (Persichetti 1896, 5)).

279 Ulrichs (2004, XVII), originally Ulrichs (1894, 295): "Ein Deutscher, der in Italien lebt, war vor einigen Jahren im Begriff, ein Buch herauszugeben. Ihm war es eine Lieblingsbeschäftigung gewesen, wenn ihm poetische Gedanken kamen, diese in lateinische Versmaße zu kleiden. So waren lyrische Poesien entstanden, und diese wollte er als ein bescheidenes Bändchen herausgeben. Da kam ihm aber eine andere Idee. „Du solltest ein kleines lateinisch geschriebenes Unterhaltungsblatt gründen. Darin könntest du, eine nach der ändern, deine Poesien veröffentlichen. Außerdem müsste dasselbe jedoch Prosa enthalten.“ Gedacht, gethan."

280 During the first several months of his enterprise, Ulrichs received attention from newspapers from all around the world, built a substantial worldwide readership (about 200 subscribers in two months or so), maintained a lively correspondence with his readers and generally interested people. See footnote 258.

200 subscribers, who originated from around the world. So Ulrichs could feel that his journal formed a true international network, a global community of equals – he even proposed that it could be called *Fratres Latini* or *Sodales Latinitati Propagandae*.²⁸¹ In the pages of *Alaudae* he noted various things happening in Latin around the world and reflected together with his correspondents²⁸² on its international mission.²⁸³ He imagined utopian *civitates Latinae* – Latin speaking countries and communities (see p. 66), where Latin would have performed an international role and would have been present in everyday life. So it seems that Ulrichs originally came from the tradition of Neo-Latin verse and later discovered the international dimension of Latin. As such, he condemned other international language projects such as Volapük – it is better to use even a broken and impure Latin for communication rather than Volapük, “a pure barbarity”.²⁸⁴

Belief in the *vitality* of Latin was central for Ulrichs. He described Latin as a *bloodless shadow* (*umbra exsanguis*) to which he had decided to return life and to return it to its rightful place as the international language of the *res publica litterarum*²⁸⁵ after a period of neglect when it was only a despised language languishing in classrooms. For this, an international movement was needed, and Ulrichs imagined that *Alaudae* could be an effective means to inspire such a one. The periodical would become a proof that Latin is not obsolete and is indeed suitable for expressing everything modern.²⁸⁶

The death of Ulrichs in 1895 showed that this community was a real one. Marquess Niccolò Persichetti (1849-1915), friend of Ulrichs, reached out to the community of *Alaudae*, which contributed letters, testimonies, Latin verses, and, most importantly, contributed both an appropriate Latin inscription and funds for a marble plaque – Ulrich’s gravestone.²⁸⁷ This fundraising effort was also helped by Arcadius Avellanus and his *Præco Latinus* published in Philadelphia. Therefore, the roll of contributors resembles the internationality of the list of subscribers, spanning from New

281 *Alaudae* Iun. 1890 No. 12 p. 90; *Phœnix* Kal. Iul. 1890 No. 1 pp. 2-3

282 Sacré (2020a) writes about Colonel William Siddons Young (1832-1901), a Latin poet and one of the most active correspondents of Ulrichs (Kennedy (2002, 280) cites Hirschfeld (1914, 967) that Young used to write to Ulrichs *daily* (sic!)), supporting the journal with 50 (!) new subscribers.

283 E.g., *Alaudae* Sept. 1889 No. 6 pp. 47-48: “Justitiam erga cunctos, erga cunctas quoque linguas! Hoc decere mihi videtur ante alios eum, qui se signiferum profitetur unius linguae, quae sit internuncia communis inter nationes orbis terrarum, quique hōc ipso tendit ad fraternitatem populorum.”

284 *Alaudae* Mai. 1893 No. 27 p. 284: “Laudat Ausonius in Mosella puram Latinitatem Trevirensium. Jdem, si hunc indicem vidisset, hanc loquelam certe *puram Latinitatem* non vocaret. Quamquam fortasse eam compararet Latinitati aliarum urbium gentiumve sui temporis. Quid enim suspicari possumus de Britannis, Lusitanis, Tingitanis, Rhaetis, Illyricis, Daciaeve colonis Latinis? Nonne credibile est, horum Latinitati admixtas fuisse formas barbaras? Et adhiberi Latinitatem Brunensem melius saltem esse censeo quam linguam Volapuc, non sit admixta una vel altera forma barbara, sed quae tota sit una barbaries.”

285 *Alaudae* pr. Id. Apr. 1890 No. 11 p. 83: “Cur non lingua civitatis illius incorporeae et universalis, quae aspernatur populorum confinia terrarumque, cui non sufficit una pars mundi, cui Europa nostra est nimis arcta, quae maria transgreditur oceanosque?”

286 This manifesto was published in *Alaudae* pr. Id. Apr. 1890 No. 11 pp. 81-84. Discussed also by Colapietra (1995, 314-315).

287 Persichetti (1896)

Zealand to the USA, with Finland and Romania in between. In 1898, the Latin journal *Vox Urbis* (1898-1913), published in Rome, in its first issue celebrated²⁸⁸ Ulrichs and his *Alaudae* as the first Latin journal and one of the main inspirations their own project. Thus *Alaudae* were already seen as the beginning of the Living Latin movement.

3.3 George James Henderson and *Phœnix*

George James Henderson (1860-1911)²⁸⁹ and his Latin journal *Phœnix, or the International Latin Messenger, published as a statement for the adoption of the Latin language to the modern use* (*Phœnix, seu Nuntius Latinus internationalis linguae Latinae ad usus hodiernos adhibendae sicut documentum editus*; 1890-1892, 4 issues, quarto, 32 pages) represent an intersection between the international auxiliary language activism and the nascent Living Latin movement.

Phœnix has received almost no attention from the Neo-Latin scholarship,²⁹⁰ but both *Phœnix* and Henderson have been treated in the international language question scholarship²⁹¹ and the contemporary advocacy of (simplified) Latin.²⁹² Since everything about *Phœnix* in later scholarly attestations can be derived from earlier ones,²⁹³ it is clear that it has not been read and analysed after 1903.

George J. Henderson was a scion of a newspaper publisher family based in London, an enthusiast of the international language question, one of the most prolific inventors of international languages (creating four of them),²⁹⁴ finally in his later years a reluctant Esperantist. For Henderson, promoting Latin was not as important as solving the international language question, Latin was only one of the solutions he attempted and promoted for a time and that he abandoned when the attempt did not give the desired results. Therefore, his journal *Phœnix* needs to be considered not so much

288 de Angelis (1898)

289 Bryant (2015)

290 Waquet (2001) mentions testimony of Couturat and Leau (1903) and Rasmussen (2000), who mentions Henderson in broad terms. Licoppe (2014a, 17-18) cites the praise of *Phœnix* project in the preface by Émile Chatelain of Quicherat (1891, XVI), using this as evidence for the already ongoing movement of Living Latin: “Une entreprise très louable et qui a pour organe un journal latin intitulé *Phœnix* voudrait faire du latin la langue universelle. Au lieu de créer une langue fictive comme le Volapuk, disent les fondateurs, pourquoi ne pas se servir des éléments que possèdent tous ceux qui ont fait des études chez les peuples civilisés? De cette manière les élèves verraient plus clairement le but des exercices qu’on leur impose. C’est là, sans doute, une idée généreuse et féconde. <...>”. *Phœnix* is present in a passing reference in Lurz (1935a); Lurz (1949); Sacré (1988).

291 The contemporary Couturat and Leau (1903) treats *Phœnix* and Henderson’s artificial language projects in detail. Also Stojan (1929), Drezen (1931), Guérard (1921), Duličenko (1990). Secondary literature, based on Couturat and Leau (1903), include Pei (1968), Rasmussen (2000).

292 André (1903)

293 Couturat and Leau (1903) and André (1903) have certainly read the journal itself.

294 Couturat and Leau (1903), Duličenko (1990). Two versions of simplified Latin: *Lingua* (1888), *Latinesce* (1901). A simplified French: *Langue Facile*. A mixture of English and French: *Anglo-Franca* (1889).

as a Latin literary monument in its own right, but rather as a phenomenon related to both the international auxiliary language activism and the nascent Living Latin movement.

The purpose of *Phœnix* was (1) to be a manifesto of Latin as a future international language, (2) to gather and publish reactions to this idea, (3) to establish an authoritative global organisation for restoring the international use of Latin. This *modus operandi* – (1) publishing a manifesto,²⁹⁵ (2) collecting supporters, (3) pleading for an authoritative international organisation to discuss and decide the best possible international language solution and finally (4) using this organisation's authority to impose the decided solution on the world – was quite typical in the international auxiliary language activism Henderson was so involved in. It was the model tried by many movements for international language. In this grand scheme the *Phœnix* project is to be regarded as a failure, as it did not proceed much after step (2) – the collection of supporters. But, to be fair, no international language project has ever successfully implemented the whole of this imagined ideal algorithm.

The manifesto Henderson first published²⁹⁶ in July 1890 was completely utilitarian, in the spirit of general rationales characteristic for the international language movement. It acknowledged that artificial language movements (generally, *Volapük*, which is also criticised for its structure) had not yet been successful in gaining universal acceptance, English had not yet become widespread enough to become a viable solution, so both the living languages (because of lack of impartiality) and the artificial languages (because of the unending discussions and the lack of acceptance) were to be rejected. “It is then proposed to temporarily adopt Latin language as it was used in the Middle ages, that is, until people focused on this question will find a language more useful, more elegant and more compatible with the modern life”²⁹⁷. This utilitarian *temporary* adoption of free form of Latin until *a better language* would be found, without any concern for culture could not appeal to the more culturally-minded proponents of Latin. Indeed, Ulrichs, the publisher of *Alaudae*, the only other Living Latin periodical at the time, was the first one to reject this *temporary adoption* while approving of the general initiative of the revival of Latin.²⁹⁸

295 The *Phœnix* manifesto was first disseminated over mail to prospective candidates and later the responses were published in the first issue of the periodical. *Alaudae* Iun. 1890 No. 12 pp. 89-91, Id. Iul. 1890 No. 13 pp. 97-98 testify that Ulrichs, the publisher of *Alaudae*, received a typographically printed copy of it in March, while the manifesto itself is dated the Kalends of March 1890. The first issue of *Phœnix* is dated Kalends of July 1890.

296 *Phœnix* Iul. 1890 No. 1 pp. 1-2

297 *Phœnix* Iul. 1890 No. 1 p. 2: “Propositum deinde est linguam Latinam tanquam medio in aevo usurpatam accurate ad tempus adoptare, hoc est, donec, intentionibus ad rem hominibus, utilior et elegantior et cum hodierna vita congruentior inventa erit.”

298 *Phœnix* Iul. 1890 No. 1 p. 2: “Exceptionem quam proponitis: “Ad tempus, donec ... inventa erit,” rejicio, latinam linguam poscens “*sans phrase*.””. Also in *Alaudae* Iun. 1890 No. 12 p. 91.

The third issue²⁹⁹ of *Phaenix*, published in June 1891, a year after the original proposal, contains a new version of the manifesto, caused by insistence of “some friends”³⁰⁰. It now takes into regard the complete grandeur of the Latin tradition and its importance for saving the culture of the world. It now fulminates against the so-called “universal” languages and against those who want to abolish the study of Latin: if that would happen, the culture itself would disappear and the world would soon relapse to barbarity.³⁰¹ They shall not prevail against the language which is *the teacher of mankind (linguam generis humani magistram)*.³⁰² The initial broad proclamations of the practicality of Latin are reduced to the licence of using (1) not only classical words, but rather from across the whole Latin tradition, (2) well-formed international words of Latin or Greek origin, (3) word order in sentences approaching that of the modern languages. A generic exhortation is added that “it is desired that the use of the Latin language would become more frequent in communication between people of different nations; that books, articles and newspapers would be published in Latin more often than they presently are”.³⁰³ And so the manifesto of Latin as a practical world language becomes a more usual praise of the pre-eminence of Latin and a generic wish that Latin would be used more often than it currently is. However, the focus on the modernisation of language is still here – the slogan of the proposed *International society of modern Latin (Societas internationalis Latinitatis modernae)* is *Let us, the moderns, dare to use the modern Latin (Audeamus moderni uti Latinitate moderna)*.

The fourth and the last issue, published in April 1892, continues this trend – it is prefaced by a long letter *About the Roman speech (De sermone Romano)* by Constantinus Stauder (*Costantino Stauder*, 1841-1913), an Italian Episcopal (!) priest living in London.³⁰⁴ He praises the universal progress of the times, deplores the language barrier between nations and asserts that it is the sole obstacle to “universal fraternity, universal peace, universal commerce/communication, and

299 *Phaenix* Kal. Iun. 1891 No. 3 pp. 17-18

300 *Phaenix* Kal. Iun. 1891 No. 3 p. 17: “Amici quidam nostri consilium nobis dant de Schemate Societatis Internationalis mense Martio 1890 jam edito emendando. De quo quid sentiant ex hominibus comperire valde desideramus. Sequitur deinde consilii expositio: // SOCIETAS INTERNATIONALIS LATINITATIS MODERNAE // “*Audeamus moderni uti Latinitate moderna.*” // Diversitatem et multitudinem linguarum, quae in oribus hominum versantur, nemo sanus non habet invisas. Inde evenit, ut tot viri decepti sint phantasmate linguarum illarum “universalium,” Volapük, Pasilingua, Lingua Internacia, Spelin, Nal Bino, Kosmos, Lingua, Lingua Franca Nova, Anglo-Franca, Langue Facile, Veltsplik, Lingua Catolica, etc. Sed hae nomine tantum universales sunt, non re, nec quicquam hucusque tentamentis illis effectum est, nisi ut numerus linguarum augeatur, nedum minuatur. // Ast in Europa culta per quindecim et amplius saecula fuit lingua quaedam universalis, non nomine, verum re, nempe lingua Latina”.

301 *Ibid.*: “Id si crederemus, dicendum esset, jamjam culturam ipsam nationum modernarum perituram, et orbem universum brevi tempore collapsurum in barbariem.”.

302 *Ibid.*: “Dicant, clament, delirent hostes nominis Latini, quicquid libuerit: adversus linguam generis humani magistram non praevallebunt.”.

303 *Phaenix* Kal. Iun. 1891 No. 3 p. 18: “optandum esse, ut usus linguae Latinae inter homines nationum diversarum frequentior fiat; ut saepius, quam nunc fit, libri, commentationes, ephemerides Latine edantur”

304 See Appendix A.2 for a biography of Stauder.

reconciliation of the whole mankind”.³⁰⁵ The end of the letter sees a praise of the perfection of the eternal Latin language, to which we have to return if we want our works to survive throughout the ages.

Therefore, Latin as a cultural symbol takes hold and drowns the initial concern purely for a practical world language for trade (*Phœnix* starts with the question “Does the Latin language serve commerce?”).³⁰⁶ In *Phœnix*, even though it is just a short project and a small periodical, we see the tension inherent in any attempt to revive the use of Latin language – the opposing poles of utilitarian and cultural concerns, when one side emphasises the possible widespread utility of the language, the other emphasises the traditional, literary and cultural aspects.

Phœnix was singular for trying to involve a wide spectrum of adherents and for being an open forum for publishing their opinions. Even though *Phœnix* has only 32 pages, it contains 49 non-anonymous letters, almost all of them by unique authors (it was not a journal where the same correspondents appear in every issue) with very different viewpoints. Some of them are by Latin teachers, several by the Living Latin activists.³⁰⁷ As *Phœnix* was also advertised in periodicals aligned with the international language movement, we can find in it letters written in Latin by many artificial language proponents (including those of Esperanto)³⁰⁸ who expressed their opinions *against* Latin, preferring the languages they themselves have created or even English (!).

The context in which Henderson published this journal is instructive, as it shows how the Living Latin activism could arise from and intersect with the general international auxiliary language activism. So *Phœnix* was published in 1890-1892. In 1888, two years before *Phœnix*, Henderson had authored a language called *Lingua*: it had a Latin lexical base, which is most well-known and international, with the addition of internationally used words like *sport* or *café*, but also an analytical grammar like English – just as in most of the artificial auxiliary language projects, inflection was considered superfluous.³⁰⁹ In 1889, Henderson, under the pseudonym of *P. Hoinix* (NB!), published another language: *Anglo-Franca*, a mix of English and French. The main principle was the combination of the internationally better known French vocabulary and the simpler English

305 *Phœnix* Kal. Apr. 1892 No. 4 p. 25: “En universalis fraternitas, universalis pax, universale commercium et totius generis humani reconciliatio ab hac miscellanea linguarum interpellata, impedita, advocata.”

306 “An deservit lingua Latina rei mercatoriae?”

307 Letters of Karl Heinrich Ulrichs and Arcadius Avellanus have been published in *Phœnix*.

308 Richard H. Geoghegan (1866-1943), the first Esperantist in the English-speaking world (who published Zamenhof’s *First book* / *Unua libro* in English in 1889), favours Esperanto, but is benevolent – he sees the possibility of the return of Latin as a great solution (“rei internationalis enodatio optima”, *Phœnix* Iul. 1890 No. 1 p. 3). In fact, his initial contact with Zamenhof in 1887 was established by corresponding in Latin (Forster (1982, 268); Richardson (2009, 13)).

309 See Couturat and Leau (1903, 380 ff.). An example sentence (p. 387): “Mesiur, me recipi-tum tuo epistula hic mane gratissimé. <...> Me mitt-num le pretio-nota cum hic epistola, non cum le mercs.”. -*tum* indicates the past tense, -*num* the present tense; *mercs* is the plural of *merc* – merchandise (from the Latin stem: nom. *merx*, gen. *merc-is*). In 1903 Henderson had a quite negative view of his old project: “*Lingua*, mee prime experimente, essete vere crude et imperfecte.” (Henderson 1903a).

grammar.³¹⁰ After several years of promoting the *genuine* Latin as the international language through his *Phoenix* campaign, the disillusioned Henderson gradually returned to the idea of simplified Latin and in 1901 created another variation of it: *Latinesce* (form reminiscent of *Latinesque*), a much less violent modification of Latin.³¹¹ In 1902 he wrote a brochure about his *Phoenix* experience, making it one of the first works about the history of Living Latin.³¹²

In 1903-1906 Henderson used *Latinesce* for corresponding with another proponent of simplified Latin – the Italian mathematician Giuseppe Peano, who replied to Henderson’s letters in his own *Latino sine flexione* which he had published in 1903.³¹³ In the 1906 conversation³¹⁴ Henderson explains his ideology, which is surprisingly similar to that of the utilitarian strands of Living Latin, even if he is promoting a basically artificial language:

What do we finally have to do? You, D^r. Daniel Rosa, D^r. Beerman, and I have invented the best solution – a language intelligible to anyone who knows some Latin, but does not dare to write it and feels that the Latin style is too difficult for modern uses. *Nov Latin*, *Latino sine Flexione* and *Latinesce* are intelligible to every well educated person of every nation, without any explanation.³¹⁵ *Latino sine Flexione*, *Nov Latin* and *Latinesce* are only dialects of the same language.³¹⁶ Our *Neo Latin*, *Latinoid* or *Latinesque* method can reach the proposed goals, because through this method all well educated people can understand what we want to say, without any explanation. It is only necessary to write in *Latino sine Flexione* or in *Latinesce* or in *Nov Latin* and all well educated people will understand us. – No grammar, no dictionary will be necessary. That is the power of our idea.³¹⁷

310 Couturat and Leau (1903, 393 ff.). An example from p. 398: “Me pren the liberté to ecriv to you in Anglo-Franca... Me have the honneur to soumet to you’s inspection the prospectus of me’s objets manufactured, which me to you envoy here-included.”

311 Couturat and Leau (1903, 389 ff.). An example from p. 391: “Nostre Patre qui esse in coele, sanctificate esse tue nomine: veni tue regne; facte esse tue voluntate, ut in coele, ita in terre.”. The infinitive-like forms are used for the functions of infinitive, present conjunctive and future indicative; stem-only forms like *veni* are used for present indicative and imperative. *Esse* is used for the latter case, while *essere* for the former. See footnote 319 for another example of *Latinesce*.

312 Henderson (1902). It is noted by Couturat and Leau (1903, 520), but it is not clear if any copies survived.

313 The paper in which Giuseppe Peano first described his language (Peano 1903) is famous for its ingenious composition: Peano starts from the classical Latin and then gradually takes away more and more of the synthetic grammar, replacing it with analytical constructions and explaining his changes in the process. The beginning: “Lingua latina fuit internationalis in omni scientia, ab imperio Romano, usque ad finem saeculi XVIII. Hodie multi reputant illam nimis difficilem esse, iam in scientia, magis in commercio. // Sed non tota lingua latina est necessaria; parva pars sufficit ad exprimendam quamlibet ideam.”. The end: “CONCLUSIONE. Articolo, qui praecedere, proba quod flexio de nomen et de verbo non es necessario.”

314 The correspondence, consisting from 10 letters, is located in the archive of Giuseppe Peano in the Library of Cuneo (*Fondo Giuseppe Peano / Biblioteca Civica di Cuneo*), which is available online (<https://www.comune.cuneo.it/cultura/biblioteca/cataloghi/fondo-peano.html>, consulted 14.8.2023).

315 Henderson (1906a): “Que debe nos, tandem, facere? Vos, D^r Daniel Rosa, D^r Beermann, et me habe invente i optime solutione – une Lingue intelligibile ad omne homines qui scie aliquantulum Latine, sed qui aude non scribere idem, qui senti que i Latine Stile esse nimis grave pro moderne uses. *Nov Latin*, *Latino sine Flexione* et *Latinesce* esse intelligibile ad omne bene instructe homine de omne natione, sine ulle explicatione.”

316 Henderson (1906c): “*Latine Sine Flexione*, *Nov Latin* et *Latinesce* esse modo dialectes de idem lingue.”

This idea of a Latin-based international language of the learned is contrasted with that of Esperanto, which is deemed to be excessively democratic – after all, the educated need an international language much more than the common people (this idea was certainly represented in the artificial language movement, e.g., Schleyer destined Volapük to the *educated*, thus mirroring the historical role of Latin).³¹⁸ Also, Latin is already taught everywhere, so projects based on Latin are far superior to those artificial languages that require people to learn them separately:

And Esperanto? – Will this artificial language solve our problem? – I believe not. – Why? Because the school teachers (*i ludi-magistres*) do not want to adopt it, and without the help of schools, *Esperanto* will be only a language of several thousand enthusiasts in various countries. – No language will be of real utility if not taught in all high schools in all countries. ⟨...⟩ Nevertheless, the Esperantists say that the international language has to be for the people (*i popule*), for the masses (*i vulge*), not only for the erudite and well-educated. But that idea is in fact an illusion, because the masses in all countries will never use an international language, which will always be a language more for reading and writing than for speaking. If Esperanto were to be taught in all schools, how many people after two or three years would be able to understand or speak in that language between themselves? – Without practice, people forget a language after a short time. // An international language will be useful chiefly *for the educated people (ad instructe homines)*. It will save the time of students because for them it will be necessary to study only *one* language, namely Latin, through the method of the New Latin Lingua Franca, in order to be able to communicate with the foreigners, and to read the ideas of foreigners writing about things of interest to them. // Esperanto is not a bad system, but the Esperantists are too hopeful (*i Esperantiste esse nimis sperante*). We will never have an international language if it will not be taught in every high school just as Latin is today.³¹⁹ But Esperanto is not intelligible, if one has not read its simple grammatical rules. This difficulty would

317 Henderson (1906b): “Nostre *Neo Latin*, *Latinoid*, seu *Latinesque* methode pote attingere i fine proposita, quia per iste methode omne bene instructe homines pote intelligere que nos vole dicere, sine ulla explicatione. Ille esse modo necessarie scribere in *Latino sine Flexione*, vel in *Latinesce*, vel in *Nov Latin* et omne bene instructe homines intelligere nos. – Nulle grammaticae, nulle dictionarie esse necessarie. Tale esse i potentie de nostre idea.”

318 Garvía (2015, 26): “The relatively well educated was Schleyer’s target group. As he indicated in the subtitle of his first handbook, Volapük was not invented for the common people, but for the *Gebildete* (the educated). Like Latin in the Republic of Letters of the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries, Volapük was meant to be a written language catering to the needs of “scholars, travelers, and merchants” (*Studierenden, Reisenden und Kaufleuten*).”

319 Henderson (1906a): “Et Esperanto? – Solvere iste artefacte lingue nostre problemate? – Me crede non. – Quare? Quia i ludi-magistres vole non adoptare ille, et sine i auxilie de i scholes, ‘Esperanto’ essere solé i lingue de nonnullae millie de enthousiastes in i varie terres. – Nulle lingue essere de vere utilitate ni[s]i ille esse instructe in omne superiore scholes in omne terres. ⟨...⟩ Esperantistes dice, autem, que i internationale lingue debe essere pro i popule, pro i vulge, non solé pro i erudites vel bene instructes. Sed iste idee esse vere illusionem, quia i vulge in omne terres numquam utere una internationale lingue, que essere semper maiore una lingue de lecture et scripture quam una lingue pro colloquere. Si Esperanto esset instructe in omne scholes, quot homines post duo vel tres annes potere intelligere vel colloquere cum una aliene in ille lingue? – Sine praxe homines oblivisce una lingue post breve tempore. // Una internationale lingue essere praecipue utile *ad instructe homines*. Ille parcere i tempore de studentes quia ille essere necessarie stude solé *une* lingue – i Latine, cum i methode de i Nove Latine Lingua Franca, ut illes pote communicare cum alienes, et ut illes pote legere i ideas de alienes que scribe de i res in que illes interessa se. // Esperanto esse non una male systemate, sed i Esperantistes esse nimis Sperante. Nos habere numquam una internationale lingue nisi ille esse instructe in omne superiore schole sicut i Latine esse hodie.”

be solved if Esperanto would be taught in all schools in all countries of the civilised world. But I see no signs that the schools would start to teach Esperanto.³²⁰ Our solution, on the other hand, is intelligible *without any explanation*.³²¹ The day of Esperanto is almost gone. – The day of Neo-Latin approaches. – Neo-Latin builds on the school disciplines. – Without the schools Esperanto will be nothing.³²²

Henderson also rails against the classical establishment not enthusiastic about the idea that Latin should be taught in a heavily practical way like a basis for an international language:

Recently in our country the question of the future position of Classical languages (Latin and Greek) in our schools and universities has been much agitated. I have made an experiment³²³ by asking the most important people who are interested about this culture, whether they would support the proposition of teaching the Greek language in such a way that it would be possible to use this language as the international language between all well-educated people of all nations. The opinions which they have expressed, are not really favourable. These friends of classical culture are really enigmatic to me. They talk much about the terrible tragedy which would strike the civilisation if the teaching of the classical languages in schools were either diminished or abolished. – But when people suggest a method, through which the Latin or the Greek language could become a language of greatest utility, they remain without any zeal (*studie*) or enthusiasm, and do nothing for establishing these so laudable languages in a permanent and indispensable position. “Do not trust the professors or the teachers of Latin and Greek, because they have narrow minds.” – !!! // The causes for recalling the Latin language to life or for extending the use of the Greek language are lost, because these who *can* help *do not want to* help.³²⁴

320 Henderson (1906b): “Esperanto esse non legibile sine explicatione. Ille esse necessarie habere studite sue regules antequam homines pote intellegere ille. – Iste difficultate essere superate si Esperanto essere docte in omne scholes in omne terres de i civilizate munde. Sed me vide nulle signes que i scholes suscipere docere Esperanto.”

321 Henderson (1906a): “Sed Esperanto esse non intelligibile, nisi homine habe lecte i simplice grammaticae regules. Nostre solutione autem esse intelligibile *sine ulle explicatione*.”

322 Henderson (1906b): “I die de Esperanto esse fere praeterite. – I die de Neo-Latin appropinqua. Neo-Latin aedifica super i discipline de i scholes. Sine i scholes Esperanto essere nihil.”

323 Henderson is referring to an open letter he published in *The Outlook* 7 July 1906 Vol. XVIII No. 440 pp. 14-15: “Esperanto or Greek? (To the editor of “The Outlook”)”

324 Henderson (1906a): “Nuper in nostre terre i questione de i future positione de i studie de i Classice lingues, Latine et Hellenice (Graece), in nostre scholes et universitates habe essete multe agitate. Me habe facte une experimete interrogare i praecipue homines qui interessa se pro iste culture si illes adjuvare i propositione de docere i Hellenice lingue in tale mode que ille essere possibile utere ille lingue pro i internationale lingue inter omne bene instructe homines de omne nationes. I opiniones, que illes habe expresse, esse non vere favorabile. Iste amices de i classice culture esse vere enigmaticae ad me. Illes loque multe de i terribile clade que advenire ad civilizatione si i discipline in i classice lingues essere aut diminute aut abolite ex i scholes. – Quum homines, autem, suggere une methode, per que i Latine vel i Hellenice lingue pote essere facte i lingue de i maxime utilitate, illes mane sine studie et enthousiasme, et face nihil pro instituere iste tam laudate lingues in une permanente et indispensable positione. “Confite *<sic>* vos non in Latine et Hellenice professores, neque in ludi magistres, quia illes habe anguste mentes.” – !!! // I causes de revocare i Latine lingue in vite, et de extendere i use de i Hellenice lingue esse perditae, quia illes, qui *pote* adjuvare, *non vole* adjuvare.”

Henderson is advocating for a *modified* Latin as an international language. However, his arguments and concerns are very similar to many of the utilitarian promoters of Living Latin, who also strived to imbue the usual teaching of Latin in schools with an additional communicative function, arguing that this would provide a great additional value for its teaching. Even the conflict and the frustration with the “narrow minded” teachers is quite similar: Henderson sees primarily a utilitarian purpose in Latin and is surprised that the teachers (who in fact believe that they are performing a *cultural* mission by teaching Latin) do not share his enthusiasm.

The proposal of a simplified Latin as a language which would be immediately recognisable by anyone who had learned Latin in school, and the repeated emphasis on the *well-educated men*, even underlining these words in the manuscript, strike one as elitist. Esperanto is seen as delusional by preoccupying itself with the idea that it is a language for everyone, for the *vulgus* and the *populus*, who will never really need an international language. This opposition between the learned and the common people often appeared in the positioning of Latin; the ancient Latin-speaking *res publica litterarum* was a *res publica eruditorum* and Latin was hardly, if ever, proposed as a language of communication between common people – not even the most ardent Living Latin proponents imagined this role.³²⁵ Henderson maintains the classical social stratification characteristic of Latin.

This idea of a universal recognisability and the focus on learned communication is incredibly similar to what Carlo Galassi Paluzzi promoted in the 1930s Italy – a very simple Latin, a language that would be *universally read*.³²⁶ Paluzzi proposed that one should use a very simple Latin in the Latin abstracts of scientific publications, but for him the original grammar of Latin had to be maintained; Henderson went a step further. Nonetheless, the thinking exhibited by Henderson

325 For example, see the near-contemporary quote of Arcadius Avellanus in *Præco Latinus* Feb. 1896 Vol. II No. 5 p. 1: “Consilium enim non est ut omnes omnino homines Latine edocendos arbitremur. Nec profecto somniamus ut plebecula vilis in compitis triviisque Latine vociferetur; ut “nauta de ventis de bobus (Latine) narret arator;” absit! Utatur vulgus suo idiomate, docti autem *sunto pares* Latine scribendo & loquendo.” In 1897 Avellanus wrote this against *Novilatiin*, another version of a simplified Latin: “Nec adulandum est numeris plebis. Plebs Anglica, Russica, Germanica, &c., lingua peregrina aut gentium non eget; docti egent. 2-do, Sat bene conventum inter “linguifices” fundamentum l. Lñam esse oportere, sed singulari quodam modo etiam conventum est eam non incolumem esse usurpandam, sed diffringendam et in articulos laniandam, quasi Itali, Hispani Gallicque non iam satis eam in floccos discerpserint. Sensus communis suadere videtur ut ex his tristissimis rudibus (Italica, Hispanica, Gallica, &c.) ipsa mater esset eruenda, imo ut hæ ipsæ gentes sua idiomata ad matrem pedetentim reducerent, ita ut proles non amplius discerent *hommes, uomini, hombres* sed *homines*. Sed si iam plebes Lñe nunquam loquuntur, saltem eruditi hoc faciant.” (Mart. 1897 Vol. III No. 6 p. 8). Later (Iul. 1899 Vol. V No. 10 p. 147) Avellanus wants Latin to separate the profane unlearned masses from the learned discourse: “Vulgus indoctum utatur qualibet lingua; nihil attinet. Litteræ ac scientiæ sunt gentibus communes, res sacræ, quæ linguam quamdam sacram, profanis imperviam postulant.”

326 See page 135, chapter 4.3.2.

and possibly others in this splintered movement of many versions of simplified Latin could probably also be seen as a certain reception of Latin, an offshoot of the Latin tradition.³²⁷

Peano traced a deep intellectual pedigree for his approach – in his project of *Latino sine Flexione* he quoted recently published manuscripts of Leibniz, where he alluded to a possible simplification of Latin as the first step to a universal language and grammar.³²⁸ Peano explicitly promoted his language as a scientific language, publishing his mathematical works in it, and presenting it as the successor of Latin for today.

The fundamental difference between Living Latin and such projects is the concern for the *integrality* of the language. The enthusiasts of a practical international language acknowledge that Latin provides a neutral basis for international communication, but they are willing to break the language into fragments and to use them as bricks for creating their own perfectly neutral, rational, simple and useful solutions.³²⁹ On the other hand, the Living Latin supporters believe that they are using and promoting an integral language, preserving a certain organic *whole* and a certain continuity – the Latin used is perceived to be the same one that had been used historically. They believe that even a non-modified Latin is capable of modernity.

Therefore, Henderson contributed to the establishment of the Living Latin movement – his agitation and efforts to create an international organisation (he was the first one to propose one) contributed to the perception that a movement for the restoration of Latin was going on,³³⁰ his Latin journal helped to bring together the community – but ultimately his views and goals did not align with this movement and he continued his efforts to solve the international language question in what seemed to him more promising directions. The Living Latin movement, even if engaging with the international language question and justifying itself through practical concerns, was ultimately about love for Latin itself.

327 In fact, sometimes it is hard to separate some of the advocacy for Latin as an international language from that of a simplified Latin or some kind of a Latin-based artificial language. André (1903) promotes Latin as an international language and copiously describes the “modern Latin” movement, but finally opts for a simplification of language. See appendix A.15 for an introduction to two figures who promoted a simple or a simplified Latin as an international language – Nahida Sturmhöfel in 1884 and Sylvia Pankhurst in 1927.

328 Couturat (1903a, 35) publishes the text of Leibniz specifying language simplification steps, e.g. the elimination of cases (“nominum casus semper eliminari possunt substitutis in eorum locum particulis quibusdam cum nominativo [...] ut patet ex linguis in quibus nullae sunt nominum inflexiones”). The publisher Louis Couturat, a prominent logician, later used Leibniz’s authority to strengthen the historical intellectual basis of his own artificial language programme (he does that in Couturat (1903b) and Couturat and Leau (1903, *passim*); see also footnote 476).

329 These are the main criteria for creating an international auxiliary language of *a posteriori* type, namely, one based on existing natural languages and vocabulary. Another type is called the *a priori* languages, which are created *ex nihilo*, such as the philosophical languages which started being invented in the 17th century. Most of the artificial languages combine elements of both approaches, making them *mixed*, so Esperanto is often put in this category. The movement of such languages like Volapük or Esperanto is covered by Garvía (2015). Libert (2004) catalogues “artificial descendants of Latin”. See also footnote 325 – Avellanus had noticed that the language creators like to use Latin as a basis for their creations, but not in an integral way.

330 Cf. footnote 290.

3.4 Arcadius Avellanus and *Præco Latinus*

Arcadius Avellanus (1851-1935) was one of the most outspoken and productive advocates in the early *Living Latin* movement – he published Latin periodicals, textbooks, readers, audio records, numerous translations of modern fiction, he advocated Latin in the press, he led a Latin club for decades, he taught Latin in schools and colleges, in summer schools and privately.

His life and writings received scholarly attention – several papers³³¹ have been dedicated to his life and works, they have been mentioned in surveys of Living Latin periodicals,³³² in Neo-Latin³³³ and universal language³³⁴ scholarship. He is also of considerable reputation in the Latin-speaking world (and the Internet) because of his (possibly erroneous) reputation as “the last native speaker of Latin”; nonetheless, no comprehensive study exists that would encompass all of his life and the whole of his extensive and scattered corpus.

3.4.1 Life of Avellanus

Born Mogyoróssy (or Mogyorósi) Árkád near Esztergom³³⁵ in Hungary in 1851 to a family of a probable noble background, in 1864 he entered³³⁶ a Franciscan gymnasium, in 1869 entered³³⁷ the order as brother Hermannus (or *Hermann Árkád*), in 1874 was consecrated as a priest after theology studies.³³⁸ From 1875 he taught Greek and Latin in the Érsekújvár (today Nové Zámky in Slovakia) lower gymnasium, where education was provided by the Franciscan friars.³³⁹ In 1878, at the call of his order, he migrated to the USA to be the librarian³⁴⁰ of Saint Bonaventure’s Franciscan

331 Beach (1947) is a survey of Avellanus’ life based on his surviving friends’ reports; Platzdasch (2009) a collected bibliography; Owens (2014) is a fundamental reconstruction of his life based on written and even archival sources. Slednikov (2020) introduces Avellanus to the Russian audience. Lyvens (2016) is the thesis I wrote in Latin for the Master’s degree in Classical Philology in Vilnius University; it is primarily about Avellanus’ life and works, parts of this section are based on the data collected and analysed back then.

332 Lurz (1935a); Lurz (1949, 11); Sacré (1988); Slednikov (2017a); Slednikov (2017b)

333 IJsewijn (1990, 218, 292)

334 Couturat and Leau (1903); Stojan (1929, 125); Guérard (1921, 58)

335 Viczián (2004). The place of birth *Mogyorós* was located in the Esztergom county, today this village is called *Mogyorósbánya*.

336 Owens (2014, 6)

337 Viczián (2004)

338 Zelliger (1888, 136)

339 Száraz (1992, 4)

340 Owens (2014, 6)

college³⁴¹ near Buffalo, New York, where he also taught a variety of subjects.³⁴² In 1882, after the death of the rector of the college, he succeeded to this office.

However, in year 1886 he suddenly left both the college and religious life and contracted a marriage, which probably lasted only for a short time.³⁴³ Later in his life he maintained an ambiguous relationship with religion – in his Latin advocacy he sought support of the Catholic Church, but was characterised³⁴⁴ by his friends as an atheist and seemingly never revealed his religious past to them; even before leaving the Church he was known for his liberal views.³⁴⁵

Even though he had learned Latin in an ecclesiastical setting (as he confesses, “my familiarity with the Latin suitable for modern world is owed to the 18 years spent in monastery where we used Latin just like as a vernacular language”),³⁴⁶ in the later years he preferred to raise his stature by telling stories how he was “speaking the language as a child and becoming fluent in it before he learned his mother-tongue”.³⁴⁷ While at first he used his Latinised name *Arcadius Avellanus* only in his Latin writings, by 1910 it was made his official name³⁴⁸ and so Latin became a core part of his identity.

So Avellanus had experience in teaching Latin and an ecclesiastical background of using Latin as an everyday language. This life experience influenced his interest in Latin, especially his perpetual focus on teaching methods. Already in 1883/1884 he contributed to a Latin periodical *Latine*,³⁴⁹ which was directed at Latin teachers and promoted teaching Latin through active

341 Today it is the *St. Bonaventure University*.

342 Frank (2018): “Herman, Arcadius, O.S.F. (1878-1879) // Professor of Dogmatic Theology, Church History, Hebrew and Arabic Languages <...> Magyrosi, Arcadius, O.S.F. see Mogyorossy <...> Mogyorossy, Arcadius, O.S.F. (1879-1886) // Professor of Dogmatic Theology, Church History, Hebrew and Arabic languages, Sacred Scripture, German, French, and Hermeneutics”. OSF = *Ordo Sancti Francisci*; a synonym, as it seems (Avellanus is in some sources named as OSF, in others as OFM), of OFM = *Ordo Fratrum Minorum*, both denoting the Franciscan Order.

343 Owens (2014, 7); *The Olean Democrat* (*Olean, New York*) Nov. 4 1886 p. 1. If the source (*The Boston Globe* (*Boston, Massachusetts*) Oct. 30 1886 p. 3) is reliable, it is unclear if this marriage was even valid, as Edith E. Clare (1856-?) was already married and no divorce had been initiated before her marriage to Avellanus.

344 Beach (1947, 506)

345 *The Olean Democrat* (*Olean, New York*) Nov. 4 1886 p. 1: “His actions sometimes caused his friends to think he was not sound in Catholic doctrine, but he was no hypocrite. He did not conceal his contempt for the opposition to the celibacy of the priesthood. <...> His moral conduct was above reproach; but his liberal views made his friends fear that the step he has now taken was not far off. <...> the professor expresses the most liberal views on religious subjects and renounces the superstitions of the church, being willing even to be called an infidel, <...>”

346 *Phœnix* Dec. 1890 No. 2 p. 15: “Propria familiaritas mea huius, paene impenetrabilis linguae partis <that is, of Latin suited to describing modern objects> penitus debetur octodecim annis in monasterio exactis, ubi Latinae <sic> perinde ac vernacula sumus usi.”

347 Beach (1947, 505). Leonard (1908, 25): “He learned to speak Latin when a child, pursued all his studies in Latin, and completed his education in an alumnium in Hungary.” Several passages in *Præco Latinus* also claim childhood experience with Latin: Ian. 1901 Vol. VII No. 4 p. 102: “Puelli honestorum parentum iam domi suæ ex unguiculis Latine blaterare didicerunt, quemadmodum ipsi nos.”; Feb. 1899 Vol. V No. 5 p. 69: “Rñi nati non sumus; I. Lñam partim pusiones, genibus Avunculi obequitantes, partim in ludis didiceramus, nec medio vernaculæ solum, sed perpetuis colloquiis”.

348 In 1900 census he is still *Arcade Mogyoróssy*, but in 1910 he is already *Arcadius Avellanus*.

349 Edgar Solomon Shumway (1856-1928), after having taught Latin by the natural method in the 1882 Amherst Summer school of languages (*Journal of Education* 30 Nov. 1882 p. 346), founded the journal *Latine* (later called *Latine et Graece*), published from November 1882 to May 1886. It was initially published in Latin only, later in

methodologies. By 1887 he had already finished³⁵⁰ the manuscript of *Palæstra*, his textbook for teaching Latin as a living language.

Avellanus' publishing activity can be divided into three fields: periodicals, textbooks, translations. In 1893 he started publishing *Palæstra* in the journal *Tusculum*, from 1894 to 1902 he has been publishing *Præco Latinus*. His textbooks were published from 1893 (serially in *Tusculum*) and from 1894 (as separate books) until 1919. In the period between 1914 and 1928 he published a series of translations of modern fiction into Latin, intended as engaging readers. Apart from Latin publishing, he was active in the Hungarian community of the USA, editing several newspapers.³⁵¹

After Saint Bonaventure he taught in the Rugby Academy, Pennsylvania;³⁵² after the *Præco Latinus* period he may have taught in the University of Pennsylvania around 1908.³⁵³ From 1909 he was a private tutor of Latin for the daughter and grandchildren of John D. Rockefeller, the oil magnate; the family also financed the translations of modern fiction into Latin.³⁵⁴ In 1910 he was apparently teaching Latin in Middletown, Connecticut.³⁵⁵ Maybe this list is incomplete.³⁵⁶ Finally he taught in St. John's College in Brooklyn (1918-1924).³⁵⁷ In 1933 Avellanus is present as a contributing editor in the Latin journal *Auxilium Latinum*.³⁵⁸

English. Shumway organised his fellow teachers into an organisation called the *Latin Chain* and *Latine* was its publication for various Latin texts and exercises (*New-York Daily Tribune* 14 Aug. 1883 p. 5). *Latine* Jan. 1884 Vol. II No. 5: "A Partial List of Contributors to LATINE includes: {...} Professor A. MOGYOROSI, of St. Bonaventure's College." See also footnote 442.

350 *Præco Latinus* Aug. 1899 Vol. V. No. 11 p. 184: "Non ignoramus Mgrum D'Ooge nos respectu temporis antecessisse, quamquam MSS. *Palæstræ* æstate anni 1887-mi iam parata fuissent. <sic>".

351 *Magyar Amerika* in New York in 1879; *Önállás* in Hazleton, Pennsylvania from 1890 to 1897; *Magyar Napilap* in Cleveland, Ohio in (at least) 1906. See the entries for these newsletters in the *Magyar Katolikus Lexikon* (Diós and Viczián 1993-2014); also Batári (1987) and Batári (1999). Judging from some of the echoes, in these Hungarian projects Avellanus was just as conflict-prone as in the Latin ones.

352 See the beginning of chapter 3.4.5.1 in page 96.

353 Owens (2014, 8)

354 See the beginning of chapter 3.4.5.4 in page 102.

355 1910 census found Avellanus in "St. Elizabeth's convent" of Sisters of Mercy, R.S.M. in St. John's square in Middletown in the state of Connecticut. He was the only male inhabitant in the convent. Maybe Avellanus was teaching Latin in the local school of St. John that was curated by the Sisters of Mercy (Herron 1922, 187). Middletown as the address is also given by Avellanus (1909).

356 Viczián (2004) claims that he taught Latin, Greek and Hebrew in St. Joseph's college in Orleans, Massachusetts and later in Wooster University, Ohio: "Orleansban (Mass.) a St. Joseph Coll., majd a Wooster University (Oh.) gör-lat-héb. tanára".

357 Owens (2014, 10). A typewritten letter by Avellanus written in 1927 and contained in the facsimile of *Palæstra* (Avellanus 1919) available online (<https://archive.org/details/palaestrabeingpr12avel/page/n569/mode/1up>, consulted 20.9.2023) provides the 1924 date of leaving St. John's.

358 See footnote 529 for the journal. In the *Auxilium Latinum* issues available for consultation (Nov. 1932 Vol. IV No. 2 – Apr. 1933 Vol. IV No. 7) *Arcadius Avellanus, Ph.D.* is one of the ten *Contributing Associate Editors*. See Appendix A.3 about the source of the doctoral degree of Avellanus.

From 1912³⁵⁹ until sometime between 1931 and 1933³⁶⁰ he led an officially incorporated³⁶¹ Latin speaking society *Societas Gentium Latina* in New York that used to meet fortnightly, gathering about twenty amateurs of Latin who had learned it in school or college and now wanted to revive their knowledge through speaking.³⁶² Today the many Latin circles or *circuli Latini* are exactly of the same type, making Avellanus a pioneer of this format.

Avellanus died in 1935.

3.4.2 Avellanus in *Phœnix* in 1890: a vision of a comprehensive Living Latin programme

The public life of Avellanus in defence of Latin begins in 1890 with a letter³⁶³ published in *Phœnix*, where he gives his motivation and plans for making Latin the world language. Volapük, the first artificial language to become a worldwide phenomenon, seems to have provided the impetus – Avellanus despised this *Chimaera Germanica* and was convinced that Latin provided the real solution to the international language problem.

According to him, there are two difficulties in popular opinion – Latin not having technical terms suitable for the modern world and it being too difficult – but both of them can be easily resolved. The question of the terminology of Latin has eventually to be solved collectively, but it is not the most urgent one, reforming the teaching of Latin is. Avellanus has already constructed a new textbook of Latin that makes Latin both easy and pleasant; its first part will be practical, while the second part will consist of the classical authors annotated in the style of *ad usum Delphini* editions. This textbook would partly take care of the lexicographic problems inherent in resuscitating Latin – Avellanus promises to treat all the modern topics in the practical part of the textbook and to use words and phrases he had learned during his time in monastery which only “very few “Classical”

359 See *New Yorker* 1 Feb. 1930 p. 12; 15 Feb. 1930 p. 30 for the dates and description starting “It was about eighteen years ago that Dr. Arcadius Avellanus of Brooklyn began talking Latin to his buddies Mr. Herbert Cornwell and Dr. Leffingwell Hedge. They used to meet in small restaurants twice a week *<an error – all other sources give a fortnightly interval>* to speak to each other in Latin. They soon decided that they would invite others so disposed to foregather with them and talk Latin. Now there are twenty of them. When they get together, they keep minutes in Latin, read papers in Latin, eat dinner practically in Latin, and when they have nothing else to do they write each other letters in Latin *<...>* They are incorporated – The Society of Latin Gentlemen, Inc.”. This English name was probably made up by the journalist, as the official name was *Societas Gentium Latina* and *gentium* means “international” rather than “gents” (a short form of “gentlemen”). Two volumes of the minutes are available in the New York Public library under the name of *Acta Societatis Gentium Latinae* (vol. 1: 1913-1917; vol. 2: 1917-1925).

360 In 1931 newspapers described Avellanus’ Latin-only birthday celebration put up by the *Societas Gentium Latina*. Beach (1947, 510); Owens (2014, 10); see also *Brooklyn Daily Eagle* 9 Feb. 1931 p. 18. An extant Dec. 1933 handwritten letter by Avellanus available online (<https://babel.hathitrust.org/cgi/pt?id=hvd.hwp4zl&seq=7>, consulted 20.9.2023) testifies that the society disappeared a while ago: “Licet silentium diuturnum intercesserit ex quo Societas Gentium Latina exinanivit, *<...>*”.

361 Cf. footnotes 359, 386.

362 Appendix A.13 contains an enthusiastic testimony of a member attributing his success in Latin to the practice of it in the *Societas*.

363 *Phœnix* Dec. 1890 No. 2 p. 15

professors of our universities have ever heard”.³⁶⁴ This ironic remark about academia and the promise to surprise with non-standard Latin vocabulary are very typical of Avellanus, who liked to accuse philologists of being badly informed and of having killed Latin.

In the same letter Avellanus also outlines the course of action that would have to be taken in order to make Latin the world language. First of all, friends are to be found who would defend Latin in the press and so would attract the attention of the public, secondly, public lectures are to be delivered in many cities, thirdly, most affordable conversational grammars published, and finally Latin newspapers are to be founded.

3.4.3 *Præco Latinus*, the *Latin Herald*

In October 1894 Avellanus started to publish the monthly Latin journal *Præco Latinus* (*The Latin Herald*); its last issue was published in September 1902. This constitutes a not inconsiderable literary corpus (about 1550 pages). For studying the early Living Latin movement this corpus is a veritable goldmine: it is quite extensive, it contains numerous letters from readers, the editor reacts to what is happening in the world, involves himself in discussions about various topics (his statements are full of polemical outbursts and designations of “colleagues” and “enemies”), provides a running commentary on nearly everything published in the pages.³⁶⁵ This publication helps determine various aspects of Living Latin ideological positions both from individual and collective perspective. The active engagement with the outside world helps one observe the context of the times.

The original purpose of *Præco* was twofold – Avellanus founded it to advertise his *Palæstra* textbook series and to proclaim (hence the name *Præco*, “The Herald”) and fight for the new way of looking into Latin. For Avellanus these two purposes went together and he was convinced that his

364 *Phoenix* Dec. 1890 No. 2 p. 15: “Exemplar hisce litteris meis adieci duorum pensorum ut ex iis intelligere iudicareque methodum meam possitis. Videbitis me inchoare a puncto et linea et sic construendo progredior ad altiora. Postquam precepta grammaticae tradita fuerint, opificia, officinas fabrorum, navigationem, ferroviā, res militares, politicas, mercatorias omnesque alias topicas discussurus aggrediar iconibus paginatim illustrando adhibendoque vocabula et phrases Latinas quas pauci admodum Professores Universitatum nostrarum “classici” unquam audiverant. // Propria familiaritas mea huius, paene impenetrabilis linguae partis penitus debetur octodecim annis in monasterio exactis, ubi Latinae perinde ac vernacula sumus usi.”

365 Sacré (2020a, 256) gives an apt summary of the general impression: “Avellanus was an awkward figure, to some extent a fantast exaggerating his achievements so as to further his career, and a polemic figure, always convinced of being in the right; moreover, he did not possess the refined literary taste of Ulrichs. Whoever engages in reading the entire journal, cannot escape the conclusion that it served, above all, Avellanus’s self-promotion.”. Beach (1947, 505): “One of his friends told me that according to the Doctor there were but two kinds of people in the world: those that agreed with him and stultissimi.”. Needless to say, Avellanus himself thought that his barbed polemical outbursts were brilliant: “But particularly was he delighted with my easy and lively manner that I would hit back at French, Spanish, Catalan, Italian and other periodicals, their editors, our critics, &c., who, either in the meshes of foolish “world-languages,” or blinded by School-Ciceronianism, knew nothing of fluent Latin, would assail us. Then I would pour out a volley of information mixed with ridicule, for the great delight of my readers and disciples. Such occasions were veritable treats for our noble-minded friend, Mr. Schuler.” (Avellanus 1909, 115).

efforts constitute *the* movement to restore Latin and *the* inspiration for Latin initiatives worldwide.³⁶⁶ Those who do not read *Præco* and do not like *Palæstra* are probably hostile to Latin itself,³⁶⁷ while those who do read *Præco* and practise the living methods (most probably *Palæstra*) in teaching or learning the language, are considered to belong to the worldwide community of Latin speakers.³⁶⁸

This Avellanian worldwide community of Latin speakers might seem quite similar to the imagined ideal Republic of Letters once enabled by the common Latin language and culture. The old *Res publica litterarum* spoke about the universal culture, about the perpetuity of Latin. Avellanus would concur and add that he too is advocating for a language of the educated. However, there is a crucial difference – while utility used to be an afterthought compared to Latin’s cultural and formative value, Avellanus is making it the primary concern, he wants to expand the use of Latin language beyond its traditional spheres. While Avellanus does not believe that ordinary peasants³⁶⁹ or businessmen³⁷⁰ would start studying Latin, he thinks that the “educated” for whom the international language is destined includes all college-educated people, who “ought to learn Latin to write and to speak, so that they could take places in the business houses as international correspondents and interpreters in Latin”.³⁷¹ So in the ideal world as imagined by Avellanus not only scholarship, but also business would be enabled by Latin – the businessmen would use Latin secretaries for international trade, so the study of Latin would now have an additional practical side of career possibilities.

366 Avellanus (1919, III): “My agitation in behalf of spoken Latin was felt in Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Chile, producing pamphlets, at least two other Latin periodicals, and one French in Belgium, and an Italian in Italy, an International Latin Congress at Rome, Latin popular courses at the Berlin University, discussions at the Royal Prussian Academy of Sciences, in the French Parliament, and in governmental circles in Italy, Russia, Chile, etc.”. See also footnote 371.

367 *Præco Latinus* Ian. 1899 Vol. V No. 4 p. 53: “Qui *Palæstram*, *Tusculum Præconemque*, sola Latinitatis adminicula non curant, certe ipsam linguam non curant neque eius fontes, Classicos.”

368 These friends of Latin are often called synonymously *Præconiani*, *Palæstrites*, *Tusculani*. An Avellanocentric perspective.

369 See footnote 325.

370 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1897 Vol. III No. 9 p. 1: “At mercatores ac fabricatores linguas nunquam discent. Unicum nonnisi remedium: discant iuvenes Latine loqui & scribere, mercatores autem & fabricatores singuli habeant *scribas Latinos!*”

371 *Scientific American* 7 Dec. 1901 Vol. 85 No. 23 p. 363: “I started a movement eight years ago to restore Latin as an international tongue of cultured people, Latin being an international tongue by the fact of its being taught in all secondary schools of the world. That graduates of colleges do not speak it is the fault of the methods and teachers. <...> We therefore take the ground that all college-bred people ought to learn Latin to write and to speak, so that they could take places in the business houses as international correspondents and interpreters in Latin <...> All the hatred, misunderstanding, lack of respect for each other is due to this one fact.”. Regarding the last sentence, see Appendix A.8 for a similar sentiment by Zamenhof.

3.4.4 Language style

Through his textbooks and translations, Avellanus fulfilled his 1890 promise to teach idiosyncratic and non-standard Latin. He refused to limit his vocabulary to the classical authors and instead deliberately chose post-classical Latin as his model,³⁷² and would sometimes use this vocabulary even where there were ready classical alternatives.³⁷³ Therefore his series of Latin translations of modern literature had a mixed critical reception – reviewers praised³⁷⁴ the general pleasure of reading the translations, but also pointed out that deviations from classical usage harm the applicability of these books as reading material for students who are supposed to learn “standard” Latin, so the incompatible peculiarities do not help.³⁷⁵

Palæstra, his Latin textbook, also exhibits a similar pattern – words are introduced disregarding their usage (for example, the rare word *sarracum* is consistently used for a wagon carrying heavy loads instead of its much more frequent synonym *plaustrum*), and many neologisms are included. This pattern is taken to an extreme in *Arena Palæstrarum*, a series of dialogues about a Latin-speaking American family in modern Philadelphia (!), where the whole of the modern world is described in great detail, so every page is filled with rare words or even *hapax legomena* (*formaster*, dandy) and numerous personal neologisms not used by anyone else (*volvellum*, cigarette; *diga*,³⁷⁶ automobile), all noted in copious lexicographical footnotes.

This peculiar style is dictated by the concept and purpose of Latin as imagined by Avellanus – both of them are driven by some kind of functional universality. Avellanus refuses to make the classical canon his sole criterion, for him an obscure Latin word discovered as part of a Roman inscription is just as real and just as worthy to be taught as that of Cicero as long as it helps express some desired meaning – it is Roman too, after all!³⁷⁷ He aspires to teach “modern Latin” at the same

372 Cf. Beach (1947, 507): “He did not wish to be confined to the classical period but chose deliberately the Latin of the Empire, particularly of the age of Tiberius and Claudius, and the pronunciation that he asserted to be “Roman Imperial.””.

373 Owens (2014, 10): “At times he appears to prefer terms from the *Digesta Corporis Juris Civilis* and Plautus even when equivalents frequently appear in Cicero and Caesar.”; Forbes (1915, 28): “In these less than thirty pages there is spread before the wondering eyes of the reader a composite picture of the vocabulary and usage of the entire body of the Latin literature from Plautus to Avellanus.”

374 Forbes (1916a) is the most critical review of Avellanus translations; it criticises many lexical and syntactical aspects, but still admits that “The Latin version, however, is certainly entertaining, and the reviewer is deeply grateful to the translator for the pleasure which he has afforded him.”

375 This is the conclusion of a generally positive review by Rouse (1918). The bibliography of the other reviews: Forbes (1915), Forbes (1916a); Avellanus (1916) replied to these two critical reviews, prompting a reply by Forbes (1916b).

376 *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1900 Vol. VI No. 10 p. 240: “*Digæ* est vocabulum a nobis ad normam *bigarum* fictum. Siquidem *bigæ* idem valeant atque *bi-iuga*, *digæ* idem erunt ac *de-iuga*, *deiugare*, seu nullum iugum equorum.”. So this word was formed by generalising *bigæ* and *quadrigæ*. According to Avellanus, the international word *automobile* is not logical, as wind or people are also *self-propelling*. Avellanus sometimes uses it as *diga*, *ae* f., sometimes as *digæ*, *arum* f.

377 *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1897 Vol. III No. 7 p. 1 treats *Thesaurus Linguae Latinae* – Avellanus is excited about this monumental project, which promises to catalogue all the Latin words used by Romans, and believes that this great

time as the classical one, as it would become the basis for a revival of Latin for international communication. He believes that Latin of the Classical authors will always be suitable for writing in the humanities and the user should not depart from this style without purpose, but if a new *Latinitas technica* is not developed, Latin will not be able to take up this practical international role – if required by circumstances, Latin needs to be brief and technical, the classical periphrases are insufficient.³⁷⁸ So this style of writing is actually a creative lexicographical effort to create a technical register to make Latin suitable for a universal international communicational role. Avellanus never published a universal dictionary that would supposedly solve this problem (although he did dream about a universal dictionary of neologisms published by a universal committee),³⁷⁹ but he weaved his inventions into texts, with *Arena* serving as a dictionary in concentrated prose.

The neglect of the classical style is related to Avellanus' hostility towards German philology, which centred on the classical Latin and disparaged later Latinity. For Avellanus, (supposedly ignorant) philology killed Latin by treating it as a corpse. In this case, the use of non-standard (but still Roman) language had a polemical effect: Avellanus saw his own language as something fresh and living, showing that Latin is a perennial language and is not limited by the canon of the most Classical authors. By *deliberately* using unclassical words, Avellanus consciously distanced himself from the academical tradition he scorned; he prided of not limiting himself to the classical period (thus transcending the ignorance of the philologists).

His ecclesiastical background might also be a factor. He had confessed that he had learned his Latin from his monastic years.³⁸⁰ Avellanus was an admirer of the Jesuit Latin fluency, their system of education (*ratio studiorum*)³⁸¹ and of their traditional Latin grammar by Emmanuel

dictionary will provide a lot of useful words for modern use of Latin. Caelestis Eichenseer (1924-2008), the publisher of *Vox Latina*, would agree with this statement completely – he himself had worked in the *Thesaurus Linguae Latinae* project and was fond of supplementing his Latin texts with lexicographical footnotes citing its findings.

378 *Præco Latinus* Nov. 1898 Vol. V No. 2 p. 31: “nobis, seris Latinitatis nepotibus, in hac idearum cœptorumque novorum ætate, oratio pæne nova est creanda, vidl, *technica*. Nisi enim linguam technicam creando pares simus, programma nostrum est absurdum.”; Iun. 1897 Vol. III No. 9 p. 8: “Nisi enim res, nova, utili methodo tractetur, nisi, porro, factis comprobetur res etiam modernas maximeque technicas Latine tractari posse, cuncta conamina ac desideria nostra somnia reputabuntur. <...> Nulla lingua moderna est magis technica aut aptior rebus technicis edisserendis quam Latina.”; Mai. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 8 p. 171: “qui poetica, oratorica aliaque abstracta Latine tractant, sequantur Classicos; qui technica, moderna, popularia arguunt, stylum suum postulatis horum aptent. Illis delectus verborum sit ante oculos, his brevitatis, claritas, rectitudo, ne ambagibus periphrasticis sensum mergant ac perdant.”

379 *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1896 Vol. II No. 7 p. 8: “Alia propemodum innumera quæ fieri debeant supersunt. Huiusmodi est Congressus doctorum Latinus, cuius esset peritos delegare eisque demandare ut vocabularium Latinum *modernum* conderent, utique salvis litteris veterum Rñorum. Opus tanti momenti molisque perficere nemo unus sufficit. Quantum mihi vires suppetunt, partem meam rite expedio. <...> Id quod ego habeo sunt: animus (quamcunque tenuis), voluntas & vita; hæc Musis Latinis paratus immolo.”. See also Lyvens (2019, 153-154).

380 See footnote 346.

381 *Præco Latinus* Mart. Vol. V 1899 No. 6 p. 84: “Nec quisquam negat PPres. S. I. esse Lñitatis peritos; imo hæc ipsa est causa quare iis plus quam aliis confidimus, semperque sperabamus fore, ut ii essent laborum nostrorum

Alvarus SJ (*Manuel Álvarez*, 1526-1582), praising it and reprinting parts of it in his own *Palæstra* textbook.³⁸² Alvarus advised the teachers to make their students to speak Latin even before the grammar has been explained fully – this free approach to Latin is certainly similar to Avellanus.³⁸³

Church Latin is often much more accepting of non-classical forms and Avellanus often used words from the late Antiquity, the age of the Church Fathers. The orthography Avellanus uses consciously avoids the 19th century philological reform of Latin orthography, sticking with the traditional one developed in the Middle ages and the Renaissance and still used by the Church – for example, a letter is *epistola* and not *epistula*; others = *caeteri*, not *ceteri*; sky = *coelum*, not *caelum*; forest = *sylva*, not *silva* – these examples have traditional (often false) etymologies³⁸⁴ based on the analogy to Greek which Avellanus accepts, rejecting both the modern classicised orthography and its philological foundations (the study of ancient manuscripts, the modern linguistic explanations). Church texts are also fond of using the ligatures (*æ*, *æ* = *ae*, *oe*) and some (*Eppus* = *Episcopus*) of the many abbreviations Avellanus consistently uses – every page of *Præco Latinus* has some unusual abbreviations such as *Rñus* = *Romanus*, *Lñus* = *Latinus*, *l. Lña* = *lingua Latina*. However, he also saw the Church Latin as not Roman enough, criticising the influence of the Hebrew language in Christian literature and advocating for a new edition of the Vulgate and of other Church authors.³⁸⁵

propagatores ac fautores omnium maxime strenui. Hoc autem tanto magis, quod ex auditu teneamus suam celebrem “Rationem Studiorum” methodo nostræ apprime congruere. Nec nos fugit et apud alios Sacerdotum Coetus haud paucos inveniri qui Lñe non modo fluenter, sed plane eleganter loquantur.”.

382 Avellanus (1919, 521 ff.). He had a personal experience with Alvarus’ verses for memorising the grammar: “we all have memorized them even in my boyhood, whence I have gained the experience and conviction, that nothing can take their place in aiding to holding fast the general principles of the genders of the nouns, of the exceptions, of the præterita of the verbs, &c., and enriching our vocabulary.”

383 See footnote 176.

384 *Epistola* < ἐπιστολή = letter (etymology is correct, but Latin language modified the word phonetically to *epistula*); *caeterum* < καὶ ἕτερον = and else; *coelum* < κοιλόν = hollow; *sylva* < ὕλη = forest. Avellanus also liked to preserve such distinctions maintained in the Renaissance orthography as between the preposition *cum* and the conjunction *quum* (another Renaissance spelling is *cūm*; both of these are written *cum* today), between *carus* (dear in price) and *charus* (dear in affection; supposedly related to the Greek χαίρω and χάρις).

385 *The imitation of Christ* by Thomas à Kempis got a Roman make-over by Avellanus (a Kempis 1901); *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1900 Vol. VI No. 9 p. 208: “Nostrum erat, ut initio laborum monebamur, curare, ut Latinitatem Hebraïsmis, atque aliis peregrino, præsertim Germanico et Italico dicendi modis obfuscatam detergeremus, atque ad mentem Romanam, pro viribus, et quoad rei natura sineret, restauraremus.”. Regarding the Vulgate “emendation” (one wonders if Avellanus had ever heard of the translation of the whole Bible into Classical Latin by Sebastian Castellio in 1551), he motivated it in this way: Apr. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 7 p. 146: “Quum autem Vulgata versio esset, fere ad verbum, librorum Hebraïcorum, saepe maximo detrimento Latinitatis, quod non raro necessarium non fuit, novi cuiusdam idiomatis, quod Latinitatem Hebraizantem vocamus, auctrix ac magistra facta est. Hoc idioma vicissim, quum per templa, scholas, libros, vivaque voce a Clero in cunctis regnis ac nationibus propagaretur, inde, non autem a Populo Romano pagano, omnes linguae Neo-Latinæ originem traxerunt.”; Feb. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 5 p. 99 has an article called *Recensendane sint Biblia?*: “Prima ac præcipua conditio eiusmodi novaminis recensio textus Latini, editionis Hieronymianæ, *Vulgatæ*, esse ac fieri necessario debet, si hoc non fieret, reliqua conamina omnia parum ad rem facerent. // At licetne textum tam sacrum manibus criticis contingere? Licetne *Biblia* eidem, cui nos *Thomam a Kempis* submisimus, operationi subiicere? Ecquid prohibet? <...> Si Classicos in linguas alias convertas, <...> totum corrumpis: sententiam et argumentum parum curamus aut nihil, linguam curamus. – At, contra, *Biblia* (a) non fuerunt *Hieronymo* revelata, (b) non fuerunt *Latine* revelata; adeoque <*sic*> lingua non refert <...> Perpende, Lector amice, quantum motum, quantumque incrementum rei Lñæ, et pietatis non secus, res ea in

Finally, there are some discernible traces of the Hungarian tradition of Latin; for example, he uses³⁸⁶ the medieval verb *intabulare* (to register in documents; a medieval variant of Cicero's *in tabulas referre*), which in the 19th century is attested almost only in Hungary and even survives today in the neighbouring Romanian language.³⁸⁷ He also mentions that he is sometimes using the Latin words he heard in the streets in his childhood.³⁸⁸

Avellanus' style of Latin is not a negligent approach to language – the search for words appropriate for modern things, judging from the rarity of some of the adopted ones, and the coining of so many other neologisms must have taken a great amount of effort. However, the idiosyncratic attitude of Avellanus – his peculiar taste rejecting the modern advances of scholarship, his deliberately non-Classical language and his neglect of Latin tradition in appropriating or coining vocabulary³⁸⁹ – made his non-standard style a subject of criticism and his legacy problematic, rendering his texts (a minefield of non-Classical, non-standard and unique vocabulary) much less suitable for reading in an educational setting. Nonetheless, the ambition of Avellanus is very much in the spirit of the Living Latin movement, demonstrating the tensions and possibilities inherent in bringing Latin to modern use.

3.4.5 Language teaching initiatives and innovations

3.4.5.1 Language pedagogy and the Greek connection

Avellanus pursued a very similar course of action as to what he had outlined in the 1890 *Phoenix* manifesto. His first main focus was on the language pedagogy. In 1893 Avellanus happened to be in a place very supportive of teaching all languages by the natural method. *Rugby Academy*, a private high school in Philadelphia, was in 1893-1895 headed by William Greenwood (1845-1931),³⁹⁰ a teacher of Greek and Latin who had travelled to Greece and reached the conclusion “that

orbe Christiano concitaret, si prelum Pontificium Biblia *Leonina* sæculi XXmi per fasciculos evulgaret!”. Owens (2014, 11) notes that Avellanus claimed to have “persuaded the Holy See and the pope to retranslate the Bible into intelligible Latin”.

386 Beach (1947, 509): “Probably the source of the Doctor's greatest renown was his *Societas Gentium Latina*, *Intabulata*”. Here *intabulata* means *incorporated*. Cf. the obituary in *New York Times*, 19 June 1935: “His ardent love of Latin led Dr. Avellanus some years ago to form a Latin-speaking club known as the *Societas Gentium Latina*, Inc.”. In other sources this *Inc.* is rendered as *Int.*

387 Romanian *a intabula* “to register a property deed”, *intabulare* “the registration of a property deed”.

388 *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1897 Vol. III No. 7 p. 1: “Thesauri hi in usum vitæ quotidianæ sunt digerendi, h. e., methodo colloquendi in ludis sunt dispergendi, ut nos in Tusculo nostro præstitimus & præstamus, adhibendo etiam interdum vocabula, quæ in pueritia nostra adhuc in compitibus audivissemus.”; Jul. 1900 Vol. VI No. 10 p. 229: “**Decuriones.** <...> In scholis olim, imo et in iuventute nostra, pueri diligentiores hoc nomine vocabantur, <...>. Hos etiam *schedatores* soluimus <sic> appellare.”.

389 Owens (2014, 9); see footnote 415.

390 *Bulletin of Yale University: Obituary record* Vol. XXVIII No. 6 (90) 1931 p. 288

Greek is a living tongue, and that, if it is worth learning at all, as a living tongue it should be learned. Nor should any other rule apply to Latin.”³⁹¹

Here, the Modern Greek is seen as the gateway to the Ancient Greek; this is not an isolated case.³⁹² The literary variant of the language at the time was an increasingly archaising Katharevousa,³⁹³ meaning that it increasingly approached Ancient Greek. John Stuart Blackie (1809-1895), the professor of Greek in Edinburgh University, in his youth had learned Modern Greek conversationally³⁹⁴ and was sure that it was for all purposes not a different language from Attic, making it the easier path to mastering Ancient Greek.³⁹⁵ He promoted this idea throughout his life, even organising scholarships for students to Greece.³⁹⁶ According to him, it is wrong to think that Greek is a dead language, as a casual look into any modern Greek newspaper shows that the living language is virtually identical to the ancient one. He wrote this in the preface of a conversational grammar of Ancient Greek;³⁹⁷ earlier, in a book of quite modern dialogues in Attic he had argued for the conversational method when teaching Latin and Greek.³⁹⁸ So Blackie connected the ideas of the superiority of the conversational language instruction (Blackie already in 1845 named it the Natural method;³⁹⁹ the term *Direct Method* appeared much later) with the idea that at least in the case of Greek one should proceed from the (quasi-ancient) modern language to the ancient one, as they are but different registers of the same language. Therefore, the promotion of conversational methods for teaching (Ancient) Greek had a strong connection with the idea of the identity between Ancient and Modern Greek.

391 See Appendix A.12, part A for the source.

392 E.g., Stedman (1896) is titled “Modern Greek mastery: a short road to Ancient Greek”. Page V: “Modern Greek is [...] simply ancient Greek made easy”. This book was praised by Avellanus in his *Præco Latinus*.

393 Mackridge (2009, 160): “During the period 1833–53 there was a gradual turn of written Modern Greek towards greater archaism, to the extent that it was possible to write in 1857 that ‘the language has progressed so much that even Korais himself has long been out of date’.”; Blackie (1853, 78): “All these scientific and literary works, moreover, whether original or translated, are written in a style of Hellenic elegance and purity, which even the Greeks themselves twenty years ago would have deemed impossible.”

394 Walker (1909, 60-65) is the edition of Blackie’s letters from 1831. P. 65: “I am also striving to accomplish myself as a Greek scholar, and having made acquaintance with a Greek student here, I take instruction from him in Modern Greek, which is hardly in anything different from the Ancient.”

395 Wallace (2006, 186) cites Blackie (1853, 21): “and may learn more available Greek in two days from the discussion of the Turkish question in the *Αθήνα* or other Greek newspaper, than he could have learned from the pages of the harsh Thucydides in a month.”. Blackie (1891, xii) : “The delusion that Greek is a dead language, springing as it does mainly out of our “insular ignorance,” as Professor Seeley calls it, and partly, I fear, our national insolence, will be dispelled in a moment by a glance at any current Greek newspaper; as for instance the following paragraph, the first that met my eye, from the 2d November number of the Athenian “*Ἀκρόπολις*,” giving a short notice of the application of Koch’s remedy for consumption.”

396 Wallace (2006, 185): “ ‘Greek was and is one unbroken living language, and ought to be taught as such,’ became his watchword. He took every opportunity to converse in modern Greek, or Romaic as he often called it, and recommended the same practice to all students.”

397 See footnote 395.

398 Blackie (1871)

399 Appendix A.7 quotes this use and details its context.

This kind of thinking corresponds to what Avellanus later believed – that modern Latin is the same language as classical Latin and that one should teach the whole continuum, proceeding from modern to ancient. It seems that for him the relationship between modern Latin to classical Latin paralleled that between Katharevousa and Attic. Avellanus saw in Blackie a companion in the common struggle.⁴⁰⁰

Greenwood, having met Avellanus and approved his methods of teaching, invited him to teach Latin in the *Rugby Academy*, while for Greek he hired a native Greek John P. Leotsakos (1851-?), who already advocated⁴⁰¹ teaching Ancient Greek as a living language and himself practised this.⁴⁰² Since these three teachers had a common interest in reforming the teaching of ancient languages, they founded a society called *Societas Rugbiana colloquii Latini Graecique* (*The Rugbian Society of Latin and Greek conversation*) and a monthly journal called *Tusculum*,⁴⁰³ in which they published a series of conversational lessons in Latin and Greek.⁴⁰⁴ In 1894 this society, without indicating individual authorship, published the lessons from *Tusculum* in two books:⁴⁰⁵ *Nova Sermonis Latini Palæstra* and Ὁμιλεῖτε Ἑλληνικά; = *Do you speak Greek?*. These two books are in fact substantially the same book, many lessons being the same but expressed in a different language. The Greek taught is peculiar – for example, one immediately sees Ἑλληνικά in the title instead of the classical Ἑλληνιστί (*in Greek*); the modern εἶνε is consistently used instead of the usual classical ἔστιν (*is*), and negated with δέν rather than οὐκ (*not*). So the Greek language here is not exactly Ancient Greek, but some form of Katharevousa; however, the differences from Attic are

400 *Præco Latinus* Oct. 1896 Vol. III No. 1 p. 1: “Quod nos hic orbi proclamamus, sequenti epistola inedita Magni Blackii confirmatur”

401 Leotsakos (1894); Leotsakos (1895). E.g., Leotsakos (1895, 208): “Modern literary Greek is but Attic simplified, and it should, therefore, more properly be called Modern Attic.”

402 *Programme of the Sauveur Summer School of Languages* (…), Vermont, 1891, p. 9: “Prof. J. P. Leotsakos, of the University of Athens (Greece), says: – // “The aim in learning Greek should be to read Greek in Greek, and not in some other tongue. Mere translation is the means to an end, not the end itself; and its function ceases the moment it brings us into contact with the Greek mind; then we become Greeks – in mind. Greek should be taught as a living language; for there is nothing dead about it, though the antiquated methods of teaching it have done much to make it appear so.”

403 *Alaudæ* Aug. 1893, No. 28 p. 294: “Missa sunt haecce: // S. P. Q. R. Tusculum. Periodicum Latino-Graecum, instar enchiridii sermonem Latinum Graecumque viva voce tradendi editum curâ academiae Rugbiana. Coursus I, ser. I, fasc. I. Kal. Apr. 1893. Philadelphiae PA. Typis exscripsit Rugby press. Copyright by societas Rugbiana colloquii Latini Graecique. Fasciculi singuli prostant 10 centesimis. Haec ait libellus. (Libellus 16 paginarum.) Utriusque linguae prima elementa. In prooemio: Friends of classical learning of either sex are welcomed. –”. *The Pittsburgh Press* (*Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania*) 14 May 1893 p. 13: “The headquarters of the Societas is the old and well-known Rugby academy of Philadelphia, among whose instructors its proprietor has secured Professors Mogyorossy and Leotsakos, a Greek, and graduate of the university of Athens.” Avellanus (1919, III): “I started in Philadelphia with an associate of mine at Rugby Academy, in April, 1893, a small periodical, called TVSCVLVM, bringing out seriatim my colloquial Latin primer, the PALÆSTRA,”; *Præco Latinus* Oct. 1895 Vol. II No. 1 p. 7: “Virum Revdum GUILIELMUM GREENWOOD, quondam collegam sociumque in Tusculo I. <sic> efferendo, I. Latinae, imprimis autem Græcæ peritissimum, utpote qui gratia studiorum Athenis quoque moratus fuisset, <…>.”

404 See Appendix A.12, part C for the source.

405 Societas Rugbiana colloquii Latini Graecique (1894a); Societas Rugbiana colloquii Latini Graecique (1894b). The Greek book is also partly available in a recent digital edition with a Russian translation (<https://glossa.info/books/rugbiana/>, consulted 22.8.2023).

noted in footnotes, so the book really does what it claims to do – it does teach both Modern and Ancient Greek at the same time, making the Modern Greek the gate to the Ancient one.⁴⁰⁶

Therefore, the beginning of Avellanus' publishing activity is owed to the perceived equivalence between the Modern and the Ancient Greek⁴⁰⁷ and to the general desire to reform language teaching, as some reformers exploited this equivalence to teach the Ancient Greek through the Modern one.

The Latin-Greek analogy was quite extensive and influential for Avellanus. In his *Præco Latinus* years, Avellanus maintained connections with several Greek newspapers and praised them as his colleagues in advancing the classical cause; *Atlantis*, a Greek newspaper in New York, returned favour and bore an advertisement for *Præco Latinus*. Achilles Rose (1839-1916), a German-born physician in New York and a correspondent of *Præco Latinus*, promoted Greek as the international language and based this claim on the identity of modern and ancient versions of Greek.⁴⁰⁸ Avellanus himself held that Greek should be taught by native speakers and that the modern pronunciation should be used, being convinced that if Greek would be taught as a living language, this parallel would inspire a similar change in the teaching methods of Latin.⁴⁰⁹

3.4.5.2 Modern Latin textbooks

The Rugbian society seems to have been short-lived (I could not find it mentioned after 1894), but Avellanus continued developing the Latin side of it independently until the end of his life. He continued publishing *Tusculum* in his own name and later issued multiple editions of the Latin textbook *Palæstra*,⁴¹⁰ also adding a second volume⁴¹¹ called *Arena Palæstrarum*.

Students in the first year would learn to speak grammatically (through *Palæstra*), in the second year they would learn the vocabulary for naming the (modern) world (the whole of *Arena* describes it) and only then, in the third year, they would progress to reading the Latin authors

406 See Appendix A.12, part B for the source.

407 The Greek language situation was peculiar: the (literary) language was increasingly approaching the ancient one, and, as a consequence, many Greeks desired to overlook the differences and to identify the modern language with the ancient one.

408 Rose (1898, 243) contains a virtually identical observation as the one by Blackie – that opening a modern Greek newspaper would immediately prove the Ancient Greek and the Modern Greek to be the same language.

409 *Præco Latinus* Nov. 1896 Vol. III No. 2 p. 1: “Græcorum victoriam nostra sequatur est necesse. Cathedras Græcas Græci nati consendent. Iuventus studiosa non discet vocabula typis expressa oculis nonnisi agnoscere, sed et auribus capere & labiis exercitatissimis volvere. Versiones oblitterabuntur, vocabularia non amplius terentur, sed conceptus mentis sentiis Græcis, velut lingua vernacula, edisserentur. Nec octennio erit opus ut studiosi scamna ludorum premant; quadriennium satis superque erit ut iuventus non modo theses Graece scribat, verum etiam ut linguam vernaculam saltem e classibus Græcis penitus eliminat. Sed si in classibus Græcis hæc taliaque gerantur, num classes Latinæ secus agere poterunt?”.

410 Avellanus (1896) is the second edition, while Avellanus (1919) seems to be the third.

411 Avellanus (1900) is the second edition.

(Avellanus intended to name this reader *Medulla*). The intended final part of his personal *Tusculan curriculum* – annotated classical authors in style of *Ad usum Delphini* with a Latin paraphrase and commentary – never arrived in a book form, but in *Præco Latinus* selections of Cicero, Caesar, Virgil appeared.⁴¹² Avellanus also published⁴¹³ the *Colloquia* of Maturinus Corderius (1479-1564) and his own reader⁴¹⁴ of short Latin stories. It is unclear how widely the curriculum was adopted, even if some schools using it are mentioned in Avellanus' writings.

This textbook series was probably the first Latin curriculum with a clear objective of teaching modern usage in the foreground, which was the starting point: students would first learn to talk about abstract forms drawn on blackboard (lines, circles, points), then they would describe in Latin various topics, e.g., the classroom, parts of the house, various modern buildings (*fabrica* – a factory), they would learn the numerals and arithmetic by counting dollars⁴¹⁵ – all this without any recourse to the Roman culture, which was presumably taught separately. This quotidian content and the conversational methods employed⁴¹⁶ put Avellanus' textbook firmly in some part of the family of the New methods (*Direct*, *Natural*, etc.) for teaching the modern languages; Avellanus had spent time in the circles of conversational language teaching (e.g., in the *Rugby academy*) and developed his own methods. Meanwhile the unemphasised Antiquity and the focus on the modernity, the fascination with giving a Latin designation for every modern trifle – further emphasised by *Arena*, the second part of the curriculum, a story about the life of a modern and Latin-speaking American family – place Avellanus' textbooks in the radical part of the Living Latin territory. For Avellanus, the living *use* of Latin is the gate to the whole of Latin itself.

412 They were published in *Præco Latinus* during the last year of its existence (Jun. 1901 Vol. VII No. 9 – Sept. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 12) and took up 184 pages. These editions included the standard works by Caesar (*De bello Gallico*, up to book I chapter 55.3), Virgil (*Aeneis*, up to book II verse 86), Cicero (*In Catilinam*, up to oration II chapter 6.10).

413 Avellanus and Corderius (1904). These *colloquia* were published in *Præco Latinus* from 1900 July to the end of the periodical in 1902 September.

414 *Fabulae Tusculanae* were first published in a serial manner since 1913; the first issue contains 20 pages. In 1928 the second edition was published in form of an 80-page book (Avellanus 1928), so probably four fascicles were published in the first serial edition. The stories are supplemented with a Latin commentary, vocabulary and text comprehension questions.

415 A *dollar* in Avellanus' writings is *centussis*, originally a Roman word meaning 100 *asses*. Avellanus applied this antique lexicographical rarity to the modern money instead of using *thalerus*, an etymological cognate of *dollar* used in the Neo-Latin tradition. A *cent* for Avellanus is *libella* – a quite rare (but classically attested) Roman word, an equivalent for an *as*. Owens (2014, 9) makes an apt observation: “he freely appropriated vocabulary and coined words whenever he didn't have a term immediately at hand and did so without regard to ancient or Neo-Latin tradition.”

416 Avellanus describes them in the preface of *Palæstra* (Avellanus 1919). The teacher should deliver the main part of the lesson from memory on blackboard and the students should listen and engage with their books closed. This focus on the oral aspect and on the directness is characteristic to the Direct method and its cognates.

3.4.5.3 Phonograph records

The end of the 19th century saw another important invention. In 1877 Thomas A. Edison invented a device called a *phonograph* that could record and play back sound. It initially used tinfoil wrapped around a cylinder as the record medium, but the foil was brittle and produced low-quality sound; however, in 1888-1889 the cylinders were refashioned to a solid wax design and this new durability of the medium enabled a record industry to take off immediately.

Already in 1878 Edison imagined that his device could be used for recording *phonographic books* (that are vital for the blind and valuable for everyone) and as an educational aid containing pre-recorded (e.g., elocution) lessons.⁴¹⁷ Avellanus also saw in these technical possibilities a great boon for Latin⁴¹⁸ and wanted to provide a competitive edge to his Latin teaching materials. In 1901 he decided⁴¹⁹ to be the first one to publish Latin voice records that would go together with his textbooks and classical text editions, and so he managed to sign a contract with the *Columbia Phonograph Company* (today's *Columbia Records*). The wax cylinder record technology at the time allowed⁴²⁰ one to publish about 2-3 minutes of music or 5 minutes of voice in one cylinder, so while too cumbersome for actual "audiobooks", the technology was sufficient for recording short fragments like textbook exercises. The first language instruction records appeared in 1889⁴²¹ and already in 1891 the same *Columbia Phonograph Company* published language instruction cylinder records for several languages,⁴²² but it was not a widespread product, few⁴²³ other publishers would compete. So a Latin textbook with all of its lessons recorded and distributed together with the book

417 Edison (1878, 533-534). Edison was way too optimistic about the recordings – he pointed to a “strong probability” of “a book of 40,000 words upon a single metal plate ten inches square” that became a reality only recently, in the digital era. His random guess of 10 in² even approximates the area of the platter in a standard 3.5" hard disk drive! The first recordings of unabridged novels appeared only in the 1930s after a slowly rotating disc containing ~20 minutes was developed in 1932 (Rubery (2011, 3-6); Hoffmann (2005, 626)), but even then *Les Misérables* (admittedly a huge novel, a usual one would be five times shorter) took up 104 (!) double-faced discs (Camlot 2011, 25).

418 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1901 Vol. VII No. 9 p. 217: “In hunc modum enitemur, ut l. Latina modo mortua, nostro interventu in vitam resuscitetur, ut studiosorum aures et labia patescant, quo fieri speramus ut studium l. Latinæ novo impetu concitetur, et ut idem quod hactenus cum tædio et nausea insequerentur, præceptores et studiosi cum gaudio et voluptate tractent, PRÆCONEM autem, ut amicum et ducem vivum in scholis adoptent.”; *Præco Latinus* Mai. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 8 p. 176 “Minime dubitamus quin tam machinæ locutrices, quam enuntiatio Romana amicos plurimos concilient, quum sic factis ostendatur quanto plus valeat sermo vivus quam litteræ mortuæ, enuntiatio Romana, quam quælibet barbara.”; *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1901 Vol. VII No. 10 p. 228: “Sunt præceptores plurimi, qui phonographiam Latinam, tamquam Cæsarem, Virgilium atque Tullium ipsos redivivos, sibi in schola secundantes, cum pleno cordis gaudio salutabunt.”.

419 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1901 Vol. VII No. 9 p. 217: “unum igitur et unicum nobis patere potest iter: aliquid præter dubium **utilius**, **melius**, et omnino **insolitum** offerendi, ut <...> id quod nos <...> offerimus, practica utilitate ac bonitate cunctas methodos, omnia tentamina *superet*, *excedat* et *antecellat*. – Hoc autem nos assecutos esse arbitramur molimine prorsus novo: **phonographiam** in auxilium invocando.”

420 Shambarger (1995, 135; 137); Hoffmann (2005, 260).

421 Hoffmann (2005, 237; 595): “The firm was the first to record language instruction courses, beginning in 1889 with Spanish in Twenty Lessons, on Edison cylinders. <...> The earliest recorded language instruction is credited to Cortina Academy of Languages, which issued Spanish lessons on Edison cylinders in 1889. As early as April 1891 *Phonogram* carried notices of language cylinders available at \$30 from Columbia, 24 records in each set, for French, German, Italian, or Spanish.”.

would have been the first endeavour of this kind – that is how Avellanus imagined his *Palæstra*. The project did not proceed to its full extent, but a number of cylinders indeed *were* recorded⁴²⁴ by Avellanus, bought by his subscribers,⁴²⁵ and at least five of them, all by classical authors, sold⁴²⁶ by *Columbia* in 1902.

It is unclear if Avellanus' attempt was consequential and if the recordings made any wider impact; the fate of his cylinder recordings is unknown. However, Avellanus' vision is instructive – it shows how eager the Living Latin movement was to use new technological possibilities and extend Latin to new media, which was wholly consistent with the emphasis of the movement on the spoken word. He was, with hardly any doubt, the first Living Latin activist to venture into the field of audio recordings.⁴²⁷

3.4.5.4 Translations of modern fiction

In his later years, Avellanus found a wealthy patron – Ezra Parmalee Prentice, the husband of Alta Rockefeller, daughter of John D. Rockefeller, the *Standard Oil Company* magnate and the richest man of the time. In 1909 he was⁴²⁸ already teaching Prentice's children Latin and soon it was reported that they “speak fluent Latin”.⁴²⁹ Interestingly, it seems that the children of John D.

422 Brooks (1978, 11): “Another recording activity which Columbia pioneered in early 1891 was language instruction. [...] Columbia offered instruction in French, German, Spanish and Italian, recorded on 24 cylinders for each language. Price of books and cylinders for a single language was \$25, which included the right to correspond with Dr. Rosenthal *<the author of these courses>* and correction of exercises.”. So this set of 24 cylinders might have included up to 100 minutes of recorded material, quite similar to the today's audio CDs included in language learning textbooks.

423 Cf. Kitao (1984), Hoffmann (2005, 595)

424 *Præco Latinus* Nov. 1901 Vol. VIII No. 2 p. 41 provides a catalogue of what Avellanus already recorded – 33 or 37 (if four extra verses are inserted) verses from Virgil's *Aeneis*, first chapter with 3 extra sentences from *De bello Gallico*, 3 chapters and 5 sentences from Cicero's *In Catillinam*, two pages from his own *Palæstra*, a chapter from Thomas à Kempis *De imitatione Christi*.

425 *Præco Latinus* Ian. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 4 p. 89 lists eleven people who bought his recordings,

426 An undated cover of *Præco Latinus* provided by Owens (2014) contains an advertisement stating that “Nunc demum in usum Scholarum ad recitandos textus Classicorum Latinorum mancipata, **Recitabula** nostra recitabunt textus **C. I. Caesaris, P. Virgilli Maronis et M. T. Ciceronis**, [...] elegias **P. Ovidii Nasonis**, odasque **Quinti Horatii Flacci** [...] We alone furnish the Latin records of the texts of **Cæsar, Virgil, Cicero** and other Classics, as published in **PRÆCO**. Our Latin Graphophones make Latin a **living speech**, therefore, they are of **incalculable benefit to schools and scholars**, as well as a novel source of pleasure for College Clubs, fraternities, literary people, and classically cultured families the world over. **COLUMBIA PHONOGRAPH CO.**”. *Præco Latinus* Mai. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 8 p. 176 mentions someone who bought all five authors mentioned in the advertisement.

427 His successor was W.H.D. Rouse, who had his Latin and Greek lessons, demonstrating his Direct Method, recorded by the Linguaphone Institute and published in 1932 both as recordings and books of commented transcriptions. See Stray (1992, 56-59); the Latin recordings of ten short lessons are available online (e.g., https://archive.org/details/78_latin-lesson-2_dr-w-h-d-rouse-and-boys-of-the-perse-school-cambridge_gbia0072066).

428 It was already reported in newspapers in 1909 (*The News-Herald* (Morganton, North Carolina) 23 Dec. 1909 p. 4) that Avellanus was teaching Rockefeller's daughter and grandson Latin. See also Owens (2014, 8): “Avellanus departs Pennsylvania to move-in with the Prentice-Rockefeller family where he lives for months at a time as the general tutor to the children.”

429 Owens (2014, 3) reports, based on Chickering (1910): “At the close of the meeting Dr Avellanus told of his experience in teaching a boy of seven and another of ten, so that they spoke Latin easily: the elder of these boys

Rockefeller (most probably including Alta) had been taught Ancient Greek as a living language,⁴³⁰ so hiring Avellanus with his similar approach to Latin perpetuated this family tradition for another generation.

With Prentice's funding, Avellanus embarked on an ambitious programme to translate a number of modern books of fiction that would attract children to Latin.⁴³¹ His translations were published⁴³² by Prentice in 1914-1928. This seven-volume series, including such books as Robert Louis Stevenson's *Treasure Island* in Latin, is today the best-known Latin legacy of Avellanus. He was the first one to embark on such a project on this scale.⁴³³

The last work published in this series in 1928, Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*, continues the long tradition (since 1785!) of translations into Latin of this work and its derivatives as engaging reading material for students. However, Avellanus used Defoe only for the beginning of the book – as indicated by the title, he rewrote the whole story after Crusoe's arrival to the uninhabited island. Therefore, this whole two-volume novel of almost 700 pages can be seen as Avellanus' literary début.⁴³⁴

Aside from the great mass of technical accounts describing the activities on the island (full of technical terms in the peculiar Avellanian Latin), one of the threads introduced in his narrative is an autodidactic Latin utopia. His Robinson finds in the shipwreck a great stash of books – including three Bibles (English, Portuguese, Latin), Latin dictionaries and grammars, a set of Latin classics, and, finally, Latin editions of then the most recent philosophical works by Descartes and Spinoza. After a while, he starts to teach himself Latin by comparing editions of the Bible, thus he learns to

took a passage from Livy, selected for him by a stranger as most difficult, and on hearing it read aloud once by Dr Avellanus gave immediately an accurate paraphrase in Latin.”. This Latin fluency of John Rockefeller Prentice was reported in newspapers through the summer of 1910.

430 Telemachus Thomas Timayenis, who used to teach Ancient Greek as a living language (see page 105 and appendix A.14.4), was a tutor of the Rockefeller family. Seligman (2020): “His linguistic talents afforded him the opportunity to rub elbows with New York's rich and famous. He taught Greek and Latin to the children of Charles Scribner and Jay Gould, among other luminaries, and, for a half dozen years during the 1880s, the children, wife and sister-in-law of John D. Rockefeller.”

431 Avellanus (1916, 38): “How then shall students learn the language? If that be really the question, there is but one answer. Languages are learned by use – by much reading, much writing, if possible by hearing and speaking. And since modern stories interest modern youth I have tried to provide Latin reading which will invite the attention of the young.”

432 The *Mount Hope Classics* volumes: I *Pericla Navarchi Magonis sive Expeditio Phœnicia annis ante Christum mille. Opus Franciscæ scripsit Leo Cahun* (1914), III *(sic!) Mysterium arcae Boulé. Opus Anglice scripsit Burton E. Stevenson* (1916), II *(sic!) Mons Spes, et novellae aliae ex Anglica narratione variorum auctorum* (1918), IV *Fabulae Divales. Ex narratione Anglica heræ Heriberti Strang* (1918), V *Insula Thesauraria ab auctore Roberto Ludovico Stevenson* (1922) VI *Robinson Crusæus* (2 vols.) (Avellanus, Cahun and Frewer (1914), Avellanus and Stevenson (1916), Avellanus (1918), Avellanus, Strang and Apuleius (1918), Avellanus and Stevenson (1922), Avellanus and De Foe (1928a), Avellanus and De Foe (1928b)). Other translations published: Avellanus, Goffaux and Defoe (1896) – Avellanus' edition of Goffaux's Latin translation of Kampe's (not Defoe's!) book (see appendix A.1); Avellanus and Ruskin (1914) – a short story by Ruskin later included in the *Mons Spes* volume of the series. See Platzdasch (2009) and Kobler (1966) for more detailed bibliographical information.

433 See appendix A.1 for the broader tradition of translating children's books to Latin.

434 The first volume contains 57 pages of preface, 304 pages of the novel; the second one has 379 pages.

read this Latin fluently, then continues to Cicero's philosophical works and finds the greatest wisdom there.⁴³⁵ After that, he continues to explore the Roman poets (Virgil, Ovid) and playwrights (Plautus), continuing to Descartes and Spinoza and then returning to the Bible again. So Robinson, initially an uneducated sailor, completes a perfect curriculum and becomes a mature and cultured man; this culture and humanity radiates from him. After an encounter with Caribbean natives (seen as barbarians and cannibals), he takes them in as guests and civilises them (in this narrative they are enthusiastic recipients, a clean slate for the European culture). Their leader, later named Leo by Robinson, already knew some Portuguese; Robinson teaches Portuguese to the whole group using Aesop's fables (!). The leader Leo wanted to know more – so Robinson taught him Latin colloquially (no doubt Avellanus had his own *Palæstra* methods in mind), introduced him to the Latin and Portuguese Bibles and so finally had a Latin-speaking companion in the island with whom he can speak all of his mind and “open up things for him that [Robinson] believed should kept from those with no Latin”.⁴³⁶ Finally, after the coming of some more European stowaways (some of whom are judged far inferior to the civilised model citizens the Caribs have become), they decide to stay in the island and to create an official colony with Robinson as the governor. Robinson goes to Europe accompanied by his well-cultured Caribs and comes back with an official recognition of the self-governed colony, with equipment and volunteers to build a new town. It will have a printing press.

The story of Robinson Crusoe demonstrates Avellanus' beliefs. Latin is the gate to the real culture transforming Robinson. The new civilised society created from Caribs has a certain pattern – it has a Portuguese-speaking lower class and a Latin-speaking higher class speaking about sensitive topics. Avellanus does not want to impart his new society with a full-fledged Christian doctrine, for him a simple monotheist theology of a just God Creator, as understood by the ancient philosophers, suffices and Latin is a safeguard that the *vulgus indoctum* would not engage in the *odia theologica* – only Leo is allowed to touch the language, presumably judged mature enough to touch these topics.⁴³⁷ This idea is certainly not new, Latin has been seen through centuries as a

435 Avellanus and De Foe (1928b, 91-92): “Fatone factum est et casu fortuito, ut mihi iuveni nautæ ignaro et inscio, moribus haud commendabili, non modò vita, domicilium, victus et res prosperæ concedantur, dum sodales intereunt, sed etiam instinctus Latinè discendi, et opera Ciceronis subministrantur, ut ex iis illud ipsum discam, contra quod et semper peccare solerem et peccaturus essem, nempe lumen gloriosissimum vitæ humanæ, Philosophiam morum! <...> Habeo autem agoque Diis immortalibus grates, quòd me in hanc solitudinem detruserunt, ut animum meum ad disciplinam Philosophiæ converterent, et ad vitam beatam per solitudinem me educavissent.”. These sublime thoughts were kindled after reading Cicero's *De finibus bonorum et malorum*.

436 Avellanus and De Foe (1928b, 248): “Docui eum [Latine] eodem simplici et efficaci modo, perinde atque eodem effectui. Tum ei tradidi Biblia Latina atque Lusitanica, et eandem quam ego sum semitam secutus, longè celerius quam ego potueram, Latinitate potitus est magno meo commodo, quoniam nunc licebat cum eo Latine colloqui, ac res ei patefacere, quas Latinitatis ignaris reticendum existimabam.”

437 Avellanus and De Foe (1928b, 247-248): “Sæpius evenit ut unus vel alter me appellaret quum quædam nomina, verba aut allusiones in his libellis essent, quæ notissima essent Christianis, aut Iudæis, his autem peregrinis nequaquam. Ea interpretanda non arbitrabar, nolebam enim sinceram et innocentes horum virorum mentes odiis

society-stabilising force excluding most of it from the learned controversies. The Robinson of Avellanus is constructing a paradise and Latin protects the harmony from collapsing due to the poison of learned controversies permeating the society.

The central place of philosophy shows the transformative power of classical culture, which is a humanist belief. Avellanus, an *ex*-priest, might himself have been more of a Ciceronian than a Christian – *Ciceronianus es, non Christianus*, as St. Jerome was accused in the famous vision he had in a dream.⁴³⁸ Avellanus strips Defoe's tale from most of its violence⁴³⁹ and of its Christian content, replacing religious experience with a humanist revival, making Robinson an autodidact humanist just like himself.

3.4.5.5 Summer schools

The end of the 19th century, beginning in the 1870s, saw the *Chautauqua* and the university extension movements aiming to make education more accessible for adults outside the formal educational system. As the result of technological progress (e.g., railways), it was now quite practical to gather in a resort during summer months for an educational experience, the prime example being the gatherings since 1874 by the Chautauqua lake in the New York state. Summer schools rapidly proliferated.

Language teaching was one of the first fields to participate in this. In 1876 Lambert Sauveur (1826-1911),⁴⁴⁰ an immigrant from France and a reformer of language education, commenced the series of *Summer College of Languages* dedicated to teaching languages according to the *Natural method*. Sauveur was certain that this method could be applied to teaching not only modern, but also the ancient languages, and himself developed a way to teach Latin conversationally by starting with Caesar from day one, often questioning the audience in Latin for text comprehension.⁴⁴¹

theologicis imbuere, ac præiudiciis inquinare. Perspectum enim habebam eos Deum credere, huius mundi Creatorem, Patrem generis humani, Iudicem et Vindicem virtutum et scelerum; sapientissimi Græcorum atque Romanorum his notionibus contenti erant, sic et ego. Si hæc ingenio humano demonstrari queunt, ut mihi quidem Cicero satis demonstrare videbatur, non arbitrabar expedire hanc simplicem fidem atque theologiam naturalem, ut inductis aliorum placitis labefactem, atque hos incorruptos iuvenes in nostra devia seducam.”

438 Beach (1947, 506) sees Avellanus' beliefs in the Robinson quote. The inclusion of Descartes and Spinoza might also hint at his non-canonical beliefs.

439 For example, in the original tale by De Foe the invading Caribs are slaughtered in battle.

440 See appendix A.14.1

441 See appendix A.14.3

Already in 1877 Sauveur was teaching Latin through his method;⁴⁴² in 1878 Greek,⁴⁴³ Hebrew and Sanskrit (!) were added to the *Summer College* to be taught the same way. In 1880, Leotsakos, the future colleague of Avellanus, endeavoured to demonstrate in this summer school that Ancient Greek could be taught just like French;⁴⁴⁴ he probably was quite successful, as he continued to teach there for about twenty years.⁴⁴⁵ Thus, in this series of summer schools both Latin and Greek were taught conversationally, but they were not the only languages taught and it was not a dedicated immersive environment.

Avellanus was acquainted with the summer school tradition and participated in it – at least in 1893, while teaching in the *Rugby Academy*, he taught Latin in the summer courses of colloquial Latin and Greek organised by Principal Greenwood.⁴⁴⁶ During the time when Avellanus was publishing his Latin periodical *Præco Latinus*, he wished to teach summer schools of his own and tried to organise them, but it seems that he never managed to do this;⁴⁴⁷ however, later he did teach intensive courses when invited.⁴⁴⁸ He imagined that summer courses could become an instrument to convert Latin teachers to Living Latin methods,⁴⁴⁹ precisely what W.H.D. Rouse did later (since 1911) by organising summer schools for teachers in order to promote the Direct Method applied to Latin and Greek.⁴⁵⁰

442 This information is provided in the testimonies contained in the 1878 programme. In 1882 Edgar Solomon Shumway, the publisher of a Latin periodical *Latine*, taught there, see footnote 349. He is present as a contact person of Sauveur's school already in 1879, when still a student in Amherst College: it is probable that his teaching methods were inspired directly by Sauveur. Considering this, we can infer that the journal *Latine* owes its existence to Sauveur's *Natural method* (and in fact the focus on text comprehension questions in the early volumes of *Latine* does have a very Sauveurian flavour). He also taught in the *Chautauqua School of Languages* in 1884; the announcement describes his methods (Chautauquan 1884, 105).

443 See appendix A.14.4

444 *Amherst College. Summer School of Languages under the direction of L. Sauveur* {...}, Concinatti: Robert Clarke & Co., 1880: "Prof. J. P. Leotsakos, a graduate of the University of Athens, and an enthusiastic scholar of his language, maintains that the Greek is a living tongue, as much as the English or the French, and begs to demonstrate it by teaching Plato, Xenophon, and Homer, at the Normal School, in the same way that he will teach my "Petites Causeries" in his course of modern Greek." The *Petites Causeries* referenced is Sauveur (1875), a book of French conversations.

445 He is present in the 1898 programme of the *Sauveur Summer School of Languages*, the last one accessible on the Internet.

446 These summer schools were organised in 1893 and 1894. In July 1893 Avellanus and Greenwood were both present (*Asbury Park Press* 7 Jul. 1893 p. 8 announces their arrival) in Asbury Park (New Jersey). *Asbury Park Morning Press* 7 Jul. 1893 p. 1: "Rev. William Greenwood, M. A., the proprietor of the famous Rugby Academy of Philadelphia, is a guest at "The Oaks". Prof. Greenwood, with his assistants, will, while in the Park, teach Latin and Greek colloquially to all interested in those languages." In 1894 a summer school was advertised, but there's no further information (*Germania: a monthly magazine* Jun., Jul., Aug. 1894).

447 According to *Præco Latinus*, attempts were made in 1895-1897 and failed mostly in the invitation stage, 1898 is unclear (this volume of *Præco Latinus* was not accessible), while no attempts were made in 1899-1902.

448 Avellanus in 1904 taught Latin for seven weeks with good results to a convent of Dominican Sisters (Avellanus and Corderius 1904, 1-2).

449 *Præco Latinus* Ian. 1899 Vol. V No. 4 p. 49-50: "Mgtri Lñe loquendo impares schola æstiva gratis possent institui".

450 Stray (1992, 44-45): "The first 'School of Latin' was held at Bangor from 28th August to 11th September [1911]. {...} The School appears to have been a great success. Over a hundred teachers attended: 'the very first time', as the *Times* report commented, 'on which the teachers who agreed with [Rouse and his followers] had been concentrated in one centre for a common purpose.' The school included demonstration lessons with pupils from local schools, reading groups, lectures on phonetics and conversation practice in Latin and Greek. {...} [E.V.] Arnold wrote short

So already in the end of the 19th century Latin was taught conversationally in summer schools. Avellanus was one of the early adopters of this format and can be regarded as one of the pioneers of this tradition. But this period did not focus on this educational possibility as much as the Living Latin movement has done since the 1970s – the exploration of possibilities inherent in the summer school format was still in the future.

3.4.6 Greater universalities: artificial languages, pacifism, international organisations for Latin

3.4.6.1 Artificial languages

Artificial languages, being a prominent part of the intellectual landscape of the time, form a certain background to Avellanus' Living Latin efforts. His first public proclamation in 1890 was in *Phœnix*, a periodical founded as part of the international language question efforts. The Living Latin Avellanus strived for was a middle way between the simplifications of Latin seen in the international language projects and the academic cultivation of Latin restricted by the Classical standard.⁴⁵¹

Avellanus was aware that his project had certain similarities with the artificial language movements. There was a period when he had a rather nuanced view of the situation. In 1895-1896, he was happy that the international language question had a resonance in the society and that the discussions abounded⁴⁵² – even though the artificial languages proposed were inane and ridiculous, the authors of them were good people and the spirit of these works deserved praise, as they endeavoured to solve the urgent problem of a modern Babel:

“Honest and prudent men have worked on creating new languages in order to avoid national envy and political prejudice. This is how *Volapük*, *Lingua Franca*, *Lingua* and other vain creations were born, which we believe should be judged not by their resulting form (*ex opere*), but by their intention (*ex animo*). Even if it is clear that these are groundless and unfounded endeavours, their intention is not to be despised. People from all nations in their hundreds and thousands devoted themselves,

Latin plays which were performed by the participants;”

451 *Præco Latinus* Dec. 1898 Vol. V No. 3 p. 48: “Nisi Latinitas nostra *litteraria*, *h.e.*, quodammodo *ornatior* esset, elegantiae Classicae fautores conciliare haud possemus. Extrema nobis non arident. Nec rustici cupimus esse, nec “Nov Latin” creare gestimus, neque coram Tullianismi idolo nos prosternere libet.”

452 *Præco Latinus* Nov. 1895 Vol. II No. 2 p. 1: “ast æqua certitudine constat desiderium, imo necessitatem apud omnes gentes agnitam, vigere, ut lingua quædam proponatur, aut fiat, qua periti omnium gentium uti conversarique possint. Hinc variae “linguæ”, veluti “Volapük”, a somniatoribus concoctæ & consutæ.”; Sept. 1896 Vol. II No. 12 p. 8: “Germania reapse fervet motibus tam classicis quam quaestionibus circa linguam gentium universam. Ut dimicent! Vale!”

sparing no effort nor expense, to the honest proposal of learning whatever language that would finally be capable of uniting the learned of the world.”⁴⁵³

In this view, the supporters of the artificial languages can be seen as potential allies that only need to be persuaded that the genuine Latin language would solve the problem they are worrying about.⁴⁵⁴ Right now, they have a peculiar relationship with Latin: they are convinced that it is the Latin language that contains the building blocks of the proper international language (the Latin-derived words have the greatest internationality), but they do not want to keep the (complicated) structure of the language.⁴⁵⁵ As Avellanus had hopes that Latin could prevail in these discussions, he even subscribed to *Linguist*, a journal published in Hamburg in 1896-1897⁴⁵⁶, that acted as a forum aimed to hasten an agreement on the solution; he praised the neutrality of the journal and was content that Latin also was represented in the discussion.⁴⁵⁷

The internationalist journal *L'Étranger* (1894-1899) / *Concordia* (1899-1903) by Émile Lombard (1852-1903),⁴⁵⁸ a Warsaw-born and Leipzig-educated Parisian lycée teacher of German, strived to create an international correspondence network – anyone could submit his or her name, notes, interests, post address and languages spoken to the journal and these data would be published in a public catalogue, which by 1901 contained about 1000 members.⁴⁵⁹ *Præco Latinus* contains many echoes of it – Avellanus read the journal at least since 1896, corresponded with and praised Lombard for his internationalist outlook and his support for Latin.

453 *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1896 Vol. II No. 10 p. 1: “Quorum interest, obsecramus, ut Babel modernum in perpetuum vigeat? Iam erant suntque viri candidi & cordati, qui, ut zelum gentium studiaque politica devitarent, operam in creandis novis linguis contulerunt. Sic enata sunt Volapük, Lingua Franca, Lingua, aliaque figmenta vana, quæ quidem nos non ex opere sed ex animo æstimanda arbitramur. Vana licet infundataque <sic> studia hæc esse constet, non tamen animus contemnendus. Centeni enim & milleni omnium gentium proposito honesto incubuerunt, ut quæcumque demum ea lingua sit quæ peritos gentium in unum compingat, spreto labore & sumptibus, eam addiscant.”

454 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1896 Vol. II No. 9 p. 8: ““Linguarii” atque volapükiani quodammodo auxiliares & fœderati sunt nostri, quos ad partes nostras ciere iuvabit. Quum viderint quemadmodum nos l. Lñam tractemus, quamque sit perceptu facilis usuique apta certa pro incertis non periclitabunt. <sic>”.

455 See footnote 325.

456 Editor of the journal *Linguist*. *Unabhängige Zeitung für alle Freunde der Weltspracheidee* was Max Wahren (-1899); journal described in Couturat and Leau (1903, 468-476).

457 *Præco Latinus* Dec. 1896 Vol. III No. 3 p. 6 contains a review of the journal. After reviewing the new language proposals Avellanus notes the defence of Latin and the neutrality of the journal: “His deliramentis supinis A. Koenig quidam Berolinensis *Latine* sat apte reponit, licet passim obscuriuscule. <sic> <...> // Cæterum “Linguist” sese nulli sophismati addicit, sed res tractat ad libitum scriptorum. Lingua quidem gentium universa ab omnibus qui sapienti exoptatur, sed ea esse debet *lingua*, non somnium aut figmentum amile. <sic> L. Lñam est universa, decreto nullo eget, nec quidquam nisi methodus eam tractandi est mutanda. Cæterum “Linguist” congratulamur.”; later (Mart. 1897 Vol. III No. 6 p. 2) he is indignant that in *Linguist* Latin is judged too difficult to become the international language.

458 His life is described by Jacques Tasset in *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1901 Vol. VII No. 10 p. 225-226; see also *Enciklopedio de Esperanto* (Širjaev et al. 1933, s.v. Lombard) and Védrine (2007, 19-21).

459 *Concordia* Jan. 1901 Ann. 7 No. 74 p. 57 shows that about 143 of them indicated Latin as one of their languages.

This connection is primarily owed to Jacques Tasset (*Jacobus Tassetius*, 1868-1945),⁴⁶⁰ a French Oriental scholar and an active contributor to both *Præco Latinus* and *Concordia*, where he incessantly argued for (Living)⁴⁶¹ Latin as the international language. After a three year journey (1894-1896) around the world – studying in Korea and Japan and returning to France through America – he turned to Latin, contributing to *Præco Latinus* at least since 1898. After personally presenting his idea to the sympathetic Lombard, in November 1898 he entered *L'Étranger* with a manifesto for Latin:⁴⁶² the need for an international language is clear, but the proposed languages are artificial and devoid of life, one can only translate into them and use them for practical purposes, but they cannot be used for living thought; Latin is already taught, it only has to be used as the international language; wherever the cultivation of Latin recedes, barbarity proceeds; now is the time when a new kind of Latin is arising – the Latin of today – heralded by *Præco Latinus*. Latin should be practised in speech and writing, used internationally and the governments lobbied to make Latin the official international language.

This text started in the pages of *Concordia* a long (1898-1901) confrontation between the proponents of Latin and artificial languages: Latin chiefly represented by Tasset (other supporters include Woldemar Lommatzsch, the future editor of the Latin journal *Civis Romanus / Scriptor Latinus*)⁴⁶³ and Esperanto represented principally by Louis de Beaufront, the leader of the French Esperantist movement. Lombard favoured both sides, enquiring⁴⁶⁴ of his colleagues if they prefer Latin or Esperanto and bearing⁴⁶⁵ an advertisement of *Præco Latinus*.

460 See Appendix A.4 for a biography of Tasset.

461 Tasset even uses the term *latin vivant* once! *Concordia* May 1899 Ann. 5 No. 6 p. 233: “Par le latin vivant rendre l’éducation internationale, et rapprocher l’école populaire de l’enseignement classique.”

462 *L'Étranger* Nov. 1898 Ann. 4 No. 12 pp. 381-382: “**Aperta Epistola** // *De Usu Latini Sermonis Evulgando*, D^r ÆMILIO LOMBARDO, *suus quondam discipulus* JACOBUS TASSETUS, *salutem precatur*. // Post multos annos, post itinera et labores medium jam appropinquantis vitæ, quum vidi te, Magister, iterum, intentum ingenti operi, paucos ante dies, per breves minutas, patefeci curatum sedulo a me inceptum, scilicet: *restaurandi sermonis latini pro commodo eorum qui lingua inter se differunt*. Tum motus gratia tua, rem amplius tibi et tuis, si placeat, multarum gentium sociis describere animadverti. // <...> Advenit *finis sæculi*, ultima tempora modernæ ætatis, veterum resurrectio : Latinorum hibernationis finis. Somno exagitat nos clamitans ab <sic> Philadelphia *Præco*. // <...> Tertia hodierna, præteritarum firma ambarum stirpe defixa, nunc in cunabulis, ut scis, americanis edit per mensem crescentes vagitus. <...> Qui fit motu proprio civis romanus, is ipso facto orbis jus civitatis nanciscitur. // Itaque rogo te, Magister, per tuam benevolentiam ut *Extranei* paginis studiosos humanitatis, orbicolas, nusquam peregrinos moneamus et adhortemur. // 1^o Matris deficiente, sermone utantur Almæ Parentis ; 2^o Eum foveant epistolis, colloquiis, orationibus, carminibus, aliisque scriptis, vel dictis, vel cantibus ; 3^o Suos poscant magistratus et reges : LINGUAM GENTIUM LATINAM DECERNI.”. Tasset’s abstract and metaphorical way of speaking behoves a Theosophist; the “two Latins” are the Classical and Christian one, and the Latin of today, the third Latin, is founded on both of them.

463 See footnote 249. He was an active member of the society, having entered it in February 1898 – so in December 1900 he is listed as the “président de notre Comité de Chemnitz”. He wrote multiple articles about Latin as the universal language.

464 The section “Notre enquête. De l’utilité d’une Langue internationale : Latin ou Espéranto” is present from June 1899 to March 1900.

465 At least since February 1900, as noted by de Beaufront ([1905], 44) and at least till November 1901. The advertisement dismisses artificial languages as fit only for children and fools: “Linguæ artefactæ pueris & nugatoribus placere possunt, sobriis & doctis indignæ sunt.”. Avellanus reciprocated the advertisement, advertising

De Beaufront took this question seriously – Latin as a possible solution of the international language question was a fundamental challenge for Esperanto that needed to be answered in a non-perfunctory manner; his long-running response of more than 50 pages enumerating the vices of Latin and the virtues of Esperanto was later even published as a separate pamphlet.⁴⁶⁶ He derided the Latin party as “regressionists” trying to resurrect the historically rejected communicational role of Latin and resisting the natural evolution of languages to greater simplicity.⁴⁶⁷ To make his point, he emphasised the linguistic problems: there are so many varieties of Latin, which one should be used? Ciceronian, Augustan, Medieval? How does one make this language *easily acquirable* for anyone with a school education? The capability of Latin to express modern notions was a concern. He analysed the existing Latin periodicals (*Præco Latinus* and *Vox Urbis*) and criticised the vocabulary in both of them – periphrastic expressions of *Vox Urbis* were not recognisable by a casual reader, while the neologisms of *Præco Latinus* are also not recognisable (*typoscriptorium* – a typewriter) and additionally are artificial elements in the language. Neither he felt that extending the sense of existing words is good – the Roman word *birota* means a two-wheeled vehicle, not a *bicycle*; no revived Roman would understand this.⁴⁶⁸ Finally, the grammar is complex and the words have broad and multiple (hence ambiguous) meanings, while the consciously-engineered Esperanto avoids both of these problems.

Avellanus read all these discussions (I do not cover all of them) and even participated in them – his text (*De lingua universali*) was published by Tasset.⁴⁶⁹ He was incensed by de Beaufront criticising both Latin itself and his own neologisms⁴⁷⁰ and unhappy that it was only Tasset who was defending Latin.⁴⁷¹ Maybe it is this experience that made Avellanus disillusioned about the

Concordia in Præco Latinus.

466 De Beaufront’s first reaction to Tasset’s challenge and the general enquiry was already in Feb. 1899. His (unfinished) long-form treatment of the question (*L’Espéranto. Seule vraie solution de la Langue internationale*) ran in *Concordia* from July 1899 to March 1901 (43 pages, more than 50 if related articles are added). It was later reprinted in *L’Esperantiste*, the primary Esperanto periodical of the time, and as a separate booklet (de Beaufront [1905]).

467 These points are made in *Concordia* Feb. 1899 pp. 82-83 “La langue internationale”; June 1899 pp. 258-259 “Les Espérantistes et les Régressionistes”.

468 These inflexible criteria in judging the understandability of language are not very convincing – those who take a purist stance tend to be at war with metaphors or generally with the extended senses of words and to pretend of not understanding anything outside the most narrow interpretation of the dictionary definition.

469 *Concordia* Feb. 1901 pp. 79-81.

470 *Præco Latinus* Mai. 1900 Vol. VI No. 8 p. 192: “Epistolarius quidam Franco-Gallus (!), ut inopiam et ineptitudinem verborum Latinorum ad usus modernos demonstret, simul autem deliramentum illud “Desperationis” commendet, collegam nostrum Rñum carpit, *birotam*, *subnotationem*, aliaque vocabula ut inepta notando, tum autem nos adoritur, velut qui sine scrupulo, animo *vere Americano*, novamina amplectamur, nulla habita ratione classicitatis. <...> Delicta nostra hæc sunt: <...> Filum quod ex ferro est, *ferrofilum* audemus nominare, id autem quod non calamo, sed paratis typis scribit, *typoscriptorium* impii appellamus, ut de *ferrovia*, quod certe sacrilegum est, plane sileamus. <...> Mirare demum pulchritudinem “machine à écrire”, *h. e.*, machina ad scribendum! Ecce nos tantam pulchritudinem non imitamur? *Birotae* Rñorum non erant ut nostræ. Nec *panis*, *vestes*, *domus*, *arma*, *libri*, etc., erant ut nostra, nec sol luna ac stellæ, cælum ac maria erant eadem. Quid ergo?”.

471 *Præco Latinus* Dec. 1899 Vol. VI No. 3 p. 53

possibility of successful propagation of Latin in the international language movement. From now on, he referred to Esperanto as *Desperanto* and as an absurd fiction (*figmentum absurdum*).

In 1908 the *New York Times* published a short note by Avellanus condemning Esperanto as an “asininity” that has “no right to exist” and Esperantists as people with whom one cannot reasonably discuss,⁴⁷² stirring up a hornet’s nest – this resulted in a three-month⁴⁷³ discussion in the pages of the newspaper (24 letters!); the offended Esperantists immediately jumped to the defence of their dear language and called Avellanus “an academic fossil” ignorant of the fact that Esperanto is uniting thousands of people and that it is Latin that is dead.⁴⁷⁴ Later Avellanus restated his point of “Desperanto”⁴⁷⁵ and outlined in a grand style his own programme of Living Latin. But the bulk of the discussion was concerned with other affairs of the quarrelsome international language community. There were pro-Esperanto and anti-Esperanto statements; the Esperanto language was going through a schism at the time – in 1907 *Ido*, a radically reformed Esperanto, had been proposed anonymously and in May 1908 the authorship of it was unveiled⁴⁷⁶ – so in midst of this drama⁴⁷⁷ there were acrimonious pro-Ido and anti-Ido statements as well. There were also

472 *The New York Times* 4 July 1908: “Dear Sir: Why do you not turn your activities into promoting Latin instead of Esperanto as a world language? Yours truly, Charles L. Dana // Mr. Dear Doctor: As to the Esperantists, I have neither the means of reaching them nor do I consider them a class of people with which one could argue or reason. No man of thinking nature will concede to that mutilating, Germanizing, and barbarizing Latin word-stems will make a “language.” [...] the present asininity has no chances nor right to exist. // Neither has that idiotic product the stamp of scholarship on it: quite the contrary. [...] anybody professing Esperantisim [...] in my eyes is an ignorant man. Arcadius Avellanus”; Becker (2010, 71-72) also contains the text. This long article is a good introduction to Avellanus’ thought.

473 Every Saturday from 4 July to 19 September 1908.

474 *The New York Times* 11 July 1908 p. 20 contains three letters. Myles Murphy is the author of this statement. Also in Becker (2010, 73-75).

475 *The New York Times* 1 Aug. 1908, p. 24: “Strangely enough, but for natural reasons, those who were shipwrecked in their Latin studies, unable to master the endings, have rebelled, and have hatched out spite “languages”, stitched together from the tatters and rags of third-fourth-hand Latin, in the method of the ancient barbarians, chipping off the formidable endings they so hate, patching the leaky parts of their scanty supply of Latin from their barbarous sources at command. Among these monsters is Esperanto, or Desperanto. // The victims of this crazy-quilt reproach me for calling their hobby “asinine.”. Here I give some of my reasons for so doing.”; Becker (2010, 82-88).

476 *Ido* had been secretly authored by Louis Couturat, the president of the same *Delegation for the Adoption of an Auxiliary language* which was supposed to select the best project, and Louis de Beaufront, the representative of Esperanto in the *Delegation*, where the *Ido* project was first presented in October 1907. This was a flagrant conflict of interest for both of them. In May 1908 (Privat 1923b, 58) de Beaufront came forward as the author and became the traitor of the movement – this explains the temperature of the discussions in *New York Times*. Garvía (2015, 137): “Incensed, [Otto] Jespersen informed Ostwald about this double game and asked both Couturat and de Beaufront to come out in open. It took de Beaufront four months to come forward. In his public confession, and in order to save Couturat’s reputation, de Beaufront assumed the entire responsibility for *Ido*’s authorship. This satisfied Jespersen. [...] And to some extent, it also satisfied the Esperantists. They had unveiled de Beaufront, the Judas of Esperantism, a villain whose last service to the movement was to unite all Esperantists against him and *Ido*.”.

477 The level of tension can be seen in the letter by Andrew Kangas, president of the N. Y. Esperanto society and an *Idist*: “I want to warn the conservatives that the reformers are after them. [...] Pluck out your eyes! Throw away your brains! We want them! You may try to maintain a “united front” for a short while longer, but you are rotten at the core [...]” (22 Aug. 1908; Becker (2010, 99-102))

supporters of English, simplified English, even Irish (!) as the world language. But only Avellanus and an anonymous *Veritas*⁴⁷⁸ stood for Latin.

The evolution of Avellanus' attitude from 1890 to 1908 is not only a personal matter. It reflects a fundamental change in the environment. In 1890, when *Phaenix* appeared, the international language movement was in a crisis and had no strong players – Volapük was already in a free-fall because of internal discord, while Esperanto, proposed by Zamenhof in 1887, was just beginning to be known internationally. The former Volapükists were now searching for new solutions, so the proposals of new languages abounded and the atmosphere was that of an expectation of an *agreement*, of a forum where the best language would prevail. *Phaenix*, proposing Latin as the solution, used this situation. The 1896 journal *Linguist*, which Avellanus used to read, was founded in a similar spirit to provide a forum; *Concordia* also was open for discussions, welcoming both Esperanto and Latin.

However, the Esperantists did not wait for the worldwide agreement to appear, they worked on promoting their movement and creating language resources: translations into Esperanto, lexical and educational materials. The movement was growing steadily and now Esperanto was a *fact* rather than just a proposal. The initial phase of the international language movement was characterised by endless discussions between projects that existed only on paper, but now every proposal had to face an existing strong movement of Esperanto. Year 1900 marks a turning point in Esperanto's growth – for example, back then there was only three Esperanto journals (principally Louis de Beaufront's *L'Espérantiste*) but by 1910 there were over ninety of them⁴⁷⁹ and the annual congresses (happening since 1905) used to gather over a thousand participants.

Most Esperantists believed in their own language and were numerous enough to make any discussion about the international language centred around Esperanto with pro- and anti-Esperanto positions.⁴⁸⁰ Discussions about the best international auxiliary language tended to be acrimonious – after all, there should be only *one* winner for the role of *the* international language – and with little effect, as it consistently proved impossible to agree on any detail of this language supposedly *objectively suitable* for the international role.⁴⁸¹

478 *The New York Times* 15 Aug. 1908: "We have the universal language, made for us thousands of years ago, and why not use it, instead of concocting a toy language fit only for goblins?". *Veritas* also suggested a weekly column for teaching conversational Latin.

479 Large (1985, 85); Garvia (2015, 154).

480 For its detractors who wanted to reform it or who had their own projects, Esperanto abounded with irrational imperfections, while its followers were seen as fanatically obstinate and, once again, irrational. The detractors liked to use linguistic-style arguments, while the Esperantists used social-style ones, centred on their ideas and on their successful growth: citing their reach, community, the language resources, congresses.

481 To quote Harrison (1997): "People will accept arbitrary or irregular features that were invented or tolerated by an entire culture, but they will not accept identical "bugs" in a language that was deliberately created by one or a few auxlangers. It is impossible to create a language which has no objectionable features. [...] On rare occasions the holy war between pro- and anti-Esperanto partisans has broken into the letters columns of significant periodicals;

Latin could not compete – while *Phoenix* could reasonably propose it in the initial stage of the international language movement, no discussions would have had any effect when it was no longer an equal discussion between proposals, but between a theoretical proposal and a working system already rapidly gaining ground. In 1903 Henderson, even if sympathising with the (simplified) Latin movement, reluctantly came to support Esperanto as it was the only international language with a community.⁴⁸²

So the later angry diatribes of Avellanus fitted the eristic milieu perfectly well and reflected the situation that had developed – it turned out that the initial idea that people could agree on the international language through discussion was an illusion. One could only love and believe in his or her own universal language, be it Latin or Esperanto, and cultivate it. And there were no magical arguments that could convert the rest of the world.

3.4.6.2 Pacifism

The turn of the century is characterised by a lively and developing scene of overlapping internationalisms. The international language movements constituted only one outlet of many for the internationalist impulses – therefore, internationally-minded people can be seen both in the artificial language journals and in various other initiatives. Studying the personalities of this period means seeing events happening simultaneously in different movements and tracing networks of connections and influences across them. In this case, I look at some of the connections of Arcadius Avellanus and Jacques Tasset (who were active both in *Præco Latinus* and *Concordia*) with the pacifist movement. Latin had a mission here.

In 1897 Avellanus registered as a member of the *Universal Peace Union*, a pacifist organisation led by the Philadelphian activist Alfred H. Love, and, visiting its meeting in Philadelphia, delivered a speech about the importance of Latin as the international language for peace – peace is often disturbed by language barriers, so there is a need for *one* international

looking at the microfilm records of these debates, one gets the distinct impression that the editors sorely regretted allowing the subject to arise.”

482 Henderson (1903a): “Postquam me habe studete omne suggestiones de alies, me puta, que i Latinesce methode esse i optime solutione, sed me adjuva nunc *Esperanto*, quia ille esse i sole internationale lingue in use, *Esperanto* essere meliore quam nulle internationale lingue”; Henderson (1903b): “Interim me adjuva *Esperanto*, quia Esperanto esse actualé in use, et Esperanto essere meliore quam nulle internationale Lingue.” (the preceding two quotes, stating the fact that Esperanto is not the best language, but better than nothing, are in Latinesce; see footnote 311); *L'Espérantiste* 31 Mart. 1903 Vol. VI No. 63 p. 196: “**Anglujo.** – La Esperantista movado Angla fariĝas pli kaj pli interesa. S^o Georgo Henderson, aŭtoro de projekto pri lingvo internacia (*Lingua Anglo-Franca*), iam partiano de lingvo latina, ne sole ĵus alportis sian kunhelpon al la Delegacio por la L. I., tradukante anglan *<sic>* ĝian broŝuron, sed ankaŭ li donis helpon al Esperanto mem, publikigante folion-vortaron Esperantan-anglan, similan al tiuj, kiuj estis presitaj en diversaj lingvoj je la komenco de Esperanto. La aliĝo de S^o Henderson povas nur ĝojigi nin forte kaj ni lin tre sincere dankas pro lia kunlaborado en nia afero.”; see also *La Belga Sonorilo* Mart. 1903 Vol. I No. 7 p. 63 and *Lingvo internacia* Oct. 1903 Vol. VIII No. 10 pp. 252-254.

language, namely Latin. Apparently the lecture was received well, after it there were people who expressed their desire to learn Latin.⁴⁸³ Avellanus subscribed to their journal *The Peacemaker*, which also praised *Præco Latinus* in its pages.⁴⁸⁴ The same year, the Philadelphian industrialist Ferdinand Philips (1850-1908), patron of Avellanus, lobbied the Universal Peace Congress (*Congrès universel pour la paix*) to support Latin as the international language,⁴⁸⁵ but the congress postponed the international language question.⁴⁸⁶

Jacques Tasset was active in the pages of *Concordia*. In 1901 this organisation (*Société d'Études et de Correspondance Internationales*) prepared a brochure for the Glasgow International Exhibition that was prefaced by a pacifist poem *Invocation to the Spirit of Peace* in four languages – French, English, Latin (translated by Jacques Tasset) and Esperanto (translated by Louis de Beaufront).⁴⁸⁷

Concordia had among its members princess Gabrielle Wiszniewska (1836-1903),⁴⁸⁸ who headed the *Universal Alliance of Women for Peace*.⁴⁸⁹ In 1900 the *Universal Exhibition (Exposition Universelle)* was to happen in Paris, so this was a good occasion for the *Alliance* to have its first congress in the same city. Jacques Tasset translated the programme of the future congress into Latin and had it published in *Præco Latinus* in March 1900; both Tasset⁴⁹⁰ and Avellanus were happy that among the proposed means furthering the cause of peace the universal language (*langue universelle*) was included, meaning that Latin had a chance. Wiszniewska politely received this

483 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1897 Vol. III No. 10 p. 7: “Intereramus conventui affabilitate et amicitia summa invitati, ubi plures litteræ ad rem Cubanam, item ad tumultus fodinarios facientes sunt lectæ. Orationibus aliquot habitis, demum nos ad cœtum diximus ut l. Lñam velut gentium universam commendarem. Ostendimus pacem & concordiam e linguis peregrinis male intellectis sæpissime turbari, nec vicenas a cunctis addisci posse, hinc unam, eamque Latinam, adoptari oportere. Propositum cunctis placuit, suntque inter membra viri et mulieres qui l. Lñam addiscere summo ardore cupiant. Statuimus proinde, ut familiaritatem Societatis Pacis summo studio coleremus.”

484 *Præco Latinus* Dec. 1899 Vol. VI No. 3 p. 66

485 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1897 Vol. III No. 10 p. 1: “Si fata amicorum consilia non eluserunt, certum erit nec Gallos nec Germanos usquequaque dormire. Societas enim *Pacis Gentium* propagatrix, 12 Aug., Homburgi, <sic> in prov. Borussiae Hasso-Nassoviana, concilium universum iniit, delegatis variarum gentium frequentissimum. Causam Lñam Galliarum R. RAQUENI, vir præstantissimus, Officialis Academiae Gallicae, Director *L'Epoque* diarii Parisini, agebat. De re hac edocti, <sic> rei Latinæ apud nos Procurator, FERDINANDUS PHILIPS, ex parte Academiae Gentium Latinæ hic condendæ, virum supralaudatum per litteras humanissime precatus est, ut in Congressu partes l. Lñæ caperet, et Congressum permoveret, ut l. Lñam, ut gentium universam, adoptandam inter suas leges decerneret. Nova, quæ hactenus percepimus, nullum dubium relinquunt quin de lingua gentium universa ibidem actum sit, nec facile dubitamus quin vir ille clarissimus l. Lñam pro viribus sustinuerit. Facta tamen diserta, ad hanc usque horam, nobis non innotuerunt.”

486 *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1900 Vol. VI No. 10 p. 221

487 *Concordia* May 1901 p. 162 describes the plan; the poem *Invocation à la Paix / Invocation to the Spirit of Peace / Invocatio ad Pacem / Alvoko al la Paco* by Jules Gondoin (*Homme de Lettres, Professeur de Littérature française*) was published *ibid.*, p. 186.

488 See Cooper (1983, 20), Cooper (2011, 12 ff.), Cooper (2020, 63-64), Clinton (2001, 28).

489 Founded in Paris in 1896 as *Ligue des femmes pour le désarmement international*, renamed in 1900 to *Alliance universelle des femmes pour la paix* (with *par l'éducation* added later).

490 *Præco Latinus* Mart. 1900 Vol. VI No. 6 p. 144: “Respicias in argumento rerum quæ in concilio tractabuntur, illam linguæ mundanæ quæstionem a perspicacibus fœminis haud omissam.”

issue and promised to distribute *Præco*,⁴⁹¹ the next month *La Paix*, a pacifist journal of Paris, praised *Præco Latinus*.⁴⁹²

In the July issue of *Præco Latinus*, which was supposed to be disseminated to the members of the *Alliance*, Avellanus published a praise of Wiszniewska followed by an article about the *Universal language*. Peace congresses which do not treat the question of universal language are useless, Latin is the precondition for lasting peace and justice in the world, as this medium would help the smaller nations to communicate on an equal footing:

“The Hamburg Peace Congress and other such attempts were nothing but a ridiculous comedy of ignorance and a shameless tyranny of the powerful, who were busy with oppressing the weaker and forcing their own odious languages to them. They are talking about “peace”, but under the condition of oppression and extermination of the smaller and weaker. This is not a work of peace, but of war. // Might does not make right. Force produces hate and, finally, war. Do the Portuguese, Danes, Dutch, Icelanders, Lithuanians, Poles, Czechs, Vlachs, Greeks, Hungarians, Finns, Catalans, Chinese, Turks, Bulgarians, Croats have no rights? Does anyone want to purchase “peace” with the death of these nations and languages? What could be more impious and insane? Will we all have to learn English, French or German, and, abandoning our own languages, which are much better and more beautiful, to learn the awkward and barbarous languages of the powerful? Is suicide the precondition of peace? // There will never be any peace, there must never be any peace that would have to be bought with the price of injuring and insulting the smaller nations..”⁴⁹³

Nonetheless, this congress was not an exception to the rule – just as the other international gatherings, it did not dare to decide on the international language question. The *Alliance* excused itself from the decision by saying that it is a matter of such great importance that the answer needs preparation.⁴⁹⁴

491 *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1900 Vol. VI No. 7 p. 161

492 *Præco Latinus* Mai. 1900 Vol. VI No. 8 p. 171

493 *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1900 Vol. VI No. 10 p. 221: “Congressus de Pace Hamburgi indictus, Congressus de Pace Potestatum Hagæ, Congressus de Pace Americano-Hispanicus, Parisiis, delegati de pace apud Philippinos, aliaque id genus conamina nostrorum temporum, nihil erant nisi comœdia partim ridicula insciorum, partim tyrannis impudica fortiorum, qua se debiliores fortunisque exiliores opprimere, suasque linguas exosas his obtrudere sategebant. <sic> De “pace” tractant hi, sed ea lege ut minores ac debiliores opprimantur, exterminentur, linguæ autem odiosæ potentiorum iis inculcentur. Hoc iam non opus *pacis* est, sed opus belli: <...> // Vis non est ius; vis iniuriam, adeoque odium, demum bellum parit. Num Lusitanis, Danis, Batavis, Islandicis, Lithuanis, Polonis, Bohemis, Valachis, Græcis, Hungaris, Fennis, Catalanis, Seribus, Turcis, Bulgaris, Croatis nulla iura? An quis “pacem” morte harum gentium et linguarum præstinare vult? Quid est magis impium et insanum? An vero omnes sub iugum Teutonum potentiorum agemur? An omnes adigemur ut Anglice, Gallice aut Germanice discamus, nostras autem linguas multo meliores ac pulchriores eiuremus, linguas vero inconcinneas ac barbaras potentiorum amplectamur? An suicidium est conditio pacis? // Nulla unquam erit pax, nunquam esse debet pax, quæ iniuria atque insultu gentium minorum præstinari debeat.”

494 *Concordia* Oct. 1900 pp. 355-358 contains a report by Tasset on the congress of the *Alliance*. P. 358: “La question de la langue universelle, à cause de son importance et du manque de temps, a été remise à ce futur Congrès. Il a été décidé qu’elle serait, en attendant, sérieusement préparée.”. *Præco Latinus* Aug. 1900 Vol. VI No. 11 p. 259 contains a caustic remark by Avellanus: “Quum iam “otium defuisset”, ut hoc passim fit, *de lingua gentium*

Esperanto similarly had problems in getting officially accepted by any international organ, but the connection with pacifism was overwhelming. Zamenhof himself imagined his language to be an instrument of peace and equality between nations: “when the peoples will be able to understand each other easily, the mutual hate will cease”,⁴⁹⁵ “to the eternally fighting world / [Esperanto] promises sacred harmony.”⁴⁹⁶ As noted by Roberto Garvía, “Pacifism was certainly a privileged platform to make Esperanto visible. In fact, in 1905, six of the twenty-six members of the International Peace Bureau were also leading Esperantists.”⁴⁹⁷ In a 1927 survey, about 30% of respondents said that they learned the Esperanto language because of its association with peace.⁴⁹⁸

Even if Latin did not manage to get included in the agenda of the pacifist organisations, there certainly existed a vision of Latin fulfilling a worldwide pacifying role and there were attempts to promote it. Avellanus held on to this view: in 1918, after the First World War, he once again proposed Latin as the proper international language to be used in the peace conference.⁴⁹⁹ The connection between Latin and peace certainly existed and thoughts about Latin being a neutral language and about its possible contributions to the justice between nations often contributed to the motivation for using Latin. In Latin, the Esperanto-like feeling of the brotherhood of nations – both Avellanus⁵⁰⁰ and Ulrichs⁵⁰¹ have expressed the ideal possibility of seeing the other enthusiasts as friends and *fratres Latini*, transcending other possibly unwelcome identities – is complemented with the feeling of belonging to the perennial *res publica litterarum* spanning the ages.

universa statutum est nihil, sed ‘proxime.’”

495 See Appendix A.8 for the source of this quote and for its relationship with the only monument (!) for Living Latin.

496 Verses from *La Espero*, a poem published by Zamenhof in 1890 that became the anthem of the Esperanto movement: “al la mond’ eterne militanta / ĝi promesas sanktan harmonion.”

497 Garvía (2015, 111)

498 Garvía (2015, 99)

499 Brewster (1920, 125): “In the Philadelphia Public Ledger of December 1, 1918, appeared an article by Professor Arcadius Avellanus, of the Catholic College of St. John, suggesting Latin as the official language for the peace conference!”

500 *Præco Latinus* Mart. 1899 Vol. V No. 6 p. 85: “Sed nos dissidia creare v. fovere nolumus. Imo contra, nostra conamina sunt ut et Rño Catholicos, et Protestantos, et Infideles, Atheosque, quos omnes homines esse scimus, Latinitate, in commune bonum gris hñi, in unum congregemus et convincamus, <sic> quod non odiis, sed humanitate fit. Propositum est, ut quum Atheus Americanus Rdum Prem cuiuscunque Ordinis in India, in Argentina, v. Protestans Germanus Infidelem Lusitanum, Bohemum, in Seribus, Russus Orthodoxus Anglum Protestantem in Brasilia convenerit, *Latinum fratrem*, amicum *Præconianum* in eo deprehendat, non *odiosum* Russum, Anglum, Bohemum, Iesuitam, Catholicum, Protestantem, qui <sic> cum invicem *loqui* et velint et possint, sicque humanitatem alere et fovere.”;

501 Alaudae Jun. 1890 No. 12 p. 90: “Etiam societatem quandam jam efficimus inter nationes diffusam – res ipsa loquitur – lectores mei unâ mecum. Haud immerito nos quis vocaret *Fratres Latinos* vel *Sodales Latinitati propagandae*, nos sparsos per totam fere Europam, per Aegyptum et Americam septentrionalem.”. As mentioned above (p. 66), Ulrichs imagined that Latin as the official language could provide harmony and justice to the Austro-Hungarian empire; see Laes (2022a).

3.4.6.3 Projects of international organisations

Præco Latinus contains many ideas of international organisations for Latin. Victor S. Clark (1868-1946), then the principal of a high school in Minnesota and an enthusiastic correspondent of Avellanus, suggested in 1897 that a society of Latin correspondence could be founded (*Germanitas Gentium Epistolaris Latina*).⁵⁰² This was an idea very similar to what Lombard's journal *L'Étranger* accomplished by promoting correspondence in all languages. In the case of Latin, in 1901 Jacques Tasset raised in *Concordia* an idea of connecting Latin students through a register of Latin pen-friends;⁵⁰³ later Woldemar Lommatzsch added such a section to his Latin journal *Civis Romanus*.⁵⁰⁴ In the case of Esperanto (first published in 1887), this was one of the first steps Zamenhof took to disseminate his language – from the very beginning he had been encouraging contacts between the learners of the language and already in 1889 he did this officially by publishing the first thousand addresses of them,⁵⁰⁵ thus creating a central register of this social network.

Avellanus and his readers approved of this idea of an *International Society of Latin* (*Germanitas Gentium Latina*),⁵⁰⁶ but it quickly grew out of proportion. After two months, this society, which was initially a simple idea of encouraging a Latin letter exchange, became a grand project. The Philadelphian industrialist Ferdinand Philips, patron of Avellanus, would be the leader of an effort that would involve forty serious men (*virī graves Philadelpheni*) sending out letters to the whole world to unite all the friends of Latin into one great body.⁵⁰⁷ Naturally, this was a herculean task. In the later proposed structure Philips increased the number of these most learned men who would form the core of the organisation now called the *International Academy of Latin* (*Academia Gentium Latina*) to fifty (*in vicinitate hac viros 50 gravissimos, doctissimos*); they would pay 100 dollars yearly (for comparison: the price of an annual subscription to *Præco* was \$1) and would form the core of the organisation. The ordinary members would pay \$15, the

502 *Præco Latinus* Feb. 1897 Vol. III No. 5 p. 4: “Primipilus noster fortissimus, Cl. VICTOR S. CLARK, putat condendam esse quandam Germanitatem Gentium Epistulariam Latinam, membra cuius e civibus Reip. Lñæ omnium gentium coalescerent, qui catalogum cunctorum membrorum tenerent seque verbi sacramento obligarent, ut epistolis Lñis a quolibet membro acceptis responsum Lñum remitterent. Idea hæc præclara placet. Quid lectoribus videtur? Certe, ne torpescamus, aliquid huiusmodi suscipiendum censemus.”

503 Tasset proposed that students learning Latin could enter a register of interested Latin correspondents and sign their names with the initials S. L. (*Socius Latinus*); the platform of *Concordia* would be in a great position to promote such a project. Tasset outlined his plan in *Concordia* March 1901 pp. 115-116; the *Concordia* board meeting where Tasset's proposal was considered is described in April 1901 pp. 131-132; an anonymous *Discipulus* enthusiastically supported this proposal in April 1901 p. 139.

504 For example, *Civis Romanus* Jul. 1902 Vol. II No. 1 p. 4 contains a section called “Nomina sociorum epistularium” which contains the names and addresses of such volunteers; later in Mart. 1903 Vol. II No. 9 p. 46 “Nomina sociorum libentissime ad epistulas Latinas respondentium”. Tasset is the first one in the list.

505 Forster (1982, 19)

506 *Præco Latinus* Mart. 1897 Vol. III No. 6 p. 1

507 *Præco Latinus* Apr. 1897 Vol. III No. 7 p. 7

corresponding members \$10, while the honorary ones would be exempt from the fee.⁵⁰⁸ 2,500 copies of *Præco* presenting the project were printed and distributed primarily among the clergy;⁵⁰⁹ five prospective core members willing to pay \$100 yearly were found and public lectures for recruiting the rest were planned;⁵¹⁰ finally, a 52-page pamphlet *Thoughts Concerning an International Latin Academy* was published and it expressed the main purpose – to “forward the movement towards making Latin the *international* language of learning and science”.⁵¹¹ This pamphlet is probably the end of the *Academy* project; but in 1900 summer a new project of *Tusculaneum* appeared.⁵¹²

Avellanus most probably read Michael Olmo’s excerpts published in *Phœnix*.⁵¹³ Even if no direct reference to Olmo can be found in his known writings, Avellanus himself was a fervent Utopist believing in some kind of a *civitas Latina*. Avellanus’ *Tusculaneum*, a project of a great school for Avellanus’ brand of universal education, by its size blurs the lines between a school and a state or a town just as Comenius’ proposal does. In a huge campus of a thousand acres (approximately 400 hectares)⁵¹⁴ a thousand boys from all nations would live together and would be educated free of charge; every discipline besides other languages would be taught in Latin.⁵¹⁵ The

508 *Præco Latinus* Iun. 1897 Vol. III No. 9 p 2: “Quum tamen ad cœptum tantum nemo unus sufficeret, [Philips] statuit, ut in vicinitate hac viros 50 gravissimos, doctissimos, conquereret, qui de l. Lña conservanda, restauranda ac propaganda nobiscum conspirarent & consentirent. <...> Firma igitur in corde eius spes viget 50 “immortales” congregari posse, qui collatis \$100.00 singillatim, in “*Academiam Gentium Latinam*” coalescant. Hi 50 fient nucleus, qui identidem encyclicis emissis membra ordinaria cogent, qui \$15.00 annue conferant; tum membra epistolaria, denis centussibus, tandem honoraria, quæ a collatione quacunque sint immunia. Pauci admodum sunt qui hactenus albulas subsignarunt, sed tamen *sunt*, adeoque labor leniter progreditur. Nec est ullum dubium quin membra ordinaria catervatim confluet, <sic> modo nucleus coalescat. De hoc litteris pluribus sumus certiores. Mox, interea, prospectus brevissimus prodibit, ut omnes ii, qui sapiunt, nobisque obsecundare cupiunt, Clar. PHILIPS litteris edoceant. <sic>”

509 *Præco Latinus* Aug. 1899 Vol. V. No. 11 p. 177

510 *Præco Latinus* Sept. 1897 Vol. III. No. 10 p. 4

511 It was published in Nov. 1898, as indicated by Dec. 1898 Vol. V No. 3 p. 48. The number of pages is sourced from Platzdasch (2009). *The Homœopathic Recorder* Nov. 1898 Vol. XIII No. 11 p. 518: ““THOUGHTS CONCERNING AN INTERNATIONAL LATIN ACADEMY” is the title of a treatise respectfully addressed to men and women, who, amid their various vocations, duties and occupations, command *some leisure*. “Now the object of this pamphlet” is to invite those who will “to join into a learned body to be called Academia Gentium Latina or International Latin Academy,” and thus forward the movement towards making Latin the *international* language of learning and science.”

512 *Præco Latinus* Aug. 1900 Vol. VI No. 11 p. 244 is the first description of the idea. Avellanus developed this idea together with Arthur T. Abernethy (1872-1956), his private Latin student who dreamed about the idea of free education; he was the driving force in publicity and fundraising.

513 Avellanus’ own letter to *Phœnix* had been published in the preceding issue.

514 See footnote 521.

515 *Præco Latinus* Aug. 1900 Vol. 6 No. 11 p. 244: “Cl. ARCTURUS T. ABERNETHY, Dr. Phil., vir iuvenis, <...> consilium mente concepit amicos mediaque comparandi, ut *Societatem Gentium Educationis Gratuite* conderet, cuius esset Collegium condere nomine “TUSCULANEI” insigniendum, non pro quæstu, sed ad iuventutem, cuiuscunque nationis, *gratis educandam*. <...> ita ut in TUSCULANEO protinus *mille* iuvenes congregentur <...> Locatum potius ruri, in regione montana, quam in urbe, esse volumus. Curriculum octo annos complectetur, ad normam Gymnasiorum maiorum. Ut libertati opinionum ac doctrinæ consulatur, necesse est ut media a pluribus, v. a multitudine, procurentur quam ab uno, aut a factione. Gradus “Academicos” nec conferre, nec acceptare volumus. <...> Ubi magistri apti suppetent, enchiridiaque scripta fuerint, præter linguas, cunctæ disciplinæ Latine tractabuntur. Institutio mentalis ante-meridiem tantum fiet, quotidie, dempto die Solis, post-meridiem corpora

previous *civitas Latina* projects presented an unusual combination of a Latin language immersion and a manual trade education which critics, living in sharply class-conscious societies, believed to create a social conflict; Avellanus, probably inspired by modern pedagogical ideas, includes the skills of manual work as indispensable parts of education.⁵¹⁶

Just as Olmo, Avellanus tried to reach out to the press, various influential persons (including kings and millionaires), and even collected money for this proposal. The readership of the periodical was enthusiastic and believed that this grand project would help Latin worldwide. The project was advertised in the local newspapers in 1901,⁵¹⁷ funds were being raised both by approaching prospective sponsors⁵¹⁸ and by leaving boxes raising funds for *The International Free School Association* in the public spaces of Philadelphia. The latter activity caused a fraud investigation.⁵¹⁹ In a newspaper interview Avellanus admitted that this method of fund-raising was unprofessional,⁵²⁰ but the grandeur of this project should excuse for this: the purpose is “to found a college in which the highest classical education shall be afforded, the highest mathematics and profoundest philosophies taught, the sciences, manual training of every description”, and all of this for free.⁵²¹ A local journalist later commented that the sincerity of Avellanus was utterly convincing,

exercebuntur: hyeme quidem opificiis, coquendo, suendo, ensibus dimicando, æstate autem equitando, natando, hortum, vineam, pomarium, agros colendo, plantas, mineralia, insecta, vermes, scarabaeos, papiliones, apes, &c., legendo et discendo. <...> His mediis volumus efficere ut alumni TUSCULANEI disciplina omni exercitissimi prodeant, qui, ut res postulaverit, viri ingenui, rustici, milites, nautæ, diplomatae, magistri, actarii, opifices, ut quondam Athenienses, fieri queant.”

516 This curious mixture of spoken Latin and most practical trade lessons can also be seen in W. H. D. Rouse – see footnote 269 and page 75.

517 *The Times* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 7 Feb. 1901 p. 2; *The Courier-Journal* (Louisville, Kentucky) 19 Mai. 1901 p. 21

518 *The Charlotte Observer* (Charlotte, North Carolina) 19 Aug. 1901 p. 10 describes that approached by Abernethy, a Philadelphian industrialist Frederick D. Turnbull gave \$750 to the project; after being approached by journalists covering the fraud investigation, he was surprised that the *Tusculaneum* was not yet functioning, as that is how the situation was described to him (Abernethy’s methods were definitely questionable). Turnbull is praised in *Præco Latinus* of May 1901.

519 *The Times* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 11 Aug. 1901 p. 1. The titles of the article: “POLICE TO PROBE BEGGING SCHEME // “The International Free School Association” Gives a False Address // GLASS GLOBES FOR MONEY”; *The Times* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 15 Aug. 1901 p. 4: “The pamphlet issued by the association, portions of which have been published in THE PHILADELPHIA TIMES, was shown to Mr. Converse, and, after looking it over, he said: “This certainly bears all the ear marks of a swindle, and THE PHILADELPHIA TIMES is to be commended for beginning an investigation””

520 *The Times* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 13 Aug. 1901 p. 1; Avellanus indicates that Abernethy was responsible for the method. The third member of the team who was interviewed together with Avellanus was Countess Loveau de Chavanne, recruited by Abernethy. Born in 1861 as Ouida Benson at Brooklyn, daughter of captain Henry John Benson of United States Navy, “Opibus affluens iam tenerrima ætate Parisios deducta est. Adolescens, societatis Gallicæ diva exstitit, mox Comiti LOVEAU de Chavanne nupsit, qui tamen 1892, post bona uxoris eversa et dissipata, mortem oppetiit.” (*Præco Latinus* Vol. VI Aug. 1900 Nr. 11 p. 248). She returned in 1896 to live in the USA, living in Philadelphia, engaging in charity (“nursed sick soldiers at Camp Merritt during Spanish-American War”; Hamersly (1904, 120)) and publishing in 1900 an autobiographical novel *Ouida, or American Gold Regilding the Coronets of Europe* that warned against such marriages to foreign nobility. She was going to teach French in the *Tusculaneum*.

521 *The Times* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 13 Aug. 1901 p. 1: “ “But no trivial mistake as to method can detract from the grandeur of the project. The purpose to found a college in which the highest classical education shall be afforded, the highest mathematics and profoundest philosophies taught, the sciences, manual training of every

he “presented the project in so engaging a light that the aspersions that have been cast upon it can proceed only from the heartless”, and “on paper it is one of the greatest things imagined since the death of Colonel Sellers, and if the collection of pennies had not been rudely interrupted its possibilities would have been immense.”.⁵²² This benevolent and sarcastic conclusion fits Avellanus perfectly.

All these plans were obviously products of an unbridled fantasy, being unrealistic already in their conception and especially in their execution. They led nowhere. But in the history of Living Latin they can be considered explorations of Latin’s universality. After all, if Avellanus managed to find multiple rich businessmen willing to support such ventures, Latin was still a strong symbol in the society. The Latin activists have been dreaming about the worldwide unification of Latinists at least since Olmo, and Avellanus is certainly not the last one in this list. The imagined *Academia Gentium Latina* with its formal academic structure was later realised by the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* that arose from the formal Living Latin movement after the Second World War. And the dream of a great Latin-speaking school pertains to the centuries-long tradition of the *civitates Latinae*.

These dreams and the distant echoes of projects were an inspiration the Living Latin community. As Jacques Tasset put it, “even if *Tusculaneum*, the college of Roman arts, does not yet stand in Philadelphia in a material form, its great ambition has already built it in our hearts”.⁵²³

description, agriculture, care of animals <...> // “All this is to be free. <...> The colleges of the day are big department stores, selling Latin and Greek and mathematics and so-called science at so much per month or year. There is no chance for the son of a poor person or even of one in comfortable circumstances. <...> We are assured of munificent contributions as soon as we can make our project understood. // “One gentleman, a railroad president, has already pledged himself to contribute 1,000 acres of land in Maryland. Other rich gifts are promised as soon as we are in working form. It is a gigantic undertaking, I know, but I believe that at no distant day we shall start with 500 students as a nucleus for the free college. We now have buildings in both Carolinas which may be used in a small way, but we are encouraged to think that we may make a beginning with more elaborate machinery.””.

522 *The Times* (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania) 15 Aug. 1901 p. 6

523 Tasset notes that Avellanus’ project is a desire of all proponents of Latin: “Multi nobiscum, terrarum multarum incolae, romano pariter ingenio cultuque praediti, in societatem cunctorum sermone latino utentium per totum orbem uno regimine confirmandam votis cogitatisque conspirant. Sic *Tusculan[e]um* Philadelphiae, artium romanarum collegium, re licet nondum stet, propter ipsam magnitudinem propositi, voluntate tamen nonnullorum iamdiu aedificari animis coepit.” (Tassetius 1902)

4 *Living Latin* between the World Wars (1914-1945)

4.1 Introduction

For the *Living Latin* movement, the period between the two World Wars is a period of growth of multiple communicating national movements with various aims. The formal “universal” movement would only be founded after the Second World War, so this preceding period is often omitted or relegated to a footnote in recent treatments of the history of *Living Latin*.⁵²⁴ However, this period already contains most of the components the later *Living Latin* movement would incorporate, for example: formal organisations with the explicit aim of promoting the usage of Latin, periodicals published in Latin, lexicographical efforts to provide modern extensions for the language, radio broadcasts. Even international congresses were planned.⁵²⁵ This phenomenon was already recognised as a movement in contemporary writings,⁵²⁶ even if the “Living Latin” label for this phenomenon would only later become applied consistently.⁵²⁷

In this chapter I present the context, motivation and relevance of *Living Latin* to this historical period and then I give a brief history of these efforts, concentrating on the only case when the use of Latin was being promoted and financed by a state entity – Italy under the Fascist regime of Benito Mussolini. I concentrate on two directions, one of them represents the church and the other represents the state.

I do not treat the massive amounts of text, inscriptions, the prose and poetry of the occasional genre that were written at the time in Latin on the subjects relating to Fascism or generally the regime.⁵²⁸ I rather centre this perspective on the works of *Istituto di Studi Romani*,

524 For example, Licoppe (2014a) in his narrative skips from *Phœnix Latinus* (1890-1892) to the 1956 Avignon Congress for *Living Latin*, while Stroh (2001) and Stroh (2008) also give only a passing mention of the Interwar period journals. However, the recent comprehensive study Slednikov (2019a) does cover the Interwar period as an integral part of the history of the movement.

525 Second World War prevented the planned congress from happening. See page 169.

526 Lurz (1949); Lurz (1950); Lurz (1951); Lurz (1952) is a series of articles with a purpose to “demonstrate that there is a Latin movement going on” (Lurz (1949, 1): “Daß es eine Lateinbewegung gibt, wollen die Ausführungen der vorliegenden Arbeit erweisen”) and stating that “one can speak of a movement from the beginning of the 20th century” (Lurz (1949, 7): “Von einer Lateinbewegung kann seit dem Beginn des 20. Jahrhunderts gesprochen werden.”); Wagner (1941a) tells us that this movement started after the (First) World War, enlarged treatment in Wagner (1941b).

527 For example, for Lurz (1949) it is “the modern Latin movement” (*Die moderne Lateinbewegung*), for Wagner (1941a) it is “the Neo-Latin movement” (*neolatin mozgalom / Neolatinus qui dicitur motus*), while Schmied (1937) titles his speech “About the living Latin language” (*De viva lingua Latina*) and later the *Iuventus* journal would have a column “*Latium vivum*”.

528 Which are being collected by Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2022).

which under the leadership of Carlo Galassi Paluzzi (1893-1972) tried to coordinate a worldwide campaign of returning Latin to its role in international scientific communication.

I also look into the Latin movement centred around the Roman Catholic Church, which was quite separate from the state initiatives. I treat the works of Giuseppe Fornari (1868-1942), who edited the Latin periodical *Vox Urbis* (1898-1913) and later published *Alma Roma* (1914-1942), resulting in a huge corpus of 45 years of (almost) uninterrupted Latin publishing activity.

The connections between the individual parts of the Interwar *Living Latin* movement are very helpful to understand the interconnected whole. Therefore, I also treat a selection of movements for Latin in other countries that had their own Latin periodicals: the German movement is represented by *Societas Latina* in Munich with an eponymous Latin journal (1932-1944, 1947-1955) and the Hungarian movement by the journal *Iuventus* (1910-1919, 1926-1944) in Budapest. There are (at least?) two more Latin movements in Interwar Europe that should be taken in consideration: the Spanish movement by the Claretian missionary order in Cervera (Catalonia, Spain) and their periodicals *Candidatus Latinus* (1928-1930) and *Palaestra Latina* (1930-1936, 1939-1975); the Polish movement by the society *Societas linguae Latinae usui internationali adaptandae* (*Towarzystwo umiędzynarodowienia łaciny*) in Warsaw (1933-1939?) with the journal *Lygia* (1938-1939). In this chapter I mention them in a cursory manner, a more comprehensive survey is left for the future.⁵²⁹

In the beginning of the period surveyed, the 1910s, there were two⁵³⁰ notable Latin periodicals with their own Latin movements. In Rome since 1898 a culturally-minded journal *Vox Urbis* was being published until the end of 1913. It was closely aligned to the Vatican and the Roman Catholic Church, but was nominally independent. In 1910 the journal *Iuventus* was founded in Budapest by a Catholic teachers association and had secondary school students as its primary audience. Both of these movements survived through the whole Interwar period. *Vox Urbis* was continued from 1914 to 1942 under the name of *Alma Roma*, while *Iuventus*, except a several year break after the end of the First World War, continued from 1926 up to 1944.

⁵²⁹ There were several more Latin journals with educational purpose, but they were not as influential, being mostly confined to school use. In the USA the journal *Auxilium Latinum / Latin Aid*, meant to provide reading material for students and to prove Latin's suitability for today, was published since 1929 by Albert E. Warsley (1903-1976) until about 1960. Warsley (1939) presents the project. Surprisingly, the organisation *Association for Promotion of Study of Latin – National Latin Honor Society / Associatio ad promovendum studium Latinum*, founded in 1929, still exists and even has a website (<http://www.latin-society.org/>, consulted 23.9.2023). Beside publishing the journal, it provided a service for schools by organising standardised Latin exams. This journal was the most successful out of many other (mostly bilingual) Latin journals for schools which appeared at the time in the USA. Sacré (1988, 100) provides a substantial list of them.

⁵³⁰ There was also the periodical *Civis Romanus / Scriptor Latinus* published in Germany by Woldemar Lommatszsch (see footnote 249). from 1901 to 1917. However, it was a mostly individual affair and much smaller than these two big movements.

The end of the 1920s and the beginning of the 1930s witnessed an apparent shift in the Latin movement: the number of active Latin journals and movements increased, as did the number of initiatives. In 1928 the Claretian order in Spain started a Latin journal *Candidatus Latinus* for schools of their order; this movement with its journal, soon renamed as *Palaestra Latina*, went on until 1975. In 1931 the Vatican Radio was founded and immediately started to broadcast both general and science news in Latin.⁵³¹ In 1932 in Munich there appeared *Societas Latina*, a movement and a journal aiming to promote Latin as an international language; in the following year 1933 in Warsaw *Societas linguae Latinae usui internationali adaptandae* was founded, aiming to do what the name suggested. This sense of a possible renaissance of Latin was greatly aided by the initiatives promoted since 1932 by the *Institute of Roman Studies (Istituto di studi romani)* in Rome, when it seemed that Italy was officially going to assume the mantle of leading a global movement for reviving Latin as the international language of science.

4.2 Latin proposed to international organisations as the official international auxiliary language

After the First World War, the question of an international language was as acute as ever. The stalemate between French, German and English, that had caused in the end of the 19th century an explosion of artificial language movements and had subsequently contributed to the genesis of the early movement of Living Latin, was still present. One of the signs of this was the situation in the newly founded international organisations.

In the newly founded League of Nations, English immediately became the second official language, dislodging French from its traditional monopoly over diplomacy. In December 1920, as a sign that the Esperanto movement was strong at the time and maybe also that the (mostly minor) nations using languages other than English and French were not particularly enthusiastic about this duopoly, delegates of 11 nations⁵³² petitioned for Esperanto to be recommended to be included worldwide in school curricula as a possible international language.⁵³³ Eventually a report favourable

⁵³¹ *Alma Roma* Iul. 1931 Vol. XVIII No. VII pp. 109-112

⁵³² Initiated by Persia (Iran), where Edmond Privat (1889-1962), a prominent Swiss Esperantist, was a vice-delegate to the League of Nations.

⁵³³ Garvía (2015, 161-162): “A public discussion began in December 1920, when, following the undertakings of the Esperanto lobby in Geneva, the representatives of Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Czechoslovakia, Haiti, Italy, Japan, India, Persia, Poland, Rumania, and South Africa petitioned the General Assembly of the League to endorse Esperanto instruction in the schools of member states as an auxiliary, second language.”. The campaign has been described in detail by Lapenna, Lins and Carlevaro (1974, 748 ff.) in the chapter *The common language question in the international institutions (La demando de komuna lingvo antaŭ internaciaj institucioj)* and by Lins (2016, 47 ff.). Lurz (1949, 13-14), a historian of the Living Latin movement, also covers this. League of Nations (1922), titled *Esperanto as an International Auxiliary Language. Report of the General Secretariat of the League of*

to Esperanto was produced, which also explicitly rejected Latin, insisting that the classical form of the language was not suitable for the international role and that grammatical simplification would need to happen (Peano's *Latino sine flexione* presented as an example), and acknowledging that such a change would not be popular among Latinists, so it was better to desist from Latin.⁵³⁴ In 1922 the final discussions of this initiative happened when it was transferred⁵³⁵ to the *Commission of International Intellectual Collaboration*. In the *Commission* the line of thought (historically characteristic to the Latin supporters) that *it is the learned and not the common people who need an international language* was present⁵³⁶ and some of the delegates were even supporting Latin for such a role,⁵³⁷ so it was felt necessary to include in the conclusions alongside the non-adoption of

Nations Adopted by the Third Assembly, 1922, <...> is the report compiled by the Secretariat of the League of Nations and presented for consideration.

- 534 League of Nations (1922, 8-9): "From this point of view, it is evident that some of the languages proposed, such as English and Latin, have great advantages, but their drawbacks are obvious. <...> // Latin has at least the advantage of being a neutral language from a political if not from a religious point of view, but it is difficult to learn, and is therefore not very accessible to the masses; its vocabulary, too, has long ceased to meet the needs of modern life. To restore its practical role as an international language, in which it was formerly so useful, it would be necessary arbitrarily to revise its vocabulary and to simplify its grammar.¹ Many admirers of the language of Cicero would prefer in that case that an artificial language should be chosen and classical Latin be left untouched. <...> ¹ Professor Peano has published a remarkable study of *Latino sine flexione*."
- 535 Lins (2016, 58): "At the Third Assembly in the autumn of 1922, the Fifth Commission studied this favorable report. The British Hellenist, Gilbert Murray, representing South Africa, was among those expressing sympathy for Esperanto. But the French delegate, Georges Reynald, declared that he had received instructions to oppose any world language other than French. While Reynaud's (*sic*) arguments were relatively moderate, the Brazilian delegate, Raul do Rio Branco, in an extended speech, which he afterwards had printed and distributed privately, inserted into the discussion ideological accusations of the crudest kind. He condemned Esperanto as a 'language of derelicts and communists, without traditions, without literature, without intellectual value', and asserted that in Brazil Esperanto was taught only in Sergipe, 'the least civilized' state in his country. // After three days of discussion a compromise solution was achieved. The report was officially approved as a League document, but with the fifth part, containing conclusions and recommendations, deleted. The question of teaching the language in schools was transferred to the Commission for International Intellectual Collaboration."; Lapenna, Lins and Carlevaro (1974, 754-755); Garvía (2015, 162-163): "In 1922, the League of Nations had completed the research. The report, Esperanto as an International Auxiliary Language, was very positive. Although approved by the General Assembly, it recommended further discussion on the Esperantists' main petition to introduce Esperanto the school curricula. But eventually the French delegate was able to kill the debate by transferring the discussion to the Committee on Intellectual Cooperation, which, instead of Esperanto, recommended the study of national languages."
- 536 Lins (2016, 59-60): "The degree to which the problem extended beyond the framework of linguistic discussion was alluded to – more elegantly than by Rio Branco – by the Frenchman, Julien Luchaire, who was (under Bérard) general inspector of public instruction. He contested the assumption that there was even a need for an international means of communication among 'non-intellectuals', given that (as he put it) the mass of the people in the various countries came into contact with one another through their 'leaders' and through translation. By this logic, then, international contacts should remain a monopoly of a chosen few, and it was inadvisable to open the door to worldwide relations among the lower classes through the easily learned means of communication known as Esperanto."
- 537 Lins (2016, 59): "Before such a Commission, the supporters of Esperanto accordingly found themselves in a hopeless position, facing political pressure from France and the prejudices of intellectuals. The chairman, the French philosopher Henri Bergson, privately assured Privat of his sympathy, but he was obliged to subordinate his personal opinion to the instructions that he received from Paris. Esperanto's chief opponent turned out to be the Swiss member Gonzague de Reynold, professor of history and French literature at the Universities of Berne and Fribourg. Although he focused his public criticism on the linguistic inadequacy of Esperanto and argued for the Latin language 'familiar to Catholics and intellectuals', he was evidently more disturbed by the fact that – as he wrote privately – 'behind Esperanto or Ido lurks an internationalist and revolutionary mysticism'". See also Lurz (1949, 13-14).

Esperanto the one of Latin as well. The rejection was a political compromise – the report favourable to Esperanto was formally approved, but with its sections of conclusions and recommendations deleted, rendering its legal force null. In the follow-up meeting in 1923, a new recommendation was provided for an eventual examination of the merits of both languages for the role of an auxiliary language; regarding Latin, a commission should be set up to see “whether it would still be possible to use Latin as an auxiliary language, the progress achieved in the knowledge of Latin in the last twenty-five years being taken into account”.⁵³⁸ This, combined with the fact that the League of Nations during the same time period would also receive correspondence and petitions for Latin,⁵³⁹ can probably be called a small campaign for Latin as an official international auxiliary language waged in the sidelines of the much larger one for Esperanto and some other artificial languages.

This international Latin used to surface as a proposal in international organisations even of unexpected fields. The International Police Congress, celebrated in Vienna in 1923, from which congress the modern-day Interpol arose, had as one of its themes “the introduction of an international language for police”. It seems to have presented a very similar picture to the contemporary situation in the League of Nations: the Esperanto lobby was very clearly present (represented even by a union of Esperantist policemen recently formed in Vienna),⁵⁴⁰ and, as reported,⁵⁴¹ the adoption of Latin was proposed by the Vienna Police President Oskar Dressler, but these suggestions were rejected and the usual languages adopted (English, French, German, Italian). Similarly as in the League of Nations, the resolutions of the congress contained no decisions on the question of the suitability of Esperanto and this question was relegated to a footnote for further consideration,⁵⁴² while Latin was altogether omitted.

538 In the discussions the following year (1923), France tried to push for a complete rejection of Esperanto (Lapenna, Lins and Carlevaro (1974, 758)). United Nations Archives in Geneva, reference code R1048/13C/29913/23516: “League Of Nations. C.I.C.I. 56. Geneva, July 20th, 1923. Committee on Intellectual Cooperation. Resolutions. <...> 8. as regards this classical language [Latin], it would be glad if a Committee of specialists were set up in order to consider, with a view to completing the examination of the various aspects of an auxiliary language, whether it would still be possible to use Latin as an auxiliary language, the progress achieved in the knowledge of Latin in the last twenty-five years being taken into account.”. These and other cited documents are available in the United Nations online archive (<https://archives.ungeneva.org>).

539 United Nations Archives in Geneva, reference code R1049/13C/38006/23516 provides a report made in 1922 by the Committee on the International auxiliary language of the International Research Council. It includes two petitions for Latin formulated in 1921-1922: one by the American Philological Association and another by the “Institute of International Education of the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace”. One of the signatories was Roland G. Kent (1877-1952), professor of Indo-European linguistics in the University of Pennsylvania, who also published an article (Kent 1922) proposing Latin as the international language. Classicists were on both sides of the divide in this debate – as seen above (footnote 535), the Hellenist Gilbert Murray was one of the proponents of Esperanto.

540 *Polizei-Esperanto-Verein* was founded in Vienna in 1922 and later expanded to other countries (Sabitzer 2014). This fits an existing pattern: the Esperanto movement consisted of many separate organisations with different views and purposes. There were associations of the blind, communists, Catholics, vegetarians, etc.

541 Lurz (1949, 14)

542 *Beschlüsse des Internationalen Polizeikongresses in Wien. (3.–7. September 1923)* (<https://www.interpol.int/content/download/5667/file/1923-Resolutions.pdf>, consulted 16.08.2022)

The international language question was often raised in the international bodies, but any decisions resulting in endorsements of Esperanto or of some other solution were few and far in between; this question would almost always be postponed to an indefinite future. The early 1920s were the years when Esperanto had the most real chances to get endorsed by the League of Nations at some level – much of the non-endorsement (and the subsequent celebration of very minor victories) came from a strong resistance by the major nations, most prominently France.⁵⁴³ If Latin would have miraculously managed to progress in these debates as far as Esperanto had, then it too would have had to face the same barrier to adoption consisting of the self-interest of the great nations and their languages. This internationalism was destined to fail in a world with increasingly overwhelming nationalist interests.⁵⁴⁴

These initiatives, even if they ultimately were not successful, show several things about this time period. The years immediately after the First World War saw the founding of numerous international organisations and the general presence of a belief in international cooperation, a feeling that a new world order is being created. This feeling implied that international organisations and cooperation would and should be able to solve problems that formerly used to be defined only by the political will of sovereign nations. Esperanto sensed an opportunity to be included in this new order and suggested itself as a viable intermediary of all this cooperation: after all, if the declared ideals do correspond to reality and every nation is indeed equal, why not a truly neutral language be chosen rather than affirming the *status quo*, the monopoly of English or French? As the examples show, Latin was still somewhere in the subconsciousness of the society and it used to appear wherever Esperanto would be, for example, proposed as an official language. It basically offered a more conservative answer to the same international language question: the arguments for it were usually based on historical precedent of Early Modern Europe, its continued usage in sciences (even when Latin was often just a word root mine for terminology), greatness of cultural tradition and, most importantly, it did not have the perceived artificiality of Esperanto.

⁵⁴³ See footnotes 535 and 537. Also see the medial phase of this 1920-1922 debate as described by Garvía (2015, 162): “Undaunted, the Esperantists brought more pressure, and in September 1921, eleven representatives of the Committee on the Agenda of the League voted to request that the secretary general call for research on the status and prospects of Esperanto. Only the French representative on the Committee, Gabriel Hanotaux, voted against. // The possibility that the Esperantists might prevail was real, or at least this is what Hanotaux and his government thought. Thus, while research on the qualities and prospects of Esperanto was being conducted, the French Minister of Public Instruction Léon Bérard issued a directive to forbid the teaching of Esperanto in public schools. But Bérard’s directive was not only addressed to French public opinion. Widely reproduced in the international press, it was intended to alert all nations to a common danger: the danger of the dissolution of the sacred link between language and nation.”.

⁵⁴⁴ See Lins (2016, 61-62).

4.3 The Italian movement for Latin

Ever since the dawn of the Renaissance, the Alps were seen as a fundamental dividing line of culture; the so-called Transalpine Europe (everything north of the Alps) was perceived as a late-comer to the Humanist movement that started in Italy. For the Latin tradition Italy has always been a special case. It is no wonder that also in the time period now examined the Italian movement for Latin is highly distinct and thus has to be classified as a special self-contained tradition. There are at least two factors. First of all, Italy is home to Vatican, the seat of the Roman Catholic Church using Latin as its official language, so the ecclesiastical element has been strong both as an institution promoting Latin, and as a popular conception of Latin as the language of the Church. Secondly, Italy is the geographical heir to the Roman empire, its heritage is everywhere and Latin is not just a language of ancient culture, but also a core part of Italian identity. Ever since the Renaissance, the Italians have traditionally been convinced that they are the true heirs of Rome and Latin language, often claiming that the present day Rome is (or should be) the rightful centre of Latin even today. The Latin tradition has been evolving there through centuries relatively independently, with less attention being paid to the outside world beyond their symbolic mountain range.

4.3.1 Latin and the Fascist state

During the Interwar period, the position of Latin was strengthened through several education reforms and it later did not retreat, as elsewhere, in the 1960s – it is still very much in Italian secondary education system in a way rarely seen elsewhere.⁵⁴⁵ Latin formed an extensive part in the Italian culture: for example, in contrast to other countries the Neo-Latin poetry tradition was still quite lively in the first half of the 20th century.⁵⁴⁶ Since Latin did form such a notable presence, it is quite natural that the rhetoric for the revival of Latin was not as relevant as the rhetoric to keep the existing Latin tradition and to excel in it. In this environment where cultural arguments for Latin have always held sway, the “Living Latin” ideology of “practical and simple Latin” to be used as the international language became transformed in the Italian context to a matter of national pride and cultural soft power.

The ideology of Fascism was founded on the notion of modernity, on action and on the future; the past for it was not something valuable in itself. Mussolini himself knew only rather basic

⁵⁴⁵ Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016a, 5) mentions the reforms. Waquet (2001, 29) compares the situations between the countries and observes that the decline of Latin was modulated by political factors and notes the case of Italy: “In fascist Italy, by contrast, the idealization of Roman-ness led to a wave of what can only be called pan-Latinism in the schools (which incidentally outlived the Mussolini régime).”. Bruni (2005) describes the reforms, Calderini (1966) covers the post-WW2 years, Maronese (2019) gives a brief survey of both periods.

⁵⁴⁶ Sacré (2020b, 14)

Latin,⁵⁴⁷ he did not use to visit any museums at all,⁵⁴⁸ he barely ever referenced ancient Roman remains.⁵⁴⁹ However, the Ancient Rome for Mussolini is an idea of greatness, a call to action to become as great in all aspects as the Romans were and to surpass them; in this way Mussolini filters and simplifies the past and with the content removed it is reduced to a “highly abstract feeling” that could mobilise the masses.⁵⁵⁰ The past for Mussolini and generally the Fascist movement is only an example for the future.⁵⁵¹ So the incoming Fascist regime doubtlessly exalted Rome as a symbol, but there was a tension between the future and the past in its ideology, as fundamentally only the future mattered. The past mattered only if it provided an example of subjectively perceived greatness. This can be illustrated by the approach Mussolini took to the urban planning of Rome, where many buildings in the historical centre were torn down as not valuable in order to “liberate” and exemplify only the most impressive ruins from the Roman era, decorations which in turn became tools of propaganda to glorify Mussolini’s Rome and the man himself.

This preoccupation with the future and practicality rather than with maintaining the tradition and heritage was clear when Mussolini came to power in 1922. Immediately, concerns arose about the new government’s plans to substitute modern and practical subjects for Greek and Latin in secondary school curricula.⁵⁵² The tension was clear. However, it turned out that soon the contrary thing happened: Fascism evolved to ever more increasingly embrace Latin in education and to increase its availability. Already in the next year (1923) the new minister of education, the prominent philosopher Giovanni Gentile (1875-1944) introduced a reform of the secondary school system. While Latin had always been the staple of *Liceo classico*, the *Liceo scientifico*, a new type of school which had been established in 1906, used to have no Latin in its curriculum; now the *riforma Gentile* introduced Latin to the *Liceo scientifico* with a similar number of weekly hours as

547 Lamers (2022) and Nelis (2007, 397) report that Mussolini learned some Latin through several cycles of private classes he took from 1901 to 1910 (age 18 to 27).

548 Arthurs (2012, 33): “In early 1923, Mussolini boasted – to the delight of Marinetti – that he had “only visited a museum twice at most””.

549 Nelis (2007, 412): “When talking about archaeology, Mussolini nearly always referred to the city of Rome. Aside from a text on Herculaneum and the Roman ships in Lake Nemi (in O.O. 22:341-45), there does not appear to be any evidence for Mussolini’s “love” for ancient Rome and its remains. He clearly appreciated its vestiges, but saw them above all as symbols of eternal values and as scenery for his regime, not as something in itself”.

550 Nelis (2007, 402): “At this Birthday of Rome, in 1922, Mussolini delivered one of his most famous and cited speeches, entitled “Passato e avvenire” (“Past and Future”). Here he presents a Fascist ancient Rome, an idea rather than a past, a Rome stripped of most of its content, a highly abstract feeling rather than a “history”: Rome is our point of departure and reference; it is our symbol or, if you wish, our myth. We dream of a Roman Italy, that is wise and strong, disciplined and imperial. Much of what was the immortal spirit of Rome, resurges in Fascism: Roman is the Lictor, Roman is our organization of combat, Roman is our pride and courage: *Civis Romanus sum*.”.

551 Nelis (2007, 409): “Fascism did not preach a return to the past; the past – in a filtered, simplified form – was an example for the future, but it was always the future that was at the heart of Mussolini’s concern.”

552 Arthurs (2012, 33): “If anything, early Fascism was hostile to the academic study of the past – as seen by its association with Futurism. Less than a month after Mussolini’s accession to power, the Vatican newspaper *L’Osservatore Romano* noted with dismay the new government’s plans to “combat the old Italian malady of rhetoric and literature” by substituting technical training and modern languages for Latin and Greek in secondary-school curricula.”.

in the *Liceo classico*. The next major reform by Giuseppe Bottai in 1939, even if it was presented as a radical reform introducing practical subjects to the school system, actually further increased the reach of Latin by unifying the different curricula of lower classes of secondary school to a single *scuola media unica* – once again, the students who had avoided Latin by choosing a technical path, after the new reform had to learn Latin.⁵⁵³ During the *ventennio fascista* the percentage of secondary school students who learned Latin only increased.

And, most interestingly for the present study, on 7th May 1936 king Victor Emmanuel III signed a royal decree prepared by the Ministry of National Education (then headed by Cesare Maria De Vecchi) renewing curricula and timetables for secondary schools. The “general instructions for teaching” introduced a requirement (!) to teach Latin through *the use of Latin* as a living language – the traditional translation from Latin to Italian was still permitted, but it *could not be the only way to teach the language*, the students from the very beginning needed to be taught to express themselves directly by speaking and writing Latin.⁵⁵⁴ As a result of this official endorsement, in the immediate pre-war years in Italy (1936-1940) many books were published for school use with Latin reading and speaking material, often filled with vocabulary for modern topics.

Heralded by some as a renewal of the old humanist (as opposed to philological?) traditions of teaching Latin,⁵⁵⁵ this requirement contributed to a veritable Fascist appropriation of the language. Among the usual Latin reading material of classicising themes, some very modern and not infrequently explicitly Fascist topics were treated. For example, in a book published in 1937 pupils could read admiring texts about the most recent Italian invasion of Ethiopia (1935-1937).⁵⁵⁶ In various examples of formative propaganda it is easy to find various praises or even hagiographies of Mussolini.⁵⁵⁷ Latin vocabularies of modern expressions were developed and published either

553 Cassese (1971): “Ma punto principale fu la scuola media unica – ove era conservato l’insegnamento del latino – risultante dalla fusione dei corsi inferiori ginnasiale, magistrale e tecnico”. See also Bruni (2005).

554 This fact is pointed out by Sacré (2019a, 3) and Sacré (2020b, 28); also by Miraglia (2009, 282); Maronese (2019). The text of the decree *Approvazione degli orari e programmi per le scuole medie d’istruzione classica, scientifica, magistrale e tecnica* (it is available in <https://www.gazzettaufficiale.it/eli/id/1936/05/09/036U0762/sg>, consulted 24.9.2023) is cited in various Latin materials of these years, such as Pasquetti ([1936], 5): “Così è prescritto nei nuovi Programmi pubblicati con R. D. del 7 maggio 1936-XIV: «nello studio del latino gli alunni debbono essere educati fin dalle prime classi all’uso diretto della lingua sia come espressione orale sia come espressione scritta. La versione dall’italiano è quindi una delle forme di esercitazione, ma non la sola. Anche dai primi passi, con opportuni spunti di conversazione, con risposte a domande su letture fatte, con piccoli riassunti, con brevi composizioni, gli alunni debbono essere indirizzati per mezzo di esercizi e anche dell’espressione diretta in latino a raggiungere la padronanza della lingua indispensabile alla piena conoscenza dei classici.”

555 The Catholic journal *Civiltà Cattolica* (10 July 1936 p. 117) was enthusiastic about these changes, believing that they herald a humanistic renewal of the schools: “Il primato del latino nel ginnasio non potrà avere tutta la sua efficacia in ordine all’unità didattica, se non vi si adopera un buon metodo, qual è quello dell’antica scuola umanistica, come diremo più innanzi. Siamo perciò lieti di trovare nei nuovi programmi [...] Queste norme, di non difficile attuazione, se verranno osservate, susciteranno un fecondo rinnovamento umanistico almeno nel ginnasio. Così si potesse restaurare nel liceo lo studio della vera filosofia secondo il metodo scolastico!...”

556 Balboni and Neri (1937). Cf. Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016a, 14)

557 Sacré (2019a) provides a survey of many such *colloquia scholastica* written during the 20 years of Fascism. Footnote 32 in page 8 provides a story published in some Latin reader of Fascist culture (sic!) (*Epitome di cultura*

attached to the same books or separately.⁵⁵⁸ It would not have been possible to write Fascist propaganda in Latin without them.

It would be fascinating to know what motives determined the official endorsement and requirement of the active use of Latin in schools. Was it an explicit desire to “fascistise” (*fascistizzare*) Latin, to make it a real Fascist language? To provide an additional Fascist relevance to the language, making it a tool of propaganda with a Roman dignity? Or was it just a desire to reconnect with the old humanist tradition? Or maybe a wish to make the Latin a more practical language? We do not know. But it is not surprising that when such a decree (even if it hypothetically could originally have been neutrally intentioned and motivated purely by the love for Latin) was introduced to a totalitarian or at least an authoritarian society with a cult of party and personality, it inevitably provided an additional space, an additional instrument and medium for propaganda. We do not know if there were explicit instructions to provide Fascist propaganda in Latin. It is unlikely, as Mussolini’s regime tended to use indirect methods in courting the academia⁵⁵⁹ – so maybe the funding agencies (ministries and the like), instead of following explicitly written down rules, were simply more favourably disposed to support books providing material for the new Latin curriculum if they contained some explicit praise of the regime, but the rules were not explicitly written down.

It is interesting that quite many of these Latin readers and other didactic material for schools were named Living Latin (*Latino Vivente*) or similarly,⁵⁶⁰ they utilised the imagery of vividness and aliveness in their prefaces.⁵⁶¹ “Latin has the right to be treated like our own language, a national language, a living language”.⁵⁶² The Fascist regime of Mussolini appropriated Latin as a symbol and infused it with life just like every other impressive Roman relic. This kind of aliveness of Latin can also be connected with the Fascist conception of *Romanità*, when the Roman past is also the present and the future.

So Latin is a strange case of an apparently neutral international language which was in fact tied to nationalist interests and consequently the strongly nationalist context of Benito Mussolini’s Fascist regime shaped the fortunes of Latin. During the first years the regime tended to be more modern, but in its latter years it increasingly utilised the Roman imagery. In the beginning the regime had anticlerical tendencies and did not emphasise Rome’s Christian heritage at all, but when in 1929 the Lateran treaty with the Roman Catholic Church was signed and the Vatican state

fascista), where Mussolini embraced people in streets who were crying from joy (!).

558 Bini (1940), Cognasso (1936a), Cognasso (1936b) – the list can go on.

559 Arthurs (2012, 32)

560 E.g., Levi and Bini (1937) – *Il latino come lingua viva*, Bini (1940) – *L’uso vivo della lingua latina*, Bernini (1937) – *Latino vivente*.

561 Pasquetti ([1936]), Levi and Bini (1937)

562 Pasquetti ([1936], 8): “l’insegnamento come di lingua, che, a parità dell’italiano, ha il diritto di essere trattata come lingua nostra, lingua nazionale, lingua viva”.

founded, the resulting public reconciliation with the Church integrated also the heritage of the Church into the regime's public ideology. In the 1930s, when the Italian empire was proclaimed and Mussolini was being presented as the new Augustus, the Classical imagery became even more prominent in the state propaganda. And so, along with all this evolving cult of Rome (Roman-ness, *Romanità*), Latin formed an increasingly important part of the regime's symbolism, its presence visibly growing in Fascist Rome in the form of epigraphy, imagery and, finally, education.

4.3.2 *Istituto di Studi Romani*

One of the main actors in promoting the rebirth of Latin as a modern and international language of science was the Institute of Roman Studies (*Istituto di Studi Romani*). Founded in 1922, it was an important actor in Italian cultural politics, promoting a variant of *Romanità* based on the cultural synthesis of Classical, Christian and modern Rome that would be accessible to everyone, not just academical specialists. In 1932 Carlo Galassi Paluzzi, the founder and leader of this Institute, announced that the Institute of Roman Studies was starting a national and worldwide campaign to renew *the study and use* of Latin, which would, with the support of all the Italian resources, modernise the language to make it fit for modern scientific usage and would lobby it to be adopted worldwide as an international auxiliary language.

4.3.2.1 Carlo Galassi Paluzzi and the *Institute of Roman Studies* (*Istituto di Studi Romani*)

Carlo Galassi Paluzzi (1893-1972) and his main creations – the journal *Roma* (1922-1944) and the *Institute of Roman Studies* (*Istituto di Studi Romani*, 1925-) – played a notable role in the Interwar Italy, providing an expression of the Roman-ness / *Romanità* so prevalent both in the nationalism of united Italy since the *Risorgimento* and in the Fascist ideology. As such, they have been studied in depth in context of the Fascist times and many aspects have already been considered and discussed – whether *Institute of Roman Studies* was an integral part of the Fascist regime or not; how closely its *Romanità* aligned with the Italian state ideology and the Catholic Church; what role it played in the more general field of Fascist cultural politics.⁵⁶³ The initiatives of Galassi Paluzzi

⁵⁶³ Biographies of Carlo Galassi Paluzzi include Romanelli and Mora (1972), Mora (1973) and Coccia (2000). Dedicated studies of the activities of the *Institute of Roman Studies* include Visser (2006), Arthurs (2012, 29-49), Aramini (2015a), Nelis (2010), Aramini (2015b). The activities of the Institute are mentioned (Canfora (1980a,b); Nelis (2014)) and outlined in more general studies of *Romanità* (Visser (1992), Nelis (2007), Nelis (2018)), of Fascist Latin literature and epigraphy (Bettegazzi, Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2019), Lamers (2017), Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016a), Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016b, 16-21), Lamers, Reitz-Joosse and Sanzotta (2020, 133-134)), of the history of Latin teaching in Italy (Calderini (1966)).

and his Institute regarding the revival of Latin as an international language deserve a comprehensive treatment.

Throughout his life, Carlo Galassi Paluzzi was characterised by his broad view of Rome – for him it encompassed past, present and future, both the Pagan and Christian heritage of Rome – and his managerial skills, complemented with an ever-present zeal for organising new initiatives. Having born in 1893 in a noble family in Naples, he started his studies in the Faculty of Letters in the University of Rome, but never graduated.⁵⁶⁴ Instead, he led an active social life and immediately involved himself in cultural activities. In 1920-1922 he was already publishing on museum organisation and art (often in a bibliographical vein) both independently and in the conservative Catholic newspaper *Il Corriere d'Italia*.⁵⁶⁵ Then, having organised a group of scholars, he founded the journal *Roma* (“a journal of Roman studies and life” – *rivista di studi e di vita romana*) in the end of 1922, in the days following the March of Rome, Mussolini’s ascent to power. Its first issue was printed in January 1923 and Galassi Paluzzi was the main editor. As the preface stated, the subject of the journal was Rome in all of its aspects – “in every facet of its life, its history, its memories and modern affairs”; it continued that the relics of Rome’s monumental past should not be only noble memories and marvellous decorations, but should rather figure in our daily lives “as elements of productive activity, a ferment for our spiritual and material industriousness”.⁵⁶⁶ “Here [in Rome] truly the past and the present come together and intertwine, and the present draws from the past strength and courage for living.”⁵⁶⁷

In 1925 this group of scholars, centred around the periodical *Roma*, was reformed into the Institute of Roman Studies (*Istituto di Studi Romani*) which was officially recognised by the Ministry of Public Instruction in the following year.⁵⁶⁸ According to its charter, the aim was “to promote and support studies with *Romanità* as their subject” and to contribute to solving various problems concerning the city of Rome.⁵⁶⁹ In doing so, the charter continues, it would also “awake Italians’ ‘historical sense of the function Rome had in the unfolding of the civilization across the

⁵⁶⁴ Coccia (2000, 9-10)

⁵⁶⁵ Coccia (2000, 10; 27); Arthurs (2012, 30)

⁵⁶⁶ *Roma* 1923 Vol. I No. 1 p. 1: “Col porre in testa a questa rivista semplicemente il nome di Roma nella sua solenne brevità abbiamo voluto significare che ci proponiamo di illustrare la nostra città, per quanto lo comporta la modestia delle nostre forze, in tutte le manifestazioni della sua vita, nella sua storia, nelle sue memorie e nei suoi interessi moderni. <...> Nè ci si deve meravigliare se del programma noi accostiamo le memorie storiche e le questioni artistiche ai problemi economici, chè se il considerare questi vari elementi di vita organicamente come indissociabili è una verità ovunque, questa indissociabilità deve essere assoluta, qui, dove la storia e l’arte non possono e non debbono essere solamente nobili ricordi e maravigliose <sic> decorazioni, ma occorre che entrino di continuo nella vita nostra d’ogni giorno, come elementi di attività fruttifera e come lievito di operosità spirituale e materiale. // Qui veramente il passato e il presente s’accostano e s’intrecciano, e questo trae da quello forza e coraggio per vivere.” Translation cited taken from Arthurs (2012, 29)

⁵⁶⁷ *Ibid.*

⁵⁶⁸ Arthurs (2012, 30); Nelis (2010, 370)

⁵⁶⁹ Arthurs (2012, 30)

world’ ”.⁵⁷⁰ Encouraging academic study of Rome and informing the general public about all aspects of it from Antiquity to (eventually Fascist) present by publishing the periodical *Roma* and by giving courses for the wider public (*Corsi Superiori di Studi Romani* opened already in 1926) were the primary goals of the institution. This goal remained substantially the same through all the expansion and developments of the Institute during the *Ventennio Fascista*.

It is hard to unequivocally pinpoint the ideology of the *Institute of Roman Studies* in the context of the political situation in Fascist Italy. On the one hand, it is clear that its emphasis on the ideology of *Romanità*, the myth of Rome, was affine to the ideology the Fascist regime espoused and used to mobilise the population. However, it is also clear that “the ISR never became the regime’s official organ for the promulgation of *Romanità*”⁵⁷¹ and was not fully dependent from the state. Only from 1933 it would get regular funding from the state, receiving an annual contribution,⁵⁷² and only in 1937 it would be allowed to have the *fasces* in its ensign.⁵⁷³ Even though the regime would instrumentalise the activities of the *Institute* for its own goals (so, for example, the Institute’s celebration of the bimillenary of Augustus contributed to the celebration of Mussolini as the new Augustus), often it would be that Galassi Paluzzi himself would take the initiative and seek authorities’ approval for his own ideas,⁵⁷⁴ and not the other way round by just executing top-down instructions. So it was a quite independent, a not fully state and a not fully private institution that was quite free to form its own goals, its own projects and then to try to get funding for them from various governmental and non-governmental bodies⁵⁷⁵ – ranging from Mussolini himself and various government ministers to private entities.⁵⁷⁶

On the other hand, Carlo Galassi Paluzzi and his Institute were active actors in the Fascist state. As he himself later noted, “the institute was ‘a typical expression of the atmosphere created by the Regime, whose main source of inspiration is the Roman spirit’ ”⁵⁷⁷. The Institute was working in the context of the Fascist regime and actively initiated projects which would be supported by it, and the dissemination of the Institute’s vision of *Romanità* was doubtlessly useful for the state. The Institute was particularly valuable to the Fascist regime precisely because of the elements of its ideology that were outside mere nationalism and fascism. While regime’s conception of the

570 Aramini (2015a, 192)

571 Arthurs (2012, 31)

572 This date is given by Arthurs (2012, 31), citing an official report by Carlo Galassi Paluzzi, while Aramini (2015a, 193) reports 1927 as the first year of funding, citing the *ISR* archive. Later the financing grew together with the Institute and during the WW2 years reached its peak.

573 Arthurs (2012, 31)

574 This observation is by Nelis (2010, 374). The petitions not always were successful: Arthurs (2012, 31).

575 Nelis (2010, 374-375)

576 For example, Galassi Paluzzi (1936, 54) gives the list of various professional organisations which are contributing financially to the making of dictionaries of Latin terminology of their own professional fields.

577 Arthurs (2012, 32). The quote is from 1934.

Romanità was primarily secular, based on the greatness of classical pagan Rome, and ignored the Catholic Church heritage (to the dismay of Catholics), Galassi Paluzzi, a devoted Catholic, continuously emphasised the dual nature of Rome – it being both pagan and Christian.⁵⁷⁸ Therefore, his Institute proved to be an important bridge between the regime and Catholicism, especially when after the rapprochement through the Lateran accords of 1929 the regime massively introduced Catholic elements to its national ideology.⁵⁷⁹ This mediating position of the Institute, helping the Church and the State to mutually influence each other, was useful for and obtained favour from both Mussolini and the Vatican.⁵⁸⁰ The Institute of Roman studies was a convergence point in many ways, and this consequently helped it to rapidly grow in size, resources and influence in the academia of Fascist Italy.

4.3.2.2 The conception of the project *for the renewal of the study and use of the Latin language*

In June 1932, Carlo Galassi Paluzzi published in *Roma* an article called *For the renewal of the study and use of the Latin language (Per il rifiorire dello studio e dell'uso della lingua latina)*,⁵⁸¹ starting his Institute's mission for the revival of Latin by presenting his personal views about the past, present and the desired future of Latin. This started a project in the *Institute of Roman Studies* that lasted to the end of the World War II with some of these elements lasting until today.

We can understand the motivation, the progress and the *modus operandi* of these activities from the series of articles about the subject that were continuously being published by Galassi Paluzzi,⁵⁸² from the official bulletin and other publications of the Institute⁵⁸³ and from the archival material preserved by the Institute itself.⁵⁸⁴ These actions and rhetoric were also followed by the Latin journals⁵⁸⁵ and generally the press.⁵⁸⁶

578 Nelis (2010, 372); Arthurs (2012, 46).

579 Aramini (2015a, 192-193)

580 Observation by Aramini (2015a, 209-211). The evolution of Carlo Galassi Paluzzi's personal position between the Church and the regime is further traced by Aramini (2015b), while Gentile (2015) explores how real was the reconciliation of the Mussolini and the Church after the Lateran agreements of 1929.

581 Galassi Paluzzi (1932)

582 Galassi Paluzzi (1932); Galassi Paluzzi (1933); Galassi Paluzzi (1934a,b); Galassi Paluzzi (1935a); Galassi Paluzzi (1936); Galassi Paluzzi (1938a,b); Galassi Paluzzi (1939a,b); Galassi Paluzzi (1940a,b); Galassi Paluzzi (1946)

583 The bulletin *Rassegna d'informazioni dell'Istituto di Studi Romani* was published from 1933 to 1946.

584 The most relevant sections of the archive of the *Istituto di Studi Romani* have been inventoried under the *serie Latino* (Lodolini Tupputi 1995a) and *serie Congressi Convegni Mostre, anni 1929-1999* (Lodolini Tupputi 2003). As part of this research, the following boxes from the *Latino* series were examined *in situ*: 1-8; 16; 21; 84-89.

585 For example, by the *Societas Latina* of Munich: Welz (1932); Societas Latina (1933a); Lurz (1935b); Societas Latina (1936); Societas Latina (1938). *Iuventus* and *Palaestra Latina* also regularly covered this subject.

586 For example, Galassi Paluzzi (1936, 59) gives the number of articles about Institute's Latin initiatives collected by the Institute from the Italian and foreign press: 704 (!).

In the title of his seminal article Carlo Galassi Paluzzi used the noun *rifiorire* (renewal, or, translated literally, “reflowering”), feeling the need to explicitly insist on this usage.⁵⁸⁷ One needs to “reflower” Latin rather than to revive it, as the latter would mean a certain preceding breakpoint or death, while Latin had never ceased to be “a living medium of expression and communication between the learned of all nations of the civilised world in both sacred and profane disciplines”. One has to renew the study and use of the Latin language “to an extent that it is possible and useful for today”.⁵⁸⁸

The stated primary goal is “to interpret the need always very much felt in the field of science” and to make Latin useful again worldwide as a scientific international language. Usefulness and feasibility are the primary criteria steering the motivational part of Galassi Paluzzi’s vision – the value of Latin for the intellectual, cultural and spiritual development, the “rebirth of the Latin mindset that is imperative for the salvation of the Western Civilisation” (a trope often used in the Fascist discourse, it seems) are “for us obvious and intuitive things”⁵⁸⁹ that do not need to be elaborated, a simple allusion to them suffices.

The project is introduced by the following principles. First of all, according to Galassi Paluzzi, the question of Latin as an international language and generally the question of the international language itself needs to be pruned sharply in order to make sense and to be feasible. He consistently (in all his articles on the subject)⁵⁹⁰ emphasises that he does not believe that any language can become spoken internationally by being imposed by a deliberate effort (a scientific congress deciding on the matter and the like), the only way languages have really reached this role was by “being imposed automatically by nations which had obtained imperial power”.⁵⁹¹

Latin is *not* hoped to become an international language in sense of being *spoken* everywhere (or even one of being actively used, it seems). This is judged to be an utopian premise. Latin should rather aim to be “a language universally *read* in a vast area but at the same time restricted to scientists, the learned, and the seriously cultured persons”.⁵⁹² Educated people (and especially

587 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 271): “Lo scopo che si vuol raggiungere è molto chiaramente espresso nel titolo: si tratta di promuovere il *rifiorire* (mi sia concesso insistere su questa parola) dello studio e dell’uso della lingua latina.”

588 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 271): “Non si tratta di creare dunque del nuovo; si tratta di far rifiorire – nell’ambito di quanto è realmente possibile ed utile ai giorni nostri – lo studio e l’uso di una lingua che (pur decaduta dall’alto seggio che la scienza e il sapere europei le attribuivano fino a ottant’anni fa) non ha mai cessato di essere un mezzo vivo di espressione e di comunicazione fra i dotti nelle discipline sacre e profane di tutte le nazioni del mondo civile.”

589 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 280): “Della somma utilità che la nostra azione può presentare per una rinascita della mentalità latina che si è resa necessaria per salvare addirittura la civiltà occidentale, sarebbe superfluo parlare, sia perchè *<sic>* per noi è cosa ovvia e intuitiva”

590 For instance, Galassi Paluzzi (1939a, 520); Galassi Paluzzi (1939b, 2).

591 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 273): “le lingue internazionalmente parlate sono state e sono quelle imposte automaticamente dai popoli che si affermano imperialmente”.

592 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 273): “Noi siamo qui in sede di *uso* della lingua latina; e finora, più o meno, appena si è parlato di questo argomento si è creduto subito di doverlo – ancora più che poterlo – confondere con quello della

scientists or scholars in most fields) are already more or less capable of understanding a simple fragment in Latin, but using the language actively is a wholly different thing: Galassi Paluzzi himself confesses that he does not feel able at all to hold a conversation in Latin, while writing even a poor summary of his own text in Latin would require a great effort from him. Nonetheless, he is able to read such summaries.⁵⁹³ So if one could provide a summary for each piece of scientific production (articles in scientific journals, conference proceedings) written in a very simple Latin,⁵⁹⁴ then they would be widely understood and this could greatly facilitate the international scientific communication.

If one starts from the fundamental error of Latin being a universally *spoken* language, then inevitably there arise unending and fruitless discussions about the proper ways of neologism formation, style, pronunciation, possible grammatical simplification. The wrongly set goal sets up a lot of barely surmountable (and wholly avoidable, if this goal would be avoided) problems and the whole project is doomed. It is the insistence on these things that was one of the main reasons why none of the initiatives aiming to renew the use of Latin succeeded up till now – because they wanted to give tasks to Latin that it could not solve.⁵⁹⁵ Here Galassi Paluzzi is referring to the futility of all of the endless discussions of the international language question and proposing his own solution which would solve this Gordian knot: it is enough for the language to be *recognisable* and *readable* for the educated audience, while the actual writing of the summaries in this international language, as will be seen below, could be left to the professionals.

Galassi Paluzzi also directs his ire towards the “philologism that has reigned during the last fifty years” and prevented the rebirth of the international use of Latin language. The professional “Latinists, who are believed to be the only ones having the right to competently discuss the problem” have been proposing the use of Ciceronian Latin while forgetting that a comprehensible and correct Latin had already been used on a vast scale. Other very learned philologists, who knew too much about linguistics, philology and philosophy, decided to burden others with the

lingua universale o internazionale che dir si voglia; in dipendenza di questo errore fondamentale si sono poi periodicamente iniziate delle interminabili e sterilissime discussioni sulla formazione dei neologismi, sulla limitazione delle flessioni, su lo stile da adottare, su la pronuncia da uniformare, su mille altri impossibili provvedimenti: tutti escogitati per fare del latino una lingua universalmente o internazionalmente *parlata*, e non già – come potrebbe e dovrebbe essere – una lingua universalmente *letta* nell’ambito vasto ma al tempo stesso ristretto degli scienziati, dei dotti, e delle persone seriamente colte”.

593 Galassi Paluzzi (1935a, 290): “E cade qui acconcia la sincera se anche dolorosa confessione del relatore il quale, pur avendo avuto l’onore di farsi promotore di un’azione per la rifiorire lo studio e l’uso della lingua latina, deve semplicemente confessare che, mentre più o meno è capace di leggere un sunto o un brano in lingua latina, non si sentirebbe minimamente capace di tenere una conversazione; e soltanto a gran pena, e certamente assai male, potrebbe scrivere il sunto di una sua relazione, a cominciare da quella che sta svolgendo.”

594 Carlo Galassi Paluzzi consistently names this kind of Latin *Muratorian* (*muratoriano*), referring to the Muratorian canon that was discovered by Ludovico Antonio Muratori (1672-1750), a fragmentary index of books in the proto-canonical New Testament, probably dating to the second century. It is noted for its very rough Latin.

595 See footnote 592.

“mechanisms they themselves had studied” and started creating hybrid artificial languages, thereby discrediting the initiative of the revival of Latin rather than helping it. The fascination with the international language question is palpable – later he even commenced writing a book on the international language question and the problem of Latin, becoming its historian.⁵⁹⁶

Galassi Paluzzi therefore proposes the following five actions *for the renewal of study and use of the Latin language*:⁵⁹⁷ 1) to obtain that in Italy all the articles published in important journals would be supplemented by Latin summaries; 2) that the same would be done with the international conference proceedings; 3) to achieve that all the foreign movements for the renewal of the use of Latin language (e.g., Polish, Hungarian, German, American)⁵⁹⁸ would be coordinated by an International Committee in Rome; 4) to organise Latin competitions promoting the use of Latin; 5) to compile specialised terminological vocabularies in Latin for various modern sciences. These five actions boil down to three directions: 1) the translation of scientific article summaries to Latin, using the specialised dictionaries as a guide; 2) the coordination of the worldwide movement for the revival of Latin language; 3) competitions of Latin prose (and, as it was hoped, of conversation).⁵⁹⁹

By concentrating his rhetoric on the translation of summaries of scholarly production, Galassi Paluzzi is imagining this to be a task that can be commenced immediately, and moreover to have the best cost-to-benefit ratio. It is an action that “could, with the least effort, with almost no effort from the scholar himself (everyone who is in humanities, and many of those who are in the exact sciences more or less know to read Latin), enable the scholars themselves to remain connected to the scientific current of everything that is serious and worthy to read in their own disciplines”.⁶⁰⁰ He is also clear that this is has to be a methodical effort throughout many years “in order to have a

⁵⁹⁶ Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 274-275). Galassi Paluzzi in this article gave a historical overview both of artificial Latin-based languages and of various Latin revival efforts. He was so interested in this topic that he even intended to publish a book volume about this. Galassi Paluzzi (1939b, 3) outlines the contents (“In uno studio che, nelle sue linee essenziali, ho avuto occasione di esporre in una conferenza, e che mi accingo a pubblicare in volume, dimostrerò come una delle più serie cause del progressivo scadimento dello studio e dell’uso del latino vada ricercata nella mentalità utopisticamente universalistica dei filologi e glottologi del secolo scorso, e dei latinisti che non comprendevano nè l’ufficio nobilissimo che insostituibilmente il latino poteva ancora esercitare, nè i limiti che non bisognava varcare sotto pena di cadere nel ridicolo e di condannare all’insuccesso anche ciò che si poteva realizzare.”); Coccia (2000, 16; 25) gives the title of the preparatory book material preserved in the private archives of Carlo Galasso Paluzzi: *Il latino e la lingua internazionale (150 anni di storia)*. This manuscript fits in with the other histories of the Living Latin movement and of the international language question. The manuscript is currently in the Institute’s historical archive– the inventory (Istituto Nazionale di Studi Romani 2023, 24-26) even provides the titles of the chapters.

⁵⁹⁷ Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 277-278)

⁵⁹⁸ Zielinski (1939); Wagner (1939a); Wagner (1939b); Lurz (1939); Warsley (1939).

⁵⁹⁹ This competition of Latin prose (with poetry added in 1980 after the demise of *Certamen Hoeufftianum*) continued after the Second World War (1947, 1949) and, after being lightly reformed in 1950 (for example, the competition became open to foreign contestants) and renamed to *Certamen Capitolinum* it is still being organised by the same Institute up to this day, making it the only initiative from the *rifiorire* programme still surviving. Sacré (2019b) surveys the 1934-1949 contest and notes (p. 8) that while in 1934 the contest of extemporaneous Latin speeches was scheduled and announced, at the last minute (*paucis ante pericula ipsa habenda diebus*) it was postponed to the next year and later the plan abandoned altogether.

⁶⁰⁰ Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 279-280)

serious chance of success”.⁶⁰¹ This was a language of efficiency and seriousness, a conscious distancing from merely cultural arguments and an alignment with the practical concerns. Latin was seen as the useful language, action was put before theory.

This whole project was in many ways integrated both with the Institute and, arguably, with the Italian Fascist state. It was a grand project that would, most importantly, put the present-day Rome in the central role. Rome was to promote the use of Latin, Rome was to coordinate the various national movements for Latin located outside Italy, Rome was to be the centre.⁶⁰² Galassi Paluzzi felt obliged to always emphasise that this coordinating organ would not mean any centralisation controlling the external organisations, it would be concerned strictly with coordination and with improved exchange of information.⁶⁰³ However, modern researchers are not very convinced that there was no political agenda.⁶⁰⁴ Even though Galassi Paluzzi only alluded to the spread of the “Latin mindset” together with Latin, this objective was still present. Mussolini himself approved of this initiative of an international coordinating centre of Latin.⁶⁰⁵

Italian is not going to be replaced or diminished in any way by Latin, its prestige would only be increased by it, there is no overlap between the roles – Latin is not supposed to be the international language that would be spoken (for that we have Italian), it would only be read. The treatment of Latin, an ancient language, as a useful thing that is compatible with or even indispensable for modernity, went hand-in-hand with how Roman heritage or generally *Romanità* was treated in Fascism of the time: as something that is not to be only contemplated theoretically (because of this, philology got criticised), but embodied by action that is being acted right now. As Mussolini himself concluded in 1940 while handing out prizes in the fifth *National competition of Latin prose (Concorso nazionale di prosa latina)* organised by the Institute of Roman Studies, “the

601 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 278).

602 Galassi Paluzzi (1932, 277): “Ottenere che i movimenti che già si sono manifestati ed organizzati in Ungheria, in Polonia, in Svizzera e altrove per il rifiorire dell’uso della lingua latina, si coordinino in un Comitato Internazionale con sede in Roma.”

603 Galassi Paluzzi (1935a, 293): “sarà bene dichiarare che non si intende minimamente di creare un organismo complicato e accentratore”.

604 Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016a, 18): “Tensions between the different functions of the Latin language within Fascist cultural politics were inevitable. How could Latin function as an egalitarian means of international communication and yet also be so closely tied to the Fascist movement of Italy? Far from being seen as problematic, however, this double function of Latin was deftly exploited in ISR circles. Despite its purported supranational mission, the ISR’s journal, *Per lo studio e l’uso del latino*, tactfully promoted the ISR and Rome as the centre of Latin studies worldwide. It not only stressed the role of the institute in long and tedious lists of its achievements, but also printed Fascist claims to the Latin language <...> despite Galassi Paluzzi’s insistence that the initiative to revive Latin was a strictly pragmatic and not a nationalist project.”

605 AISR (Archive of Istituto di Studi Romani) Latino.8.20 (= Latino series, box 8, file 20) *Relazione sull’attività dell’Ufficio Latino = ottobre 1937-novembre 1938* p. 4: “Centro Internazionale di Informazioni <...> L’iniziativa, destinata ad avere il più lusinghiero successo, ha ricevuto l’ambito onore d’incontrare l’alta approvazione e l’incoraggiamento di S. E. il Capo di Governo”. Mussolini was officially the Head of Government (*Capo di Governo*). *Rassegna d’Informazioni dell’Istituto di Studi Romani* 30 Genn. 1939 Ann. VII No. 5 starts with “Con l’alta e ambita approvazione di S. E. il Capo del Governo, l’Istituto di Studi Romani si è fatto editore di un Bollettino di studi, ricerche e informazioni «Per lo studio e l’uso del latino».”

language of Rome is a language of our time”.⁶⁰⁶ These contests⁶⁰⁷ survived the World War II and are still being organised by the Institute (with Latin poetry supplementing the prose) under the name of *Certamen Capitolinum*.

4.3.2.3 The sessions of the steering committee

After publishing this programmatic article in June 1932 in his own journal *Roma*, on 3rd of October Carlo Galassi Paluzzi called a meeting of the newly created commission *Steering committee for the renewal of the study and use of the Latin language (Commissione ordinatrice per il rifiorire dell'uso e dello studio della lingua latina)*. The minutes⁶⁰⁸ tell us that this meeting happened in the office of prof. Pietro De Francisci, the Minister of Grace and Justice, who was presiding over the meeting. Beside Carlo Galassi Paluzzi, there were also present prof. Arrigo Solmi, who was then a member of the Senate and the Undersecretary of the Ministry of National Education; prof. Emilio Bodrero, who was then one of the vice-presidents of the Senate; professors Vincenzo Ussani, Vittorio Rossi, Guido Rispoli who were members of the Institute of Roman Studies. Several other illustrious professors justified their absence.⁶⁰⁹ The membership of this commission would later remain quite stable; usually De Francisci would preside, being the highest ranking official.

The composition of this assembly shows the ambition of Carlo Galassi Paluzzi: this commission was not supposed to be an internal affair of the Institute of Roman Studies, the renewal of Latin should rather be debated on the highest national level, with high level Fascist governmental officials attending. Since Carlo Galassi Paluzzi involved in this initiative also the officials of the Ministry of Education and because he had extensive personal connections, counting the future

606 Galassi Paluzzi (1940b, 327): “Il Duce ha concluso rammentando che la lingua di Roma «è la lingua del nostro tempo, di questo durissimo ma bellissimo tempo fascista. Essa ci impegna severamente perchè *<sic>* è la lingua di un popolo di soldati, di conquistatori, di costruttori, di legislatori, di vincitori. Quello che Roma ha fatto in questo campo, si può dire senza esitazione, sarà imperituro».”. Cited by Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016a, 14) and Lamers (2022). It seems it was one of the very few times when Mussolini publicly commented on the Latin language. Mussolini personally participated in the 1939 and 1940 competition award ceremonies, also granting a personal audience for the winners (Galassi Paluzzi (1939a); Galassi Paluzzi (1940b)). *AISR Latino*.8.20 *Relazione annuale ottobre 1938-ottobre 1939* (20 nov. 1939) p. 8: “L’adunati si compì nella maniera più felice e la visita ai principali monumenti dell’Urbe antica, cristiana e littoria, colmino con il più gradita onore, che l’Istituto potesse procurare ai vincitori: infatti il DUCE li ricevette nel Suo Gabinetto di lavoro, al Palazzo Venezia, alla presenza del Ministro dell’Educazione Nazionale elogiandoli per essersi segnalati in una gara nazionale non facile e premiandoli oltre che non una fotografia fatta con Lui anche con un dono in danaro. Precedentemente erano stati ricevuti anche dal Governatore di Roma, in Campidoglio che formulò per loro lieti auspici.”. Galassi Paluzzi (1939a, 517): “I 18 partecipanti al raduno hanno avuto l’ambito onore di essere ricevuti in udienza speciale dal DUCE, alla presenza di S. E. Bottai, del Presidente dell’Istituto di Studi Romani e dei dirigenti dell’Ufficio latino.”

607 Sacré (2019b) investigates them.

608 *AISR Latino*.1.1 and *Latino*.7.14 contain most of the minutes of this particular commission.

609 Vittorio Scialoja, G. Aurelio Amatucci (see Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016b) – in the very same October 1932 Amatucci buried a propagandistic laudatory Latin text about the history of Fascism under the obelisk of the newly inaugurated *Foro Mussolini*), Bartolomeo Nogara, Ugo Frasccherelli, Roberto Paribeni.

minister of education and reformer of Latin instruction Giuseppe Bottai among his personal friends,⁶¹⁰ he may have had some influence on the national decisions for strengthening Latin. So it is in principle possible that the royal decree of 1936 requiring that Latin be taught as a living language in schools could in fact have been related to this initiative of Galassi Paluzzi.

In this first meeting Carlo Galasso Paluzzi first read the article that had been published in June and so inaugurated the initiative. The presentation was well received, especially the idea of Latin that would correspond to the modern needs and that would not be as difficult as the classical Latin. Then followed the intended measures – the same five ones that were present in the published version of the programmatic article.

When telling about his initiative to obtain that in Italy the scientific journals and conference proceedings would publish Latin summaries, he wanted to say “to obtain by means of the law” (a nationally enforced one!). But both of the honourable commissaries, namely the Minister of Justice and the Undersecretary of Education, reacted negatively and remarked that it was not necessary to use a legislative provision; it would be enough if the Ministry of Education sent out a circular to organisations that could become interested in this initiative. The Undersecretary Solmi gave his guarantee for this. In the same session Galassi Paluzzi obtained from the Minister of Justice an assurance that the next Law Congress (*Congresso Giuridico*) would have Latin summaries.

This scheme of Latin summaries was therefore completely voluntary. The Institute of Roman Studies, helped by the contacts of the Ministry of Education, later lobbied various organisations, which were publishing journals or organising conferences, to join the initiative of Latin summaries.

This question of the Latin summaries also raised concerns about the Latin lexical renewal necessary for expressing modern terminology; a subcommission for dictionaries of modern scientific terminology was instituted. Galassi Paluzzi outlined the scheme of the future competitions of Latin prose and secured a promise of financing from the Undersecretary of Education. Finally it was announced that in 1933, the following year, the Third National Congress of Roman Studies was to be organised by the Institute and that it was going to have Latin summaries of all proceedings and also a dedicated session for the *rebirth of the study and use of the Latin language*.⁶¹¹

These are the proceedings of the first session of this particular steering commission. According to the archives of the Institute of Roman Studies, there were 8 of them in 1932-1937.⁶¹² The coordination of the initiative branched into subcommissions of Latin lexica of modern

610 Nelis (2010) explores their relationship.

611 The full title of the congress: *III Congresso Nazionale di Studi Romani La Celebrazione del Bimillenario Augusteo. La Rinascita dello Studio e dell'Uso della Lingua Latina. Roma 22-27 aprile 1933*. Carlo Galassi Paluzzi added the second theme and a separate section to the congress for his Latin renewal initiative. The *vota* of the congress include its principal aims.

scientific terminology (*sottocommissione dei lessici*), several subcommissions for the compilation of Latin dictionaries, commissions for judging the contests of Latin prose.

The archives also contain correspondence with the members of the committees, with the translators of summaries and dictionaries, with the Ministry of Education, with various entities which the Institute was lobbying to participate in their Latin modern terminology project or in the Latin summary one. There are also many summaries the Institute had translated into Latin, there is the prepared lexical material for various domains of science and technology in various states (some still in Italian, some in Latin and some ready for publication). Finally, there is the journal *For the study and use of Latin. International bulletin of studies, research and information* (*Per lo studio e l'uso del latino. Bollettino internazionale di studi – ricerche – informazioni*, 1939-1942) which tried to fulfil the function of the coordinating centre of the renewal of Latin. It tried to survey all the Latin phenomena in the world, describing various journals and organisations for the revival of Latin and the general state of Latin studies worldwide.

4.3.2.4 The Latin Office (*Ufficio Latino*)

This initiative by the Institute of Roman Studies had so many directions that it is hard to present the subject without either giving broad overgeneralisations or getting bogged down in small and bureaucratic details, especially since so many people and institutions were involved and this initiative was present in the Institute for a long time from 1932 until the end of the War.

Carlo Galassi Paluzzi organised all these activities in a very methodical, truly bureaucratic process. In the Institute there was created a new department, the Latin Office (*Ufficio Latino*). Professor Guido Rispoli was chosen to lead it. According to the plans of 1939,⁶¹³ it had five projects: the dictionary (*dizionario*), the lexica of terminology (*lessici*), the bulletin (*bollettino*) – the journal *Per lo studio e l'uso del latino*, the translation office (*ufficio traduzione*), the contest of Latin prose (*concorso prosa latina*).

It seems from the later sessions of the steering committee that the dictionary project consumed most of the energy of this department. In the original project by Galassi Paluzzi, he wanted to provide two dictionaries for use in schools: the Latin-Italian one and the Italian-Latin one. This was part of the greatness of Italy theme – at the time the Italian schools have been using dictionaries compiled by foreigners and translated into Italian, but this project by the Institute of Roman Studies would return the honour of having a true proper Italian dictionary in schools that

612 *AISR Latino*.1.1; *Latino*.7.14. Dates of the individual sessions are listed in the inventory of the archive (Lodolini Tupputi 1995a).

613 *AISR Latino*.8.20: “Ufficio latino. Lavori di sistemazione e impianto per il periodo 15 maggio – 15 novembre 1939 XVII”.

would be more extensive and superior to the foreign offerings. Moreover, the Italian-Latin one should have contained modern terminology. But it seems that this project, when going through the sessions in committees, evolved in a different direction. Now the Institute was trying to create a big *scientific* dictionary, which would later be abridged to these school dictionaries. In 1940 Carlo Galassi Paluzzi presented this project to Mussolini as “the compilation of the biggest school dictionary that has ever appeared. Today the biggest dictionary in our schools has the name of a foreign author and has 26,000 words; the new one will be an Italian dictionary of Latin and will contain 60,000 words”.⁶¹⁴ This project continued until 1943. Later only a slim sample volume was published in 1979,⁶¹⁵ while the rest of the dictionary remains in a manuscript form. The material collected was vast, it was reported that it occupied 12,487 sheets (*cartelle*),⁶¹⁶ today in the archive the manuscript takes up 22 standard archival boxes.

The national bureau of Latin translations (*Ufficio nazionale di traduzione per la lingua latina*) in 1939 had 30 members and had already translated 860 summaries of various articles and conference proceedings.⁶¹⁷ The archives of the Institute preserve a substantial collection of texts translated.⁶¹⁸

614 Galassi Paluzzi (1940b, 326)

615 Ussani (1979). The Italian preface outlined the history of the project – it stopped after the war, in 1969 it was resumed, but it was hard to sustain the efforts, so this specimen expressed hope that a publisher could be found to fund the publication. The Latin preface emphasised the demonstration of past efforts: “Cum pecunia ad perficiendum opus defecerit, parvum specimen edere instituimus ut omnes Latini sermonis cultores agnoscere possint quanta cura quantaque diligentia novum ac singulare consilium susceptum sit atque ex aliqua parte effectum.”

616 Ussani (1979, VII)

617 *AISR Latino*.8.20 “Relazione annuale ottobre 1938 – ottobre 1939” p. 6: “L’Ufficio Nazionale di traduzione in Lingua Latina ricostituito su larga base nello scorso anno con la partecipazione di 30 valorosi docenti di latino”.

618 *AISR Latino*.21 (the whole box!) contains both the translations and the Italian originals, enabling an evaluation of the translation techniques. It seems that various medical summaries form the greater proportion. An example summary about some pioneering work in genetics, translated by prof. Gaetano Gigli for *Istituto di Sanità Pubblica*: “3 (Timofëeff-Ressovsky) Auctor lucide splendideque docet quemadmodum characteres hereditarii transmittantur. Multis ille luce pictis imaginibus proiectis “Genotypi” generalem exhibet structuram, atque ostendit hereditarios characteres de alia in aliam generationem transmitti per id quod dicimus “Gene” cuius sedes sit in cellulis sexualibus. “Gene” autem appellantur elementa secretiva, quae in interiore chromosomatum parte, quasi definitae particulae, certo sunt ordine disposita. Sed illud quoque tenendum est “gene” elementa esse chymicis physicisque agentibus obnoxia, ideoque mutabilia et variabilia. Quid inde inferre liceat, quatenus ad populi rem geneticam spectat, plane apertum est. = 3 (Timofëeff-Ressovsky) L’autore chiarisce in modo brillante il meccanismo di trasmissione dei caratteri ereditari ed ha descritto, illustrando le sue parole con numerose proiezioni, la struttura generale del Genotipo mostrando come i caratteri ereditari vengono trasmessi di generazione in generazione dal così detto Gene localizzato nelle cellule sessuali. Per cui s’intendono per Gene le unità di segregazione che materialmente sono ordinate sotto forma di particelle definite nell’interno dei cromosomi. Ma i Geni devono venire pure intesi come unità di mutazione o di variazione suscettibili all’azione di agenti chimici e fisici. È ovvio quale applicazione se ne può fare alla genetica delle popolazioni.”. An example from elementary particle physics: “(Amaldi, Bocciarelli, Trabacchi) Dimetiri volunt Auctores angularem distributionem protonum a repulsu neutronum 12-14 MV, ut pernoscant quae vires inter protones neutronesque mutuo operentur. Prima haec charta pervestigationis et ostendit rationem et primos exitus exhibet. = (Amaldi, Bocciarelli, Trabacchi) Gli AA. si propongono la misura della distribuzione angolare di protoni di rinculo di neutroni di 12-14 MV allo scopo di avere informazioni sulle forme esercitantesi fra protoni e neutroni. In questo primo lavoro viene esposta la tecnica usata e vengono discussi i primi risultati.”.

The Institute of Roman Studies decided that the terminology of modern Latin needs to be provided for methodically. So in order to compile a dictionary of a particular field that would be authoritative, the process had to involve all interested parties. A professional association representative of that field (for example, if the field is chemistry, then it would ask the *Associazione Italiana di Chimica*) would be asked for a list of vocabulary needed and for an editor, who would be a specialist representative of the field (in this case a chemist) and would consult the translation process. The Institute of Roman studies would find a competent Latinist for this work (it might announce a contest for this role). Finally this translation would be revised and approved both by the Latinists and by the specialists. This whole process would usually be funded by the association representative of the field, because they are the interested party who wants to have their own field honourably represented by Latin. The compiler of the glossary, the translator, the editor, the reviser would be compensated from this sum.

So in order to have a dictionary of just one field, there was a long and impeccably bureaucratic process to go through.⁶¹⁹ Carlo Galassi Paluzzi was quite successful in finding support from other institutions. For example, he contacted the Italian council of research (*Consiglio Nazionale delle Ricerche*) and its head Guglielmo Marconi, the Nobel laureate for his contributions to radio telegraphy, and Marconi kindly agreed to join the project and promised to provide both the vocabularies and the funding (3000 lire) for each of the 8 fields the associations of which belonged to the council.⁶²⁰ Later this number was extended to 20. The rest of the fields were supported by individual associations – for example, the *Ente per l'Acquedotto Pugliese* contributed financially to the Institute and promised to send a vocabulary of hydraulic engineering; *Sindacato Provinciale Fascista Ingegneri di Roma* funded a dictionary of building engineering.⁶²¹ Finally, the number of the dictionaries promised or sent and where funding or promised provided grew to 26⁶²² or even 30

619 What a contrast to all these enthusiastic lexicographers of Latin who were writing dictionaries by themselves! But, to be fair, many of them dreamed about a dictionary of modern Latin that would be authoritatively approved by an international committee (Lyvens 2019). The Institute of Roman studies is the only one which actually tried to do something like this.

620 *AISR Latino*.84.6, letter by Carlo Galassi Paluzzi to Ugo Frasccherelli, the *Segretario Generale del Consiglio Nazionale delle Ricerche*, stamped with the date of 1 July 1935, tells the story of the collaboration with this National Council from the first contact on 28 Nov. 1932. To this letter a photocopy of Marconi's 14 Feb. 1934 letter is attached, where he lists the eight lexica (*Agricoltura; Chimica; Matematica, Astronomia e Geodesia; Fisica e Geofisica; Geologia e Geografia; Ingegneria; Biologia; Medicina*) the Council will provide the Italian vocabularies for and will finance the translation of them.

621 Galassi Paluzzi (1933, 415): “Con animo grato riferisco pertanto che dalla Confederazione Nazionale Fascista Professionisti e Artisti abbiamo avuto un contributo per la compilazione del lessico riguardante il diritto corporativo; dall'Ente per l'Acquedotto Pugliese abbiamo avuto un cospicuo contributo per la compilazione del lessico concernente l'ingegneria idraulica; altro contributo ancora abbiamo avuto dal Sindacato Provinciale Fascista Ingegneri di Roma per il lessico sulla ingegneria edilizia; <...>”

622 Galassi Paluzzi (1938b, 372)

(one of which was translated independently of the Institute).⁶²³ The readiness of so many specialist associations to support Latin projects even financially hoping for Latin as the international language of their field testifies to the vitality and prestige Latin had in the Italian society.

Not one dictionary of this list finished going through this whole procedure, being approved in the final form. Many of them remained in Italian, only about five of them were translated into Latin, only one (on experimental psychology, translated by Giovanni Battista Pighi, an illustrious Latinist who was then a professor in Milan)⁶²⁴ was typeset for proofing purposes, none of them was published. It was intended to do this once enough dictionaries would be finished, then they would be printed together as a real volume. Maybe if the Second World War had not intervened, this project would have been successfully executed – after all, dictionary projects tend to take a long time, and the seven years between the beginning of the project and the outbreak of the war was not a particular long time, the progress was apparently quite decent.

Even if it is not clear if this particular project of creating the arguably universal and authoritative dictionary of modern Latin was progressing successfully or if it had a chance of being finished, impressions mattered. Carlo Galassi Paluzzi was a masterful presenter and created an impression that Latin is now finally getting the honour it deserves. It was communicated that thirty (!) Italian-Latin dictionaries of scientific terms are being prepared in collaboration under the guidance of multiple most authoritative scientific institutes. It did not matter that these dictionaries, being selected vocabularies of individual fields, were each maybe about 600 lemmas in length (the *experimental psychology* one had 624 terms), a brief chapter in a reasonable volume of a printed dictionary, and all of them collected would result in a single book volume, but the impression for the public was that of a bookshelf full of most copious scientific dictionaries that would finally solve the problem of the modern usage of Latin. In the first years of the initiative, when lobbying for Latin summaries to be included into the scientific journals and conference proceedings, Galassi Paluzzi in his reports used to provide a page-long list of organisations “generally favourable, but reserved” to the idea of Latin summaries – in order to get into this list, it was probably enough to

623 Galassi Paluzzi (1939b, 7): “I lessici italiani finora assicurati o promessi sono i seguenti: // Agricoltura e Zootecnia – Architettura moderna – Arte – Astronomia e Geodesia – Assistenza Sociale – Biologia – Chimica – Diritto Corporativo – Dottrine assicurative – Filosofia moderna – Fisica e Geofisica – Geodesia – Geofisica e Meteorologia – Geologia e Geografia – Geografia fisica e antropica – Geometria algebrica – Ingegneria – Edilizia – Ingegneria elettrotecnica – Ingegneria idraulica – Matematica – Medicina – Mineralogia e mineraria – Oceanografia – Psicologia sperimentale. – Radiotecnica – Scienze bancarie – Scienze attuariali – Urbanistica. // A questi si è aggiunto ultimamente quello di Acustica, preparato dall’Istituto Elettrotecnico «G. Ferraris» di Torino, di cui è Presidente S. E. il Prof. G. Vallauri.”

624 624 is the number of words in the already typeset dictionary of experimental psychology. *AISR Latino*.8.20 “Relazione annuale ottobre 1938 – ottobre 1939” p. 2; *Latino*.86.41 “Nota 663 Per il Signor Presidente”, dated 14 March 1940, p. 1: “Il lessico contiene 624 termini di psicologia, tradotti in latino dal prof. PIGHI”. Giovanni Battista Pighi (*Ioannes Baptista Pighius*, 1898-1978) was a prominent Latinist, then a professor in the Catholic University of Milan (*Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore*).

just politely reply to the soliciting letter. In 1939, Galassi Paluzzi is telling Mussolini that the Institute has established contacts with 75% of the Latin professors in the world,⁶²⁵ in 1940 the before-the-hostilities percentage is already 80%.⁶²⁶ The efforts of the Institute of Roman Studies and its political will to fight for Latin are not to be discounted, they were very substantial. But this rhetorical image lived its own life, Galassi's rhetorical flourishes contributed to the prestige of Latin and helped the initiative. This was felt throughout Italy and throughout the network of Latin activists in the world, admired in Latin journals *Iuventus*, *Alma Roma*, *Societas Latina*, who were all recruited to the new axis of Latinity through the journal *For the study and use of Latin* (*Per lo studio e l'uso del latino*) the Institute published from 1939 to 1942, which was intent of becoming the centre of the global movement for the renewal of the study and use of Latin.

4.3.2.5 Aftermath

As part of the defascistisation of Italy, Carlo Galassi Paluzzi had to leave the Institute in August 1944, as he was judged to be a collaborator of the Mussolini regime. The Institute was taken over by the assigned extraordinary commissioner prof. Quinto Tosatti (1890-1960), and he was assigned the task of reorganising the Institute without the intention to liquidate it.⁶²⁷ Tosatti turned out to be very sympathetic to the Institute – just like Galassi Paluzzi, he also believed in the mission of Rome and its universality, reporting to the mayor of Rome that if “in the past the frequent evocation of the rhetoric of *Romanità* could be used by the ruinous imperialistic spirit”, one should not forget that the real and perennial ideal heritage with the name of Rome remains the lodestar for Italy to aspire to.⁶²⁸ Tosatti further noted that even if there were some Fascist colouring in some of ISR's activities, the ISR was performing essentially scientific activities and did not belong to the Fascist party.⁶²⁹ So the *Romanità* which Galassi Paluzzi cherished was rehabilitated. Even if the change of personnel was quite extensive because of the defascistisation measures, the ideas and activities displayed a notable continuity.⁶³⁰ The Institute was preserved and relatively intact.

625 Galassi Paluzzi (1939a, 520)

626 Galassi Paluzzi (1940b, 326)

627 Lodolini Tupputi (1995b, 440)

628 Lodolini Tupputi (1995b, 440): “«Se nel passato la rievocazione spesso retorica della romanità poté essere messa a servizio di un esizial spirito imperialistico, non può e non deve essere dimenticato che il reale e perenne patrimonio ideale che si riassume nel nome di Roma, resta guida e polo di orientamento al quale l'Italia dovrà attingere l'ispirazione per riprendere il suo faticoso cammino di ricostruzione che la dovrà riportare ad esercitare la sua alta missione di cultura»⁵. Anche il Tosatti in definitiva credeva fermamente, come il Galassi, nella missione di Roma. <...> ⁵ In questi termini scriveva il commissario Tosatti al sindaco di Roma, principe Filippo Doria Pamphili, il 25 set. 1944, in Archivio storico dell'Istituto Nazionale di Studi Romani, serie Corsi, b. 185, fasc. 1.”

629 Lodolini Tupputi (1995b, 441)

630 Visser (2006, 656); Lodolini Tupputi (1995b, 440-441); Lodolini Tupputi (1996, 232)

In the historical archive of the Institute of Roman Studies we can find documents with Tosatti's stamp that the National Latin Translation Office (*L'Ufficio Nazionale di traduzione in lingua latina*) was still translating Latin summaries for scientific journals in December 1945,⁶³¹ and in 1948 there still were discussions about the translation to Latin of the physics dictionary manuscript received before the war (pointing out that it is already obsolete and does not include such inventions made during the war as RADAR).⁶³² So the Latin revival activities initiated by Carlo Galassi Paluzzi seem to have still gone on after the World War II in a certain extent.

Quinto Tosatti in 1950 became the president of the Institute and later participated in the 1956 Living Latin congress in Avignon. He had a good command of spoken Latin language and quickly became involved in this movement.⁶³³ After his death in 1960 his successor in leading the Institute became Pietro Romanelli (1889-1981), who had been part of the Institute ever since 1926, so since its first years.⁶³⁴ He similarly had a good command of spoken Latin and was his intention to organise the 1966 congress of Latin language and literature in Rome, during which he founded the precursor to the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae (ALF)* as a part of the Institute. *ALF* became *de jure* separate from the Institute of Roman Studies only in 1989 and left the premises of the Institute only in 2004, almost 60 years after its foundation.⁶³⁵

So maybe the history of the postwar Living Latin movement was determined by the legacy of Galassi Paluzzi?⁶³⁶ *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* was not just something that arose from the Avignon conference of 1956 and its *Vita Latina* movement, it was also a long-delayed dream of the Institute to finally create the coordinating organisation of worldwide Latin initiatives envisioned by Galassi Paluzzi in his *rifiorire* programme. Pietro Romanelli, who apparently had a penchant for the use of spoken and written Latin for communicating with international colleagues and who had worked with Carlo Galassi Paluzzi for 18 years could not have been ignorant of these dreams and initiatives. Even the 1966 congress itself had the same title that Galassi Paluzzi used as his motto and the title of his journal: *for the study and use of Latin (Congresso internazionale per lo studio e*

631 *AISR Latino*.21.12 contains numerous notes about the ongoing collaboration with the *Istituto Superiore di Sanità*, which still continued to ask the Institute of Roman Studies for translations of summaries into Latin. For example: "19 Dic. 1945. Spett. ISTITUTO SUPERIORE DI SANITÀ Viale Regina Margherita, 199 Roma. Invio la traduzione latina degli ultimi sunti inviatici. Il compenso del traduttore è L. 150,=. Con osservanza. IL COMMISSARIO (Prof. Quinto Tosatti)"

632 *AISR Latino*.86.42

633 Licoppe (2014a, 21)

634 Lodolini Tupputi (1996, 239); Visser (2006, 657)

635 Licoppe (2014a, 13); *ibid.*, pp. 223 ff., 343-346.

636 After writing these lines, I found that Sacré (2019b, 12) already made this observation: "Mea quidem sententia historia *Academiae Latinitati Fovendae*, ut cum 'motu illo Latinitatis vivae' Avennionensi, ita cum Instituto Romanis Studiis Provehendis eiusque coeptis arte est coniuncta; et quae incepta fovit Iohannes ille Capelle apud Francogallos, eadem in Urbe multis ante annis fovere coeperat hoc Institutum."

l'uso del latino). The 1932 initiative of Carlo Galassi Paluzzi to “reflower” the studies and use of Latin and to provide a centre for the Living Latin world had effects lasting until today.

This is the quasi-state branch of the Italian Living Latin movement. At the same time, Italy had a strong tradition of Latin in the Church.

4.3.3 Italian Catholic movement for Latin. *Vox Urbis / Alma Roma* and Giuseppe Fornari

Let us now return to the end of the 19th century, as the Italian Catholic movement for Latin dates from that time and cannot be separated from the Interwar period. In November 1898, when *Alaudae* (1889-1895) had already gone silent together with their editor K. H. Ulrichs (1825-1895) and *Præco Latinus* (1894-1902) by A. Avellanus was still active, in Rome appeared a new periodical *Vox Urbis, de litteris et bonis artibus commentarius* (*The Voice of the City: a journal for letters and good arts*), starting a long tradition – last issue of *Vox Urbis* was published in December 1913, but already on 15th of May 1914 *Alma Roma, Latinitatis praeconium singulis mensibus editum* (*The Nourishing Rome: a monthly publication for promoting Latinity*) appeared, lasting until September 1942, the death of its founder and editor Giuseppe Fornari (*Iosephus Fornarius*, 1868-1942). So this tradition lasted for 45 years.⁶³⁷ In this section I cover this huge corpus – about eight thousand pages⁶³⁸ – very briefly; a more detailed version of this text has been published separately.⁶³⁹

Vox Urbis was founded and financed by Aristide Leonori (1856-1928), a prominent Catholic architect of the time,⁶⁴⁰ and edited by Giuseppe Fornari, a Latinist and lawyer by profession.⁶⁴¹ Both

⁶³⁷ A brief survey of existing scholarship: Couturat and Leau (1903, 521-523); Lurz (1935a, 33-35); Lurz (1949, 9-11); Romani (1953); Sacré (1988, 98); Mir (1993); Jenniges (2007); Slednikov (2017a, 227-228) Slednikov (2019a, 91-93); Slednikov (2019b); Slednikov (2019c). Sienkiewicz and Angelinius (2010) is a republication and scholarly treatment of *Anthea*, a short story of Henryk Sienkiewicz which he composed before writing his *Quo vadis?* on similar Roman and Christian themes, translated into Latin by the principal Vatican Latinist Pietro Angelini (*Petrus Angelinius*, 1847-1911) and published in *Vox Urbis* from its first issue; later also in a separate booklet (Angelini 1902).

⁶³⁸ See Appendix A.5 for the technical details of this page number estimate.

⁶³⁹ The paper developed from my address in the 2022 *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* congress in Rome has been published in the conference proceedings (Lyvens 2023). It treats *Alma Roma* and *Vox Urbis* and their founders (A. Leonori, G. Fornari).

⁶⁴⁰ For his biography see Venturini (1931); Bianchi-Cagliesi (1932); Gondi (1936); Di Marco (2005).

⁶⁴¹ The main source for Fornari's life is an anonymous (signed by ROMANUS) obituary in *L'Osservatore Romano* 20 Sett. 1942 p. 2; followed by funeral related 23 Sett. 1942 p. 2; 24 Sett. 1942 p. 2. Other obituaries include *Roma: Rivista di studi e di vita romana*, Sett. 1942 Ann. XX Num. 9 p. 400; *Alma Roma* Sept.-Oct. 1942 Ann. XXIX Fasc. 9-10 cover page II; *Juventus* Ian. 1943 Ann. 27 Num. 5/307 p. 39; *Palaestra Latina* 1942 Nov.-Dec. Ann. XII N. 76 p. 120; 1943 Ian-Apr Ann. XIII N. 77-78 p. 28; *Societas Latina* Vol. XI Nr. II/III Sept. 1943 p. 63. While the condolences were international in the Latin-speaking world (Italy; Hungary; Spain; Germany), there seem to be no further publications on his life. He is later mentioned in treatments of the 20th century Latin poetry (Sienkiewicz and Angelinius (2010, 165); Sacré (2011, 336); Sacré (2012, 124); Sacré (2015a)) and for managing the help by Pope Pius X for orphans of the 1908 Messina earthquake (Dieguez (2003, XIX); Pagano (2005, 10); Dieguez (2008); Dieguez (27-28.12.2008); Dieguez (2010); Dieguez (2014, 180); Dieguez (2016, 547-548); especially Dieguez (2010); Dieguez (27-28.12.2008)).

of them were laymen with strong ties to the Catholic Church: Leonori would travel extensively⁶⁴² building churches and other ecclesiastical buildings, while Fornari, who had been born in a pious family that sided with the Pope not recognising the unified Italian state, worked in the Roman Curia in various positions⁶⁴³ and was close to the popes. He also was a passionate teacher of Latin, teaching it in a conversational manner.⁶⁴⁴ His involvement with education of children did not end with Latin: he was entrusted by Pope Pius X with care of hundreds of orphans who lost their parents in the 1908 Messina earthquake,⁶⁴⁵ and in 1920 he was entrusted by Pope Benedict XV with heading a children's sanatorium in Nettuno, which became the primary occupation of Fornari and his family for the next 22 years.⁶⁴⁶ The Latin journals were just a side-project.

As Fornari later explained,⁶⁴⁷ Leonori had an epiphany in his travels that led him to the decision of creating the Latin periodical. He understood that culture (*humanitas*) everywhere is derived from the Latin source and that all the nations began their literature under the Roman

642 Venturini (1931, 8): “Basti dire che il Leonori, per dirigere da sè i suoi lavori, compì 34 volte la traversata dell’Oceano, 12 volte il viaggio d’Oriente, 10 volte quello d’Inghilterra, e giunse a parlare il francese, l’inglese, il tedesco, lo spagnolo, l’arabo.”

643 For example, *L’Osservatore Romano* 23 Sett. 1942 p. 2: “Di tale e tanto amorosa conoscenza del latino Fornari si servì alla Congregazione dei Riti per lunghi anni preparando e seguendo le sedute, che venivano verbalizzate in latino e questa geniale e paziente attività di fiducia fu largamente apprezzata da prelati insigni quali il Caprara, il Persiani, il Verde.” For this Congregation of Rites he published a book (Fornari 1899).

644 *Alma Roma* Id. Mart. 1922 Ann. 9 Num. 3 pp. 44-45: “Quum – heu! iam plures defluerunt anni – in quarta et quinta nostri gymnasii classe – quae antea *humanitatis* et *rhetoricae* classes nuncupabantur – linguam latinam tradere suscepi, et communis docendi rationis – ceterum a gubernio propositae – absurditatem facile intellexi, eoque magis quod ab habitu Italicae mentis nostrae eadem ratio aliena mihi omnino videretur, grammaticos libros, quos non immerito fastidiebant, relinquere alumnos meos iussi, eosque invitavi ut vivam meam vocem sequerentur. <...> Nec pueri illi, tertium aut quartum supra decimum aetatis annum vix attingentes, ab instituendis inter se et mecum latinis colloquiis de variis argumentis abstinerebant, et novo anno adventante, atque die meo nominali, certabant ut grati animi sui sensus et omina latinis litterulis mihi expromerent.” A description of his methodology follows. Some of his educational writings in *Vox Urbis* and *Alma Roma* were later published as separate books: Fornari (1915); Fornari (1917); Fornari (1927); Fornari (1931). Fornari (1907) is a speech on education he gave in *Circolo di San Pietro* which he headed in 1904-1907.

645 See bibliography in footnote 641. Dieguez (2010, 161): “Il 20 maggio 1909, nel corso di un’udienza, Pio X nominò suo speciale incaricato il prof. Giuseppe Fornari, segretario del Comitato di soccorso della Gioventù Cattolica Italiana, affinché in suo nome si prendesse cura dei fanciulli e delle fanciulle superstiti del terremoto di Sicilia e Calabria ricoverati dalla munificenza pontificia nei diversi istituti, «visitandoli, vigilando al loro benessere ed alla loro igiene, pagando le dovute quote mensili, provvedendo a tutto quanto è necessario per la buona riuscita dei medesimi in quei ricoveri, e mettendosi così in grado di dar poi conto di tutto a chi di ragione»”.

646 *Casa della Divina Provvidenza*. Avenarius (1943): “Anno 1920 Neptuniae in agri Romani litorali oppidulo condita est domus divinae Providentiae curandis educandisque dubia valetudine parvulis, eiusque domus gestio a Summis Pontificibus commendata est Fornario. Hic suorum immemor commodorum administravit omnia. Statis diebus eo ex urbe profectus prospiciebat rei culinariae et sacrae aedi, scholae et ludis parvulorum, egregia eum adiuvante filia.” This brief sketch is derived from the primary obituary in *L’Osservatore Romano*. Fornari also published annual reports of his institution, for example: Fornari (1929); Fornari (1933).

647 *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* Apr.-Mai. 1903 Vol. II. Num. 1-3 p. 13: “Ecquis autem vir exstitit, cuius consilio et ope Vox haec alma, quam restinctam plurimi voluerant, insonuit iterum ubique gentium, veluti commune percipiendi signum et vinculum sapientum <sic> commune? Honoris causa, altius affirmo: Romanus civis fuit ille. Aristides Leonorius, qui artis suae causa saepe abesse patria coactus, quemadmodum hac etiam die infauste contigit, dissita ad loca et varia iter faciens, animadvertens ubique omnem humanitatem latino ex fonte esse derivatam, expertus ubique omnes populos, quavis stirpe genitos, ex Romanorum libris et sermone suarum quoque rudimenta litterarum hausisse, unam esse loquelam arguit, unam linguam, nulla saeculorum diuturnitate deletam, immo in memoria virorum honestioris ordinis ubique gentium viventem adhuc et plurimorum in calamo vivacem ac vivam in ore multorum.”

influence,⁶⁴⁸ Latin is also the language that has in recent memory united the learned of the world and still lives among many of them today. At that time the international language question was being fervently discussed – this cultural value of Latin, coupled with its historical and still partly existing function of international communication made Latin, “the heritage of common humanity”, was a ready solution for it.⁶⁴⁹ Neither was this Latin to be of the lowest common denominator that could be read by anyone who had any meagre amount of Latin in school, but Latinity as true and beautiful as the writers could make it, that would delight and educate the readers.⁶⁵⁰ Leonori also felt a need in the Catholic Church for a general culturally minded Latin publication uniting the Church – some Latin journals circulating in the Church internationally certainly existed, but they were rather technical and did not perform this function.⁶⁵¹ After developing this idea, he communicated the plan to his friends (starting from Fornari) to create the journal as a private initiative from his own funds, as such a universal project needed freedom of action and could not be subservient to any other organisation.⁶⁵² So *Vox Urbis* was not an official Church publication, but was aligned to and embraced by it; it seems that the Catholic press in Italy at the time generally was organised in a similar informal manner. The religious aspect was certainly there: already in June 1898 Avellanus received a letter announcing the future periodical where religion would be the first priority, followed by all the news and good arts; the periodical would also provide an example how Latin could solve the international language question.⁶⁵³

648 One wonders if this statement applies also to Leonori’s travels to the East (some Leonori’s projects have been built in India), where Latin does not have this fundamental position.

649 *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* Apr.-Mai. 1903 Vol. II. Num. 1-3 p. 13: “Fatorum itaque haereditate utendum Leonorius sensit audacter, quumque, novissima praesertim aetate, varie agigaretur a plerisque consilium de certo sermone proponendo, quo gentes in artium disciplinarumque commercio, quavis aemulatione semota et exiguo labore uterentur, id praesto esse adspexit in patrimonio communis humanitatis, lingua et sermone latino.”

650 *Ibid.*: “Linguam et sermonem consulto dixi: non enim viro commentarium huiusmodi in Urbe instituenti, neque scribentibus nobis consilium esse potuit, ut latina verba perpauca eademque soluta et quasi totidem fragmentis adhiberemus, ut perlegeremur quomodolibet ab omnibus qui linguam maiorum vix pueruli in ludo delibaverint; sed ut, pro nostris viribus nostraque humanitate, lingua plane uteremur quali patres utebantur; eorum, inquam, lingua prout unum aliquid est simplex pariter ac multiplex, variis membris conflatum ordine certo connexis, itemque mobile ad omnes mentis rationes exprimendas, sese denique illa forma offerens, quae simul et mentes erudiret, et aures oblectaret.”

651 Gondi (1936, 24): “Egli, nelle sue peregrinazioni artistiche, comprese le necessità che alle *Ephemerides* per gli studi superiori ecclesiastici della Teologia, del Diritto Canonico, della Liturgia, si unisse un Periodico d’indole letteraria ed artistica, che, partendo da Roma, si diffondesse specialmente negli Episcopi, nelle Curie, nei Seminari, nei Conventi e presso i singoli prelati ed i dotti delle diverse nazioni.”

652 *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* Apr.-Mai. 1903 Vol. II. Num. 1-3 p. 13: “Anno itaque millesimo octingentesimo nonagesimo octavo cum auctori nostro haec perspecta fuissent satisque cogitata, amicis ipse communicavit, mihi que inter primos, qui – candide fateor – rei quamvis novitate allectus, magnitudine tamen ausus renui deterritus eumque coepi a proposito revocare. Quomodo enim unus ipse privato suo aere ad opus non solum posset admoveere manus, sed rei tam diuturnae, tot difficultatibus obnoxiae resistere? Liberum enim ac solutum a cuiusvis tutela eum esse oportebat, nec cuiquam, nisi studio patriae Urbis, servire, huiusque gloriam maxime prae oculis habere, dum universae humanitatis commercia prospiciuntur. Qua libertate, libens obtestor, iure gloriamur, atque inde Commentarii incrementum maxima ex parte sumptum arbitramur.”

653 *Præco Latinus* Oct. 1898 Vol. V No. 1 p. 6

The first issue on Kalends of November 1898 elaborates on these points. The first page contains a letter of endorsement by Lucido M. Parocchi, the Cardinal Vicar of Rome, who treats the international language question by ridiculing the artificial languages and praising Latin. The introductory editorial (signed by VOX URBIS) starts from the greatness of Rome and of the Latin language, as the journal aspires to be the *Voice of Rome*. Later, the mission of the journal is expressed:

They will be in error who think that for us all old things are praiseworthy, while the present ones we averse. We are not so incurious of today that we would not be moved by the progress of the sciences; we also think that it is a advantage of the times that the uncorrupted purity of Latin has now been sought much more fervently than before. However, just as in every art one has to reckon with both practice and theory, in Latinity too we want to be not only perfectly erudite, but also polished by everyday use.

But it is not only the present culture, which is growing in new discoveries every day, that does not permit to examine the Latin language as some dead body, with no use from all this study. In this great flood of books permeating all the world it will be very hard to communicate in speech if we do not somehow get to know all the languages. Therefore many have already understood that the learned people must be united by one language. Even if different solutions are being proposed, it is easy to understand that the fitness of Latin is approved by very many.

Therefore, if we ever have to find ourselves in the role of ignoble word fabricators (*ignobiles verborum opifices*), we will nevertheless try to make them appear to be generally Latin. On the other hand, whatever advantages our industry will have in the future, it will be a comfort that we will have ignited the hearts with affection for the City and the Latinity, with both of which the real faith and humanity are most firmly connected.⁶⁵⁴

654 *Vox Urbis* Kal. Nov. 1898 Ann. I Num. 1 p. 2: "Pravum quoque iudicium erit illorum qui putaverint, nobis, vitio malignitatis humanae, vetera semper in laude, praesentia fastidio esse. Neque enim ita sumus recentium incuriosi, ut nos doctrinae cuiusvis incrementa non moveant; quin etiam id ipsum aetati nostrae laudi tribuimus, quod multo acrius quam antea excitata studia fuerint, ut incorrupta inquireretur latini sermonis integritas. Verum, quemadmodum in singulis artibus ducenda simul ratio est et scientiae et usus, ita etiam latinitate cupimus nos esse non solum perfecte planeque eruditos, sed etiam cotidiano usu limatos. <...> Sed nec praesens humanitas, quae crescit in dies rebus novis cognoscendis, patitur in latinam linguam tamquam in corpus inspicere demortui animantis, studio nullum in usum deducto. Etenim in tanta librorum per orbem colluvie, nisi forte gentium omnium linguas tenere posse arbitremur, loquendi audiendique commercium erit profecto perarduum. Quare multis iampridem visum est oportere homines eruditos eiusdem linguae societate inter se esse coniunctos. Etsi autem alii aliam proponant, facili negotio intelligi potest latini opportunitatem sermonis probari quamplurimis. <...> Quamobrem, si quando ignobiles verborum opifices esse cogemur, conabimur tamen ut, in universum spectantibus, ea quae afferemus latine dicta esse videantur. Ceterum, qualiscumque industriae nostrae erit futura virtus, illud certe recreabit, et Urbis et latinitatis studio animos incendisse, quocum utroque vera fides et humanitas arctissimo sunt nexu coniunctae."

This is a quite conservative view of Latin, but even in this case the fascination with modernity is clear. The philological acumen is appreciated for its contribution to knowledge, but true knowledge of Latin involves the active use of it and it should not be a dead corpse fit only for examination. The attraction characteristic for the Living Latin movement to the vitality of the Latin language contrasted with the widespread “dead” practices is present (corpse imagery is commonplace). The tension between the classical purity of the Latin language and its use for modern subjects is inevitably felt; however, while some others might argue for simplification or extensive renewal of Latin, *Vox Urbis* is confident that Latin is already suitable for this. It might be necessary to sometimes coin a word or two, but this is just a necessary evil rather than something to be excited about. The utilitarian value of Latin is secondary to the cultural one.

The same issue contains an article *The predecessors of Vox Urbis (Vocis Urbis antesignani)*. It describes *Alaudae* and *Præco Latinus* and acknowledges them as the predecessors; the new journal follows in their footsteps: Ulrichs is praised as the first pioneer, while Avellanus’ steadfast perseverance is seen as an inspiration for entering this arena.⁶⁵⁵ The tradition of Latin journals was already seen as something real. It finally cites with approval a 1892 speech by the Italian Catholic naturalist Giuseppe Tuccimei in favour of Latin as the international language,⁶⁵⁶ showing that the Latin cause has scientists on its side. As a demonstration of the intimate connection that *Vox Urbis* enjoyed with the Vatican, the issue is closed with an anonymous Latin riddle in verse, a charade – it turns out that Pope Leo XIII, himself a Neo-Latin poet, used to anonymously (usually signing just as *X.*) publish riddles in *Vox Urbis*.⁶⁵⁷

Avellanus, ever self-confident, even before this issue had no doubts that it was his own agitation for Latin that caused *Vox Urbis* to appear,⁶⁵⁸ he enjoyed the praises in *Vox Urbis* and reminded that *Præco Latinus* is the *elder brother* of *Vox Urbis* (that’s true by the temporal precedence, but when compared with the learned team of contributors which wrote in *Vox Urbis*, this statement of priority is questionable). The Latin words for bicycle (*birota*) and subscription

655 de Angelis (1898)

656 de Angelis (1898, 3): “Id tandem consequi vehementer cupimus quod egregie animadvertit Iosephus Tuccimei, rerum naturae scientia et multarum doctrinarum cognitione clarissimus, latinam linguam esse restaurandam, sibi que auguratur fore ut, qui eruditione praestant atque opes suas assiduo studio conquisitas divulgant, non quique suum sed perspectum doctis omnibus latinum sermonem usurpent et scientiarum incremento prospiciant.”. See Tuccimei (1892); it employs all the usual arguments encountered in the apologiae for Latin: the international language question, the artificiality and ugliness of Volapük, the ridiculous simplified Latin projects, the cultural value and suitability of Latin, citing quite many botanical and zoological treatises written in the 19th century, and the sterile reality when Latin is only studied and not employed for practical communication.

657 *Vox Urbis* Kal. Nov. 1898 Ann. I Num. 1 p. 8. Apparently the anonymity was short-lived: the authorship riddle was solved by *Le Figaro* on 9 Jan. 1899. Panetti et al. (2014) recently published a collection that was discussed by L’Osservatore Romano (2014), Glatz (2014), Plinthos (2014). Scholarly survey given by Giustiniani (1979, 55-57).

658 *Præco Latinus* Oct. 1898 Vol. V No. 1 p. 6: “Si ergo, in *Urbe* periodicum Latinum, nobis praeuntibus, conditum sit, nos volumus esse primi, qui Cœtui Romano *Salve* gratissimum acclamamus.”; p. 9: „Nullum est dubium quin novum hoc periodicum Lñum nostræ agitationis est fructus. *<sic>* Utrum etiam Gubernaculum Regium nos audiet?”

(*subnotatio*) that *Vox Urbis* used came from *Præco Latinus*, as Avellanus thought.⁶⁵⁹ So the beginning of this connection was amicable enough – Avellanus promoted *Vox Urbis* to his readers and sent copies of his journal to Rome. However, after several issues, both of these journals stopped exchanging them and they entered into mutual disregard.

The German classical philologist Hermann Diels (1848-1922), just as so many in this era, also studied the international language question and its history; in a 1899 article on Leibniz and the problem of universal language he expressed an opinion that the scientific Latin of Kepler and Gauss could also function today, praising *Præco Latinus* as an example of Latin suitable for today.⁶⁶⁰ In another article on this question in 1901, he praised both *Vox Urbis* and *Præco Latinus*; but Latin could fulfil the practical function only if taught as a living language rather than as a philological subject.⁶⁶¹ A certain Nazareno Capo, a writer in *Vox Urbis*, summarised this article in Latin and added that he does not believe in the feasibility of this plan, but approves of the idea of Latin as the universal language of the learned. Moreover, *Vox Urbis* is going on a better path of stronger arguments and uncorrupted Latinity than *Præco Latinus*.⁶⁶² Avellanus reacted to this angrily and, after asserting that his Latin is better and more Roman, he accused *Vox Urbis* of inflexible Ciceronian purism that Diels himself rejected: it is better to propose neologisms than use periphrases.⁶⁶³ Capo responded by reprinting Avellanus' article verbatim as a demonstration of his

659 *Præco Latinus* Nov. 1898 Vol. V No. 2 pp. 30-31

660 Diels (1899, 600-601): "Ich halte persönlich das wissenschaftliche Neulatein, d. h. das Latein eines KEPLER, LEIBNIZ, LINNÉ, GAUSS, auch heute noch für durchaus geeignet zur internationalen Verständigung in wissenschaftlichen Fragen, wie es noch immer die gemeinsame Sprache der katholischen Christenheit ist. <...> In America, wo der Betrieb des Lateinischen in neuester Zeit einen merkwürdigen Aufschwung genommen hat, erscheint seit fünf Jahren ein mit Abbildungen versehenes Journal *Praeco Latinus*, das monatlich erscheint und durchaus nur actuelles Leben behandelt. Da findet man Artikel über den spanisch-americanischen Krieg, die Dreyfus-Affaire, die Frauenfrage und Parlamentsberichte aus America und Europa, Alles in der Sprache, aber glücklicherweise nicht im Stile Ciceros. Vielmehr wird das Latein, wie es für solche Zwecke selbstverständlich ist, durchaus als lebende Sprache behandelt, die sich zum Altlatein ähnlich verhält wie das Neugriechische zur Sprache des Demosthenes." The connection to Greek is similar to Avellanus' conception. Today the revival of Hebrew is sometimes compared to the revival of Latin, sometimes even coming to suggestions that maybe it was Hebrew revival efforts that inspired the Latin journals (e.g., Loch (2013, 158)), but this era hardly ever mentioned the Hebrew language (such comparisons came to vogue, it seems, only after the creation of Israel), instead seeing connections with the Greek diglossia and Katharevousa.

661 Diels (1901, 55-56): "Aber freilich dieses internationale Latein, wie es mir vor Augen schwebt, ist kein Philologenlatein, mühsam aus ciceronianischen Phrasen zusammengebraut und vor jedem modernen Luftzuge ängstlich behütet, sondern ein frisch und modern weiter gebildetes Neulatein, etwa wie es in der amerikanischen Zeitung *Praeco latinus* (*folia gentium latina menstrua litteraria ac critica, ad propagandum sermonem latinum, necnon ad fovendas litteras latinas*) oder in der römischen *Vox Urbis* (*de litteris et bonis artibus commentarius, bis in mense prodit*) zur Anwendung gelangt. <...> Natürlich müßten die Fachmänner selbst und nicht die Philologen diese Sache in die Hand nehmen. <...> Betrachtet man hingegen das Latein als eine, praktischen Zwecken dienstbare, lebendige Sprache, so muß sie natürlich auch wie andre lebende Sprachen gelehrt werden."

662 Capo (1901a, 27): "Hoc potissimum exoptamus nos, qui ad latinitatis studium amoremque propagandum iam ab initio intendimus, alio et forsitan aptiore itinere, quod ad incorruptam latini sermonis integritatem propositaque argumenta pertinet, quam alterum latinum commentarium, qui *Praeco latinus* inscribitur. Quod quidem pronuntiare liceat nobis, quibus maiorum nostrorum lingua, velut haereditate relicta, maximopere est tuenda incorruptaque servanda."

663 *Præco Latinus* Feb. 1901 Vol. VII No. 5 p. 128: "Præterea, ut doctissimus Mgr. Diels scite declaravit, Latinitas Ciceroniana pro vita practica inepta est, putatque recentiores sequi oportere, quod nostrum principium est, et a

bad Latin and bad manners, commenting on some of the points, e.g., that *Vox Urbis*, far from being only Ciceronian, goes on a sensible moderate path.⁶⁶⁴

The same year Hilary J. Doswald (1877-1951) O.C.C., a young monk of Swiss origins and a future prior general of the Order of Calced Carmelites, who had been contributing to both *Vox Urbis* and *Præco Latinus*, expressed frustration that “neither *Præco* would mention *Vox Urbis* nor *Vox Urbis* would mention *Præco*, which I found even more sad when it was clear that both of you are struggling in vain to unite various nations if you cannot even unite Latins themselves”.⁶⁶⁵ This statement was acutely correct. There were only two Living Latin periodicals in the world – but neither of them read the other. The ideological differences and personal interests were insurmountable.

In 1902, prolific writer and oriental scholar Angelo De Gubernatis (1840-1913) founded the *Helleno-Latin society* (*Società Elleno-Latina*) encouraging communication between the nations speaking Latin-derived languages (a version of pan-Latinism) and everyone united by the common Greco-Roman heritage. On 16-21 April 1903 this society convened the First International Latin congress (*Il Primo Congresso Internazionale Latino*),⁶⁶⁶ timed to follow the International congress of historical sciences (*Congresso internazionale di scienze storiche*) celebrated on 1-9 April and to precede the Birthday of Rome (21 April). It was a splendid congress celebrated in Campidoglio with about 600 participants – the Mayor of Rome was present, as were the Ministers of Education of Italy and France. There were five sessions; most of them were dedicated to various countries of Latin heritage,⁶⁶⁷ while the first one, 16 of April, was dedicated to the Dissemination of Latin and Latin culture (*propagazione del latino e della civiltà latina*). So this was the first time a congress for the revival of Latin was celebrated.⁶⁶⁸ Six presentations and two letters were delivered.⁶⁶⁹ *Vox Urbis*

nobis primo proclamatum. Circuite ergo vos quæritando phrases tortuosas et bombasticas, nos rectas vias prosequemur, “Romanum eloquium” sectando, atque, ubi res postulaverit, vocabula nova, sed legitima, tamquam pontes, fabricando. Nos præcedere quam sequi malumus.”

664 Capo (1901b)

665 *Præco Latinus* Mai. 1901 Vol. VII No. 8 p. 197: “Sed illo tempore animadverti, neque PRÆCONEM de “VOCE URBIS” neque VOCEM URBIS de PRÆCONE mentionem facere, quod mihi eo plus tristitiae afferebat, quo clarius pateret vos frustra studere, ut varias terrarum gentes coniungeretis, quum ne Latinos quidem possetis coniungere.”

666 The acts of the congress were published in *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* 1903 Aprile-Maggio Vol. II. No. 1-3; two issues of *Vox Urbis* treat the congress in Latin, especially the Latin session: Kal. et Id. Mai. 1903 Vol. VI No. 9-10

667 *La propagazione del latino e della civiltà latina; Francia e, in particolar modo, Provenza; Romania; Civiltà ibero-americana; Archeologia romana*

668 Fact noted by Lurz (1949); Slednikov (2019a, 40).

669 Angelo De Gubernatis: *Collegio Convitto Internazionale Latino in Roma*; Jacques Tasset: *De ratione, qua hodierna Europaea et cetera universarum gentium Latine dici aut significari possint*; prof. Angelo Valdarnini of Bologna: *Necessità d'una lingua internazionale e lo studio del Latino*; prof. Neno Simonetti of Liceo di Spoleto: *Per la vita del pensiero latino nella scuola secondaria*; “Il barone GUILLIBERT, anche a nome del prof. CHARPIN di Aix propugna l'uso del latino come lingua comune nella filologia.”, finally Giuseppe Fornari about *Vox Urbis*. Two letters were publicly read, sent by prof. Felice Ramorino (*Felix Ramorinus*, 1852-1929) of Florence and prof. Pietro Rasi (1857-1919) of Pavia.

was well represented. While Leonori was abroad on some architectural project, Fornari made a speech presenting the project of *Vox Urbis*. Jacques Tasset (he also contributed to *Vox Urbis*) delivered an address in Latin about the way how modern topics should be expressed in Latin. Two other contributors of *Vox Urbis* sent their letters: prof. Felice Ramorino (*Felix Ramorinus*, 1852-1929) of Florence and prof. Pietro Rasi (1857-1919) of Pavia. Woldemar Lommatzsch from Germany, publisher of *Civis Romanus*, also sent his greetings.⁶⁷⁰ Prof. Angelo Valdarnini of Bologna presented an idea to create a school in Rome where the students would live together and speak only Latin.⁶⁷¹ Finally, these conclusions, composed in Latin, were voted on and approved:

The First Latin Congress (*Primus congressus Latinorum*), gathered on 16 April 1903 in Rome, greatly desires and asks: 1) that Latin language would be considered the common language of all nations and would be used to foster, strengthen and maintain the cultural exchanges (*humanitatis commercium*); 2) that the learned societies and congresses would publish their acts, at least in summary, in Latin; 3) that all the nations would learn in schools the Latin language suitable for speaking with foreigners; 4) that for this purpose clear and brief books about everyday things would be published by experts in good Latin.⁶⁷²

This interesting initiative was covered in press, where the official endorsement of Nunzio Nasi, the Minister of Public Education, made an impression.⁶⁷³

In 1910 Leonori transferred the ownership of *Vox Urbis* to *Società Editrice Romana*, an Italy-wide trust of Catholic newspapers,⁶⁷⁴ which promised to keep up the project. Fornari continued his editorial duties. However, after December 1913 *Vox Urbis* was discontinued. The cause for its disappearance might be connected with the financial troubles *SER* was facing at the time – when in

670 *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* 1903 Aprile-Maggio Vol. II. No. 1-3 pp. 22-23

671 *Vox Urbis* Kal. Mai. 1903 Ann. VI Num. 9 p. 72: “Romae constituatur Latinum Ephebeum ingens, cuius pateant fores adolescentibus tam nostratibus Latinis, quam alienigenis, ubi et instituantur et alantur: in ipso autem singula quotidianae vitae nonnisi latine exprimentur; brevi, semper ibi omnes latine loquantur.” At least this is how *Vox Urbis* expressed it. Valdarnini’s speech in the Italian proceedings (*Cronache* <...> p. 11: “4° Istituire in Roma un grande Collegio-convitto latino, aperto a giovani di tutte le nazionalità latine di Europa e d’America.”) does not include Latin immersion, but does recommend the speaking of Latin (“Avvezzarvi i giovani a parlare anco <sic> in latino, come si fa oggi per alcune lingue straniere”). Angelo De Gubernatis also described a similar project in his speech.

672 *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* 1903 Aprile-Maggio Vol. II. No. 1-3 p. 15: “Ordine del giorno: Latinorum Conventus die XVI mensis aprilis, anno MDCCCIII primum Romae congregatus vehementer exoptat et poscit: 1) ut sermo latinus inter gentes universas communis habeatur et adhibeatur ad humanitatis commercium fovendum, augendum, tenendum; 2) ut collegia coetusque doctorum acta sua, compendio saltem, latine patefaciant; 3) ut universi populi sermonem latinum ad colloquia advenarum peregrinorumque conversationem interrogantium vel sciscitantium in ludis etiam primariis discant; 4) ut ad hoc propositum facilius assequendum libelli de rebus quotidiani usus a peritis pura latinitate lucidi tersique scribantur”

673 E.g., *The New York Times* 10 May 1903 p. 9.

674 Founded by Giovanni Grossoli in 1907, the trust later contained the *Corriere d’Italia* of Rome, *L’Avvenire d’Italia* of Bologna, *L’Italia* of Milan, *Il Momento* of Turin, *Il Messaggero toscano* of Pisa, *Il Corriere di Sicilia* of Panormo. See Malgeri (2002); Forno (2011).

Dec. 1912 its newspapers were denounced⁶⁷⁵ by the official Vatican publication as being too liberal and ecclesiastical subscriptions to them were forbidden,⁶⁷⁶ the trust found itself facing bankruptcy and shedding non-essential assets like a Latin periodical (probably not a very lucrative enterprise) was a very logical action to save the whole firm.

Undeterred, Fornari immediately started to organise a replacement for *Vox Urbis*, visiting Pope Pius X and obtaining in mid-January a handwritten apostolic benediction for the future project of *Alma Roma*. Fornari organised a foundation from volunteers supporting the project financially. Finally, on Ides of May 1914 *Alma Roma* appeared. This publication was essentially the continuation of *Vox Urbis*, it was still a publication for demonstrating the essential suitability of Latin for modern usage and advocating for Latin as the international language.⁶⁷⁷ There was the same team of contributors and the same breadth of topics: Neo-Latin poetry, translations, ecclesiastical and world news, curiosities, learned subjects.

But maybe the Catholic presence was a bit more prominent. The 18 patrons were primarily ecclesiastical figures, with Pope Pius X being the first one followed by five cardinals and nine bishops; there were only three laymen. When in September 1914 Benedict XV, who was also a reader of *Alma Roma*, was elected, Fornari was one of the first ones to get an audience.

The primacy of Rome was ever-present in this enterprise. *Alma Roma* had on its cover the Capitoline statue of goddess Roma with a cross-bearing orb in her hand, the picture inscribed with words *what she does not hold by the force of arms she holds through religion (quidquid non tenet armis relligione tenet)*,⁶⁷⁸ alluding to the Roman Papacy. *Vox Urbis* repeatedly expressed that the City of Rome and the Latin periodical should be the centre of culture connecting the world.⁶⁷⁹

The period roughly from 1927 to 1934 saw an optimism shared by all the Latin publications, including *Alma Roma* and Fornari. Could the general optimism regarding Latin's present and future

675 *Acta Apostolicae Sedis* Dec. 1912 Vol. IV Num. 21 p. 695: "Avvertenza. // A togliere l'equivoco che certi giornali vanno creando in mezzo al clero ed ai fedeli, si dichiara che la santa Sede non riconosce per conformi alle direttive pontificie <...>".

676 *Acta Apostolicae Sedis* Ian. 1913 Vol. V Num. 1 p. 7.

677 E.g., *Alma Roma* Ian. 1927 Ann. XIV Fasc. 1 p. 1: "ALMA ROMA commentarium condentes id spectavimus, ut maternae latinae vocis per orbem praeconium constitueremus, quod re ostenderet « ipsam, vel nostris ipsis diebus, sese exhibere amplissimam semper, nobilem, flexibilem aptissimamque, sine integritatis suae vitio, ad omnia vel hodiernae vitae exprimenda »; ut facile omnes recognoscerent eam etiam nunc, ut olim, adhiberi posse tamquam linguam doctorum saltem virorum, quam vocant, universalem."

678 Saint Prosper of Aquitaine, *De ingratias carmen* vv. 40-42: "Sedes Roma Petri; quo pastoralis honoris / Facta caput mundo, quidquid non possidet armis / Relligione tenet".

679 E.g., *Cronache della Civiltà Elleno-Latina* 1903 Aprile-Maggio Vol. II. No. 1-3 p. 14: "centrum nimirum voluimus ab Urbe constitui quo ceteri veluti radii se converterent indeque repercussionis quasi vi manarent". *Vox Urbis* Kal. Ian. 1905 Ann. VIII Num. 1 p. operculi II: "Vox Urbis itaque in annum MDCCCCV ea erit, quam socii voluerunt: commentarium menstruum, qui non unum Urbis augustae matris sermonem, sed omnem cultum et humanitatem referat, eaque omnia quae inde, veluti ex radiationis centro, animos usque a longissimis orbis partibus amice cum genetricis animo coniungere valeant."

expressed during these years in *Alma Roma* be connected to the increasing integration of ancient Rome to the Fascist state?⁶⁸⁰

The annual retrospectives in January or December are indicative. In the 1927 editorial *Alma Roma* believed that the Latin culture was making a return – the schools were teaching more Latin, maybe in better ways and the excessive utilitarianism that had characterised the pre-war years has receded.⁶⁸¹ The *riforma Gentile* was probably an indicator of this.

In January 1929 *Alma Roma* was happy⁶⁸² that Emmanuel Jové C.M.F., an active contributor of *Alma Roma*, followed⁶⁸³ in footsteps of it and created a new Latin periodical *Candidatus Latinus*. After all, if every religious order (Emmanuel Jové was a Claretian) would found a Latin periodical, maybe finally the Latin speakers would be united in some long-desired federation of common press and Latin could have a chance to become the universal language?⁶⁸⁴

In January 1931 *Alma Roma* notes that the idea of Latin as the proper international language is being discussed in the press and the periodical adduced as an example.⁶⁸⁵ On 12 February 1931 Pope Pius XI inaugurated the Vatican Radio with a speech in Latin;⁶⁸⁶ on 19 April, with the pope present, the radio inaugurated *Scientiarum Nuncius Radiophonicus*, a Latin programme of science news prepared (twice a month?) by the Pontifical Academy of Sciences.⁶⁸⁷ *Alma Roma* wanted to

680 Cf. Lamers and Reitz-Joosse (2016a, 12) and the mentioned pages in Arthurs (2012)

681 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1927 Ann. XIV Fasc. 1 p. 1: “At vero, fausto auspicio, postremis his temporibus, renovato non in Italia tantum, sed ubique apud exteras gentes, latinitatis cultu, eoque in ipsis scholis secundis *(sic)* ordinis longius progrediente, latus magis campus apparuit, cui semen committeretur: nos id sensimus, nec congruam operam adhibere negleximus.”

682 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1929 Ann. XVI Fasc. 1 pp. 1-2

683 This fact is confirmed by Sidera (1961, 135): “Quodam die, in deambulatione nescio quis de commentariolis latine edendis verba fecit. — « Quin edis, P. Jové, commentarios latinos? ». P. Emmanuel jam pridem in « *Alma Roma* » saepe scripserat et cum Fornario et Avenario non semel et epistulas commutaverat et quaestiones agitaverat. Jam igitur aliquantulum de commentariis scribendis idque latine cogitarat. Nemo crediderit verbum illud obiter prolatum tantae futurum esse virtutis ut tam brevi *Candidatus Latinus*, puerili ac virginali quodam rubore suffusus e prelo prodierit.”

684 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1929 Ann. XVI Fasc. 1 pp. 1-2: “Quid, si hoc exemplum aliae quoque Congregationes religiosae fuerint sequuturæ? Nonne inde exsurget foedus illud latine loquentium iam diu at frustra invocatum? Nonne sensim sine sensu latina lingua – quod semper fuit in votis nostris, quod semper appetivimus, quod diuturnis laboribus nostris assequi continenter conati sumus – universalis lingua fiet, imo redibit? // Non inutilis igitur, non vacua, neque imbecillis vita nostra; quam igitur, quoad Deus vires nobis concesserit, eodem animo forti atque erecto continuabimus.”

685 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1931 Ann. XVIII Fasc. 1 pp. 1-2.

686 *Alma Roma* Mart. 1931 Ann. XVIII Fasc. 3 pp. 37-38; p. 51. Speech given by *Acta Apostolicae Sedis* 5 Mart. 1931 Vol. XXIII Num. 3 pp. 65-70 and *Iuventus* Mart. 1931 Ann. XV Num. 7 pp. 49-51.

687 *Pontificia Accademia dei Nuovi Lincei* published the text of these news in a periodical *Scientiarum Nuncius Radiophonicus* from April 1931 to January 1936, fascicles numbering 41. Inauguration described in *La civiltà cattolica* 1931 Ann. 82 Vol. II pp. 266-267, the initiative presented by Tulli (1935).

republish the texts broadcast in this programme and did this;⁶⁸⁸ it was another demonstration that Latin is suitable for communicating modern subjects.

In January 1932 *Alma Roma* rejoiced that in Warsaw a society⁶⁸⁹ had been founded that wanted to make Latin the international language of diplomacy, sciences and scholarship. However, *Alma Roma* was a bit troubled that this society distinguished the Classical Latin from the Perennial one, making the latter one mutable and the first one dead – there is only one Latin, this Polish line of thought is dangerous, as it could produce another artificial Latin-based language rather than preserving the real one.⁶⁹⁰ *Alma Roma* and *Vox Urbis* acutely felt the tension between Latin and modernity, being convinced of the need to discuss modern subjects, but also careful to not innovate too much.⁶⁹¹

In January 1933 *Alma Roma* had two causes of joy: the advent of *Societas Latina* in Munich, which similarly advocated for Latin as the international language, and the future congress of the Institute of Roman Studies which will try to further the same aim. Just as with the Polish Latin society, great enthusiasm (the decades-long effort finally seemed to be paying off) was mixed with caution – it is always a danger that under the name of Latin something false could be introduced.⁶⁹²

688 First issue containing the news is *Alma Roma* Iul. 1931 Ann. XXIII Fasc. 7 pp. 109-112: “Scientiae pervestigationes per nuntios radiophonicos vulgatae”. The last news were published in Mart. 1936 Ann. XXIII Fasc. 3 p. 47. The texts were written by members of the Pontifical Academy of Sciences, who were scientists rather than professional Latinists, so they mostly used a practical Latin with a simple syntax and a lot of modern scientific terms. This style of Latin was praised already in the first issue of the utilitarian-minded *Societas Latina* of Munich (Oct. 1932 Vol. 1 Num. 1 pp. 19-20): “Einige Proben sollen auch hier die Anpassungsfähigkeit des Lateinischen zeigen”. For example, *Alma Roma* Aug.-Sept. 1931 Ann. XVIII Fasc. 8-9 pp. 132-133 discusses the astronomical observations of spatial distribution and redshift-determined recession velocities of spiral nebulae (as galaxies used to be called at the time) showing the expansion of the Universe: “DE DISTRIBUTIONE NEBULARUM IN UNIVERSO, DEQUE HYPOTHESI EXPANSIONIS. In observatorio Montis Wilson, anno elapso, 500 regiones sunt photographice expressae, relate ad viam lacteam, uniformiter distributae in caelo. Detectae sunt plusquam 10,000 nebularum. <...> De Sitter et Lemaire demonstrarunt, phaenomenon recessionis nebularum in theoria relativitatis explicari posse, si universum consideretur ut sphaera trium dimensionum, quae se expandit. Supponitur universum expansionem inchoasse ab illo statu aequilibrum instabilis, qui dicitur universus Einsteinii. Iuxta hanc hypothesim formatio condensationum ex materia primaeva est causa expansionis Universi, quae in indefinitum pergit. IOANNES STEIN”

689 Probably *Societas Linguae Latinae Usui Internationali Adaptandae* (*Towarzystwo umiędzynarodowienia łaciny*) which was officially founded in 1933. See Zielinski (1939); Loch (2013).

690 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1932 Ann. XIX Fasc. 1 pp. 1-2: “Diaria recens passim retulere Varsaviae Polonorum societatem esse constitutam, quae satageret ut latina lingua in civilibus negotiis inque studiis doctrinae atque optimarum artium tamquam communis redeat. Optime quidem: toto animo ad rem accedimus et libentissime plaudimus! Quum vero audimus hinc distinctionem institui inter « latinum classicum » iam mortuum, et « latinum perenne » quasi quid ex sese stans et mutabile; inde necessitatem affirmari nova omnino excudendi vocabula quae hodiernis cogitandi modis hodiernisque ingenii inventis subveniant, et alia huius generis, facere omnino non possumus quin aliquid obiiciamus. Duae enim aut plures latinae linguae inter se distinctae numquam fuere <...> Hisce tantum positis principiis, iniquius, non illitteratorum hominum communis latinus sermo cum honore revertetur; secus, non latinam, sed aliam fictam linguam, seu potius confusam congeriem, perperam efficiemus.”

691 The modern vocabulary present in *Vox Urbis* was published in Iacobelli (1914), later discussed by Iozzi (1914). Fornari provided various modern expressions in the periodical in special columns (e.g., *communia vitae*), later published separately (Fornari 1927; Fornari 1931).

692 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1933 Ann. XX Fasc. 1 pp. 1-2: “Faustis quidem pro Latinitate auspiciis annus MCMXXXIII exoritur: eius enim amicorum novum agmen in Germania, Societatis Latinae sub nomine, est recens constitutum, nempe ad latini sermonis notionem apud cultos ubique viros latius latiusque ita diffundendam, ut tandem aliquando eius usus communis fiat ad ingenii facultates explicandas ac vicissim communicandas. <...> Neque satis: in Urbe, suadente

In April 1933 Fornari participated in the Third National Congress of Roman Studies organised by the Institute of Roman Studies,⁶⁹³ presenting the history of the Latin periodicals of the 20th century.⁶⁹⁴ The congress saw a number of addresses (about eight, starting from Carlo Galassi Paluzzi himself)⁶⁹⁵ for the promotion of Latin. Another representative of *Alma Roma* in the congress was Silvio Romano,⁶⁹⁶ who defended the possibility and ease of speaking Latin once one knows the language – being surprised that Galassi Paluzzi is promoting only a Latin that would be being passively read across the world. Fornari had similar reservations.⁶⁹⁷ He liked the fact that the Institute desired to return Latin to international use and to publish dictionaries of modern terms; however, this vision was focused only on the written form of language and artificially separated it from the active use of the speech. Before writing in real Latin one already should be able to speak it. According to Fornari, the rebirth of Latin is more dependent on the reform of teaching of Latin and on the widespread development of the habit of speaking it rather than just on the development of some dictionary.

In the following years the optimism about the state of Latin endured for a while, but gradually became mixed with regret. In January 1937 *Alma Roma* announced⁶⁹⁸ the demise of *Palaestra Latina* (the continuation of *Candidatus Latinus*) because of the death of its founder (see page 172); of *Scientiarum Nuncius Radiophonicus*; of the Latin pages in *Le Forze Sanitarie* that used to be published two times a month supplemented with Latin summaries of all its articles. However, the 1936 decree mandating the active use of Latin in its teaching was a sign of great optimism. In January 1939 the feeling of progress made in the restoration of the Humanistic tradition in education and in the organisation of Latin supporters was still there; only an

Collegio ad studia romana provehenda, proxime conventus congregabitur, qui de renovando latinae linguae usu peculiare habeat disquisitiones, dum certamina habebuntur, praemiis aucta, latinis dissertationibus colloquiisque agitata. // Consilio igitur nostro, cui interdum vel aegri somniis irrisum est; pro quo, contra, per annos circiter quadraginta, cum Voce Urbis primum ac deinde cum hac Alma Roma indesinenter et sine remissione sudavimus et alsimus, iustitia denique tribuitur; fax, quam accensam servare valuimus, ignibus novis augetur; qui omnes splendida corona Almae Matris caput redimant, et ad vividam hanc lucem populos omnes alliciant. // Proximum nobis locum repetere, sine superbia, liceat: {...} Scilicet nolumus sub latinitatis specie falsum aliquid induci, quod ad rei familiaris quasi eversionem ferat. Nonne enim audivimus de duplici latinae linguae genere verba fieri: firmam alteram et suo fato functam cum classicis, alteram in progrediendo mut'

693 The relevant volumes of the proceedings of the congress: Galassi Paluzzi (1935b,c). *Alma Roma* Mai. 1933 Ann. XX Fasc. 5 pp. 73-78 also described the Latin part of the congress.

694 Galassi Paluzzi (1935b, 267): "Segue il prof. G. FORNARI che illustra *La stampa periodica latina del sec. XX*, scientifica e letteraria, prevalentemente opera religiosa, di cui egli è stato uno degli animatori.". The text of this speech does not survive, as Fornari delivered it extemporaneously from notes rather than writing it down. Fornari explained this in a letter to Guido Rispoli (1893-1982), the director of the *Ufficio Latino* of the Institute, who in 1937 tried to get the text of his presentation: "La comunicazione su la stampa periodica in lingua latina, che feci al Congresso, non la scrissi; mi servii di semplici appunti, che non so dove siano andati a finire" (*AISR Latino*.84.7).

695 See the index in Galassi Paluzzi (1935c, 163). Lyvens (2023) surveys the orators in greater detail.

696 The text of his oration is in *Alma Roma* Mai. 1933 Ann. XX Fasc. 5 pp. 74-75; the official proceedings (Galassi Paluzzi 1935b, 267) note only that "ROMANI, che rivendica l'utilità del latino parlato".

697 *Alma Roma* Mai. 1933 Ann. XX Fasc. 5 p. 77; Galassi Paluzzi (1935c, 64-65).

698 *Alma Roma* Ian. 1937 Ann. XXIV Fasc. 1 p. 2

authoritative international Latin organisation was still needed that would be tasked with coordinating the proper way of renewing Latin, standardising the neologisms and removing ambiguities in usage sometimes encountered by the Latin speakers.

The beginning of the war immediately had a chilling effect on Latin. Fornari, being encouraged to do so by Pope Pius XII, persevered with publishing the periodical, even if *Alma Roma* was increasingly cut off from its foreign subscribers and the publishing expenses were rising; because of this, in 1942 the periodical was being published only every other month and consisted of only four pages each. Fornari died suddenly in September 1942 while in Nettuno, where he was performing his duties in the children's sanatorium he headed. He had no successors for heading his project and *Alma Roma* went silent.

However, already in 1943 the Vatican Latinists working on official papal documents⁶⁹⁹ Antonio Bacci (1885-1971) and Amleto Tondini (1899-1969) noted the absence of *Alma Roma* and tried to organise a replacement for it in the framework of the Roman Curia. Pope Pius XII and Giovanni Battista Montini (the Substitute for General Affairs in the Secretary of State; from 1964 Pope Paul VI), who referred this request to the pope, were favourable to the plan, but due to the war there were neither time nor resources to start the periodical. This intention was finally fulfilled in January 1953, when the same initiators started publishing *Latinitas* on the premises of Vatican.⁷⁰⁰ The first issue contained a praise of Fornari published by his colleague Silvio Romani.⁷⁰¹ The 45-year tradition of Fornari's *Vox Urbis* and *Alma Roma* was over, but is still being continued by *Latinitas*.

4.4 *Societas Latina* in Germany

Societas Latina was founded in Munich in May 1932 by initiative of the senior director of studies (*Oberstudiendirektor*) of the *Wilhelmsgymnasium*, a classical philologist and historian Georg Lurz (1873-1946);⁷⁰² the first presidency was assumed by Hermann Weller (1878-1956), a classical

699 *The Secretariate of Briefs to Princes and of Latin Letters / Segretariato per i brevi ai principi e per le lettere latine*

700 Tondini (1962, 5-6): "Primum omnium, consilium eos [commentarios] capessendi initum est, quantum memini, anno MDCCCCXLIII, cum peraeque ab Eminentissimo Viro Antonio Bacci Card., qui eo tempore erat ab Epistulis Pontificis Maximi ad Principes, tum a me, qui scribam tunc publicis Ecclesiae negotiis procurandis agebam. Etenim, quoniam Commentariolum, cui *Alma Roma* inscriptio, vita functo Iosepho Fornari eius moderatore, viro sane integritate vitae spectabili, et plurium disciplinarum litterarumque Latinarum cognitione abundanti, in lucem edi desitum erat, idcirco illud nobis est visum, ne quae essent id genus incitamenta ad linguam Latinam excolendam, ea deficerent, aliquid ab Apostolica Sede vicem eiusdem Commentarioli tum ipsum proferri. <...> Tandem aliquando, difficultatibus perruptis, medio anno MDCCCCLII, omnia parari coepta sunt, quae ad Commentarios edendos opus erant; quibus Antonius Bacci et Hamletus Tondini uno consensu *Latinitatis* indicem praescripserunt."

701 Romani (1953)

702 Platzdasch (2021) provides the biography

philologist, indologist and the most decorated Neo-Latin poet of his generation.⁷⁰³ The aim of this organisation was proclaimed in the statute very succinctly: “the cultivation of Latin as the international auxiliary language”⁷⁰⁴. It was to be a membership-based organisation with an obligation to organise yearly meetings and to publish three or four issues of the journal *Societas Latina* written in German and Latin, which would then be distributed for free among its members, who paid a small amount of 2 reichsmark a year for the membership. When founded, it already had 100 members, while by the time the first issue of the journal was published in October 1932, the organisation already had acquired 630 members; this number would grow to about a thousand.⁷⁰⁵ The whole corpus of *Societas Latina* contains 48 issues, about 1,340 pages in an octavo format (150 × 225 mm).⁷⁰⁶ *Societas Latina* would publish 3-4 issues of its journal in a year until 1942, and would continue in a reduced capacity of one issue a year (except 1945-1946) until 1955 when the society was disbanded after facing “an end by exhaustion” with a falling membership (it was about 360 at this point) and the lack of both textual and financial contributions. After the war along with the destruction there were economic problems, the already old membership was dying out or was somewhere else (in an unknown location or in Eastern Germany where they could not pay membership fees); and it seems that there were no new members and no generational replacement that could have kept the society afloat, so “the end [came] through exhaustion.”⁷⁰⁷ The last issue was published in 1955.

The first issue of this journal tries to place Latin in the context of the international language question and to show that this “Latin movement” (*Lateinbewegung*) is a growing worldwide phenomenon.⁷⁰⁸ It gives reviews of the contemporary Latin movements in Italy and France⁷⁰⁹ and provides texts showing how Latin can be used today for any topic – Arcadius Avellanus has

703 He went on to obtain 12 gold medals and 11 *magnae laudes* from *Certamen Hoefftianum*, the most prestigious contest of Latin poetry. His poetry is published in Weller (1938) and Weller (1946), secondary literature includes Thies (31.12.1931), Morabito (1935), Dubielzig (2003), Sacré (2020c), Brückner, Dubielzig and Plieninger (2006).

704 Lurz (1932a, 1), later in p. 4 the founding statute is given verbatim: “Zweck: Pflege der lat. Sprache als internationaler Verständigungssprache.”

705 Slednikov (2019a, 42): 630 in October 1932, 900 in December 1941, 950 in December 1942, 360 in spring of 1955. Lurz (1939) says there are “amplius mille viri docti ex omnibus fere totius orbis terrarum nationibus”.

706 Platzdasch (2021)

707 *Societas Latina* (1955, 1): “Das Schicksal so mancher Lateinzeitschrift (und anderer) hat nun auch unsere *Societas Latina* ereilt: Ende durch Erschöpfung. Es kam nicht überraschend. Auf die Dauer kann den Mitgliedern der hohe Beitrag für eine verhältnismäßig geringe Gegenleistung nicht zugemutet werden. Die Mitgliederzahl nimmt ständig ab (im Vorjahr um 38 von rund 400) durch Tod, Wegzug (“unbekannt, wohin”), auch Austritt. Viele können nicht zahlen, weil sie in der Ostzone wohnen, andere warten mit der Zahlung bis zum Eintreffen des neuen Heftes. <...> Zu den finanziellen Gründen kommt der zunehmende Mangel an gehaltvollen größeren lateinisch einwandfreien Beiträgen, die allein eine solche Zeitschrift auf der Höhe erhalten können. Wenn mehr und mehr die Schriftleitung selber zur Feder griff (sie hat keine Maschine), so geschah dies wahrlich nicht aus dem Gelüsten, diese ad hoc gefertigten anspruchslosen Erzeugnisse gedruckt zu sehen, sondern nur um die Lücken zu füllen.”

708 Lurz (1932a, 1): “Ins Auge fassen ließ sich der Plan der Gründung überhaupt nur im Hinblick auf die Lateinbewegung in anderen Ländern. Diese Bewegung hat besonders seit dem Kriege stark zugenommen.”

709 Welz (1932); the anonymous article “Von der Lateinbewegung in Frankreich” immediately precedes.

published a translation of Stevenson's *Treasure Island* to Latin,⁷¹⁰ Vatican Radio broadcasts science news in Latin.⁷¹¹ It is stated that the world needs an international auxiliary language and Latin fulfils all the requirements. It is not imagined that Latin would become an international language for the masses, but *Societas Latina* is thinking "primarily of representatives of scientific professions", it strives for the "equal rights for the Latin language with every other modern national language in international scientific communication, international conferences and international journals".⁷¹² In this emphasis on the scientific communication, there is a striking similarity to the later Living Latin movement of the 1956 Avignon congress.⁷¹³

Another goal explicitly outlined from the very beginning of *Societas Latina* and common to many *Living Latin* initiatives is the lexical renovation of Latin, "the preparatory work for a modern Latin dictionary".⁷¹⁴ *Societas Latina* would become a centre of lexicographical activity. After a year of its existence a 27 page word list of modern Latin terms was published.⁷¹⁵ It was understood that the final goal of "a modern, as complete as possible, multilingual dictionary with Latin at the top" would only be achieved "after years of thorough preparation through the understanding cooperation of experts and linguists from the cultural nations", but publishing a "practical selection" of vocabulary was already an intermediate step that had "programmatic significance" for the whole project of *Societas Latina* – a call for comments and collaborations from other friends of Latin to improve on these lexical suggestions.⁷¹⁶ After this, multiple other thematic lexicographical lists and discussions were published.⁷¹⁷

The focus on the "practical Latin" and the formation of new Latin terms as a creative technical exercise without much regard to past usage tradition and to language purity was not something welcomed by everyone. In these pages one can find various neologisms and expressions manifestly borrowed from modern vernaculars, e.g. *automobilista* or *dialogus postalis*. The Latin

710 Avellanus and Stevenson (1922)

711 For example, these news were published in *Alma Roma* and broadcast by the Vatican Radio: "De novis usibus ampullae electronicae", "De actione quorundam metallorum in vegetationem". See footnote 687 and 688.

712 Lurz (1932a, 3)

713 Capelle and Quigley (1953) has the same thesis.

714 Lurz (1932a, 1): "eine entsprechende Höhe der Mitgliedernzahl soll es überdies möglich machen, die weiteren praktischen Arbeiten vor allem die Vorarbeiten zu einem neuzeitlichen lateinischen Wörterbuch, in Angriff zu nehmen."

715 Societas Latina (1933b)

716 Societas Latina (1933b, 53-54): "Unser letztes Ziel ist die Herausgabe eines neuzeitlichen, möglichst vollständigen, mehrsprachigen Wörterbuches mit Latein an der Spitze. Dieses Ziel ist nur nach jahrelanger und gründlicher Vorbereitung zu erreichen durch verständnisvolle Zusammenarbeit von Sach- und Sprachkennern der Kulturnationen. Die Zusammenarbeit zerstreutet Ausschüsse gestaltet sich erfahrungsgemäß langwierig. Noch vor der Bildung solcher Ausschüsse glaubten wir einmal frisch zugreifen zu sollen, um eine praktische Auswahl zu bieten, die als Probe zugleich programmatische Bedeutung hat. Möchten nun die Anhänger unserer Bewegung nicht zurückhalten mit Stellungnahme und Verbesserungsvorschlägen! Wir bitten um Mithilfe aller Lateinfreunde."

717 For example, Goslar (1936), Wüschmidt (1941), Lurz (1952).

term preferred by *Societas Latina* for “post”, *posta*,⁷¹⁸ became a matter of controversy between *Alma Roma* and *Societas Latina*.⁷¹⁹ Giuseppe Fornari, the publisher of *Alma Roma*, published an article in his *Alma Roma* accusing this usage. Andreas Avenarius (*Andreas Haberl*, 1885-1970), a member of the *Societas Latina*, replied that *posta* has an ultimately Latin origin (from the participle *posita* present in the phrase *statio posita*), and, most importantly, it has a certain kind of semantic transparency so useful for today’s communication, much more so than the older classical term *cursus publicus*.⁷²⁰ Avenarius agreed with Fornari that it is indeed unacceptable to attach Latin endings to any vernacular word and call the resulting language Latin, but argued that some international vernacular words should be accepted into Latin for convenience. Fornari did not accept that any kind of contemporary popularity of a particular non-Latin word is an argument for it to be included in the Latin language. For him, the tradition and backward compatibility of the language is paramount: no new words should be introduced to replace those which are already present in the language and which mean the same thing.⁷²¹ According to Fornari, the way to proceed if we want to restore the use of Latin is to collect a learned team which would comb through the great dictionaries of Egidio Forcellini, Karl Ernst Georges, Tommaso Vallauri covering the complete chronological span of Latin (*in totius latinitatis lexicis*) and, having collected expressions suitable for modern use, would then organise them thematically and describe them both in Latin and vernacular. This would be a great support for restoring the use of Latin (*ita latinae linguae restituendae optimos dabimus calculos*) and would ensure the further stability of the language.⁷²² This exchange between Avenarius and Fornari continued for a while in pages of *Alma Roma* – while Avenarius saw an inflexible purism in Fornari, Fornari saw in Avenarius unnecessary innovations endangering the principal virtues of Latin language.⁷²³

Discussions like this show how different the conceptions of the language could be between different groups, in this case the Roman *Alma Roma* and the Munich *Societas Latina*, striving for superficially the same goal: the restoration of Latin as an international language. Georg Lurz saw

718 Lurz (1935a, 35). This term has been not infrequently used in Neo-Latin texts and later in the Living Latin movement; for examples in Karl Heinrich Ulrichs’ *Alaudae*, see Laes (2022a).

719 Slednikov (2017a, 229). Lurz (1936); *Societas Latina*, Fornari and Avenarius (1936); *Societas Latina* and Fornarius (1936).

720 *Societas Latina*, Fornari and Avenarius (1936, 18): “Nam etsi cursus publicus et diribitorium antiquiora sunt, ibisne infitias internationalem hanc vocem quae est posta, quae praesertim indicem trahat ex sermone Latino, simplicitatem subministrare ut ita dicam appellatoriam maiorem, quam cursum publicum?”

721 *Societas Latina* and Fornarius (1936, 33): “ego vero ulterius contendo, impugnandam in novis vocabulis licentiam tum etiam quum ad rem exprimendam iam in latinitatis thesauro exstent vocabula.”

722 *Societas Latina* and Fornarius (1936, 34)

723 Lurz (1937)

the solution for agreement only in a possible future worldwide council of Latin (*Senatus ille Societatis Gentium Latinae*) that would decide the matter.⁷²⁴

So the unification of the worldwide Latin movement through a common organisation and a common dictionary was a desideratum which surfaced again and again. Until this could happen, *Societas Latina* concentrated on giving a synoptic view of what was happening in the various parts of this perceived worldwide Latin movement. A historical and contemporary review of Latin periodicals was given,⁷²⁵ and from the next issue of December 1935 until the end of the journal in 1955 most issues contained a *Periodicorum conspectus*, the tables of contents of all journals accessible to *Societas Latina*.⁷²⁶ Developments abroad were reported; for example, the Italian movement for Latin was often reviewed.⁷²⁷

Indeed, this is where Lurz saw the possible salvation for Latin, Rome was perceived to be the real centre of the present Latin movement:

An international senate of Latin is needed. But who has the authority to establish this senate? // Italy holds the first place among nations participating in our cause. In Italy the Latin language is learned as a living one. In Italy many Neo-Latin vocabularies have already been published. No other country discusses the Latin cause in periodicals and newspapers so often and so vehemently as Italy does. The Roman Institute and its president *Galassi Paluzzi*, *vir fortissimus*, for fifteen years has been putting great effort to restore the former use of Latin language; already for three years they have been publishing the international journal “Per lo studio e l’uso del latino”, giving great joy to all the supporters of Latin. We hope that they will undertake also this noble task.⁷²⁸

4.4.1 Relationship with the artificial language movement

The similarity of a formal membership-based organisation promoting the use of an international Latin language to those numerous organisations which were founded for promoting

724 Lurz (1937, 5): “Suo iure igitur dicit Avenarius noster „cursum publicum“ etiam „postam“ vocari posse. Quae vox civitatem quandam adeptam est usu. Usus nonne appellatur tyrannus? Usus nonne maximi momenti est in omnibus linguis? Utinam brevi constituatur Senatus ille Societatis Gentium Latinae! Cuius Senatus consultum erit suprema lex. Donec autem liberum erit arbitrium, haud pauci, credo, assentientur Avenario nostro.”

725 Lurz (1935a)

726 Primarily *Alma Roma*, *Auxilium Latinum* (see footnote 529), *Iuventus*, *Palaestra Latina*. Later also *Nuntius Latinus*, *Inter Nos*, *Der Lateiner*, *Lygia*, *Per lo studio e l’uso del Latino*. Sacré (1988) describes these.

727 Welz (1932); Lurz (1935b); Societas Latina (1933a); Societas Latina (1936)

728 Lurz (1941): “Opus est internationali senatu latino. Sed quis auctoritatem habet instituendi hunc senatum? // Inter nationes rei nostrae participes principem locum tenet Italia. In Italia lingua latina discitur ut viva. In Italia iam complura vocabularia neolatina prodierunt. In nulla alia terra tam saepe acriterque in diurnis periodicisque de re latina disseritur quam in Italia. Institutum Romanum eiusque praeses *Galassi Paluzzi*, *vir fortissimus*, ex quindecim annis enixe operam dant, ut restituatur pristinus linguae latinae usus; ex tribus annis summo cum gaudio omnium linguae latinae cultorum publicant periodicum internationale sub titulo «Per lo studio e l’uso del latino». Speramus eos esse adituros hoc quoque officium nobile.”

Esperanto is not coincidental. The founder of the society, Georg Lurz, explicitly stated that the world faces a choice between Esperanto and Latin and that the example of Esperantists is to be followed in order to compete – all friends of Latin need to be collected into a “similar society”. Lurz sees his *Societas Latina* as founded in response to both the Esperanto movement and the broader movement for the international language: “It is clear for everyone that many learned men desired an international auxiliary language for a long time. This desire again and again became apparent after that calamitous World War. Growing numbers of people have been declaring that it is time to return to the Latin language.”.⁷²⁹

Because of this connection, from the very beginning,⁷³⁰ the journal contains many theoretical discussions of the international language question and descriptions of the competing artificial languages.⁷³¹ Lurz describes *Societas Latina* as being one of the best neutral places for these discussions and comparisons.⁷³² The highly sophisticated level of technical and historical knowledge of various artificial languages and of the history of the international language question that Georg Lurz exhibits makes one believe that this was his original passion. The fourth issue of the periodical already contains a huge word list, the groundwork for a future dictionary of neologisms.⁷³³ This approach is similar to those used by many of the artificial language engineers, who liked to produce word lists before actually using the language. Moreover, one of the original criteria for the composition of this dictionary was the licence to adopt recognisable international words to the language directly – this criterion was very productive in the design of the artificial international languages.⁷³⁴

729 Lurz (1939): “Auxiliarem linguam internationalem iam pridem a multis viris doctis desiderari inter omnes constat. Quod desiderium post funestum illud gentium bellum iterum iterumque apparuit. Redeundum esse ad linguam Latinam in dies plures profitebantur. In periodico, quod inscribitur «Schönere Zukunft» anno 1928 sub titulo «Das Weltspracheproblem» disserui de hoc universalis linguae problemate; quam late sit divulgata artificiosa illa lingua, cui nomen Esperanto, postquam descripsi, aut Esperanto aut Latina lingua esse utendum asseveravi; permagnas autem restituendi linguam Latinam difficultates superari non posse nisi coniunctis viribus omnium linguae Latinae amicorum; Esperantistarum exemplum esse sequendum; simili opus esse societate.”

730 For example, Lurz (1932b) is a comprehensive survey of international languages, comparing translations of a fragment of Goethe to Latin, Esperanto, Novial, Occidental, Interlingua (Latino sine flexione) and explaining the grammar and pronunciation of these languages, commenting on their relative success and even giving bibliographies for these languages. Judging from this level of technical detail, the international language question had long been a long and enthusiastic interest for him.

731 Slednikov (2017a) collected an example bibliography. See also Lather (2013).

732 Lurz (1939): “Fieri non potuit, quin saepius disserteretur de linguis arte fictis. Semper disseruimus sine ira et studio. <...> Nusquam credo pariter atque in periodico nostro hoc modo facultatem dari conferendi varias linguas arte fictas vel inter se vel cum sermone Latino.”

733 *Societas Latina* (1933b)

734 For example, this list contains entries like this: *Hockey* – *ludus 'hockey'*; *Film* – *pellicula, taenia, filmus*;

4.4.2 Political context

It is interesting that Georg Lurz published his remarks about *Societas Latina* being a neutral discussion ground for discussing international languages in an Italian journal in 1939, when Esperanto and generally all artificial language organisations had been forcibly dissolved in Nazi Germany already in 1936 after an extensive propaganda campaign.⁷³⁵

It appears that *Societas Latina* was suspected of harbouring anti-German sentiments because it seemingly favoured a language other than German for international communication. Already in 1933 the publishers felt it necessary to defend themselves against accusations that *Societas Latina* should be counted among antinational organisations because “the efforts to create an international language of communication are damaging the world status of the mother tongue”.⁷³⁶ *Societas Latina* denied that its activities in any way damage the mother tongue and claimed that Latin can even help Germans speak their own language by eliminating superfluous foreign words (*bei der Ausmerzung überflüssiger Fremdwörter*) and making it purer: if only one translates a foreign word into Latin, reducing the concept to its principal constituents, and translates it back into German, one might obtain the best German rendering.⁷³⁷ It is not clear if this was a sincere conviction or an excuse; paradoxically, a similar line of argument was also attempted in Germany for defending Esperanto.⁷³⁸ Another contributor of *Societas Latina* affirmed that “the use of Latin as an auxiliary language which would similarly be understood in the whole world” was to be only complementary to the use of the mother tongue.⁷³⁹

Societas Latina managed to maintain neutrality during the Nazi era and to keep its neohumanist character.⁷⁴⁰ Several published texts are related to the regime: some propagandistic Wehrmacht songs, the *Horst-Wessel-Lied* (the National Socialist party anthem) translated into Latin

735 Lins (2016, 117)

736 *Societas Latina* (1933b, 56): “Schließlich sei noch eine Bemerkung erlaubt zu dem Vorwurf, die Bemühungen um eine internationale Verständigungssprache schädigten die Weltgeltung der Muttersprache, die Soc. Latina sei deshalb unter die antinationalen Organisationen zu rechnen!”

737 *Societas Latina* (1933b, 56): “mehrmals aber zeigte es sich, daß die lateinische Übersetzung des Fremdworts geradezu die gut deutsche Wiedergabe liefert: Dependance = domus secunda = Beihaus, Boykott = exclusio = Ausschuß, kokett = placendi studiosus = gefallsüchtig, Initiative = primus impulsus = (erster) Anstoß, Antrieb, Intrigue = fallacia, dolus = Hinterlist u. a.”

738 Lins (2016, 90); Garvía (2015, 127): “As the Nazi Esperantists saw it (at least Zamenhof was already dead and would not have to see this development), Esperanto could be instrumental for international propaganda, as well as for strengthening the Deutschtum by protecting the German language from the invasion of foreign words.”

739 Lamer (1935, 128): “Non puto opus esse negare socios ad tantam stultitiam progredi, ut sermoni patrio praeferant linguae Latinae usum; quod si voluissent, risum movissent neque quisquam eos secutus esset. Immo id student, ut usui sermonis patrii, quem imprimis diligunt et colunt, addant usum linguae Latinae quasi linguae auxiliariae, quae pariter intellegatur in toto orbe terrarum («Welthilfssprache»).

740 Slednikov (2017a, 231-233) gives a review of this topic. “Revera iis plurimis, quae tunc temporis periodico continebantur, rerum civilium incuria aperitur quam miranda tam honoratu digna.”.

were published;⁷⁴¹ Hans Lis from Breslau (current Wrocław) published his Latin translations of speeches by Hitler and Mussolini both in *Societas Latina* and in Italian periodicals for Latin.⁷⁴²

However, *Societas Latina* also published texts contrary to the National Socialist ideology and policies. It published an antisemitism-criticising Latin poem “Y” by Hermann Weller, the founder of *Societas Latina*. This poem had received in 1938 a gold medal in the prestigious Latin poetry competition *Certamen Hoefftianum*.⁷⁴³ Julius Stern (1865-1942), a Jewish author, a teacher of Latin and Greek in a gymnasium of Baden-Baden, regularly appeared in pages of *Societas Latina* until his death by suicide in 1942. Stern foreboded his imminent arrest and his self-inflicted death occurred the very next day after he finished composing three Latin poems about the deaths of Epicurus, Petrarch and Erasmus, which were later published in *Societas Latina*. In the obituary his life was described in glowing terms without mentioning his nationality.⁷⁴⁴ So it seems that the journal was open to some Nazi-themed publications submitted by its members, but they never were presented in a prominent place and if they represented the editorial policy of *Societas Latina*, no such circumventions of the governmental policies would have happened.

4.5 *Iuventus* in Hungary

The Interwar period in Hungary is marked by a Latin journal *Iuventus* which flourished throughout the period.⁷⁴⁵ *Iuventus* was founded in Budapest in 1910 with a very clear practical and pedagogical aim in mind: to make pupils in school interested in Latin. At the time there used to be many complaints about the generally insufficient progress by school students in Latin, and some sort of remedy was being sought for that. And so Antal Prónai (1871-1914), a Piarist teacher from Budapest, participated in September 1909 in a conference by the Hungarian Catholic School Teacher Association (*Katolikus Középiskolai Tanáregyesület*) and managed to convince them that the novelty of having a journal written in Latin, filled with all sorts of interesting texts, would make pupils more motivated to learn the language.⁷⁴⁶ After this success, Prónai sought to secure funding

741 Slednikov (2017a, 232); *Societas Latina* (1934)

742 In *Societas Latina*: Lis (1938), Lis (1940); in the *Per lo studio*: Lis (1941). A translation by Lis of a 1937 speech by Mussolini was published in *Alma Roma*. About Hans Lis’ translations see also Sacré (2015b) and Luggin (2020, 133-134).

743 Dubielzig (2003)

744 Literature about Julius Stern includes Slednikov (2017a, 232-233); Slednikov (2019a, 95-96); Lather (2013, 236-237); Dubielzig (2003); Ruch (2015); Weise (2020).

745 The statistics and the general evolution of the journal are narrated in detail by Wagner (1941a), a booklet published for 25 year anniversary of *Iuventus*. The contents are summarised in Latin by Wagner (1941c), Friml (1941), Dutoit (1941), another presentation of *Iuventus* for international audience is Wagner (1939a). The other writings by Wagner are also informative: Wagner (1939b), Wagner (1941b). Regarding secondary scholarly literature, *Iuventus* is treated by Fehér (2015a), Slednikov (2017a), Slednikov (2019a), Sacré (1988), Sacré (1995), Viczián (2000), Bartók (2005), Visontay (1999).

746 Friml (1941)

for the enterprise, and managed to obtain it thanks to the benevolence of the *Society of Saint Stephen* (*Szent István Társulat*),⁷⁴⁷ the biggest Catholic publishing house in Hungary, which agreed to publish this periodical in its press.⁷⁴⁸

The first issue of the periodical came out already in January 1910. By the end of the year, there were about two thousand subscribers in Hungary and multiple abroad. By the beginning of the First World War the number of subscribers in Hungary stayed at about 2000, there were additional German and French editions published for posting abroad, even an English one considered. The World War prevented the foreign readers from receiving the journal, while in the aftermath of the War in 1919 the short-lived Hungarian Soviet Republic prohibited all “bourgeois press”. After the post-war period of Hungarian economical difficulties passed and the currency was finally stabilised, *Iuventus* was re-established in 1926. In the years immediately preceding the Second World War, *Iuventus* under the leadership of József Wagner (1882-1956) had an actively growing readership – in the 1938/1939 school year there were 2400 readers in Hungary and more than 700 abroad.⁷⁴⁹ From these statistics it seems that it was numerically probably the most widely read Latin journal at the time – while other Latin journals were directed mostly to enthusiasts and educated Latinists, *Iuventus* had a very wide demographic of young readers and was connected with the educational system.

However, it did not survive the Second World War, even though it held on almost to the very end of it – in 1944 October⁷⁵⁰ the last issue of *Iuventus* was published. Precisely during this month the regent of the Kingdom of Hungary Miklós Horthy was deposed by Nazi Germany (which had occupied the country beforehand) and a puppet regime installed; at this time war was being waged on Hungarian territory, already much of it occupied by the invading Soviet forces. *Iuventus* could not survive this – and even if it had lived through the end of the Second World War, being on the eastern side of the Iron Curtain was a deciding factor determining the fate of the classical language education. In 1948 the Soviet-directed education reform removed Latin from the secondary education system,⁷⁵¹ and because *Iuventus* had been founded precisely for students in secondary schools, it would have lost all its purpose.

The character of *Iuventus*, therefore, was very different from that of *Societas Latina* and *Alma Roma*. It was intended that the periodical needs to be legible for everyone who started

747 *Szent István Társulat* was founded in 1848 and is still in business. Its headquarters were called the *Stephaneum*, so this publishing house name is used in the published material.

748 Friml (1941)

749 The story is traced according to Wagner (1939a), Wagner (1941a).

750 Viczián (2000)

751 Bancroft (1973)

learning Latin not so long ago,⁷⁵² so the texts were selected to be interesting and engaging for young readers, they were classified (*lectoribus minimis, mediis, maioribus*), there were quite many illustrations. Long treatises about abstract topics were discouraged and not much published; surveys of subscribers performed by *Iuventus* also indicated that readers prefer more engaging genres. Pupils were encouraged to submit their own Latin writings to the journal to be published, prizes for best compositions were instituted, there were various Latin puzzles in every issue to be solved. The reader engagement was tracked – the statistics of pupils submitting their writings and solutions were measured.⁷⁵³ Judging from the journal issues, it seems that indeed the pupils would often publish their stories and translations in Latin. So the publishing of *Iuventus* was very methodical and optimised for its target audience.

Even though *Iuventus* was not dedicated to being a discussion forum regarding modern Latin, its vocabulary and ideology, it nevertheless could be described as a full-fledged *Living Latin* movement, performing the complete programme characteristic to such movements. The publishers of *Iuventus* were adapting the Latin language to modern purposes – the journal was written fully in Latin, the Latin texts were usually about modern topics with modern words, while the translations of the more difficult or unusual words were provided in footnotes.

Iuventus became even more involved in the *Living Latin* trend after József Wagner, a classical philologist and a layman, became the editor of *Iuventus* in September 1934. He immediately stated that *Iuventus* has as one of its aims the demonstration that in Latin it is possible to talk not only on ancient subjects, but also on modern ones, just like what the other Latin periodicals are doing.⁷⁵⁴ The same month a regular news column (*Nuntii recentissimi*) returned to *Iuventus*, soon more texts on the subject of the movement were published,⁷⁵⁵ and in 1937 there appeared a new column called the *Living Latin* (*Latinum vivum*) covering various news about the initiatives of this kind. The same year Wagner published a Hungarian-Latin dictionary of modern terms.⁷⁵⁶ Its vocabulary is not particularly purist (as *Alma Roma* would try to be in order to prove the cultural continuity of Latin), the terms are more functional and consistent with a nod to the practical usage of Latin (in line with the style of *Societas Latina*). Among other writings, he also published about the international language question and Latin's place in it, about the history of the

752 Sacré (1995, 8) provides the introduction of the first issue: “Grato animo accipiat *Iuventutem*, quae vos omnes et maiores et minores pari amore amplectitur; ideoque consilium est nobis ita scribere, ut ab iis quoque intellegamur, qui linguam Latinam paucos ante annos discere coeperant.”

753 Some statistical tables were published in Wagner (1941a).

754 *Iuventus* Sept. 1934 Vol. XIX No. 1 p. 1

755 In 1936 professor Otto Schmied from Vienna published a three-part lecture about the *Living Latin language* (*De lingua Latina viva*), Ladislaus Magyar published an article *About the Latin language that is being revived* (*De lingua Latina revivescenti*).

756 Wagner (1937)

“Neo-Latin movement” (*neolatin mozgalom*).⁷⁵⁷ Beside the change in the direction from a predominantly pedagogical one to something that could be called *Living Latin* activism, it seems that Wagner’s arrival also heralded a general literary shift of the periodical – while the earlier issues contained more generic and pedagogical texts, now the pages often contained Latin translations of recent Hungarian and other Central European literature.⁷⁵⁸ Among other initiatives of *Iuventus* in its latter years, in 1939-1940 *Iuventus* performed broadcasts in Latin in Budapest radio,⁷⁵⁹ announced regular lectures in Latin happening in Budapest.⁷⁶⁰

When in 1938 the International Eucharistic Congress was to be held in Budapest and numerous people were to arrive from around the world, *Iuventus* tried to use this occasion to organise in Budapest the *First International Latin congress* (*az első nemzetközi latin kongresszus, Congressus Latinus Internationalis*).⁷⁶¹ However, this project did not succeed because only theological themes were allowed in the congress. *Iuventus* also hoped to organise a parallel event with colleagues from Germany, but the National Socialist government unexpectedly introduced an anti-Catholic measure to prevent anyone from Germany or Austria to come to Hungary during the time of the Eucharistic Congress. Nonetheless, *Iuventus* reached out to Carlo Galassi Paluzzi, the director of the *Istituto di Studi Romani*, regarding this idea, and he replied that “we are really thinking about announcing an international congress for promoting the rebirth of the use and the study of the Latin language; but it will be needed to wait several months until we can prepare this in an adequate manner”.⁷⁶² It was originally announced that this congress would happen in the autumn of 1938 (this message was published in *Societas Latina* and *Iuventus*), but it seems that later this date was postponed to 1940 “when the necessary preparatory work will have been done”.⁷⁶³ But the war prevented this plan from happening.

So the immediate pre-war situation regarding Latin initiatives had most of the phenomena associated with the post-World War II movement – periodicals, radio broadcasts, translations, Latin

757 Wagner (1941b); Wagner (1941c). *Iuventus* Dec. 1939 Vol. XXIV No. 4 pp. 52-54 contains an interesting article “Vivum Latinum. De lingua latina mediatrice inter Hungariam ceterasque nationes.”, p. 53: “*Motus neolatinus* nominatur conatus eorum, qui student linguam Latinam usui internationali adaptare. Centrum et spiritus rector hujus motus neolatini est in urbe Roma «Istituto di Studi Romani», cujus patronus, Victorius Emmanuel imperator et rex, praeses autem honorarius Mussolini Dux, et auctoritate suā et pecuniā adjuvant *<sic>* hos conatūs.”

758 Fehér (2015a) treats the field of poetry translations in *Iuventus*, giving the role of Wagner in p. 286. a bibliography is provided in Fehér (2015b).

759 Wagner (1941a, 15). For example, *Recitatio Latina radiophonica* in *Iuventus* Mart. 1940 Vol. XXIV No. 7 pp. 82-83 is about the history of József Eötvös College in Budapest. In autumn of 1940 the war situation started to interfere with ordinary life and broadcasts were no longer possible.

760 *Iuventus* Dec. 1941 Vol. XXVI No. 4 p. 38

761 The question was first raised in September 1937 (*Iuventus* Id. Sept. 1937 Vol. XXII No. 1 pp. 11-12).

762 *Iuventus* Id. Ian. 1938 Vol. XXII No. 5 p. 75 cites the exact words from Carlo Galassi Paluzzi’s letter: “Noi pensiamo realmente a bandire un congresso internazionale per promuovere il rifiorire dell’uso e dello studio della lingua latina; occorerà tuttavia attendere ancora alcuni mesi per prepararlo in maniera adeguata.”

763 Wagner (1939b, 68); Wagner (1941a, 14-15); *Societas Latina* (1938)

circuli and almost a dedicated international congress. The place of Latin in the culture and the educational system was stronger. However, the political situation was quite different. If that congress of 1940 in Mussolini's Rome would have happened, it would have had a different emphasis than the 1956 Avignon congress. The international language usage aspect would be there, but it is doubtful it would have been a call for a united Europe.

If we look into the contents of *Iuventus*, we see some signs of the times and how its political position contrasts with that of the other Latin periodicals. It is explicitly both *Catholic* and *national(istic)*. *Alma Roma* is an explicitly Catholic journal, published in close relationship with the Vatican, and even if it is located in Rome, it consciously represents the Church more than it represents the Italian state. *Iuventus*, in contrast, even if being published by an association of Catholic teachers and a Catholic publishing house, often represents Hungary and its interests. During the First World War, it enthusiastically supports the Central powers and mocks their enemies (for example, in December 1914 Serbians are called "a filthy barbarian people, who have since the oldest times enjoyed the killing of their kings"),⁷⁶⁴ in the thirties the news about the Italy's invasion of Abyssinia are commented approvingly,⁷⁶⁵ as is the rearmament of Germany.⁷⁶⁶ This rearmament of Germany is held to be a just and desirable example also for Hungary to imitate: the 1920 Treaty of Trianon, by which Hungary lost 70% of its pre-war territory, had a hard-to-overestimate effect on the minds of Hungarians and resulted in a Hungarian irredentism very much felt both in the politics of Interwar Hungary and also in the pages of *Iuventus*. And so *Iuventus* celebrated in its first pages the Czechoslovakian territories annexed by Hungary in 1938,⁷⁶⁷ the annexation of Northern Transylvania in September 1940⁷⁶⁸ and already in October *Iuventus* provided a ready-to-sing Latin version with musical notes of the *Transylvanian March* that had been composed maybe only days ago.⁷⁶⁹ In a similarly swift reaction, after Benito Mussolini's aviator son Bruno died in August 1941,

764 *Iuventus* 1914 Cal. Dec. Vol. VI No. 1 pp. 1-2 *Bellum nostrum*: "Serbiani, barbarorum populus immundus, qui ab antiquissimis temporibus regum suorum caedibus gaudebant, denique manus sceleratas in regem nostrum futurum intentavere."

765 *Iuventus* 1935 Id. Oct. Vol. XX No. 2 p. 27: "natio fascistarum a duce ingenioso, Mussolinio reorganisata et quasi renata neglectis statutis Societatis Nationum, fines invasit Abyssinae, populi fere barbari, qui quamquam sodalis est Societatis Nationum, tamen servitutem vetitam adhuc colit et sustinet."

766 *Iuventus* 1935 Mai. Vol. XIX No. 9 p. 97: "Naves submarinae iterum in Germania construuntur. Quis enim aut vetare aut prohibere auderet vel posset? Gigas, sicut Gulliver in fabula Swiftii, catenas a pumilionibus iniectas decussit et ius aequalitatis sibi primo impetu recuperavit, dum nos, populi parvi, Hungari, Austriaci et Bulgari, idem ius humanum recipiendi causa Nationum Societati supplicamus, tamquam mendici stipem colligentes."

767 *Iuventus* Id. Nov. 1938 Vol. XXIII No. 3 pp. 33-34

768 *Iuventus* Id. Sept. 1940 Vol. XXV No. 1 pp. 1-2

769 This fact is noted by Fehér (2015a, 285). The march was originally in Hungarian and translated into Latin as *Embaterium Transsilvaniense* (*Iuventus* Oct. 1940 Vol. XXV No. 2 p. 11). The original author is Gyula Somogyvári, a contemporary Hungarian writer.

József Wagner immediately penned a short poem likening the father-son pair to Daedalus and Icarus and had it published in September.⁷⁷⁰

What can we take from this? It is only natural that a journal published in a particular nation usually represents its interests and feelings, and it seems that all these positions were mainstream in Hungary.⁷⁷¹ However, in this case the journal is not in the vernacular language, it is in Latin, it is expected to somehow belong to the ideal *res publica litterarum*, to an international and timeless audience. So the relationship with the Latin language is profoundly altered. It is no longer using a frame of reference slightly abstracted from the reality and rooted in classicising imagery, it is now intimately connected to the current Hungarian reality and the Hungarian point of view. Latin is now a medium reporting the most recent news for a particular national audience through their own eyes.

The fact that *Iuventus* formed a part of the Hungarian educational system might be the key for explaining this situation. *Iuventus* was performing a formative function for a wide section of society, its target audience was not limited to a quite closed circle of learned enthusiasts. In many (most?) schools of Hungary Latin teachers would read this journal in class with their students. In this position the societally dominant ideology is much more likely to be present and relevant to the situation. Is not clear if the state itself explicitly participated or embraced this project, but it seems from pages of *Iuventus* that they were corresponding with government officials, for example, presenting their journal to the minister of education.

It is interesting to compare this to the Italian situation. In Italy in the 1930s, especially after 1936, when the written and spoken use of Latin in education was embraced by a royal decree in order to make its teaching more vivid,⁷⁷² numerous Latin books were published for school use that included explicitly Fascist themes. So, for example, a school pupil could read in detail in a reader published in 1937⁷⁷³ about the events of the most recent Italian invasion of Ethiopia. However, even if these texts exist, it is not clear how widely they were adopted in the Italian schools, while we know that *Iuventus* during the Second World War was read nationwide in Hungarian schools.⁷⁷⁴ *Iuventus* was performing a similar role of making Latin in schools modern, relevant and vivid, and it was doing this for far longer (since the 1910s) than the Italian attempt. Moreover, it was a richly

770 *Iuventus* Sept. 1941 Vol. XXVI No. 1 p. 7: *De morte immatura Brunonis Mussolini*

771 As Fehér (2015a, 285) puts the situation of the content of Latin translations in *Iuventus*: “Naturally there are some ‘compulsory readings’, works which had to be done for the sake of ideology, their actuality, political loyalty or simply the all-national strive for the revision of the Trianon treaty.”

772 See footnote 554.

773 Balboni and Neri (1937)

774 Wagner (1941a, 16) states that “in this academic year (1940-1941) there is barely any secondary school in Hungary that does not read *Iuventus*”. (“Az elvesztett külföldi olvasókat pótolta a visszaszerzett felvidék és Kárpátalja, úgyhogy a folyó 1940-41. tanévben már alig van hazai középiskola, melyben a *Juventust* ne olvasnák, a rejtvénymegfejtések száma már két ízben is 300 fölé emelkedett, a 30-40 intézetből beküldött kézirat is olyan mennyiségben érkezik, mintha még mindig havi 16 oldalon jelennék meg folyiratunk.”)

illustrated journal that regularly presented the newest events together with other engaging material, so it might have been more engaging and effective than the Italian way of publishing ideological texts in separate and irregular books. However, it is more likely that in *Iuventus* the ideological themes emerged naturally and reflected the Hungarian society and its educational system rather than being obviously influenced by governmental backing as in the Italian case. Latin was probably rather a reflection than a tool for this.

Catholicism in *Iuventus* is very much present – the journal printed many texts about religious feasts, Catholic saints, popes, cardinals, excerpts from Scripture, religious hymns. *Iuventus* corresponded with Jusztinián Cardinal Serédi, the Archbishop of Esztergom and Primate of Hungary,⁷⁷⁵ copies of the journal were given to the popes Pius XI⁷⁷⁶ and Pius XII.⁷⁷⁷ This particular combination of Catholicism and conservative right-wing politics was appreciated by José Maria Mir CMF (1912-2000), a member of the Claretian missionary order, the publisher of the Latin journal *Palaestra Latina* in Spain. In a letter to József Wagner in January 1943, after praising the Hungarian efforts in teaching and promoting Latin, he goes on to state his appreciation of how the Hungarian journal was “on the right side” of the Spanish Civil War: “Who would not praise the Catholic sensibilities that abound in *Iuventus*? ⟨...⟩ When in the recent war dear Mother Spain was fighting her enemies (not sons!), *Iuventus* always defended and supported the Nationalists. If then no Spaniard had given thanks for this to you yet, please accept our gratitude ⟨...⟩ In these mournful events you, the far off Hungarians, had a sincere sympathy of us.”⁷⁷⁸ The Claretians of Cervera indeed suffered a terrible fate in the Spanish Civil War – Emmanuel Jové CMF (1885-1936), the founder of the periodicals *Candidatus Latinus* and *Palaestra Latina*,⁷⁷⁹ became one of the 51 Claretian victims of the Massacre of Barbastro perpetrated by Communists in 1936.⁷⁸⁰ If anything, this serves as another demonstration of how often Latin, Catholicism and right-wing politics intersected in the Interwar Europe.

⁷⁷⁵ *Iuventus* Mai. 1935 Vol. XIX No. 9 p. 89

⁷⁷⁶ *Iuventus* Iun. 1935 Vol. XIX No. 10 p. 101

⁷⁷⁷ *Iuventus* Ian. 1940 Vol. XXIV No. 5 p. 58. This beautifully bound volume of *Iuventus*, containing issues from Sept. 1934 to Iun. 1939, is still in the Vatican Apostolic Library under the code of R.G.Period.III.403.

⁷⁷⁸ *Iuventus* Mart. 1940 Vol. XXIV No. 7 pp. 54-55: “Ac catholica sensa, quibus abundat «Iuventus», quis non laudet? Hispanis praeter ea erga ingenuos nobilesque Hungaricos officium exstat explendum. Dum alma Hispania Mater bello nuper transacto hostes – non filios – profligaret, «Iuventus» semper Nationalistarum partes tuita et prosecuta est: si igitur etiam nunc nemo hispanorum pro eo tibi, colende vir, gratiam rettulit, en accipe nostram, dum tot errationes, tot pericula, tot praesentis mortis minae, quas passi sumus, in mentem veniunt. In illis lugendis eventibus procul a nobis, – vos hungarici – nostri sincero animo miserebamini...”

⁷⁷⁹ Platzdasch (2020); Sidera (1961); Sidera (1965); Avenarius (1936); Jiménez Delgado (1953).

⁷⁸⁰ Aramendia (1961); Sidera (1961).

5 Living Latin after the Second World War (1945-)

The Second World War marks a crucial turning point in the history of Living Latin. While an informal and divided movement promoting the use of Latin existed long before this time, in the immediate wake of the war the movement of *Living Latin* was founded as a formal “universal” organisation. This period is therefore often considered⁷⁸¹ the real beginning of the *Living Latin* phenomenon and some written histories divide *Living Latin* to pre-1956 and post-1956 eras, as the first Congress for Living Latin was celebrated that year in Avignon, when many organisations and periodicals which existed before the war had already disintegrated⁷⁸² and generally had no symbolical unifying effect.

In this chapter I present the context, motivation and relevance of *Living Latin* to this historical period and then I give a brief history of these efforts, taking the proponents of a “pure” strand of “utilitarian” *Living Latin* as the central axis around which other ideologies of Latin and general reception in academia and society are explored. The chief proponents of this strand I analyse are Jean Capelle (1909-1983), Caelestis Eichenseer (1924-2008), Guy Licoppe (1931-). For context, I also analyse the adjacent movements of *Vita Latina*, *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* and the humanistically-minded Latin movement in Italy.

5.1 The “official” Living Latin movement: *Vita Latina* and *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*

5.1.1 General outline of *Vita Latina*

In 1952, Jean Capelle (1909-1983), the rector of the university of Nancy, published⁷⁸³ an apologetic article for Latin called *Latin or Babel (Le latin ou Babel)* in the French national bulletin of education, where he presented Latin as the only practical international language for science and suggested that its utilitarian aspect should be emphasised. This article found a ready audience and

781 Waquet (2001); Licoppe (1989); Licoppe (2003a); Licoppe (2014a); Feye (2011); Tunberg (2012, 96); Loch (2013); Krukowska (2017); Slednikov (2016a); Slednikov (2016b); Slednikov (2019a). Stroh (2001) and Stroh (2008) do mention the Avignon conference, but not in central focus.

782 Some example periodicals: *Societas Latina* of Munich (1932-1955), *Juventus* of Budapest (1910-1944), *Alma Roma* of Rome (1914-1942), *Lygia* of Warsaw (1938-1939). *Societas Latina* was still there, but diminishing.

783 Capelle (1952)

raised a discussion in the French press.⁷⁸⁴ It was translated⁷⁸⁵ into English the following year and was republished⁷⁸⁶ as the introduction for the *First international congress for Living Latin* (*Premier congrès international pour le Latin Vivant*), inaugurated by Capelle himself in Avignon on 3-6 September 1956. It was organised and funded by Edouard Théodore-Aubanel (1901-1970), a publisher from Avignon. The congress was successful and had about 200 participants from 22 countries,⁷⁸⁷ so to continue the conference series⁷⁸⁸ and to publish a journal in Latin *Vita Latina* (founded in 1957) in 1958 a new international organisation called *Vita Latina* was founded by Capelle and Théodore-Aubanel.⁷⁸⁹ Five congresses of *Vita Latina* were celebrated, the last one in 1975. After the *Congress for the study and use of Latin* (*Congresso internazionale per lo studio e l'uso del latino / Omnium gentium ac nationum conventus Latinis litteris linguaeque fovendis*) which was organised in Rome in 1966 by the *Istituto di Studi Romani* and attended by 538 people (including *Vita Latina* itself)⁷⁹⁰ a new universal organisation was founded⁷⁹¹ – *Collegium Latinitati inter omnes gentes fovendae*. This international academy for promotion of Latin continues uniting the proponents until today under the name of *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*.⁷⁹² This progression can be considered the central “official” axis of the international Living Latin movement.⁷⁹³

5.1.2 Jean Capelle and the *Latin or Babel*

For Latinists, Jean Capelle⁷⁹⁴ (1909-1983) was an outsider, one of the “practical people” – a mathematician and a mechanical engineer, with a doctoral thesis (1938) about gear cutting. After several years in Citroën designing the gearbox for the motor car *Citroën 2 CV* and after two years teaching mathematics in a lyceum, in 1942 he decided to return to academia and obtained a teaching position in the University of Nancy. His career progressed very quickly. Already in 1947 he was sent to Dakar as the General director for public education in French West Africa, where he strived to

784 Some of the bibliography of discussions is collected by Jiménez Delgado (1957), Meunier (1956, 11-12). The article itself was introduced by the journal as sure to raise a controversy (“Ces vues ne manqueront sans doute pas de susciter une controverse.”)

785 Capelle and Quigley (1953)

786 Capelle (1956a)

787 The official list in Meunier (1956, 29-33) gives 171 participants, but there were others who gave speeches or sent letters to be published in proceedings. Both Pulgram (1957a) and Beach (1957b) put the number of participants at 250.

788 See Appendix A.9 for the list of conferences.

789 Licoppe (2014a, 25-27)

790 Licoppe (2014a, 57)

791 Licoppe (2014a, 47)

792 The history of this academy is given by Licoppe (2014a).

793 The *Vita Latina* movement is extensively treated by Licoppe (2014a). Waquet (2001, 266-268) is a sceptic review of the movement – however, even if the official aims of getting Latin endorsed by UNESCO were never achieved (as pointed out by Waquet) and this organisation faded away, the movement lived on under other names.

794 Biographical data from Immè (1984); Audinot and Bonnal (2009).

found a university for forming a local elite. In 1949 he returned to metropolitan France, having been assigned the rector of the University of Nancy, becoming at the age of 40 the youngest rector in France.

Capelle was frustrated with the state of the international scientific communication, which seems to have inspired him to write his article about *Latin or Babel*.⁷⁹⁵ Because of this language barrier many foreign publications were inaccessible, he himself participated in a conference reportedly terribly inefficient because of it.⁷⁹⁶

Capelle in 1961 described himself as “a product of the earlier method of language teaching in vogue 20-30 years ago” and was critical of the methods he himself experienced in school: they “could leave him, after a study of English in school and university for nine years – perhaps some 2,000 hours in class and some 3,000 hours at homework or reading – and with an extremely valuable academic knowledge about English and Great Britain, still unable to utter two sentences in succession”.⁷⁹⁷ He experienced this frustrating problem first hand while visiting Ireland after the Second World War.⁷⁹⁸ However, Capelle’s experience in Africa, where he saw that children with no French, when immersed in French schools, would progress rapidly,⁷⁹⁹ showed him that bilingualism is actually quite possible (something that did not come naturally for the monolingual French!) – he saw he would later apply this thinking about the importance of efficient language teaching methods

795 *Latin or Babel* has been treated by Waquet (2001, 266), Licoppe (2014a, 18-19), Slednikov (2019a, 44-45).

796 Beach (1957b, 119-120): “The idea of the Congress was born in the mind of M. Jean Capelle, whom the Mayor’s lieutenant in greeting the opening gathering called “l’âme de ce mouvement.” <...> He is, however, by profession a mathematician and engineer and was formerly on the staff of the Citroen Auto Works. Thus his opinion is of more weight than if he were a classicist with a subjective interest. While he was on the staff of Citroen, he participated in a meeting of engineers in London attended by British, French, Italians, Germans, Russians and others. Because of language difficulties the meeting whose objectives, had there been a common tongue, could have been achieved in a half day, consumed three days. This troubled M. Capelle. He brooded long on the matter and wrote a very trenchant article entitled “Latin or Babel.””. Beach (1957c) adds that it was the hassle of “Simultaneous Interpretation” that Capelle disliked. This testimony clashes with the Ireland story (see footnote 798) – if he visited London when still in Citroën (before 1942), then his experience in Ireland after the war was not the “first experience of a non-French country”.

797 Fortune (1962, 69-70) indicates the primary source as “In a Lecture delivered [by Capelle] in Dublin in April 1961 and distributed by the author.” (Fortune 1962, 73).

798 Fortune (1962, 70) reports Capelle’s personal experience with foreign language learning and his reflections on the implicit aim of these studies: “A visit to Ireland after the 1939-45 war, his first experience of a non-French country, had been frustrating in the extreme as he had not been able to understand the Irish or they him. His training in English was, of course, not aimed at a fluent knowledge of the spoken language, but at providing a grammatical and literary background, using the foreign language for the training of the student’s mind through systematic analysis and synthesis. Literary appreciation of English works based upon the same methods and criteria as those used for the study of French texts was the main objective. But, how, he asked himself later, could he really appreciate a text if he could not read it properly and if his understanding was based on constant mental translation. // After the war he started work in French Institutes in foreign countries and found there were no special materials for teaching French to foreigners. The books written to teach French were written as if they were to be used by French students.”

799 Capelle (1952, 7): “Mais il est intéressant déjà de noter que les enfants peuvent, sans surcharge insupportable, se familiariser avec une langue étrangère... C’est une constatation que l’on fait aisément dans nos écoles de brousse de la France d’Outre-Mer : les enfants arrivent à l’école sans connaître un seul mot de français, leur maître ne parle généralement pas leur langue et pourtant les progrès réalisés par ces petits sont extraordinairement rapides.”; Capelle and Quigley (1953, 37)

also to Latin. Therefore, his personal experience in education was also a factor in writing the article about the international language.

Latin or Babel starts with the most pressing necessities for the times when “the technical progress of the society has rendered borders archaic”: “the need for an international peace, the necessity of economic and social rapport on a world scale”. For Capelle, the solution to these problems is closely connected with overcoming the language barrier: he takes an optimistic view that “two peoples who understand the same language are by that very fact near to understanding each other”⁸⁰⁰. And it is also the highest hope Capelle expresses for Latin in the conclusion – “Latin is incontestably a beautiful and powerful language. But it has other riches. If our generation so wills, it can come back, an instrument marvellously adapted to commerce of things and ideas, and by that, a powerful factor of progress, of fraternity, and of peace”. Therefore, *Latin or Babel* is a quite unusual apology for Latin, as it presents the world as universally progressing forward in a technological sense and praises this state of affairs without . While such apologies often have a reactionary colour by enumerating the past glories of Latin and deploring the present state of the world and its culture as barbarous without Latin,⁸⁰¹ this one tries to downplay the usual cultural arguments for learning Latin. Instead, it tries to cast Latin as something eminently practical and viable for solving worldwide problems. It tries to reconcile the usual image of impractical Latin with modernity and to prove both its relevance and necessity.

Capelle emphasises many times that he is making a practical decision for practical reasons: he is taking “the most realistic point of view” “of the technician who searches for better efficiency at lower cost”. This view enables him to consider the “great good fortune” when Latin, “that admirable international vehicle”,⁸⁰² was used by eminent scientists for publishing their works and to regret together with them that these times did not last. Latin was eclipsed by French, but only as a temporary substitute, as the political reconfigurations of the nineteenth century “saw also the

800 Capelle (1952, 7): “Le besoin de paix internationale, la nécessité de rapports économiques et sociaux à l’échelle mondiale, le sentiment que le progrès technique des sociétés a rendu les frontières archaïques, voilà des données qui s’imposent aux peuples avec une intensité et une urgence jamais égalées. // Du même coup est posé, sur un plan très vaste, le problème de l’enseignement des langues étrangères, car deux peuples qui entendent la même langue sont par là même tout près de s’entendre.”; Capelle and Quigley (1953, 37)

801 For example, Pierre Grimal in the opening speech of the 1969 *Vita Latina* congress deplores the state of mind of those who will not have Latin in school: “Sciant omnes nos non magistros quosdam esse artem suam defendentes, sed cives scelus in patriam admissum patefacientes. <...> Alii ad res quas technicas vocamus unice apti fient, res omnes ad numeros revocantes, vero animi cibo expertes, in vulgarissimas delectationes sese mergentes, in domibus ad hanc vitam perverse excogitatis tempus terentes, aut, ut iam nunc persaepe videmus, aliquo altiorum rerum desiderio confectos, vita sua pertaesos, semper aliqua nova cupientes et sibi, et, quod pejus est, omni civitati.” (Théodore-Aubanel 1970, 33). In the same congress Capelle himself expressed a similar sentiment, see footnote 851 and page 189.

802 Capelle (1952, 7): “Ce fut une grande chance pour les savants du moyen âge et de la Renaissance de disposer de cet admirable véhicule international qu’était alors le latin.”; Capelle and Quigley (1953, 38)

grouping of the philosophers and savants within these less and less open worlds that constitute the new nations.”.

In Capelle’s view, “in our day there is no longer a preferred language either for international discussion, or for the diffusion of thought, or for the publication of scientific and technical results”, and this absence of an intermediary language contrasts with the incredible technological possibilities of communication. Indeed, Capelle wrote his article in the years immediately following the Second World War, when the global shift to English was not yet clearly apparent to everyone and no “single foreign language” would yet suffice. He rejected the universal adoption of “any one actual national language”, as it “would imply, as a matter of fact, that one of the nations might arise to dominate the others and to impose its law upon the world!”.

While Esperanto could also fit the criterion of neutrality, Capelle sees the current extent of its adoption as indicating a failure and proceeds to doubt the viability of any artificial language ever being adopted (it is not an authentic “living” language!).⁸⁰³ So even though Capelle claims to be “sidestepping deliberately the pedagogic question of the cultural value of the language” and concentrating purely on needs of those technical, scientific, diplomatic, commercial people who need to communicate with foreigners,⁸⁰⁴ he still manages to reach a conclusion that it is only Latin which is able to solve the Babelic situation readily apparent in any international meeting or conference. No other living or artificial alternatives are suitable for this.

Historical precedent is the crux of the argument for Latin, while the emphasis on the practical nature of the argument was relevant in time when it was already apparent that “Latin is being dropped more and more in its characteristic domain which is the secondary school, to the advantage of the modern options and techniques considered as better adapted to the needs of practical life.”. Proving this practicality would strengthen Latin’s positions in the educational system. The usual argument of its necessity for a person’s culture is denied by Capelle (modern education “in the study of living languages and of science has fully as much pedagogical value” as

803 Capelle (1952, 8): “Si elle comporte une possibilité d’issue, peut-on réellement l’attendre du succès problématique d’une langue artificielle aussi simple soit-elle – l’Esperanto, par exemple ? Les faits ne semblent pas nous laisser beaucoup d’illusions. Peut-être est-il aussi difficile d’animer une langue artificielle que de donner la vie à un composé chimique de synthèse !”; Capelle and Quigley (1953, 39)

804 Capelle (1952, 7): “Ce n’est donc pas du côté de l’aptitude des enfants que se situe la véritable difficulté ; c’est dans le choix de la langue étrangère qu’il y a lieu de leur enseigner d’abord et dans le recrutement des spécialistes nécessaires ; <...> Je voudrais aborder cette question en laissant délibérément de côté l’élément pédagogique de la valeur culturelle de la langue, et en m’intéressant particulièrement aux besoins des techniciens, des chercheurs de laboratoires, comme à ceux des hommes qui, sur le plan de l’activité diplomatique ou commerciale, sont appelés à entrer en rapports fréquents avec les étrangers.” (Capelle and Quigley 1953, 37); Capelle (1952, 8): “Ce n’est pas à cause des suaves tableaux de Virgile, des très fines odes d’Horace ou des puissants morceaux d’éloquence de Cicéron que je voudrais préconiser un retour, et un retour massif, au latin, seule langue internationale possible ! C’est pour des raisons essentiellement pratiques, sensibles par exemple à l’ingénieur découragé par le rideau linguistique qui l’empêche de percer le mystère de telles publications techniques, allemandes, anglaises, russes.” (Capelle and Quigley 1953, 39)

the earlier elite education of Latin and Greek), as is the one of Latin being necessary for the high class, while the praise of its richness (he implicitly admits its “admirable linguistic qualities, the plenitude of its phrases, and its literary masterpieces”) is considered secondary to its utility.⁸⁰⁵ The fact that the article was written by an amateur rather than a professional Latinist added weight to these statements, at least for some people.⁸⁰⁶

Latin needs to be relevant for those “who are above all practical and consider first the utilitarian aspect of studies” and the return of “Latin, the sole possible the international language” needs not be considered a “retrogression”. So what is the concrete proposed plan? “Why not strive by a very widespread movement among the universities to renew and to diffuse the teaching of Latin? That is a proper mission for UNESCO.”. So both universities and international organisations are to be involved. The most modern methods are to be applied to make language teaching efficient and to do away with the traditional boredom. The selection of texts used in teaching is to be expanded to include additional Neo-Latin texts that are interesting because of their content and because of their importance for the history of science and thought, rather than just the quality of their Latin.⁸⁰⁷

The article raised a wide discussion and had an unusually strong impact, as it was followed by a congress and a creation of a formal organisation, journal and a real movement. But how does it differ from the many other apologies for Latin? Most of what Capelle said had already been said before, for example, in Henderson’s *Phœnix* or in Avellanus’ *Præco*. There is valuable information being published in so many languages, the international language is lacking, it is unclear which language will take the dominant place, Esperanto cannot solve anything as it is artificial and lifeless,⁸⁰⁸ while Latin has proved its suitability not so long ago; teaching it more like a modern language would both add an additional practical advantage for studying it, thus raising the subject’s

805 Capelle (1952, 8): “On a eu tort, enfin, de défendre le latin en se bornant à célébrer ses admirables qualités linguistiques, la plénitude de ses phrases et ses immortels chefs-d’œuvre littéraires ! Car on a contribué ainsi à écarter de l’intérêt qu’il peut susciter, tous ceux, et ils sont nombreux, sans être forcément des béotiens, qui, étant surtout pragmatiques, tiennent à considérer d’abord le côté utilitaire des études. // Ce n’est pas à cause des suaves tableaux de Virgile, des très fines odes d’Horace ou des puissants morceaux d’éloquence de Cicéron que je voudrais préconiser un retour, et un retour massif, au latin, seule langue internationale possible !”; Capelle and Quigley (1953, 39)

806 Goodwin Beach (see footnote 96) remarks: “Thus his opinion is of more weight than if he were a classicist with a subjective interest.”

807 Capelle (1952, 8): “Une telle réforme devrait s’accompagner d’une révision du choix des textes à mettre entre les mains des élèves, car il y a de nombreux ouvrages à exploiter parmi ceux qui ont été écrits en latin par les historiens et les savants, jusqu’au XVIII^e siècle. Ils éclaireraient, chez les élèves, l’histoire de la pensée, les tâtonnements qui ont conduit aux découvertes. Même dans les cas où le style de ces textes n’atteint pas la perfection de l’hexamètre virgilien ou de la période cicéronienne, l’élève serait souvent plus intéressé par certains exposés concrets que par l’explication résignée, à longueur de semaines, des malheurs d’Enée et de Didon, ou de la conjuration de Catilina !”; Capelle and Quigley (1953, 40)

808 Tasset also used this argument in his discussion with Esperanto’s de Beaufront around 1900.

viability in the educational system, and would solve the international language problem. All these points had been made many times before.

Maybe the answer lies in the spirit of times and in Capelle's personality. He raised the point of the international language in a very internationalist moment. After World War II numerous international organisations were being formed, a new order of international relations was still being formed, Europe was enthusiastic about European integration, even with federalist projects being seriously considered. In this cardinal moment, when the atmosphere was receptive to internationalist ideas, it was a fitting time to raise the international language question once again (at that time Esperantists also campaigned in the same UNESCO Capelle referred to).⁸⁰⁹ Even if Latin as a ubiquitous school subject was already in danger, it still was present in the programmes, the heavy reductions started only in the 1960s, so the point that this universal teaching of Latin could be made to service a possible international language solution could still appear viable. Capelle also fittingly aligned his vision of Latin with the feeling of the universal technological progress (even if this is also a recurring topos), and, as he himself was an engineer, it added additional weight to this argument; the insistent distancing from the cultural value of Latin and the focus on its practical value disguised the fact that choosing Latin was still an eminently cultural decision – after all, if he would have sought for the international communication only simplicity and functionality, the effortless rejection of Esperanto would not have been possible. Here Capelle's personal qualities were important. While also before this there had been other scientists who defended Latin as the international language, they often limited themselves with a simple exposition of their position – for example, in 1892 the Italian naturalist Giuseppe Tuccimei expressed similar arguments in a speech that he got printed, but that probably marked the end of his campaign.⁸¹⁰ Capelle went further. He was already in a rather influential position of power, making his voice heard, he had good management skills and sincerely dedicated himself to this project. This makes him was a rather similar figure to Carlo Galassi Paluzzi in the Interwar Italy: both of them were good organisers, men of action and non-professional amateurs of the fields they chose to promote and fight for.⁸¹¹

5.1.3 The first international congress for Living Latin. Avignon, 1956

809 Forster (1982, 242-244) details how the *Universala Esperanto-Asocio* campaigned in the United Nations and UNESCO from 1949. In 1954 they managed to get a rather mild favourable resolution approved by UNESCO which "Recognises that these results [of the Esperanto movement] correspond with the aims and ideals of UNESCO;", allowing the association to have some consultative relationship with UNESCO.

810 See footnote 656.

811 Cf. footnotes 113 and 593.

5.1.3.1 Proposals and resolutions

Similar priorities were adopted for the *First international congress for Living Latin* (*Premier congrès international pour le Latin Vivant / Viventis linguae Latinae causa conventus universus*).⁸¹² It was intended that the three-day congress would be highlighted by four lectures⁸¹³ (“basic reports” – *rappports de base du congrès*) on the following topics, all of them relevant to this future goal of international Latin: *grammar* (how to simplify Latin for pupils without breaking it?), *pronunciation* (what pronunciation should be universally adopted?), *pedagogy* (how to apply to Latin the active methods used for modern languages?), *vocabulary* (how to adapt it for modern usage?). The congress included numerous additional *communications* and *interventions* on similar themes – the “real reasons” why Latin should be studied, how the teaching should be done, why and how it should become the international language, how does one adapt its adapt the vocabulary for this purpose. In the speech that concluded the conference, Jean Capelle presented⁸¹⁴ his vision of the way forward: this congress has not decided to create a new society or to start a new periodical (but possibilities are open, and soon it was done), it was only a preparatory congress for the next foundational one which would build on the results of this congress.⁸¹⁵

Many of these results were planned to be brought by three working groups or committees (*groupes de travail / commissions provisoires*) that would be established. The first one would be dedicated to grammar and pronunciation and would work out a basic curriculum of Latin that would suffice for future engineers (who would need some kind of simple and correct Latin for communication; would-be classicists would continue after this course); this “basic” course would have a summary of “essential grammar” “in ten or twelve pages”⁸¹⁶ (!). The second working group

812 The congress was treated by numerous contemporary publications: Sidera (1956), Guercio (1956), Egger (1956), Pulgram (1957a), Beach (1957a), Beach (1957b), Stegmann von Pritzwald (1963). Jiménez Delgado (1957) gives a partial bibliography. It was also mentioned by later sources as a historical note: Ricucci (2015a), Ricucci (2015b), Minkova and Tunberg (2012), del Col (1998), Slednikov (2019a).

813 The outline of the speeches of the future conference is in the proceedings (Meunier 1956, 12). *Estudios Clasicos, organo de la sociedad española de estudios clasicos* May 1956 Vol. III No. 18 pp. 431-432, which were published well before the congress in September, give the same list of principal four orators and themes. Grammar was treated by Jean Bayet, director of the *École Française de Rome* (France), pronunciation by Erich Burck, professor in the University of Kiel, president of the *Deutscher Altphilologenverband*, pedagogy by Dr. Goodwin Beach from Trinity college of Hartford (Connecticut), vocabulary by professor Guerino Pacitti, secretary of the *Istituto Nazionale di Studi Romani* in Rome. Licoppe (1989), Licoppe (2003a, 51), Licoppe (2014a, 21-22) treat these four speeches.

814 Capelle (1956b)

815 Capelle (1956b, 164): “En vérité, ce Congrès est une assemblée préparatoire au prochain Congrès qui, lui, pourra jouer un rôle constitutif, sur la base des résultats qui auront été consacrés dans l’intervalle.”

816 Capelle (1956b, 165): “Le premier groupe sera consacré à la grammaire latine et à la prononciation du latin : Monsieur Jean BAYET a appelé de ses vœux une grammaire essentielle « – de dix à douze pages – » a-t-il dit ! Nous souhaitons qu’il puisse l’écrire pour le plus grand bénéfice de nos jeunes maîtres et de leurs élèves.”; Bayet (1956, 56): “Nous avons pu jusque-là, me semble-t-il, réduire les cadres grammaticaux du Latin à un minimum correct, et d’acquisition aisée pour une intelligence rationnelle attachée à la précision du langage. Je crois que, compte non tenu des paradigmes, une dizaine de pages me suffiraient pour exprimer cette syntaxe.”; Bayet (1956, 58): “Sic persuasum habeo nos Latinae linguae quam dicunt syntaxin in paucas paginas redigere posse, seu ut ese solae bene memoria teneantur, seu ut, ad quemvis grammaticae libellum adjunctae, quasi summarium constituent notionum

would be concerned with publishing a Latin dictionary of modern terms that would make Latin suitable for modern life, scientific and technical communication. This handy volume would be available everywhere where needed; the working group would have a modest task of collecting or, if needed, coining suitable Latin words for the task. The third group would be concerned with pedagogy of Latin and would compare and diffuse and encourage good educational methods for rendering the teaching of Latin *plus vivant*. Then there is an additional task not assigned to any separate group – creating a good practical self-teaching textbook of *Assimil* type for independent learners.⁸¹⁷ It would synthesise and disseminate “the essence of the results of these three working groups”.⁸¹⁸ The formal conclusions of the congress were approved by an unanimous vote of all participants and tried to give some more details about how grammar should be taught (for example, indirect speech can be omitted from the basic course), what pronunciation should be adopted (the restored classical one), how neologisms should be formed (if there is no other way, the vernacular term can be used after adopting it to Latin), how the language should be taught (in a more natural method). Writing in Latin in scientific journals is encouraged.

5.1.3.2 Reception: criticism and support

These plans and generally the purpose of the congress could be understood in many contradictory ways – either one would be enthusiastic about broad and grand ambitions, or one would be sceptical about the viability of the ill-defined goal and maybe one would disagree with the goal (e.g., the emphasis on the utility) itself. This is precisely what happened. The United States of America sent two delegates to the congress: Ernst Pulgram (1915-2005), professor of Romance and Classical linguistics in the University of Michigan (delegated by the university), and Dr. Goodwin Beach (1885-1970), lecturer of Latin in Trinity college (Hartford, Connecticut; delegated by the American Classical League) and a retired businessman. After the congress they published⁸¹⁹ their

quibus necesse sit utantur omnes qui Latine inter se communicare velint.”

817 French publisher publishing the *sans peine* / *with ease* self-teaching language textbook series for independent learners. Eventually, even though no formal organisation took on the task, this call was heeded by Clément Desessard (1920-2003), engineer by profession, whose *Latin sans peine* was published by *Assimil* in 1966 (Desessard 1966); it contained texts (+ audio recordings) from Roman and contemporary Living Latin authors in equal proportion, so it clearly favoured modern use of Latin. This method gained popularity among francophones and general Living Latin community, was translated into German and Italian, and most recently, in 2015, republished and re-recorded. Bibliographical data is provided by Licoppe and Desessard (1987); Licoppe (2003b). Desessard himself wrote about the state of the Living Latin movement in Desessard (1991a); Desessard (1991b) (see also footnote 856).

818 Capelle (1956b, 165): “Cet «Assimil» vulgariserait en quelque sorte l’essentiel des travaux des trois groupes précédents.”

819 Pulgram (1957a), followed by response by Beach (1957b) and a short reply by Pulgram (1957b). After Pulgram published a sceptical article about Latin’s viability as a communicative language in the Second Vatican Council (Pulgram 1963), there followed another polemical exchange: Beach (1964), Pulgram (1964). This new exchange referenced the previous one. Beach also treated the Avignon congress in Beach (1957a), Beach (1957c), Beach

very different perspectives which can be taken as representative for the reception of the congress and analysed in depth. This exchange and other writings by these authors constitute the main recorded body of reception of this congress in English.

The article by Ernst Pulgram⁸²⁰ represents a purely academical and critical viewpoint. He finds the assertion that Latin is a “living” language problematic and emphasis on the “usefulness” of Latin counterproductive, the viability of Latin as the international language nil, while the general fuzziness of the congress did not help it achieve anything concrete. Pulgram appreciates the positive atmosphere and a splendid and hospitable stay in Avignon, but his ultimate conclusion is that “nothing was done for Latin, really.”⁸²¹ Pulgram did not participate in the following congresses (Beach did).⁸²²

Many participants started their orations from the proposition that Latin “was not a dead language” and should be considered a “living” language. Pulgram applies formal criteria to criticise this assertion. Do the places where Latin is used make it a living language? It does not “form a living part of a living culture”, “there are no speakers whose native every-day language is Latin”. Yes, maybe one in principle *could* say everything in Latin, but “anything *can* be said in any language”, “the question is whether it *is* said” by anyone.⁸²³ However, outside a restricted community (“some very small ecclesiastical, academic, or professional groups”) and “a very restricted number of occasions” nothing much is said in Latin that would be “in substance or in quantity comparable” to what is said in any living language. So Latin should be considered a “dead” language, but it does not follow that this is somehow a bad thing. People should not be prevented from using it where needed or desired or to learn it through the “oral-aural approach”, indeed, Latin *should* be taught as a real language.

For Pulgram, the selling of Latin through the claim that it is a viable international language is something that actually does a disservice for it. This claim of internationality is said to be one of the many arguments “emphasising Latin’s usefulness and its ancillary nature” and debasing the language; it can be lumped together with such statements as “Latin teaches you your native language” or that “Latin exercises the brain”.⁸²⁴ For him, Latin should be considered a valuable

(1957d) and cited it in several more of his numerous articles, including Beach (1959), Beach (1961), Beach (1963).

820 Pulgram (1957a)

821 Pulgram (1957a, 307): “All this is too bad, because Avignon is a pleasant town, the hospitality of the local organizing committee was wonderful and its work prodigious and admirable, we had an interesting excursion, we were served an impressive banquet (with good food!) in the grandiose Palais des Papes, and everyone seemed happy. I also learned something (albeit in a negative way) and was very much pleased to be a participant at the meetings. But nothing was done for Latin, really.”

822 See footnote 832.

823 Emphasis in quotes by author.

824 Pulgram (1957a, 304): “Yet at the same time-and here lies the pitiful irony of the case – many of them forever advance such arguments in favor of studying Latin as emphasize its usefulness and its ancillary nature: Latin exercises the brain; Latin teaches you your native language; Latin teaches you foreign languages; Latin increases

intellectual reward valuable by itself without requiring additional arguments to prove its usefulness – arguments based on “petty practicalness” only serve to play down the essential humanistic value of Latin.⁸²⁵

Pulgram is sceptical about the success of any project that would impose any deliberately chosen international language on the world, this process of the appearance of the international language can only be spontaneous – and it does not matter if it would be a dead or a living language.⁸²⁶ And even it were possible to choose the international language deliberately, Latin does not have a good claim for it. There are no native speakers, so everyone would have to learn it beforehand. It is not the first time Latin has been proposed as an international language (there was a similar congress in Rome in 1933⁸²⁷). No revival of Latin “for the purpose of an international language has as yet caught the fancy of anyone except of its promulgators and of those who have vested interests to defend”. “Esperanto has been considerably more successful”. Pulgram even doubts the supposed neutrality of Latin: it is an Eurocentric language, it could only unite western Europe and would not be that relevant to other cultures. Also why should “an Arab or an Indonesian” “take less umbrage on nationalistic grounds to Latin than he would to French or English?”.

Moreover, the congress did not demonstrate meaningful steps towards this goal. In the congress French dominated, German and Spanish were also heard, but Latin was heard almost only when participants would read from their manuscripts (printed texts were distributed to everyone, so there was no need to listen). These texts were written in the usual Ciceronian Latin and no examples were given of this simple Latin that would be more suitable for international usage. So “if Latin professors do not speak Latin, that is, speakable and spoken Latin, in a Congress dedicated to Living Latin, who shall, or should?”. It is not clear how the congress would make Latin more suitable for international usage.

But probably the most criticism was directed to the general fuzziness of the conference. Everyone seemed to agree “on the necessity of certain reforms in the teaching of Latin”, but there were few concrete proposals, if any – only one lady, Isabelle Plaut, explained a textbook she had

your vocabulary; Latin is important for doctors and lawyers; Latin must become an international language. Such claims contain so small a grain of truth that the attainment of all these desirable goals through the study of Latin cannot but appear a wasteful process. It's like having to study hieroglyphics as a good foundation for learning the modern alphabet: nice if you can do it, but scarcely indispensable.”

825 Pulgram (1964, 99): “It is sad and dismal to contemplate that some classicists, whose domain could be and should be among the most humane and the most humanizing within the Humanities, should sell their place for a pottage of petty practicalness.”

826 Pulgram (1957a, 304): “I do believe that no language, living or dead, can be so chosen and imposed.”. For him it seems more reasonable that the world would adopt an international language when it already has reached international understanding rather than that a language would produce this understanding (Pulgram 1948, 65).

827 “III Congresso Nazionale di Studi Romani. La celebrazione del Bimillenario Augusteo. La rinascita dello studio e dell'uso della lingua latina” organised on 22-27 April 1933 in Rome by the *Istituto Nazionale di Studi Romani*.

developed, but no one seemed to pay attention to it.⁸²⁸ It is a pity, as “the revision and modernisation of teaching materials and methods for Latin instruction” is the domain “where the Congress could have been beneficial”. There are also procedural questions – Pulgram alleges that the resolutions of the congress (which are full of generalities) are not valid as they are not the ones voted on by the participants.⁸²⁹

“All in all, then, I am afraid that the Congress was not very effective in showing the world, by word or by deed, that Latin can be and should be an international language. In fact, better attempts have been made before; and if they did not succeed it would be surprising if the Avignon Congress could.”. From a coherent linguistic standpoint all of this criticism might be true. However, we will see that the opponent uses a completely different set of arguments.

Goodwin B. Beach, when reading Pulgram’s report, was “aghast” “that anyone could have gained an impression so completely at variance” with his.⁸³⁰ He was one of the four main speakers in the conference, responsible for the language pedagogy part.⁸³¹ Beach was an enthusiast, not a pure professor, but rather an amateur turned professional. He started teaching and promoting Latin full time only after retiring from business and would continue to participate in Latin congresses until the end of his life.⁸³² For him, Pulgram is a villain: “he could not strive more enthusiastically, were he an avowed enemy, to kill the subject.”. The conclusion of his article contrasts strongly with that of Pulgram’s: “Let us hope that more Americans will attend that [next] Congress and come home enthusiastic and inspired.”.

Beach maintains that Latin is not a dead language: the congress was not meant to resurrect a dead language, but rather to revitalise it. “It is bad psychology” to maintain that it is dead, we should not forget that young pupils “look into fuller life and abhor from things smelling of death”

828 Pulgram (1948, 306-307): “Indeed nothing workable was suggested in the discussion – with one exception. A French lady, who is out of a job because of her unorthodox and subversive views on how to teach Latin, spoke twice and distributed a large amount of actual teaching material and real samples from a textbook she has written and which is available. ⟨...⟩ Many speakers offered lip service to the same “modern” and “progressive” views, but no one besides this young woman bothered to show just exactly how he intended to go about *doing* something in the matter. That no one really *wanted* to do something tangible and practical is amply shown by the triteness of the Resolutions and the fact that the lady’s contributions to the Congress were ignored or deprecated.”. The lady in question is “M^{lle} Isabelle Plaut, Professeur agrégée, Sainte-Pience”. Her books for teaching Latin and Greek to children are favourably reviewed in *Helmantica* 1957 Vol. 8 pp. 330-331.

829 Pulgram (1957a, 305): “After the termination of the Congress, I received by mail, as did, I think, all other registered participants, a set of Resolutions. Unfortunately, I am forced to say that none of the Resolutions thus divulged resulted from any formal proposals duly discussed and voted on. They were just written up, I do not know by whom, with the hope, I presume, that they represent the majority view of the assembly. There is no way of knowing whether they do.”

830 Beach (1957b)

831 Meunier (1956, 80-84)

832 For his biography see, for example, Phillip Griffin, “Spearhead for a Latin revival” in *The Courant Magazine / Hartford Courant (Hartford, Connecticut)* May 19, 1957 p. 12. There are records of Beach (1885-1970) participating in *Vita Latina* conferences in 1959, 1963, 1969, in the *Congress for the study and use of Latin* in Rome in 1966.

(Beach cited his own speech delivered in Latin: *ad plenioram vitam spectant atque a rebus mortem olentibus abhorrent*). Beach does not have formal linguistic criteria for determining whether a language is alive or dead and does not discuss them, simple ones suffice – for him, a language lives if there are two people who (can?) still speak it.⁸³³ “Its lively use in the Church surely keeps it from being a dead language”. Every language has to deal with neologisms, Latin is no different, that does not make it dead.⁸³⁴

For Beach, in the congress something *was* done for Latin – indeed, the fact that this congress actually happened is the most important one. Its scale and the fact that numerous countries were represented demonstrated that there is a “widespread feeling that a supra-national language, well developed, orderly, capable of precise expression, devoid of the jealousy that attaches to modern tongues, is needed”.⁸³⁵ “Professor Pulgram does not tell of the genesis of the Congress, a very interesting point”, but Beach tells us about it – this genesis is related to the international language question and to Jean Capelle’s motivation, his frustration with the inefficiency with scientific communication.⁸³⁶ The fact that this congress garnered international media attention was beneficial for Latin worldwide.⁸³⁷

Beach addresses criticisms levelled against the congress. He admits that there was too much of French language there, but “many were annoyed thereby, and a vote was passed that at the next Congress only Latin should be used” (but it does not seem from the proceedings of the future congresses that this was followed). It is also true that Latin speeches were being read from manuscripts, but is it not true for French speeches too, and also for speakers in English in conferences? That fact does not imply that English is dead. The resolutions that Pulgram complains about were actually properly prepared by the working groups,⁸³⁸ one of which Beach himself was

833 Beach (1964, 95): “Let us have a definition of a living language. One is: a tongue which two people still speak. Thousands can speak Latin. One definition of a dead language is one in which we do not know how the people conversed. We know how Romans conversed. We do not know how Anglo-Saxons, Goths, Hittites, Tokarians conversed. Those are dead. Latin lives and if properly taught would be livelier.”

834 In my opinion, when Pulgram wrote that “anything *can* be said in any language” (if necessary, using neologisms), “the question is whether it *is* said”, he was referring not to the presence or absence of neologisms, but to the number of speakers and the variety of occasions where the language is used. So Beach’s argument here seems to miss the point.

835 Beach (1957b, 120): “The Congress, therefore, was representative of not only Europe and the Free World in general but extended even to the Middle East and somewhat beyond the Iron Curtain. This meeting evidenced more than mere local interest, indeed the widespread feeling that a supra-national language, well developed, orderly, capable of precise expression, devoid of the jealousy that attaches to modern tongues, is needed. Such a congress cannot be written off as the ebullition of a few fanatics.”

836 Cf. footnote 96.

837 Beach (1957b, 122): “That “nothing was done for Latin, really,” I dispute. Attention was paid to the Congress throughout Europe in newspaper articles and on the radio. One evening the Italian short-wave radio was given over to a report, and apparently to a very circumstantial report. This was heard in Hartford and, undoubtedly, elsewhere. I believe that something was done for Latin.”

838 Beach (1957b, 122): “Committees were chosen to adopt resolutions on the main topics: Pronunciation, Grammar, Pedagogy, New Words. Those committees were made up of the speaker on the topic and a group of four to six international scholars.”

responsible for, and approved in a proper manner by the assembly. Generally, the procedures “differed in no wise from that of a well-run meeting in our country”.

This is not a discussion where arguments are treated in a point-by-point manner. The authors do not have much common ground – an academic matter-of-fact report of things achieved or not achieved is hardly commensurate with an enthusiastic exposition of possibilities. Indeed, Pulgram published a brief one-page response to Beach’s essay, where he reaffirmed his opposition to Beach’s statements by judging them not worth answering and by limiting himself to restating the initial arguments.⁸³⁹ For him, the achieved international media coverage of the congress does not mean anything, it is not a “substitute for good sense and good work”.⁸⁴⁰ Latin is by definition a dead language (this is non-negotiable, all the examples brought forth by Beach are beside the point), and this fact further diminishes any chances “Latin may have of ever becoming an international language” (deliberate adoption of any such language is impossible). Congress dealt with the four proposed points (uniform pronunciation, simplification of grammar, modernisation of vocabulary, reform of teaching methods) incompletely and incompetently – the program was too profuse, most of the participants were naive in matters of linguistics. There were no rigorous procedures (no proposal, no discussion, no vote) regarding committee composition and power. “There is no way of knowing if the Resolutions emanating from these Committees represent the consensus of the Congress. And even if they do, they are vacuous verbiage. “*Si haec vota vobis placent, contentus ero*” ⟨...⟩, laughter, no discussion, and unanimous approval do not quite impress me as being the conscientious votes of a laborious, earnest, and informed assembly of 250 scholars”.⁸⁴¹

This discussion can be taken as emblematic of a rift in the Living Latin movement between academic professionals and enthusiastic amateurs. Pulgram might not be a completely typical example – he is a professor of linguistics rather than literature, so his criticisms are not particularly based on humanistic ideals – for example, welcoming considerations about the simplification of Latin might not be shared by his more humanistically minded colleagues. However, Beach is a quite typical enthusiastic amateur – he had not originally been a professional Latinist, but he later did involve himself in the promotion of Latin and became one of the leading proponents of it, particularly stressing the joy of using the language rather than focusing on academic themes.

839 Pulgram (1957b)

840 Pulgram (1957b): “And spoon-fed newspaper reports and radio publicity, ephemeral at best, are no substitutes for good sense and good work.”

841 Pulgram (1957b); The last sentence was written in response to this description of resolution adoption procedures by Beach (1957b, 122): “I was asked to come forward to speak on the resolution on pedagogy. I said: “*si haec vota vobis placent, contentus ero*”. Whether pleased because I was so brief, I know not, but the assembly laughed and unanimously adopted them.”.

For Pulgram, a professional, the Avignon congress was too profuse and not serious enough, it was even an amateurish affair. For Beach, however, the fact that the congress happened and that the assembly of scholars outlined the possibilities of Latin in general terms, was quite enough to sustain hopes for future. Examples of similar cultural conflicts can be found in the field of artificial languages – for example, a similar reaction to excessive mirth can be seen in the history of Ido, the more seriously and scientifically minded offshoot of Esperanto. While Esperantists (including L. L. Zamenhof, the creator of the language) would generally encourage emotional attachment to their “dear language” (*kara lingvo*) and their meetings would often have creative and entertaining elements, Idists would heavily insist on the opposite approach. The slogan of the First Ido congress of 1921 is illustrative of this: “We have come here to work, not to amuse ourselves”.⁸⁴²

5.1.4 The later *Vita Latina* movement

The question alluded to by Pulgram is probably central to the *Vita Latina* movement and the official Living Latin movement as a whole: how far do the resolutions represent the general consensus of the assembly? To what extent the priority of Latin with modernised vocabulary being taught as a living language for practical purposes was the internal conviction of the delegates?

It is quite clear that the founding duo, Jean Capelle and Edouard Théodore-Aubanel, were convinced in this idea. The second congress was planned to be celebrated in Brussels in 1958 to coincide with the World’s Fair (Expo 58) happening there in order to spread the message of Living Latin, with its harmony of humanism and technology, to a wide audience; however, it was not possible to plan anything in the crowded city and the second congress was postponed to 1959.⁸⁴³ In this Lyon congress Capelle emphasised that *Vita Latina* “does not try to compete with the usual learned societies” and since Latin is not defended enough by “some people who are responsible for Latin”, the society should rather be a body open to all friends of Latin who would defend it and promote international usage of Latin.⁸⁴⁴ However, already in 1961 Capelle had to relinquish the

⁸⁴² Garvía (2015, 141)

⁸⁴³ Already in the Avignon congress Meunier (1956, 134), a professor in Brussels, saw a similarity between these two events – both the Living Latin congress and the World’s fair (its official theme was “Bilan du monde, pour un monde plus humain”) offered a similar message of a harmony between culture and technology: “Analogie entre « l’esprit d’Avignon 1956 » et le thème officiellement imposé à tous les participants de l’Exposition Universelle de « Bruxelles 1958 » : l’humanisme au sens le plus large, étendu à toutes les nations.”. Tosatti (1957, 39-40): “Alter Conventus Universalis Latini Viventis, ut audio, habebitur in urbe Bruxellis, inter celebrationes Expositionis universalis quæ indicitur in annum millesimum nongentesimum octavum sub signo thematis omnibus propositi: humanismus, latinissimus sensu, in omnes gentes prolatandus. Felix scientiæ et technicæ cum humanitate coniunctio! Hoc est in votis. // Nullum optatius signum etiam conventui viventis latini habendo. Læti omnes Bruxellas conveniemus. Quod bonum felix faustumque sit!”. Capelle (1957, 8): “Dum proximum conventum Bruxellis in Belgio celebrandum exspectamus”. See also Licoppe (2014a, 27).

⁸⁴⁴ The introduction to the future congress by Capelle (Théodore-Aubanel 1960, 10): “Peut-être convient-il de redire que le mouvement pour le latin vivant veut se garder des critiques stériles et souhaite mériter la sympathie de tous

presidency of *Vita Latina* due to time constraints after he became the General director of high schools in France,⁸⁴⁵ and so in 1962 the presidency was transferred to Pierre Grimal (1912-1996), a famous French classicist, professor of the University of Paris.⁸⁴⁶ Grimal himself was aware of the fact that his academical credentials alone were not enough to justify heading a movement for a practical Living Latin. Therefore, in the inaugural speech of 1963 congress he found it appropriate to perform *captatio benevolentiae* by apologising for heading *Vita Latina* and at the same time being a professor of Latin, one of those who “almost killed Latin” (!); he established his credentials as a Living Latin activist not by his own professional stature, but by citing his master-disciple relationship with Jean Bayet, one of the four keynote speakers in the first congress.⁸⁴⁷ This suggests that the promotion of international use of Latin and the usual professional life of a Latinist were understood as different things.

However, probably not for every member of *Vita Latina* this priority of international use of Latin was natural. The subtle shift of priorities from “practical” international Latin to academical and primarily pedagogical concerns is apparent in the history of *Vita Latina*, even if the conclusions of the congresses remained quite stable in emphasising the “practical” side of Latin. The second congress in 1959 (still presided by Capelle) was quite similar to the first 1956 one. *Vota* are presented as concrete suggestions (often pedagogical ones) how Latin could serve as a medium of communication for three fields: sciences, humanities, young people who are learning Latin.⁸⁴⁸ For example, UNESCO and other international organisations are urged to allow Latin summaries of scientific works. The *vota* of the third congress in 1963 contain some suggestions on increasing the use of Latin (e.g., the creation of the dictionary of modern Latin), but it is clear that it is not the only

les amis du latin. Il ne cherche pas à faire concurrence aux sociétés savantes qui, avec une autorité et un succès auxquels chacun rend hommage, maintiennent à un haut niveau la valeur et le prestige des études supérieures latines. Il veut agir sur un plan plus modeste, plus élémentaire et plus utilitaire aussi, si l'on nous permet cet adjectif qu'on n'a pas l'habitude d'associer au latin.” The opening speech by Capelle (Théodore-Aubanel 1960, 46): “Etenim cum linguae latinae defensio a quibusdam viris deserta sit qui ipsi illi colendae praepositi fuerint, omnes homines qui periculum sentiunt et ii qui in illius usu periti sibi minus videntur, proelium inire, inter se conjunctiores, debent.” Cf. also Licoppe (2014a, 29).

845 *Directeur général de l'organisation et des programmes scolaires*.

846 Licoppe (2014a, 38)

847 Théodore-Aubanel (1964, 32) gives the opening speech by Grimal: “Itaque ego, indignus, prima huius conuentus uerba feci. Quidam fortasse linguae Latinae professorem hunc locum non decere putabunt, cum hoc scholasticum genus linguam Latinam fere occiderit, ut malus medicus emortui corporis partes secare mauult quam uitam uiuentis seruare. Id nemo negat, et a uobis uenia mihi roganda est. Quam forsitan impetrem cum dixerim me magistrum habuisse et quasi patrem Iohannem Bayet, unum ex societatis nostrae conditoribus, uiuae Latinae linguae fautorem, cuius uestigia hic tantum sequor.” Cited also in Licoppe (2014a, 42).

848 Théodore-Aubanel (1960, 179-180): “Quo modo lingua latina docti inter se de scientiis colloqui possint. Quo modo humanitatis cultores lingua latina jungi possint. Quo modo adulescentes patria dissimiles lingua latina jungi possint. Le latin, moyen de communication dans le domaine de la science. Le latin, moyen de communication dans le domaine des humanités. Le latin, moyen de communication entre les jeunes.”

driving purpose any more – the proceedings start to contain general literary topics⁸⁴⁹ and there is an increasing preoccupation with Latin's position in the educational system.⁸⁵⁰

The fourth congress in 1969 marks a break away from the concern about the practical use of Latin on international level. The same Jean Capelle, who in 1952 distanced himself from the cultural arguments for Latin and proclaimed to be just a technician moved by purely practical concerns and searching “for better efficiency at a lower cost”, was now inaugurating the congress as “bearing witness to our will to preserve in education the universal values which are, more than ever, necessary for a society moving towards dehumanisation”.⁸⁵¹ The reason for this sharp difference lies in the dramatic national crisis of May 1968 in France and in the subsequent decision by the Ministry of Education to cut Latin from the first two (initially one) years of secondary school (sixth and fifth grades in the French system).⁸⁵² Therefore, the purpose of the whole congress was to assess the current situation of Latin in the world (with unenviable changes happening not only in France), to discuss teaching methods and to defend Latin's value.⁸⁵³ The recommendations of the congress are concerned purely with education – they call for more modern Latin teaching methods, the worldwide retention of Latin in secondary education, the appreciation that Latin is not inimical to technical disciplines in school programmes. The *Vita Latina* movement became focused on the pedagogical question and on France.

The fifth and the last congress was celebrated in 1975, but much reduced in scope – there were only 89 delegates compared to 235 in 1969, with fewer non-French delegates. Most of the lectures were about literary topics (August, Thomas Aquinas and Petrarca) and delivered in Latin, but the language was not used much outside the delivery of presentations. Even if the ambitions for practical Latin set forth in the initial writings and congresses were apparently without effect, the *vota* of the last congress repeated the same suggestions about Latin for communication between

849 For example, the proceedings (Théodore-Aubanel 1964) contain lectures about Henryk Sienkiewicz's use of Latin in his *Trilogy* and about Albert Camus' stylistics in relation to the Latin tradition.

850 For example, Thésée Tsannetatos' “La position présente du latin en Grèce. Une réaction contre la décadence”, Robert Schilling's “La situation des langues classiques dans l'enseignement français”.

851 Théodore-Aubanel (1970, 27): “Ce nouveau congrès pour le latin vivant témoigne de notre volonté de préserver, dans l'éducation, les valeurs désintéressées qui sont, plus que jamais, nécessaires à une société poussée vers la déshumanisation.”. Pierre Grimal was even more explicit in his denunciation of the future barbarity without Latin – see footnote 801.

852 Waquet (2001, 17-18). Also Pierre Grimal (Théodore-Aubanel 1970, 31): “Quis autem e vobis nescit, sodales, quae causa ad hunc conventum indicendum impulsus simus? Post prioris anni tumultum, cujus bonae litterae pars minima fuerunt, ecce edicto quodam, nullo legatorum publicorum consilio, sine ulla auctoritate publica, sermo latinus e duobus annis primis disciplinarum cursus expellitur.”

853 The three days of the congress were organised according to these three themes: “Ce que sont les études latines dans un certain nombre de pays”, “Diverses méthodes d'enseignement du latin”, “Ce que les lettres anciennes peuvent apporter aux hommes de notre temps”.

scientists, Latin summaries for latest research, Latin in UNESCO.⁸⁵⁴ The original ambitions of the movement still echoed in it.

At this point, the consensus of *Vita Latina* probably was not in accord with the original purpose, just as Pulgram suspected. The death in 1970 of Edouard Théodore-Aubanel, the publisher of the Latin-only journal *Vita Latina*, correlated with an increase of French texts in the journal. Pierre Grimal justified this decision to change the emphasis of the journal by the changed conditions of the general knowledge of Latin and by the necessity to attract more readers.⁸⁵⁵ The proportion of articles written in French gradually increased and finally in 1989, after Pierre Grimal stepped down as the president of the association, *Vita Latina* became a general journal of classical studies without using Latin in its pages any more.⁸⁵⁶

5.1.5 Assessment of the movement

It can be argued that the argument for Latin's practicality used to be made when Latin occupied a comparatively strong position in Western system of education and culture. In these times Capelle could reasonably support Latin under the guise of disinterested practicality, but in changed conditions he had to resort to cultural arguments to justify the preservation of its presence. Likewise, the concern for the future international use of Latin was not the primary reason of the continuing focus on modern teaching methods, there were other factors: the desire for better results than usually achieved through the traditional grammar-translation method and the necessity to make better use of ever-decreasing hours allocated to Latin in school programmes. The *Vita Latina* movement thus can be seen as a product of its times and of particular conditions, which have eventually modified its scope: when it was clear that Latin would not hold to its position in the educational system, the original emphasis on the utilitarian Latin could not be sustained as viable.

The claim for Latin as a useful international scientific language was dependent on its ubiquity in education, additional impetus was provided by the situation after the Second World War. After the Second World War there was a strong impetus for European integration and a case has been made that this pan-European sentiment was one of the main motivations of the Living Latin movement.⁸⁵⁷ Also, in 1952 Capelle believed that there is presently no international scientific

854 Licoppe (2014a, 118-122)

855 Licoppe (2014a, 100-101; 113-115)

856 Desessard (1991a) is a long and polemic article about this change of direction; Licoppe (2014a, 220) briefly summarises this change after Grimal's death.

857 Licoppe (2014a) and in numerous other writings by the same author. Slednikov (2019a), Licoppe and Desessard (1987). Capelle himself was an enthusiast of European integration, in 1950 as the rector of University of Nancy founding the European University Centre (*Centre européen universitaire*) in his university (Audinot and Bonnal (2009, 10); Capelle and Quigley (1953, 40)).

language and, more importantly, that there is no clear trend that any language would emerge to dominate internationally; in 1959 he maintained the same argument and cited rising percentage of scientific publications in Russian and other languages.⁸⁵⁸ The cited bibliometric data indicated that 44% of scientific publications were in English, but it was not yet clear that this plurality would increase to the dominance seen in later years.⁸⁵⁹ This unclear situation provided space for Latin's claims, but the later developments in language distribution and the weakening of Latin's positions in the educational system weakened this utilitarian argument, forcing the defenders of Latin to take up an explicitly cultural position.

Another reason why the initial ambitions were not fulfilled lies in the fact that they did not find enough concrete support in groups it was appealed to: scientists, Latinists, international and state organisations. Few "practical" people who would use Latin in their scientific endeavours were present in the congresses.⁸⁶⁰ The internationality of the congresses was impressive and the number of delegates considerable, but they did not manage to change the prevailing approach to the language in the broader community of professional Latinists. The *Vita Latina* movement also promoted communicational methods of teaching of Latin, but further study is needed to understand the extent and success of its advocacy (particularly in France, where the movement might have been influential).⁸⁶¹ However, the original 1956 proposal of an easy *Assimil*-like method for learning Latin was independently fulfilled in 1966 by Clément Desessard, an engineer and amateur of Latin,⁸⁶² who combined modern and ancient themes in one textbook *Latin sans peine*; the foregrounding in the textbook of modern conversation in Latin, combined with audio recordings, was similar to the vision of Avellanus in his *Palæstra*. In 1959, in the second congress of *Vita Latina*, Hans H. Ørberg delivered a Latin address⁸⁶³ *Latin language explained through itself* (*Lingua Latina per se explicata*) presenting his textbook (*Lingua Latina secundum naturae rationem explicata*, now known as *Lingua Latina per se illustrata*) which employed a different approach – it applied a version of natural method previously applied to teaching of the modern languages, but shied away from modern subjects, preferring to teach active skills of Latin through Roman themes.⁸⁶⁴

858 Capelle (1960)

859 Bibliometrics provided by Sano (2002) of chemistry journal papers indicate that English passed the 50% threshold by 1965, while the 60% threshold was passed only by 1980.

860 With notable exceptions – for example, André Gain, director of the documentation department (*centre de documentation*) of the *Institut de recherches pour les huiles de palme et oléagineux* expressed full endorsement of Latin as the only possible international language (Théodore-Aubanel 1960, 25); (Waquet 2001, 267). Henry Robert Nicollon des Abbayes, a noted French botanist and lichenologist, delivered one of the main lectures (*Le latin et la Communication scientifique*) in congress of 1963 (Théodore-Aubanel 1964, 39-44).

861 See Appendix A.10 for an interesting example of how the 1956 Avignon congress was received in the schools.

862 See footnote 817.

863 Ørberg (1960)

864 See Appendix A.6 for a very brief review of the method and its fortunes.

While government officials used to send letters of encouragement and to participate in inauguration of *Vita Latina* congresses, no state funding materialised for this endeavour and these initiatives were funded privately. So it seems that the 1956 Avignon congress itself was only possible because of support and efforts of Édouard Théodore-Aubanel, the journal was likewise published by his publishing house. It was hard to find contributors for the modern Latin dictionary project without financial support.⁸⁶⁵ An unlikely exception to the pattern of insufficient state support for Living Latin happened to be Senegal. Léopold Sédar Senghor (1906-2001), the president of the country (1960-1980), was originally a teacher of Latin who would speak the language to his pupils.⁸⁶⁶ He participated in the congresses of *Vita Latina*, later also in those of the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* (hosting its congress in Dakar in 1977) and commissioned a series of African-themed textbooks of Latin taught as a modern language, later decreeing them to be used in the republic.⁸⁶⁷ This remarkable exception actually proves the general pattern – Senghor was an enthusiast of Living Latin teaching methods well before the congress and did not need to be converted.

The movement was a success in several ways. The 1956 Avignon congress had a great symbolic value. Even if it is hard to determine how much of the published programme was implemented (and how much of this was due to negative external events), the event provided a historical reference point of the “First Congress” for everyone in the later decades who wanted to promote the use of Latin or to write the history of the movement.⁸⁶⁸ Having an official society, a congress and a definite beginning of Latin language revival effort history added prestige to the endeavour. The congresses *for the Living Latin* and the journal *Vita Latina*, published mostly in Latin, connected scattered activists and provided a sense of community. Many of the people who later distinguished themselves in activism for active use of Latin can be traced to the delegate lists

865 So complained Quinto Tosatti, the president of the *Istituto Nazionale di Studi Romani* and head of the working group for the modern Latin dictionary. Licoppe (2014a, 26) cites the *Vita Latina* journal from 1957: “Constitutis his Consiliis, aliquid tamen deest ut efficaciter laborent: pecunia. Itaque Quintus Tosatti, cui de neologismorum lexico curandum est, ad Iohannem Capelle scribit sine pecunia difficile esse idoneos invenire cooperatores.”

866 Senghor told this in a public lecture he gave when visiting Rome. It was published by *Vita Latina* (Oct. 1973 No. 51; it was republished later, citing *Vita Latina* as the original source, as Senghor (1974)) and cited by Licoppe (2014a, 108-109): “Orationis scopus patet ex eius titulo : « Le Sénégal, le Latin et les Humanités classiques ». Imprimis narrat se primum Africanum esse in Francogallia, qui factus sit « agrégé de grammaire » ; tunc ante alterum bellum mundanum munere magistri linguae Francogallicae, Latinae et Graecae functus est in lyceo Cæsaroduni (*Tours*) ubi modo vivo linguam Latinam docuit loquens cum discipulis.”. See also (Licoppe 2002). Capelle founded the University of Dakar together with Senghor (Audinot and Bonnal 2009, 10).

867 Chaumartin et al. (1974) is the first volume of the three volume series; the principal author presents the project in Chaumartin (1976). Senghor himself provided a preface “Le latin comme langue vivante” where he praised the book and commented on it as a professional Latin teacher, also noting that he himself had used a similar “living” method: “Je suis d’autant plus heureux de présenter ce premier tome de la nouvelle méthode du « Latin sans peine », comme on disait autrefois, que j’ai moi-même appliqué une méthode semblable. L’originalité de celle-ci est qu’elle est adaptée à l’Afrique.”

868 Footnote 781 lists some of the histories of Living Latin basing themselves on the 1956 as the foundational event.

of the *Vita Latina* congresses, which performed an important function of establishing the social network; many of key actors of *Vita Latina* would go on to participate in the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*.

5.1.6 *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*

5.1.6.1 An outline of the history

The third congress of *Vita Latina* in Strasbourg in 1963 proclaimed, among other *vota*, a desire to “celebrate the next congress after three years outside France – in Rome, if it can be done”.⁸⁶⁹ This call was answered in April 1966 by Pietro Romanelli, Italian archaeologist and the president of the National Institute of Roman Studies (*Istituto Nazionale di Studi Romani*), who organised in Rome an international *Congress for the study and use of Latin* (*Congresso internazionale per lo studio e l'uso del latino / Omnium gentium ac nationum conventus Latinis litteris linguaeque fovendis*) with 538 participants from 41 countries, delegated by more than 70 universities.⁸⁷⁰ At the end of the congress, in the *vota* it was decreed that all the *vota* by the previous congresses remain in effect (so this congress was considered a direct continuation of the 1956, 1959, 1963 congresses *pour le latin vivant*) and that a new international organisation would be founded in Rome in the Institute, which would have the task of organising future congresses in any country decided upon by the members.⁸⁷¹ Therefore, the 1966 congress was suggested by *Vita Latina* and it seems that the main body of its members participated it; from timing it seems that *Vita Latina* considered this congress almost as one of their own, preferring to partake in this congress and celebrate their own next one only after three years in 1969. However, the Rome congress was organised independently from *Vita Latina* and does not figure in the numbering of *Vita Latina* congresses. Finally, a new organisation arose from it, so the congress marks a meeting point where the official movement of Living Latin branched in two.

As noted above,⁸⁷² Romanelli named the congress *for the study and use of Latin* (*per lo studio e l'uso del latino*), which was the title of the Latin revival programme led by Carlo Galassi Paluzzi since 1932; this could not have been a coincidence, as Romanelli had been a colleague of

869 Théodore-Aubanel (1964, 131): “In votis quoque est ut, expletis tribus annis, in alia natione praeter Galliam – quod si fieri possit, Romae – Conventus proximus habeatur.”

870 Licoppe (2014a, 57)

871 Licoppe (2014a, 66): “1. ut maneant vota rataque habeantur in superioribus de Latinitate conventibus probata <...>
4. ut officium quoddam Romae constituatur quod sedem apud Institutum Romanis Studiis Provehendis habeat.
Præterea ut ii in hoc consilio sedeant quibus de futuris condendis conventibus cura mandetur a sua cuique gente.”

872 The end of section 4.3.2.5, page 146.

Galassi Paluzzi since 1926, the very beginning of the Institute. So Romanelli finally founded in Rome as part of the Institute of Roman Studies an institution for coordinating the global movement of Living Latin; the intention was similar to what Galassi Paluzzi tried to do before the World War II – Rome was to be the centre of Latin. Therefore, the new organisation can be seen as a merger of the movement started by the 1956 Avignon conference with the initiative started by the Institute of Roman Studies in 1932.

In this new organisation, Latin use would be enforced on lectures delivered, but vernacular would be permissible in discussions and inaugurations. In 1970 this nascent organisation (*Collegium Latinitati inter omnes gentes fovendae*) approved its first statute and became the *Academia Latinitati inter omnes gentes fovendae* that would “promote and pursue every initiative for increasing the knowledge of Latinity, the factor of moral and human progress”⁸⁷³. The series of international congresses organised by *ALF* continues roughly every four years up to today.⁸⁷⁴

5.1.6.2 The changing scope of the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*

This seemingly seamless continuity from 1966 to today is not so simple. The *Academia* was subject to similar external and internal forces and tensions as *Vita Latina* and in its long history it experienced quite a lot of uncertainty about its goals and nature. Is the primary purpose of *ALF* to advance the scholarship? Is this goal subservient to the use of Latin? Is the exclusive use of Latin in congresses an advantage or an impediment? When and if Latin use should be required from the members? Are scholarly credentials of possible members more important than the requirement of active usage of Latin? Does this requirement limit the usefulness of *ALF* in field of scholarship and possible collaborations? Should *ALF* involve itself in such Living Latin goals as writing dictionaries of modern Latin? What is more important – the adherence to language purity and classical models or the quest for practical Latin and modern terminology?

The evolution of the responses this new organisation provided to these questions has been amply described by Guy Licoppe in the Latin monograph *Academia Latinitati Fovendae: its history considered through the movement of Living Latin* he wrote after obtaining its archive.⁸⁷⁵ It should be consulted for a broader treatment of the history of *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*.

873 Licoppe (2014a, 88): “L’Accademia Latinitati inter omnes Gentes Fovendae ha lo scopo di promuovere e di sviluppare ogni iniziativa atta ad incrementare la conoscenza della latinità, fattore di elevazione morale e di civile progresso.”

874 I Rome, Italy (1966), II Bucharest, Romania (1970), III Malta (1973), IV Dakar, Senegal (1977), V Trier, Germany (1981), VI Durham, England (1985), VII Erfurt/East Berlin, Germany (1989), VIII Antwerp/Leuven, Belgium (1993), IX Jyväskylä, Finland (1997), X Madrid, Spain (2000), XI Alcañiz/Amposta, Spain (2006), XII Regensburg, Germany (2009), XIII Vienna, Austria (2013), XIV Lexington, Kentucky USA (2017), XV Rome, Italy (2022).

875 Licoppe (2014a)

Pietro Romanelli closed the 1966 congress with an observation⁸⁷⁶ that the congress strives for the study of Latin and its prestige to be restored internationally; even if it is not clear if Latin could be restored as an international language of sciences, it is a goal worth striving for. But if not only Latinists are going to participate in this, a simpler Latin, a less direct imitation of ancient models is needed. Romanelli emphasised that he himself is not a philologist, but rather an archaeologist, so he has a right to defend the simplicity of language. In this, he was a direct heir of Capelle and Galassi Paluzzi. The same congress heard also the lecture by the Vatican Latinist Antonio Bacci, who elaborated a systematic theory of neologisms, which was cautious – it included many remarks on how easy it is to introduce barbarisms.⁸⁷⁷ In the proceedings of the conference one can find many positions on the kind of Latin to be employed and on its suitability for scholarship and modernity. The tension around the purpose and the kind of Latin was present.

The new 1970 statute of *ALF* defined its purpose as the propagation of Latin as a factor of cultural progress and the elevation of morals.⁸⁷⁸ While containing sections for researching different eras of Latin, it did not have a section for the modernisation of language. However, the conclusions of congresses continued to include wishes for broader use of Latin – in 1973 congress, celebrated in Malta, many organisations were asked to provide space for Latin.⁸⁷⁹ The congresses, which were being celebrated every five years, continued to be only in Latin.⁸⁸⁰

The death in 1981 of Pietro Romanelli, the head of the Institute of Roman Studies and of the *ALF*, ended the connection the Institute still had with its Interwar initiative for Latin revival. The

876 Licoppe (2014a, 65-66); Pacitti and Ussani (1968, 374-377): “Quaestio autem illa adhuc sub iudice est, utrum ad usum linguae Latinae redeant docti homines necne. Hoc quidem spero fore ut ex hac ingeniorum concertatione evadat. Attamen, utcumque res se habet, ad id nobis maximis viribus est enitendum, ut, non solum Latinistae, qui dicuntur, sed etiam docti, <...> Id tantum vobis dicere volo, cum ego latinista non sim putandus, me nonnullos collegas audivisse dicentes se, quamvis latinistae non sint, valde cupere ut Latina lingua saltem inter doctos reviviscat. // Eis tamen, ut mihi, vos in componendis verborum circuitibus auctorum more, qui aurei dicuntur, Ciceronis scilicet, Caesaris, et Sallusti, subtiliores interdum esse videmini. Quare nunc orationis simplicitate opus esse defendere ausim, quae hodiernis hominibus apta sit et cum eorum natura atque indole magis cohaereat. Ita fortasse melius Latinitati proderitis.”

877 Licoppe (2014a, 61-62): “Ac principio animadvertendum mihi esse videtur quod de renovandis Latinae linguae vocabulis Cicero, Horatius, Quintilianus et alii non pauci Latinitatis scriptores antiqui scribunt, esse a nobis summa cum prudentia et circumspecto cautoque iudicio accipiendum, ne Folenghiana potius quam Latina lingua scribere videamur. <...> Audendum utique, sed non insolenter non indecore – ut Iulius Caesar severe admonet – ne vernacula lingua potius quam Latina scribere vel loqui videamur”. He applied his principles in the dictionary of modern terms he published (Bacci 1945). His autobiography (Bacci 1991) gives further detail on his motivation for writing the dictionary – as the main papal Latinist, he had to compose the Latin versions of encyclicals describing modern inventions, so publishing a dictionary for suitable terms came to his mind; this idea was encouraged by Pius XII (p. 23).

878 Licoppe (2014a, 88): “L’Accademia Latinitati inter omnes Gentes Fovendae ha lo scopo di promuovere e di sviluppare ogni iniziativa atta ad incrementare la conoscenza della latinità, fattore di elevazione morale e di civile progresso.”

879 Licoppe (2014a, 111-112). *Fédération Internationale des Études Classiques* was asked to allow Latin in its conferences; UNESCO was asked the same for international conferences, adding that Latin summaries should be provided of its proceedings; the same general stood for journals of classical studies, ancient history etc. Vatican was asked to preserve the use of Latin in the Mass and in the Catholic universities.

880 See the index in footnote 874.

following directors did not favour the idea of Living Latin as much as Romanelli had. *ALF* already in 1982 started thinking about seceding from the Institute, as the internationality of Latin clashed with the local character of being subordinate to another institution.

Compared to the 1950s and 1960s, by the middle of the 1980s the prestige, knowledge and position of Latin in the world had deteriorated dramatically. The original proposals of the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* rang hollow in this new climate. *ALF* was now in front of a crossroads. In the 1986 session⁸⁸¹ of *ALF* prof. Jozef IJsewijn (1932-1998) had a short presentation called *The fortunes of Latinity – what will happen tomorrow?* He saw that now, when Latin had been cut out from most of the secondary education, there is almost no-one from the school graduates who knows Latin well. There are only notable individual exceptions, good teachers like Geneviève Immè from Pau⁸⁸² who stimulate their students to write in Latin. Not even the students of classical philology in universities manage to write more than two-three sentences in Latin nor do their teachers want or are able to write in Latin. Not knowing Latin, they do not want to write it (whatever be their subtle excuses). What is then the course of action? In order to make Latin survive to the next millennium, the *Academia* should collect the rare few lovers and knowers of Latin and organise them (including existing societies for Latin) into an organised front in order to fight for modest victories that are still possible, and not far-fetched ones like requiring the European institutions in Strasbourg or the United Nations to speak Latin.⁸⁸³ Such victories would include the admission of Latin papers to philological, theological, historical, philosophical journals; diplomas should continue to be written in Latin; as would new inscriptions in buildings or medals; libraries should buy Latin books; some guest lectures abroad should be delivered in Latin. These small victories would assure visibility for Latin, without which Latin studies could disappear forever.

Caelestis Eichenseer, a great enthusiast of speaking Latin, answered this. He noticed that IJsewijn was pessimistic about Latin's future and that he himself also saw a change for the worse in the use of Latin in the Church as the result of the Second Vatican Council. However, he noticed that the ignorance of Latin speaking is produced by a vicious cycle – how does one learn to speak Latin

881 This exchange is recounted in Licoppe (2014a, 205-206) and originally in Eichenseer (1986, 234-237). The talk of IJsewijn was titled *De fortuna Latinitatis: quid sit futurum cras, quaeramus*.

882 See footnote 495.

883 Eichenseer (1986, 234-235): “Hōc rerum scholasticarum statu factum est, ut in studiorum universitatibus ne philologiae quidem classicae studiosi plerumque eo procedant, ut duas tresve sententias Latinas Latine valeant componere. Et, ut aperte loquamur, quot supersunt inter ipsos Latinitatis magistros, qui Latine scribere velint, immo possint? *Nam nolunt, quia non possunt*: quidquid subtiliter argumentantes ignorantiae suae praetexant. <...> Similiter et de historicis dicendum, de philosophis, de aliis doctis quam plurimis, et ut res quo loco sit, uno comprehendam verbo Vergiliano: “ardet Ucalegon, immo ardet domus nostra, et mox in cineres convertetur”. Quae cum ita sint, quid faciendum, ut Latinitas in proximum millennium perveniat, non capuli, sed, quod semper erat, cultus civilis et doctrinae decus. Congregandi sunt rari illi Latinitatis amantes et Latinam linguam callentes. Eorum cohors parva constituenda est, sed alacris, quae sibi non somnia fingat neque, ut exemplum ponam, coetum illum Argentoratensem vel omnium nationum universitatem Novo-Eboracensem [New York] Latine loqui iubeat, sed servet, quae servari possint, promoveat, quae etiam nunc promoveri possint.”

if the professors do not want to express themselves in Latin? Then the teachers never hear professors speak Latin and their students also never hear the language.⁸⁸⁴ It is clear at this point that IJsewijn and Eichenseer were speaking about two different things – IJsewijn was being reasonable and was speaking only about serious use of written Latin (mentioning only *writing*, never *speaking*), while Eichenseer believed that the skill of speaking Latin needs to be developed, as it is also the source from which any skill of writing Latin flows.⁸⁸⁵ IJsewijn replied that it is not so important to speak Latin today, it is more important to write in Latin about philology, theology, philosophy; after all, one could not force the atomic physicists to write in Latin, it is impossible and unreasonable, they have English for assuring internationality. Latin should be saved where it can be saved. Speaking Latin is not that important, but if we can do that, of course, it is beautiful. Eichenseer immediately retorted that it was *necessary*.⁸⁸⁶

This exchange is very symptomatic of the divide between the reasonable professional (in this case even Latin-speaking) Latinists and the enthusiasts of Latin speaking. IJsewijn is thinking about the greater good of the scholarly community of the humanities – the knowledge of Latin is disappearing, it should be somehow improved collectively, Latin should be visible in its traditional roles as a symbol (inscriptions, diplomas) and as a means of serious scholarly communication (journal articles, guest lectures). This is a well-managed approach to Latin – goals are reasonably defined and attainable enough; the Latin speaking skills are considered nice to have, but there are more pressing concerns. IJsewijn lives in and for the scholarly community. Meanwhile Eichenseer represents the enthusiast wing of the Living Latin movement which is excited by the expansive possibilities of Latin (rather than just a preservation of its traditional roles that are going obsolete). For him the speaking of Latin is necessary. He wants to be able to talk about every modern topic in Latin, so he prefaces his response with a lexicographical digression concerning the proper ways to form neologisms. For IJsewijn the speaking about atomic physics is unreasonable because that field

884 Eichenseer (1986, 236): “Et hunc in modum certe non omnes possunt promoveri et non omnes possunt instigari, ut statim Latine loquantur. Sed est quidam circulus vitiosus. Professores universitarii nolunt sententiam Latinam proferre. Unde discant magistri, unde discant discipuli? Magistri non audiverunt professores Latine loquentes, discipuli non audiunt magistros Latine loquentes, paucis exceptis.”

885 A similar exchange happened in the 1933 congress of the Institute of Roman Studies, where the sessions discussed the written form of Latin as the international language, but never talked about the development of active oral skills; then Silvio Romani and Giuseppe Fornari were surprised about this artificial divide and believed that one should start from developing full-fledged active skills of the language, including spoken ones, which would greatly help the skill of writing. See p. 158.

886 Eichenseer (1986, 237): “Prof. Iosephus IJsewijn: «Ego credo non tanti momenti esse nostro tempore – pace tuā dixerim – Latine loqui; maioris momenti est Latine scribere de philologicis, theologicis, philosophicis; non credo fieri posse, ut iterum de rebus mathematicis et physicis (et aliis) viri docti Latine scripturi sint, non credo hoc. Agitur de rebus nostris humanioribus: in rebus humanioribus servetur Latinitas et notitia linguae Latinae. Ego non credo maximi momenti esse. Si Latine loqui possumus, pulchre est.» // C. Eichenseer: «Est necessarium.» // Prof. Iosephus IJsewijn: «Nostro tempore minus est necessarium – pace tua iterum dico –: Io voglio dire questo: è importante di conservare nella conoscenza del latino negli studi e nelle facoltà letterarie, teologiche etc. <...>”

will never use Latin again, but for Eichenseer it is important to do that in order to demonstrate and to practise the perennial universality of Latin. This enthusiasm is loosely tied to the concerns of society and to the position of Latin in it. Even if Latin loses all of its roles, the use of it is meaningful in itself. Therefore, while for IJsewijn the original proposals of the *ALF* where Latin was being promoted as the international language of *all* sciences (including exact sciences like physics) might have been unreasonable at this point when there was already no hope of implementing them, so they should have been changed somewhat in order to achieve any concrete results, for Eichenseer the same proposals were inspiring for their symbolic value and their universalistic breadth. This wing wanted to preserve the lofty aims and saw them as non-negotiable. For them, the use of Latin and the adaptation of it to full-fledged modern use were overwhelmingly important.⁸⁸⁷ For them it would have been preferable if the Academy would have used Latin not only in its lectures, but also in informal communication in the breaks and elsewhere.⁸⁸⁸

In the 1988 session Jozef IJsewijn raised the point that the Academy does not have a scientific aim. His suggestion was received in two ways: prof. Bruno Luiselli agreed and saw the obligatory use of Latin in the Academy as limiting the participation of many scholars, while prof. Vincenzo Ussani jr. (1922-2001)⁸⁸⁹ noted that Latin cannot be forsaken without changing the foundation of the Academy, losing its identity.⁸⁹⁰ In 1989 the Academy became independent from the Institute of Roman Studies, Ussani became its president. In 1990 Jozef IJsewijn proposed that the next congress of the Academy could be celebrated in Belgium (Leuven and Antwerpen), but in order to get public funding, the use of other languages should be permitted. For IJsewijn, a

887 Guy Licoppe attended the 1986 session of *ALF* together with his friend Eichenseer and published a short history of the *Academia* (Licoppe (1986a); Licoppe (1986b)) which had a scathing conclusion that almost *nothing* had been done for Living Latin in its 20 years of its existence, there were no efforts to revive Latin, only learned lectures about antiquity. Here he notes (he later developed on this point in Licoppe (2014a)) that it is already clear from the title of the 1966 congress that it is not for the “Living Latin” (...*pour le latin vivant*, ...*viventi Latinitati*), but rather *litteris linguaeque*. The ending of the article also treats the IJsewijn episode: “Infelicitur manifestum est, praeter C. Eichenseer, C. Egger, I. M. Mir et S. H. Siedl, vix ullum sodalem huius academiae ad Latinitatem Vivam operam dare. Immo Iosephus IJsewijn, cui referendum erat de statu hodierno Latinitatis Vivae, ad summam dixit linguam Latinam hodie ad nullum usum aptam esse, nisi forte ad nonnullos versus pangendos, neque utile esse Latine loqui, sed iam satis esse Latine scribere; quibus sententiis assensi sunt plerique sodales. Quam longe absumus a votis decretis in III^o Conventu Vitae Latinae! // Per viginti annos ergo Academia nihil fecit ad linguam Latinam nostris temporibus accommodandam. Hic non perquiremus causas tantae sterilitatis. Licet tamen mirari quod docti professores congregari pergunt solum ad nenas dicendas...”. In the next year’s session José María Mir (1912-2000), after reading this article, proposed creating a committee of neologisms; Eichenseer, Mir and Egger constituted it (Licoppe 2014a, 209).

888 Licoppe (2014a, 243-244) provides testimonies of Tuomo Pekkanen (1934-) and Caelestis Eichenseer from 1990. Pekkanen (originally Pekkanen (1990)) notes that the Latin language in *ALF* was used in lectures, but not in conversations, which happened in Italian. Eichenseer sees the Latin speaking skills of the members more important than formal academic credentials: “Quid autem proderunt novi sodales divulgationibus scientificis perinsignes, si vix unum verbum Latine proferre sciunt? Satis quidem multae academiae aliae exstant, quarum sodales tantummodo linguis nationalibus utuntur”.

889 Not to be confused with his grandfather Vincenzo Ussani sr. (1870-1952), a prominent Latinist in the Interwar Italy and also one of the important figures in the Latin revival initiative of the Institute of Roman Studies in the 1930s.

890 Licoppe (2014a, 217)

prominent Neo-Latinist, the unique feature and the main advantage of *ALF* over other Latin associations was that it treated Latin as a whole, from Antiquity through Middle Ages and Renaissance to our days. The congress proposal was approved, but the use of Latin, at the insistence of Ussani, was obligatory for the members of the Academy.⁸⁹¹

The congress in Leuven and Antwerpen, organised by Jozef IJsewijn and Dirk Sacré, was a success, with about 250 participants.⁸⁹² The major languages of Western Europe (English, French, Italian, Spanish, German) were allowed, but Latin maintained a slight majority, being used in half of the addresses. In the inaugural lecture, that IJsewijn delivered in Latin, further developed his thinking about the future of Latin and the purpose of the Academy. The times have changed: back when the Academy was founded, the knowledge of Latin was much more widespread than today, when Latin is in danger of disappearance. So even if there will still be laudable writers in Latin in the next century, they will be writing only for a very small audience. Therefore the way the Academy fosters (*fovet*) Latin should be changed to a more efficient one. It is time to unite all Latinists – the Classicists, Medievalists and Neo-Latin scholars; *ALF*, with its holistic view of Latin, could become a forum where all these disciplines could meet. He also acknowledges that the members of the Academy are undecided about this change⁸⁹³ and that there exists a certain mutual hostility between the scholars of Latin and the speakers of it.⁸⁹⁴ The postscript of the conference contains a note that not so many classical philologists came to the conference because they feared to be associated with the so-called “Living Latin” and to suffer reputation damage from this, but the Neo-Latinists fortunately did not have such reservations.⁸⁹⁵ Therefore, the changed circumstances

891 Licoppe (2014a, 245-246)

892 Licoppe (2014a, 269-272) treats this conference.

893 IJsewijn (1995, 6-7): “Vnde colligi potest, immo necessario sequitur veterem nostrae Academiae finem non iam novorum temporum adiunctis satis respondere. Itaque alia etiam via procedamus oportet ut latinitatem apud nova saecula efficacius foveamus et provehamus. Quae via qualis futura sit nondum plane omnino et clare perspicimus, ac non una in re socii nostri dubiis torquentur et agitantur. <...> As a consequence, the initial aim of our Academy will no longer be able to be adapted to the new situation. We will have to look for other ways to foster and sustain Latin in the coming centuries. What these ways are we do not yet perceive very clearly, and I admit that my fellow-Academicians are still in the dark and most hesitantly probing.” The original Latin version was delivered in the congress (it contains literary references, etc.), the English translation is provided in the proceedings.

894 IJsewijn (1995, 10-11): “Restat denique aliquid quod maxime molestum duco: saepius fit ut Latinitatis cultores et cultrices reciproca laborent ignorantia, interdum eheu et – dicere pudet – inimicitia. Qui studiis romanis vacant, nonnumquam omnino nesciunt esse et studia mediolatina et neolatina. Idem de peritis mediae et recentioris Latinitatis dici potest. Ii qui latine loqui malunt, interdum despiciunt eos easve qui latinae linguae monumentis studere tantummodo volunt, et contrarium non minus est verum. Quodsi omnes una stare possemus in provehenda re latina, ubicumque de ea agatur, firmiores multo essemus et efficaciores; maius haberemus, ut cum sociologis loquar, pondus civile et sociale. Regnum in se divisum interibit. <...> There is, still, a last and most painful point. Not rarely students of various areas of the Latin tradition ignore each other and sometimes – it is a shame to say – they hate or despise one another. Many classical scholars know nothing about mediaeval Latin and Neo-latin studies, and vice-versa. Some who still want to speak Latin look down upon scholars who only want to study Latin texts, and vice-versa again. Why can’t we all join forces in our struggle for Latin in all its aspects? If we did, we would be much stronger and more successful and grow in social and academic relevance.”

895 IJsewijn and Sacré (1995, 826): “Nec minor disciplinarum erat copia, quarum quisque studiosus ad conventum accessit, itaque id saltem manifestavit quam late pateat totius Latinitatis campus. Dolendum tamen quod classicae

made obsolete the practical arguments for the communication in Latin, moreover it did not enjoy a prestigious reputation, it made sense to change them. The use of Latin was an obstacle rather than an advantage for the goal of saving the humanities.⁸⁹⁶

However, these arguments could not sway the direction of the Academy. The next (1997) congress was organised in Jyväskylä (*Granivicum*), Finland by Tuomo Pekkanen (1934-), who restored the exclusive use of Latin in the congress. Again the number of participants was roughly 250; even the local state and university officials addressed the congress in Latin.⁸⁹⁷ For this success, he obtained a majority vote in president elections, but the statute prevented him then from becoming one⁸⁹⁸ – this was probably a reminder that the original roots of the Academy lied in the ambition of the Italians to achieve primacy over the Latin studies worldwide. That year in the Academy session a point was made that the Academy should apply for the European Union funding of scholarship, but for this the language requirement needed to be abolished;⁸⁹⁹ even if a certain relaxation was done,⁹⁰⁰ no such proposals were filled.⁹⁰¹ In the beginning of 2004 the Academy finally left the premises of its cradle – the Institute of Roman Studies – and now was left without a permanent seat. Pekkanen, who restored the exclusive use of Latin, was now its president.

In 2013 the Academy confirmed its new statute. All references to the Institute of Roman Studies were finally purged – now the learned society was completely separate from its birthplace. The question of language reversed to the simple no-compromise statement that “the language of the Academy is Latin” (*sermo Academiae est Latinus*), removing various exceptions that had

philologiae cultores et cultrices spe et expectatione nostra pauciores venerunt. Cuius rei hanc causam esse accepimus plerosque illos philologos vereri ne nomen suum cum viva, quae dicitur, Latinitate publice coniungeretur ex eoque doctae famae detrimentum caperent. Quod si ita sit, Academiae urgenter deliberandum esse nobis videtur quo modo deplorandae huic rei remedium afferri possit. Gaudendum interim quod recentioris et recentissimae Latinitatis studiosi et studiosae huiusmodi praeiudicio non laborantes in concilium nostrum frequentes advolarunt.”. The postscript contains another note of IJsewijn – in the face of the troubles faced by all the humanities it is much more important to unite all Latinists and humanities rather to quarrel about speaking the language: “Novum est et firmissimum argumentum ut omnes Latinitatis cultores et cultrices una stent, studia humaniora sapienter defendant, vanas de loquendo latine aut vernacule rixas omittant. Ardet Vcalegon!” (p. 829).

896 Both Licoppe and Eichenseer reacted in their periodicals to IJsewijn’s statements. Licoppe (1993, 2): “Ad summam Professor IJsewijn tantum cogitat de litteris Latinis modo scientifico tractandis quacumque sit lingua; de sermone Latino nostris temporibus colendo adhibendoque minime curat. Certe nil dico contra has investigationes; multa enim conferunt ad radices, truncum ramosque ingentis arboris Latinitatis melius cognoscendos. Sed illi qui etiam virentes Latinitatis ramulos colunt propria, firma praestantique sede egent. Nolumus oblivisci ex illorum impetu Academiam Romanam ortam esse; conventuum titulus totus semper fuit: «Conventus Latinis litteris linguaeque fovendis». In hoc titulo «fovere» est magni ponderis; mortua enim iam non foveri possunt; viventibus tantum prodest foveri et praecipue pullis. // Nefas est Academiam a scopo suo avertere. Hac in re veritas etiam est colenda.”.

897 Licoppe (2014a, 299-301)

898 Licoppe (2014a, 303-304)

899 Licoppe (2014a, 302-303)

900 Licoppe (2014a, 306-307) shows the 1998 changes in the statute enabling the use of the major languages everywhere except the plenary addresses by the Academy members in the congresses organised by the Academy.

901 Prof. Bruno Luiselli was the author of this idea, but, seeing that no such proposals were formulated and that the Academy had an uncertain financial future, he resigned in 2003 (Licoppe 2014a, 337-338).

accumulated. Even the informal communications, which used to be Italian in the earlier years of the Academy, now apparently were predominantly in Latin; the presidents themselves were foreigners and not Italians. But the seat of it remained in Rome, the spiritual home of Latin culture, and every year its presiding council has been holding its meetings there.

The aims of the Academy changed significantly during its history. Initially the movement had an ambition to restore the international use of Latin, but later the changed circumstances consisting from the deteriorated knowledge and position of Latin made it doubt its aims, which were clearly not achievable any more. From there, it could either revise its purpose (as the *Vita Latina* organisation did by focusing on language pedagogy and general scholarship) to make itself more relevant for still achievable victories, or it could keep the original aims as an ideal valuable in itself. After a period of attempted moves in the first direction, the Academy returned to its roots as an organisation uniting the scholars who believe in the vitality of Latin and who use the language actively. Through the decades its regular congresses⁹⁰² have provided a great service to the Latin movement – in this microcosm Latin continued to play the role of the international language of scholarship.⁹⁰³

5.2 The “enthusiast” Living Latin movement

In the preceding section I surveyed the “official” Living Latin movement – the organisations that strived to unite all the proponents of the active use of Latin under one authoritative umbrella, and so to provide a united front for restoring the use of the Latin language. However, in these large organisations it was hard to overcome various internal tensions and to work towards these aims. It was seen above that both of these official movements – *Vita Latina* and *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* – had vocal minorities which held on tightly to the initial ambitious aims of using the language widely and they criticised the organisations for being pragmatic and not following them, hence, “doing nothing”; the ideals of Living Latin for them were more important than the changing circumstances.

It is precisely this minority which was responsible for much of the Latin activity in the movement after the World War 2. The 1980s for Jozef IJsewijn were a period of pain because of the deterioration of Latin’s position in the universities, the educational system, the society; the times begged for changing the course of action of *ALF* to something more realistic. However, the same

902 See the index in footnote 874. The first (1967) name of this organisation was *Consilium Conventibus de Latinitate constituendis* (Ussani 1995, 17) and this was precisely the main task it has fulfilled since.

903 As Greenwood (1982, 26) formulated, “Nevertheless, Latin can and does, even today, fulfil the function of an alternate supranational language for learned purposes, with a literary tradition far superior to that of Esperanto or Ido.”

1980s have been described by the Latin enthusiasts (principally represented by Guy Licoppe as the historian of this period) as the golden era of Living Latin. The Latin summer schools abounded, many local organisations for promoting Latin were being founded, new Latin journals appeared, new Latin books were being published, etc.

5.2.1 Caelestis Eichenseer

One of the central figures Living Latin in the latter half of the 20th century was Caelestis Eichenseer OSB (born *Joseph Anton Eichenseer*, 1924-2008), a Benedictine priest and arguably one of the most active defenders, promoters and teachers of Living Latin. He eventually became a member of the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* (1973), teacher of more than 100 Latin immersion summer schools (since 1973), the publisher and the main contributor of the Latin-only journal *Vox Latina* (1965-).⁹⁰⁴

In 1975 Christian Helfer, a sociologist, professor of Comparative European studies (*Lehrstuhl für vergleichende Kulturwissenschaft Europas*) based in the Saarland University in Saarbrücken, invited Eichenseer to teach Living Latin in his department and to investigate how Latin could become the language uniting Europe.⁹⁰⁵ The same year the publishing⁹⁰⁶ of the Latin-only periodical *Vox Latina* was moved to Saarbrücken and in 1976 the association of *Vox Latina* was founded. It set itself the task to publish lists of Latin vocabulary fit for modern use and materials for teaching Latin in a more vivid way. The final aim was to demonstrate the aptitude of Latin for international communication and for “peacefully propagating the agreement of nations in Europe and in the world”.⁹⁰⁷ Therefore, the usual emphasis on the efficiency of the teaching

⁹⁰⁴ According to the *Index generalis Vocis Latine* (<https://periodica.pantoia.de/vox-latina/>, consulted on 17.09.2021), 22245 pages of the journal were published until his death. Eichenseer authored 1258 articles and published 227 letters he wrote and 1109 he received.

⁹⁰⁵ Licoppe (2014a, 129). Licoppe (2014a, 132) cites Eichenseer’s report in *ALF*: “Item ibidem iussus sum in aptitudinem linguae Latinae inquirere, qua Europaei cuncti quasi lingua saltem secundaria, sed communi, intra communionem communitatemque Europensem communiter utiliterque uterentur.”

⁹⁰⁶ It was originally founded in 1965 and edited by Hans Werner (*Iohannes Werner*, 1899-1979), a doctor of chemistry and a director of a paint factory (!), together with Caelestis Eichenseer. “DR IOHANNES WERNER (*Dr. Hans Werner*), conditor editor «Vocis Latinae», natus die 8° m. Febr. a. 1899° in urbe Ungaria (*Ungvár / Ужгород*) tum temporis in Hungaria sita. Brunae (*Brno*) gymnasium frequentavit, deinde in Athenaeo technico ibidem in studia chemica incubuit. Anno 1928° in doctores est promotus. In Bohemiam septentrionalem migravit Austae (*Ústí nad Labem*) director ergasterii c. n. «*Lack- und Farbenfabrik Ant. Seiche*» factus est. Patria pulsus a. 1945° in Bavariam emigravit, ubi Otobrunnae (*Ottobrunn*) officinam instituit. Liber de lacu Brigantino (*Bodensee*) auctore Caeleste Eichenseer Constantiae a. 1964° in publicum propositus tantum ardorem Iohanni Werner incit, ut in animum induceret commentarios periodicos ex integro Latine scriptos edere, quamvis philologus non esset. Mense Iulio a. 1965i primum fasciculum «Vocis Latinae» adiuvante Caeleste Eichenseer Monaci divulgavit. Decennio post Iohannes Werner in fasciculo 42° lectoribus denunciavit se desinere fasciculos «Vocis Latinae» edere propter inopiam pecuniae, propter dissensionem inter se et Caelestem Eichenseer de facie fasciculorum, propter senectutem ingravescens.” (Platzdasch 2016)

⁹⁰⁷ Licoppe (2014a, 131) cites the initial proposal: “3° Denique probanda computatur aptitudo linguae Latinae, qua consilia cogitationesque inter homines nationum diversarum utiliter commodeque communicentur. Hunc in modum

methods of Latin was supplemented with a pan-European message and a strong focus on the modern and practical communicative aspects of the language. It seems that the usual cultural arguments for Latin were subsumed by the practical and internationalist ones. *Vox Latina* would become a true forum for Living Latin enthusiasts, with every issue publishing a number of letters from and to its readers⁹⁰⁸.

5.2.1.1 Latin summer schools

In the summer of 1973 Caelestis Eichenseer taught the first Latin immersion courses of its kind: two two-week long (16 July – 27 July; 30 July – 10 August) *seminars for cultivating and exercising the Latin language* (*Seminarium linguae Latinae colendae et exercendae*) in the pleasant Bavarian town of *Dießen am Ammersee* on the shores of Lake Ammer (*Ammersee*); organisational support was provided by *Europa-Sprachklub*, an organiser of modern language immersion workshops in Germany.⁹⁰⁹ Eichenseer went on to teach more than 100 such courses up to end of his life in 2008.

This initiative was distinct in a number of ways not seen before: the participants would convene for a long time (a week or two), live together and Latin would be used not only in the lessons, but also during all the other activities and the free time, so it was a full immersion experience. In his seminars Eichenseer would focus on teaching modern vocabulary and would speak on modern topics; the advertisements for his seminars did not use to indicate literary topics, but rather it used to be said that the seminar would be about the development of the Latin speaking skills.⁹¹⁰ Presumably Eichenseer felt that his seminars were the only place where one could learn

ostendatur linguam Latinam, qua homines eruditi ætatis veteris per multa sæcula coniungebantur, in futurum quoque habilem esse ad consensionem populorum tam in Europa quam toto in orbe pacifice dilatandam.”

908 According to the *Index generalis Vocis Latine* (<https://periodica.pantoia.de/vox-latina/epistulae.php>, consulted on 17.09.2021), about 1550 letters have been published in *Vox Latina*, almost all of them until 2008, the year of death of Eichenseer.

909 These facts were related in the fascicle of *Vox Latina* issued after the event; see especially Eichenseer (1973) and Paucker (1973). Eichenseer also presented this in the 1973 ALF congress in Malta (Eichenseer 1976). The biographers Albert and Bauer (2008, 4-5) note this event without giving the dates; Licoppe (2014a, 107-108) does, but he refers only to the second of the two seminars in Dießen, namely the 30 July – 10 August one, omitting the one that happened on 16-27 July.

910 So, for example, the future 1978 Leeds seminar by Caelestis Eichenseer (see footnote 56): “This course will be conducted by Dr P Caelestis Eichenseer of the University of Saarland, Saarbrücken. Those who have met Dr Eichenseer will know what effort and enthusiasm he puts into his courses and what success he achieves. Professor Christian Helfer of the University of Saarland will also be present. // Morning sessions will be devoted to practice in conversation and the introduction of neo-Latin words. Some of the topics discussed will be: de operibus diurnis; de hominis corpore et vestitu; de domo et habitatione; de vehiculorum commeatu hodierno; de nuntiorum communicationibus; de rebus artis technicae hodiernae; de officiis et rebus oeconomicis; de ludis gymnics; de terris populisque. // Afternoons will be devoted to grammatical or literary exercises and further Latin conversations on the above topics except for one afternoon when there will be an optional excursion to Roman York and Aldborough. <...> Although non-residents are free to make their own lunch arrangements a private room has been arranged in University House where a reasonably-priced lunch may be obtained so that members may have the

these skills, so he used to leave the cultural and literary topics to others. Since Latin would be the only language used during the time of the retreat, this modern vocabulary would be immediately relevant and applied. *Scholae Eichenseerianae* soon found imitators, now summer schools organised in a similar way have spread across Europe and USA and have become a strong ongoing tradition. However, the seminars organised by others have usually been more literary – even if they happened wholly in Latin just as Eichenseer’s did, the modern use of the language was usually in the background rather than being proclaimed in the seminar title as the topic.



Caelestis Eichenseer provided a Latin-only environment in his immersive Living Latin seminars – so his *scholae aestivae* could be imagined as temporally bounded *civitates Latinae*. This innovation provided opportunities for many enthusiast Latinists, both experienced and beginners, who otherwise would never have experienced Latin immersion, to gain fluency in Latin. However, Eichenseer himself was not always happy with the result. In 1998, 25 years after the beginning of his seminars, he published an interesting article *Could Latin cloisters be established? (Latinitatis coenobia possintne condi?)*. After many years of experience, he understood a fundamental limitation in this way of teaching: very episodic exposure to spoken Latin – for most of the participants one week-long seminar in a year – is simply not enough for many of them to consolidate their language skills. They come to the same week-long seminar year after year, but their Latin level barely gets better and Eichenseer has to correct the same basic mistakes in grammar that these students had already corrected years ago.⁹¹¹ What could be done? Here Eichenseer remembers Olmo’s 1817 proposal for founding a Latin state called *Roma Tullia* and praises it as a “very well devised plan” that is “founded by arguments quite well”.⁹¹² Eichenseer understands Olmo’s *Roma Tullia* as a certain hub to which people desiring to exercise and renew their Latin skills could come whenever they want and stay for a while. Himself a Benedictine monk,

opportunity to join in Latin conversation with Dr Eichenseer and each other.”. From an interview (10.5.2021) with Guy Licoppe: “Et consulto praesertim loquebatur de rebus modernis ut homines comperirent fieri posse de omnibus rebus disserere Latine.”

911 Eichenseer (1998, 611): “Sed multi, qui quotannis seminaria nostra participant, post absentiam annuam iterum denuoque de iisdem sermonis Latini necessitatibus monendi sunt, velut de «accusativo cum infinitivo», «de consecutione temporum», de aliis proprietatibus Latinis necessario observandis. Hic non loquor de pronuntiationis subtilitatibus. // <...> // At seminarium unius hebdomadis vix sufficit ad scientiam quandam valde communem resuscitandam et revivificandam. Tamen hoc certe iam est plus quam nihil, et non pauci percipiunt possibilitatem multimodis demonstratam sermonis Latini etiamnunc humaniter adhibendi. // At multo plus sermo vere Latinus est exercendus, plerisque in vitae condicionibus. Exercitatio etiam atque etiam iterata et reiterata necessaria est. Hunc in modum acquiruntur vera facultas facilitasque Latine loquendi, qualis loquela fiat stque sine balba tardatione. Continuata autem exercitatione magis magisque experimur linguam Latinam non esse difficiliorem quam ceteras linguas, e contrario eam esse quodammodo faciliorem.”

912 Eichenseer (1998, 611): “Circiter saeculum undevicesimum iniens Míchaël Olmon Hispanus consilium excogitatissimum plurimis argumentis satis confirmatum condendae cuiusdam civitatis Latinae, id est prorsus Latinae, proposuit, de quo proposito Iosephus Xyländer [*Holzer*] anno 1941^o fuse refert.”.

he observes that today monasteries serve a similar function for curious laity wanting to acquaint themselves with Christianity – anyone, even Muslims, can come for some weeks and experience the religion first hand. But what about Latin, it is the language of the Catholic Church after all? Maybe the same institutions could help with it too? But it turns out that even the monasteries where the liturgy is celebrated in Latin do not cultivate the language outside the liturgical use.

So Eichenseer proposes a curious mix of Catholicism and Latin to make the Church beneficial for Latin. Two *coenobia* are to be founded – one for men, another for women. Their monastic vows would include a special clause for the “use and cultivation of Latin (both Christian and profane)”.⁹¹³ In addition to the liturgy celebrated in Latin (NB – in classical pronunciation, not the Italianate Ecclesiastical one!) and the practice of Gregorian chant, the monks or nuns would always speak Latin between themselves and would strive to improve in this. They would diligently read in Latin both the Patristic and the Classical authors in order to improve both their language and theology. They would annotate useful words and collect them to dictionaries. After all these services to their own souls and minds, they would also be helpful to the society. They would discuss scholarly topics between themselves over the Internet (Eichenseer is writing in 1998!) and would hospitably answer queries over Internet (presumably e-mail), fax or phone.⁹¹⁴ Finally, men (women) would always be welcome to come and stay as guests in the male (female) *coenobium* in order to improve their Latin. Eichenseer is convinced that such *coenobia*, in addition to their religious significance, would provide great joy, benefit and concord for the mankind. This beatific vision has obviously been dictated by Eichenseer’s background as a priest, a monk, a lexicographer of neologisms and an enthusiast of Latin speaking. It is his own personal version of Olmo’s project that is motivated by educational concerns – the absence of an accessible environment with permanently residing expert speakers, the limited time of exposure to the language necessitating additional practice – and by his personal vision of Latin, where lexicography occupied a central place.



Eichenseer’s seminars would gather a diverse cast of people, many of them non-Latinists, but rather people who had Latin in school and wanted to resurrect their knowledge. Many

913 Eichenseer (1998, 613): “Votis autem monasterialibus regularibus nuncupandis votum speciale addatur Latinitatis (christianae et profanae) utendae et colendae et excolendae.”

914 Eichenseer (1998, 613-614): “Inter se autem mōnāchi monachaeque in quaestionibus scientificis ratione «interretiali» communicationes quoad studia Latinitatis quasdam explicationes faciant, qui similiter in modum hospitalitatis quaestionibus extraneorum vel extraneorum humaniter benevolenterque respondeant sive interretialiter sive telecopialiter sive tēlēphōnice.”

testimonies of participants contain remarks that Eichenseer's seminars made them reconsider the state of Latin language – that it is not a dead language, it is a living one.⁹¹⁵

These seminars also performed a very important social function for the movement and a social aspect to the language.⁹¹⁶ This immersive, communication-based environment served a community-building function for Latin speakers. Today people identifying as Latin speakers and as a part of the Living Latin community have usually participated in a *schola aestivalis* of some kind and their acquaintances with other Latin speakers have been established through this medium. Eichenseer would often remind that Latin is a neutral language suited for international communication where no-one has a native advantage, everyone had to learn it equally.⁹¹⁷ Guy Licoppe likes to note that it is the experiences of speaking Latin that made him overcome his hate for the Germans because of the devastation of Belgium in both of the World Wars. Eichenseer was his first friend from Germany.⁹¹⁸ The seminars where the participants had different native languages could make Latin the real language of that community.⁹¹⁹ Similar considerations led the *civitates*

915 So, for example, Husung (1977, 251): “Talibus studiis compérimus atque cottidie animadvertēbamus linguam Latinam non esse mortuam, quae falso adhuc dicitur, sed vivam pulchreque sonantem, tam utilem quam alias linguas recentiores.”

916 The feelings described are quite similar to what Esperantists report about their conversion to the cause, in addition to Latin-specific features arising from its cultural value – the diachronic universality and the intimate connection with Latin writers from the preceding centuries

917 From an interview (18.5.2021) with Sigrīdes Albert: “Sigrīdes: ⟨...⟩ puto re verā esse linguam internationalem, et insuper, ut ita dicam, supranationalem. Haec persuasio etiam fuit patri Caelesti Eichenseer, qui etiam semper dixit „haec lingua non cohaeret ut lingua materna cum aliquo populo. Eā de causā omnes habent eundem aditum ad illam linguam. Et nemo habet emolumentum ante alios. Exempli gratiā, si Italus et Germanus et Finnis et Russus conveniunt, quā linguā loquantur? Anglice? Cur?“ // Carolus: Sane, Latine! Tantum Latine! ⟨risus⟩ // Sigrīdes: ⟨risus⟩ Ita, Latine! Et tales experientias iucundissimas saepissime habui in conventibus, in seminariis et sic porro, ubi homines variarum nationum inter se conveniunt et omnes possunt hilariter inter se loqui. Certe ex experiētiis suis et etiam Latine de natione suā, de re suā maternā et paternā loqui possunt, et aliquid novi experiri possumus.”

918 Licoppe (2019): “Educatum sum in familia cui erat, ut fere omnibus concivibus, maximum odium et terror Germanorum. Iam primo bello mundano eorum milites ut Vandali se gesserant in Belgica, ⟨...⟩ Initio alterius belli mundani Germanorum terror in Belgica consulto ita auctus est ⟨...⟩ Hoc odium, quod mihi iuniori erat, hodiernis iuvenibus feliciter iam non est, sed ne obliti simus, hoc solum fieri potuisse beneficio confoederationis Europaeae. // Paulo post quam fortuito comperi locutores Latinos adhuc exstare, conveni Patrem Caelestem Eichenseer, Germanum, qui idem ac ego de necessitate Europae cōniendae sentiebat et putabat linguam Latinam ad usum hodiernum aptatam aliquid magnae utilitatis huic proposito conferre posse. Haec mihi quoque semper fuit ratio linguae Latinae studii. Eichenseer me Latinitatem vivam docuit; multum deinde cooperati sumus et primus amicus meus Germanus fuit; ab eo tempore Germaniam invenire et lustrare coepi et cum multis amicitiam contraxi.”

919 From an interview (10.5.2021) with Guy Licoppe: “Imprimis seminaria tantum fiebant in Germaniā. Ergo omnes inter se Theodisce loquebantur et fuit exercitatio iucunda, sed sine proposito speciali. Sed postquam cum Caelesti cooperari incepi, proposui ut seminarium instituat in Belgicā, ad litus Belgicum, quo confluerent homines non solum ex Germaniā, sed ex multis regionibus. Et hoc primum factum est anno 1983, et aderant Francogalli, Americani, Itali, nondum Hispani, hoc postea. Caelestis *statim* comperit hoc auditorium multo magis convenire suo proposito. Valde gaudebat, nam illi homines inter se extra sessiones debebant Latine loqui. Et cum hoc faciebant, non solum recordabantur veterem historiam linguae Latinae in Europā, sed videbant fieri posse ut inter Europaeos sermo communis et neutralis, ut ita dicam, adhiberi possit. Ergo haec seminaria fuerunt maximae utilitatis.” The 1983 Belgium seminar is described in Latin Vicipædia's archives and bibliography provided (<https://la.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Vestenda&oldid=2562977>, consulted 7.10.2023).

Latinae Utopists to also enforce a national mixing in order to make Latin the natural language of these imagined Utopic communities.

Numerous *circuli* started to be founded in 80's in the wake of the *scholae aestivae* phenomenon; for example, in Brussels *Circulus Latinus Bruxellensis* was founded immediately after a *seminarium Latinum* taught there by Caelestis Eichenseer in 1983. In 1985 *Circulus Lupianus* (now *L.V.P.A.* = *Linguae Latinae Provehendae Associatio*) was founded in Germany by the participants of Eichenseer's seminars. In 1986 the architect Giancarlo Rossi (*Joannes Carolus Rossi*, 1944-), engineer Claudio Piga (*Claudius Piga*) and musicologist Stefano Torelli founded the *Sodalitas Latina Mediolanensis* in Milan.⁹²⁰

5.2.1.2 Lexicographic activities

One of the most defining features of Eichenseer was his preoccupation with Latin lexicography and neologisms. He was also a collaborator of *Thesaurus Linguae Latinae* for many years (1952-1975) while he was living in Munich. Eichenseer has published numerous books in which he proposed his neologisms,⁹²¹ innumerable articles about neologisms in *Vox Latina*, and even if a given text of Eichenseer's would be about something else, he would supplement it with *copious* lexicographical footnotes. He was not the only lexicographer in Saarbrücken – Christian Helfer published dictionaries of modern terms,⁹²² later Sigrid Albert would also publish a number of works.⁹²³ Because of this collective endeavour, one can name this the *Saarbrücken school (or movement) of Living Latin*.⁹²⁴

Summer school participants were introduced to the active use of Latin by Eichenseer, so he had quite an influence on the way they spoke. With an intensive, long-running and geographically wide campaign of summer schools, with the Latin journal *Vox Latina* and dictionaries published,

920 Rossi (2018): “Durante l'università ed i primi anni di professione allentai la mia frequentazione con il latino, limitandomi a riletture dei classici e a qualche cartolina, ma un decennio dopo la laurea decisi ch'era tempo di riprendere i rapporti. In breve: fui cooptato nella redazione della rivista vaticana *Latinitas* dall'abate Carlo Egger, cui avevo scritto una lettera retoricissima, partecipai ai Seminaria *Latinitatis Vivae* organizzate a Saarbrücken da p. Caelestis Eichenseer, e alle *Feriae Latinae* animate da p. Suitbertus Siedl, ed incominciai un fitto scambio epistolare con amici tedeschi, francesi, austriaci. Incitato dalle esperienze d'oltralpe, nel 1986 fondai, assieme all'ingegner Claudio Piga ed al professor Stefano Torelli, la *Sodalitas Latina Mediolanensis*, che tuttora si riunisce due volte al mese, per leggere e commentare in latino passi di autori classici, rinascimentali, moderni. Ho seguito infine gli esordi, la fioritura e gli sviluppi dell'Accademia *Vivarium Novum*, creatura di Luigi Miraglia, emula delle accademie rinascimentali, e sono socio fondatore dell'associazione *Europa Latina*.”

921 For example, Eichenseer (1981); Eichenseer (1982); Eichenseer (1999)

922 Helfer (1982); Helfer (1994)

923 For example, Albert (1998); Albert (1999)

924 Term of Alexey Slednikov, who describes the Saarbrücken school (Саарбрюккенская школа) centred around Caelestis Eichenseer and Christian Helfer based in the Saarland university and publishing the *Vox Latina* journal, the Claretian school around the journals *Candidatus Latinus* and *Palaestra Latina*, and the Vatican school.

Eichenseer and his Saarbrücken colleagues were efficient in disseminating their brand of modern Latin vocabulary.

Eichenseer's Latinity could be described as aiming for the "simple practical Latin" wished for by Jean Capelle. He liked the syntax of his sentences to be quite simple and liberally used various non-classical vocabulary, including medieval words or words suspiciously close to modern languages. For example, such words as *costuma* (costume) or *iacca* (jacket) are present in his word lists.⁹²⁵ While such methods indeed make it easier to learn to communicate in Latin, more classical-minded proponents of the active use of Latin would avoid them.

5.2.2 Guy Licoppe and Latin as the language of Europe

Guy Licoppe (1931-) is a Belgian radiologist, the publisher of Latin journal *Melissa* (1984-), prolific author in Latin and a historian of Living Latin movement. He is also a member of the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*.

He represents the pan-European dimension of Living Latin: his initial enthusiasm for Latin was related to the enthusiasm he felt for the projects of European integration and he has always argued for the rights of Latin to be recognised as an official language for European Union.⁹²⁶ Licoppe notes that he shared this desire with many other Living Latin proponents of the time who have also experienced the World War Two and the after-war years: Clément Desessard,⁹²⁷ *Caelestis*

⁹²⁵ Slednikov (2019a, 148)

⁹²⁶ See, for example, the evolution of the subtitle of *Melissa*: in issues 2-4 (Jun. – Oct. 1984) it bore a designation FOLIA LATINA SECUNDO QUOQUE MENSE EDITA, but in the issue 5 (Jan. 1985) it became EUROPAEA FOLIA SECUNDO QUOQUE MENSE EDITA, which continued with minor change (from issue 11 May 1986 it was EUROPAEA FOLIA SEXIES IN ANNO LATINE EDITA) until the redesign in the issue 100 (Feb. 2001), when it received a designation FOLIA PERENNI LATINITATI DICATA (cf. footnote 75) as part of an alignment with the Erasmus House in Brussels (*Domus Erasmiana / Maison d'Érasme*) and then with the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae*. So in the 21st century the periodical aligns with the Neo-Latin tradition, but in the 20th it showcased a strong pan-European element. Maybe this evolution can be extended to the whole of Living Latin tradition.

⁹²⁷ Licoppe and Desessard (1987, 4) "Itaque, annis 1950^o et sequentibus, Europae coadunationem, quae a viris Roberto SCHUMAN, Conrado ADENAUER, Alcide DE GASPERI, Paulo Henrico CAROLO SPAAK nonnullisque aliis, jam adumbrata est, toto corde optavi. Eodem tempore, tum per artis radioelectricae pathologiam seu parasitologiam, cujus aerumnas technicas in officiis meis ignorare non potui, cum per artem informaticam, quae tunc erat in cunis, communicationis momentum, et inde linguae communis necessitatem – in verbi sensu latissimo – novo modo perspicere incepi."; Desessard (1991b, 17): "Hoc enim tempore, omnes homines bonae voluntatis, qui praeiudiciis nationalisticis aliisve obcaecati non sunt, Europae unitatem desiderant. Cui unitati quid utilius esse potest quam patrimonium illud, quod nobis Europaeis omnibus commune est: historia scilicet Romana, religio Christiana, et una cum eis lingua Latina, quae nobis commune hoc patrimonium vel hereditatem transmisit?"

Eichenseer,⁹²⁸ Christian Helfer.⁹²⁹ This is confirmed by their writings. Latin was seen as a hope for Europe, a way to overcome inter-national differences.⁹³⁰ The pan-European enthusiasm was expressed by such projects as the translation of European laws into Latin,⁹³¹ proposals to broadcast Europe-wide television programmes in Latin.⁹³² For Licoppe, Living Latin was a personal experience of overcoming the antagonism between Belgians and Germans.⁹³³ So Latin can be a peace-bringing language.

In 1983 Licoppe invited Caelestis Eichenseer to teach a week-long (13 – 20 August) Latin summer school in Belgium. While Eichenseer was teaching only in Germany and in a German-speaking audience Latin did not perform the role of a primary communication language, but in Belgium it became an actual international language.⁹³⁴ In the same year Licoppe founded the *Circulus Latinus Bruxellensis* (apparently the oldest still-living society of this kind), in 1984 the

928 From an interview (10.5.2021) with Guy Licoppe: “Ergo cum comperi exstare adhuc homines Latine loquentes, putavi hoc fore fortasse bonum vinculum Europaeorum in futurā unione. Et hoc non solum ego cogitavi. Cum primum conveni Caelestem Eichenseer, idem sentiebat et sic statim inter nos fuit optima coniunctio. ⟨...⟩ Sed ergo homines qui tunc erant actores principales motūs, habebant eandem mentem ac ego et Caelestis, putabant hoc utile fore ad Europaeos coniungendos. ⟨...⟩ Post bellum motus Europaeus fuit vividus et actores illius motūs bene audiebantur, illos sequebantur et erat enthusiasmus communis.”

929 E.g., Helfer (1976) hopes that Latin could be used in the European Union, acknowledging that the chances of getting a political endorsement are slim. However, if the Latin proponents could demonstrate that even the legal jargon of its laws can be translated into Latin, that would be a good argument; so the Latin community should work on example translations of modern texts.

930 To this list also Quinto Tosatti, the founder of *ALF*, can be added. Tosatti (1957, 39) writes about the necessity to unite Europe and that Latin forms the definition of the lost unity of Europe: “Omnium gentium votis undique in dies vehementius flagitatur ut Europa tandem in quandam unitatem coalescat: Europa tamen, sibi dissidens, videtur in eadem poëtae illius misera condicione versari: *nec tecum nec sine te vivere possum*, dum sæpius persecutæ unitatis iam *comprehensa manus effugit imago*. // Si quis tamen altius voluerit vestigare, invenerit Europam laborare non tam in nova omnino unitate adipiscenda quam in amissa quodammodo unitate requirenda. Europa est unicumque homines latine locuti sunt, vel saltem studium latinæ linguæ et humanitatis studium pervenit: etiam nunc resonat sapientis Apollinis oraculum olim Æneadis errantibus redditum: *antiquam exquirite matrem*.” (see also footnote 843).

931 Bauer and Niederländer (1985) is a 208 book, containing some fundamental texts of European law in a multilingual edition with a Latin translation added. The publisher’s announcement: “Itaque hoc libello continentur Statuta Consilii Europae et Conventio Europaea ad Iura Hominis et Libertates Fundamentales defendendas inita una cum introductione historica et documentis recentioribus. Exhibetur textus quadrilinguis – Anglicus, Francogallicus, Theodiscus, et primum omnium, Latinus.” (<http://www.voxlatina.uni-saarland.de/le.htm>, consulted 1.4.2024).

932 The proponent of the latter idea was Félix Sánchez Vallejo SJ (1918-2004), a Spanish Jesuit and a professor in the Pontifical Gregorian University in Rome. He attended the Living Latin conferences ever since the 1956 Avignon congress and had a lot of ideas how to promote Latin as an eventually universal language – he was particularly enthusiastic about the possibilities of the new media. Hence, in the 1966 Rome congress proposed the idea of using radio to teach Latin with engaging programmes (Pacitti and Ussani 1968, 360-362), after some time he expounded the virtues of using *Eurovision* for promoting the use of Latin (*lector candide*, beware! Vallejo meant not the song contest, but instead the *Eurovision* network, the pan-European television telecommunications network founded in 1954 and used for international broadcasts; it is a portmanteau from *Europe* and *television*) in a paper written in Latin (Vallejo 1979), and, several years later, as one of the proposals in a 198-page self-published book in Italian *Eurolatinum: Il Latino lingua d'Europa* (Vallejo and Gligora 1983). It was defence of Latin and a Latin vision for Europe and for the European integration. It is another testimony of an European enthusiasm permeating the Living Latin movement of the time. Vallejo, being consistent with his enthusiasm for exploiting new media for the greater good of Latin, in the dawn of the Internet era, in March 1997, already created a big homepage with an online Latin course of 365 lessons – one for every day of the year (<https://web.archive.org/web/19980126193858/http://www.unigre.urbe.it/vallejo/breviter.html>).

933 See footnote 918.

934 See footnote 919.

association *Melissa*, *sodalitas perenni Latinitati dicata* and the Latin journal of the same name. This pattern of students forming Latin circles of their own after participating in a summer school has been quite frequent.

As a historian of Living Latin movement, he investigates it from the viewpoint of the use of the language – the above section about both branches of the official Living Latin movement is heavily indebted to his book.⁹³⁵ He sees the movement as having begun with very good goals of restoring Latin language to its rightful place as the international language of Europe, while the abandonment of this ideal is seen as very disappointing. Another recurring theme in his historiography is the contrast between the active enthusiast amateurs promoting Living Latin and the academic establishment with a passive stance; to this one can add the majority of politicians, who are also passive or even hostile to the project.

5.3 The language of culture: the Italian movement for Latin

As noted above, the Italian movement for Latin is highly distinct and has to be classified as a distinct tradition due to its close relationship with the Roman and Humanist heritage. For example, while for many in Europe the idea of the teaching of Latin as a living language is immediately associated with the modern language teaching methods, for Italians it is rather the Humanist connection that immediately comes into mind – after all, this is nothing new, just a return to the proper tradition.

The papal Latinists Antonio Bacci and Amleto Tondini started⁹³⁶ the *Latinitas* journal in 1953 as a continuation of *Alma Roma* which had disappeared in 1942 together with its founder Giuseppe Fornari. As a contrast to the earlier journal, which was nominally independent, the new journal was now a part of the Roman Curia where its editors worked in the Latin section.

The Latin cultivation programme that the *Latinitas* journal constituted was substantially supported by the official papal documents. In February 1962, just before the Second Vatican Council was due to begin in September, Pope John XXIII issued with great solemnity the apostolic constitution *The Wisdom of the Ancients* (*Veterum Sapientia*), by which he asserted the value of Latin and Greek and, among many other things, confirmed that the theological disciplines in the seminaries and pontifical universities should be taught in Latin and from Latin textbooks.⁹³⁷ As a means to implement this apostolic constitution,⁹³⁸ in February 1964 the new Pope Paul VI

935 Licoppe (2014a)

936 See the end of section 4.3.3, p. 159.

937 The complex fortunes of these intentions are outside the scope of this thesis.

938 *Veterum Sapientia* in its imperative section had provided that in Rome an *Academicum Latinitatis Institutum* would be founded. This proposed institute would gather experts from around the world and take care of developing the

promulgated a *motu proprio* decree *Studia Latinitatis*, by which he created the *Pontifical Institute for Higher Latin Studies* (*Pontificium Institutum Altioris Latinitatis*) as part of the Salesian Pontifical University in Rome. At this point, the Second Vatican Council was already introducing the vernacular language into the Roman Catholic religious services, so the future of Latin in the Church already seemed in doubt to some observers; however, the steps that the Pope was simultaneously making in strengthening its use (*Studia Latinitatis* seemed to be a part of a greater effort of strengthening Latin in the Church) were taken as a very positive sign by the supporters of Latin, who cited them with great approval and used them when defending the use of the language.⁹³⁹

In 1976 Pope Paul VI by means of a papal chirograph *Romani sermonis* created the *Latinitas* foundation (*Opus fundatum "Latinitas"*) as a section in the Roman Curia which would eventually not only publish the journal, but also organise *Feriae Latinae* (from c. 1980; a Latin *schola aestiva* by the Carmelite Suidbert H. Siedl), *Certamen Vaticanum* (a competition of Latin prose and poetry, 1953-2010), organise Latin conferences (so for example in 1980 there was a conference about neologisms *Verba Nova*),⁹⁴⁰ publish Latin dictionaries (the famous *Lexicon Recentis Latinitatis*).⁹⁴¹ The lexical question has been important for the Vatican Latinists, who have published many dictionaries⁹⁴² and other works demonstrating the suitability of Latin to our times.⁹⁴³ Many of the collaborators worked with papal documents, so the care for a solemn style in conjunction with the elegance of Latin was expressed by quite many paraphrases. In the eyes of the

Latin language and its vocabulary as needed. It would also teach courses on Latinity of all ages, especially the Christian one. Section 11.6: "Quoniam lingua Latina est lingua Ecclesiae viva, ad cotidie succrescentes sermonis necessitates comparanda, atque adeo novis iisque aptis et congruis ditanda vocabulis, ratione quidem aequabili, universali et cum veteris linguae Latinae ingenio consentanea – quam scilicet rationem et Sancti Patres et optimi scriptores, quos scholasticos vocant, secuti sunt – mandamus propterea S. Consilio Seminariis Studiorumque Universitatibus praeposito, ut Academicum Latinitatis Institutum condendum curet. Huic Instituto, in quo corpus Doctorum conflatur oportet, linguis Latina et Graeca peritorum, ex variisque terrarum orbis partibus arcessitorum, illud praecipue erit propositum, ut – haud secus atque singularum civitatum Academiae, suae cuiusque nationis linguae provehendae constitutae – simul prospiciat congruenti linguae Latinae progressioni, lexico Latino, si opus sit, additis verbis cum eius indole et colore proprio convenientibus; simul scholas habeat de universa cuiusvis aetatis Latinitate, cum primis de christiana."

939 Kobler (1965, 1): "One of the most important documents bolstering Latin studies on a world-wide basis was the Apostolic Constitution, *Veterum Sapientia*, promulgated by Pope John XXIII on February 22, 1962. [...] In recent months, however, there has been some trepidation about the Holy Father's intended Latin reforms. Since the Second Vatican Council has introduced the vernacular into Roman Catholic religious services, some have feared that the papal Latin directives would be quietly forgotten (cf. the *Catholic Educator* 35, November, 1964, p. 279). These persons have in turn forgotten two important points: the official work of the present Council continues to be done entirely in Latin, and the Holy See is gradually carrying out the Latin reforms called for by Pope John." After the promulgation of *Veterum Sapientia*, some authors were encouraged to publish new works or new editions of existing ones (Schwieder (1963, 8) notes that he is publishing the second edition of his book of Latin dialogues encouraged by *Veterum Sapientia*), while the Catholic Living Latin activists cited the apostolic constitution as a proof that the Catholic programme corresponds to the Living Latin one (Mir ([1969], 18) notes with joy that *Veterum Sapientia* calls Latin the *lingua Ecclesiae viva* and approves of the renewal of the Latin vocabulary).

940 de verbis novis Latinis acta. XXIX-XXX m. Novembris a. MCMLXXX (1982)

941 Egger (1992) and Egger (1997). Egger (2003), the second edition, is a one-volume reprint of the first one.

942 Bacci (1945); Tondini and Mariucci (1964); Pacitti and Gentile Geraci (1966); Mariucci (1986); Mariucci (1987); Mariucci (1989); Mariucci (1990); Mariucci (1991).

943 For example, Pacitti (1980); Egger (1986).

wider public, the fact that in the Vatican Latin continued to be an official language gave an air of exceptional authority to their dictionaries (especially *Lexicon Recentis Latinitatis*).

There is another connection between the humanistic and broader culture and Living Latin that spans from the socialist Czechoslovakia to Italy and ends in Germany, where the Italian part was really prominent.⁹⁴⁴ The Moravian neoclassical composer Jan Novák (1921-1984) was unhappy with the growing restrictions under the imposed communist government after the Second World War; around 1955, he became interested in Latin and found it to be something that could give a greater spiritual liberty contrary to the repressive climate. He started writing verses in Latin⁹⁴⁵ and speaking Latin and already in a 1966 conference of classical philologists after his concert he spoke to them in Latin; he set multiple works of Latin poetry in music and in 1967 he founded a Latin *circulus* called *SAL (Societas Amicorum Latinitatis)* in Brno which met once a month. However, this did not last long. The Prague Spring events changed everything. In the night of 20-21 August 1968, the Soviet army invaded Czechoslovakia. At the time Novák happened to be in Italy and decided not to come back. After gathering his family, he settled down in Rovereto. Here, he continued his Latin activities, engaging the local Academy (*Accademia Roveretana degli Agiati*), where he found other Neo-Latin poets and enthusiasts of the language, and created in 1970 a local Latin *circulus* called the *Amici Latinitatis Roboretani* and in 1971 a Latin choir *Voces Latinae*. At the same time, Antonino Immè (1901-1988) organised a Latin *circulus* in Rome with regular meetings and even dedicated premises and a Latin library and started a Latin journal *Aventinus* in 1972. In 1972 in Rovereto a three day Latin event *Feriae Latinae* was organised with music, singing, lectures, mass, theatrical performances, excursions – everything in Latin.⁹⁴⁶ Thus Italy was having its own Living Latin revival with a strong cultural emphasis. In this event of *Feriae Latinae* Caelestis Eichenseer was also present and this could be one of the inspirations for the Latin summer schools he taught the next year, in 1973. This was followed in 1973 by *Biduum Latinum* in Rome, which gathered almost 300 participants. Jan Novák moved to Germany in 1977 and collaborated with Wilfried Stroh who was inspired to start something similar in Germany – in 1983 in *Ellwangen, Württemberg* they organised an event called *Ludi Latini* with theatrical performances and music and poetry. After Novák's death in 1984, Wilfried Stroh continued to organise these events, thus providing a parallel strand of the Living Latin tradition in Germany: Eichenseer's seminars were focused on language pedagogy and immersion, while Stroh's seminars were highly

944 This paragraph is based on the excellent study by Sacré (2022b), who surveys Novák's biography, reconstructs the events, untangles the complex network of personal relationships and the long-term influences and effects.

945 In 1970 he was received a *magna laus* in the prestigious *Certamen Hoeufftianum*.

946 There were about fifty participants; the Latin excursions were even published as a Latin guidebook to the town.

cultural events that tried to treat Latin not only as a living language, but also as a living medium for art and culture.

Today another important organisation is the Academy of *Vivarium Novum*. Its founder and president Luigi Miraglia (1965-) learned⁹⁴⁷ his approach to Latin from the naturalist Giorgio Punzo (1911-2005),⁹⁴⁸ who had been educated by the Jesuit order and for a time belonged to it; therefore, Punzo knew Latin as a spoken language – a relic of the Jesuit education system going back to Renaissance Humanism. Miraglia founded this organisation in the early 1990s and directed it since. From 1991 it organised a series of international congresses in and for Latin.⁹⁴⁹ From the very beginning of this era he has been fighting for the survival of Latin in Italian education, especially by his 1998 congress *Docere* (against the 1997-1998 reform initiatives of Roberto Maraglino which would have heavily restricted Latin). He has also been influential in popularising Hans Ørberg's textbook *Lingua Latina per se Illustrata* in Italy, becoming one of the instigators of its resurgence in the 1990s and an influential theorist of its teaching methodology.

His *Academia* is an immersive Latin-only school living together as a community where vernacular languages are not allowed, thus fulfilling the old dreams of *civitates Latinae*. In cultivating Latin he promotes the Humanist “middle way” tempering the strict Classicism of Italian professors – all eras of the Latin tradition are to be appreciated, not just the Classical one. Latin has a great educational value, connecting the student to the great writers, thinkers, philosophers of the past. This is a forceful expression of the idea of *Res publica litterarum* and of the Humanistic belief

947 An interview of Miraglia by Pistelli (2016): “Da ragazzo, appassionato di natura e militante WWF, andavo spesso sull'isola di Vivara, nel Golfo di Napoli, un luogo incontaminato. Questi momenti di vita separata dal mondo, mi facevano vedere le realtà e i mali del mondo da un altro punto di vista. <...> Su quell'isolotto, c'era un personaggio straordinario, Giorgio Punzo, un professore di Anatomia comparata in pensione, un ornitologo, fondatore della Lega per la protezione degli uccelli (oggi Lipu), un vero naturalista. Un personaggio di vastissima cultura, formatosi dai Gesuiti, il quale mi insegnò a studiare il latino in un modo diverso. <...> Ossia ampliando il vocabolario, utilizzando le strutture linguistiche, acquisendo la fraseologia, così come facevano gli antichi, i medievali, i rinascimentali. E non a partire dalla grammatica, come facevo al liceo dove per altro andavo, fino ad allora, piuttosto male. <...> Punzo mi fece leggere, sì, i *magna itinera* di Cesare, il Passero di Lesbia di Catullo, ma mi fece capire che, col latino, si poteva andare alla scoperta dell'ossatura stessa della cultura occidentale. Si poteva studiare la fisica, la medicina, le scienze, la filosofia, l'arte. Da Leibniz a Spinoza fino Pascoli, il latino abbracciava tutto. Altro che lingua morta, una lingua divenuta immortale perché non soggetta alla trasformazione incessante, un favoloso strumento di comunicazione, con cui attraversare lo spazio e il tempo. <...> Imparai più in pochi mesi a Vivara, che in quattro anni al liceo.”. This episode is also in Mead (2001, 109); Miraglia (2014); Codacci-Pisanelli (2020b); Codacci-Pisanelli (2020a): “L'idea di quest'isola di latinisti in erba è nata su un'isola vera: si chiama Vivara, uno scampolo disabitato nel golfo di Napoli. Qui negli anni Settanta era approdato l'ecologista Giorgio Punzo, che organizzava soggiorni per mettere i ragazzi a contatto con la natura. «Io ero al ginnasio, studiavo latino e greco svogliatamente e con difficoltà», ricorda Miraglia. «Un giorno avevo con me sull'isola una versione di Tacito che proprio non riuscivo a fare. Punzo mi chiese il libro, lesse davanti a me il brano e lo tradusse senza fare la costruzione, senza usare un vocabolario. Mi spiegò che per lui il latino era una lingua parlata: l'aveva studiato così nel seminario gesuita che aveva frequentato prima della guerra. Gli ho chiesto di insegnare anche a me, e presto mi sono convinto che il metodo di insegnamento tradizionale è sbagliato, perché ci presenta la lingua come un cadavere fatto a pezzi».”.

948 See, e.g., his biography by Miraglia ([2005]).

949 1991 *Latino sì, ma non così* (Procida/Vivara), 1998 *Docere* (Naples/Montella), 2007 *Humanitas* (Naples), 2008 *Litterarum vis* (Szeged/Budapest), 2010 *Monumenta viaeque* (Rome), 2011 *Alea fati* (Rome).

in the great formational value of letters. As such, the ways often seen in the Living Latin movement, where many people have enjoyed proposing their Latin neologisms for modern subjects is explicitly rejected as something not purposeful. One should be able to speak about modern subjects in Latin (this certainly happens in *Vivarium Novum*), but it should not be an end in itself.⁹⁵⁰ The end is the study and internalisation of the tradition of the perennial Latin, the *perennis Latinitas*. As such, the notion of a separate tradition of *Living Latin* is rejected – Miraglia certainly believes in the vitality of Latin,⁹⁵¹ but for him the label *Living* is misleading.⁹⁵² The unbroken continuity of the Latin tradition is emphasised, so events like the publishing of the first Latin journals in the end of the 19th century or the organised Living Latin movement that arose after the Second World War are overshadowed by it and are not considered as foundational events, but only as simple episodes in the long history of the Latin tradition.

950 The earliest journalistic portrait of Miraglia (Mead 2001, 112) contains a telling exchange: “Then we went outside and walked past the empty swimming pools to the parking lot, which was marked with a sign. “In a few years, that will say ‘Area Stativa,’” Claudio Piga said cheerfully. Miraglia looked pained; although Piga was right, it seemed impolitic to speak of spoken Latin.”. Latin is seen as primarily a carrier of culture rather than just an instrument of communication; therefore, Miraglia takes pains to emphasise that the speaking of Latin is done for an educational purpose rather than just for an end in itself. Miraglia (2013) explicitly rejected and ridiculed the notion that speaking Latin about modern topics is the purpose of speaking it; the incisive words he used aroused a broad discussion among Latin enthusiasts (for example, in the pages of *Melissa*: Licoppe (2013); Laes (2014); Licoppe (2014b); Carciotto (2014); Luttinen (2014); Feye (2014); Legranus (2014)) many of who challenged the claim that the cultural aims and the general-purpose communication in Latin form a contradiction (Laes (2014) notes that the traditions of technical neologism formation and of cultural cultivation have always coexisted in Latin). Later Miraglia (2014) clarifies his position that the criticism was directed only to those who use Latin completely separated from its cultural roots rather than to everyone who discusses modern topics in Latin.

951 See Miraglia (2014), 21:05: “Ha! Collinearunt in me sagittas multi dicentes: “Aloisius nunc dicit linguam Latinam esse mortuam!” Cur dico esse mortuam? Quia tantummodo moriendo potuit fieri immortalis. Non contendo eam esse mortuam, ut despiciam usum linguae Latinae, sed potius ut corroborem, ut confirmem, ut dicam usum linguae Latinae esse necessarium, neque umquam finem habiturum. Et videatis: “eam autem mortem, si mors omnino dicenda sit, quasi aeternae vitae ac pulchritudinis fuisse causam”. (V. Stroh) // Pulcherrima sententia, quam stipulor et pedibus manibusque in eam sententiam ire volo.”. See also footnote 63 for comparable expressions of this idea of the beautiful immortality of a dead language.

952 His views can be seen in the orations Miraglia (2013); Miraglia (2014). Miraglia (2015) is an eloquent defence of the continuity, immortality and value of Latin (in Latin). It defines how his approach is different from the philological tradition of the 19th century which concentrates on getting small details about Latin right and from the Living Latin activists who are fascinated by neologisms rather than, for example, engaging with the Renaissance humanist authors (Miraglia 2015, 33).

6 Conclusions

The history of Living Latin has yet to be written. I think I heard these words in 2010 summer, in a seminar⁹⁵³ by Guy Licoppe and Françoise Deraedt in the first Latin congress I participated in – *Monumenta Viaeque* (*The [literary] Monuments and the Ways [of teaching]*) organised by Luigi Miraglia's *Vivarium Novum* in Rome. It was a splendid event with close to 200 participants; these seven days were full of lectures, excursions and conversations. The two thousand years of continuity of the Latin tradition manifested themselves in the Roman ruins and Renaissance villas we were visiting, the texts we were reading and in the international community speaking the language. This strangely palpable universality made the statement even more intriguing.

My thesis addresses this statement and tries to give a historical survey and a framework encompassing the diverse networks and phenomena of the movement(s), its historical circumstances, internal tensions and roots reaching back to the Renaissance.

I use Wilfried Stroh's definition that Living Latin is encountered wherever the use of Latin is practised *in spite of* the general trend of its abandonment. I extend it by emphasising the intentionality: Living Latin is the conviction in the *vitality* of Latin and in the intention to assert and demonstrate it by using Latin actively (by writing, speaking). Thus, the Living Latin movement includes such phenomena as organising Latin-only conferences, seminars, publishing Latin journals, broadcasting Latin radio news. All of them are driven by a conviction in Latin's continuing universality which is (to various degrees) judged to be compatible with modernity (it is not necessary to, for example, create a new simpler Latin-based language in order to make it compatible with today). This is turn based on the memory of Latin's erstwhile ubiquity and its international role for all learned and official communication.

The concept of the Republic of Letters (*Res publica litterarum*) was first formulated in the Renaissance – it was an imagined egalitarian and meritocratic community spanning all the learned through the common medium of Latin and a network of correspondence. Besides this synchronic universality, there was also the diachronic one. The lasting value of the artful and scholarly works by predecessors made them alive also for the present and the future; Latin, the common language with its long history made the writers of the past and the Roman luminaries perpetually present the same way the contemporaries were perceived, so the participants in this Republic of Letters could reasonably hope for a similar immortality. This concept enables the users of Latin today to feel part

⁹⁵³ It was about *Niels Klim's Underground Travels* (*Nicolai Klimii Iter subterraneum*), a 1741 Neo-Latin novel by the Norwegian-Danish writer Ludvig Holberg.

of the same universality. This idea and the fascination with this universality is one of the motivating factors for its continued use.

Just like today, in the Renaissance and generally the early modern period (15-18th centuries) there were different views about the proper ways to teach Latin and about the proper relationship of Latin with the living languages. Sometimes Latin was taught in a rigorous academic manner, sometimes free conversation was encouraged or was even the primary method of teaching. One of the traditions that can be discerned in the spoken wing is the utopian thinking about projects of *civitates Latinae*, places in which Latin would become an every-day, even a vernacular, a native language; foreign students would be able to come to this town and learn Latin quickly in a completely natural way. When Living Latin proponents rediscovered in the 1890s this old tradition – the first suggestions date to 1614, many of them referencing Michel de Montaigne's Latin-only childhood in the 1530s influenced by the Humanistic ideas – they saw it as their own predecessors. This tradition can be connected both with the enthusiasm for speaking Latin and with the preference of immersive methods of teaching the language. The phenomenon of immersive summer schools (*scholae aestivae*) can be traced to this tradition.

I see the beginning of the Living Latin movement in the 1880s. As a consequence of the technological progress in communications and transportation, the period saw a great increase of international contacts and the resulting rise of the international language question. During this time period the discussions were very widespread and the public attention made the movements of artificial languages formed to answer this question, namely Volapük in the 1880s and Esperanto in the 1890s, to grow very quickly. The international role Latin had historically performed made many ask themselves if it could perform this role again; the fact that Latin still was one of the foundations of education made this thinking reasonable. This thinking contributed to the appearance of the Living Latin movement and also to various Latin-derived artificial languages.

The first Living Latin periodical – that is, an international journal that was published in Latin not because it had traditionally been employed for that field (as, for example, the Vatican official journal *Acta Sanctae Sedis* was published since 1865), but rather for love of the language itself – was *Alaudae* (1889-1895) published by Karl Heinrich Ulrichs (1825-1895) in L'Aquila, Italy. The author came from the Neo-Latin poetry tradition and saw the form of a journal preferable to the publication of books. By this time, the advances in communications meant that the journal could get a wide geographical distribution, playing into the historical advantages of Latin (the social stratum of Latin readers had been a rather thin one, but geographically very widespread), and so even if the journal had only about 200 subscribers, it was read from New Zealand to the USA. Therefore, the author soon understood that *Latin had a power to connect the nations*: it was a

humanistic response to the international language question, establishing a worldwide network of Latin readers interacting with the journal and feeling a community.

The second journal *Phœnix* (1890-1892) by George J. Henderson (1860-1911), an enthusiast of the international language question and creator of several artificial languages, for the first time aspired to create a worldwide organisation for making Latin the international language. It exploited the fact that the Volapük movement was disintegrating and the Esperanto movement had not yet taken hold and so also reached out to the artificial language enthusiasts.

Præco Latinus (1894-1902) by Arcadius Avellanus (1851-1935) in Philadelphia advocated for Latin to be taught as a living language (he had connections with some of the pioneers of the direct method in the USA) and promoted textbooks where the modern usage of Latin was seen as a gateway to the classical authors. Avellanus saw the relationship between the modern variety of Latin with the Classical Latin as something similar as Katharevousa, the contemporary literary variant of Greek, with the Classical Greek: the language was conceptualised as the same, just with a different style (modern linguistics do not share this opinion about Katharevousa, but this one was attested among many of the Greeks of the time). He was the first one to sell audio recordings complementing his Latin textbook; likewise, he was the first prolific translator of modern children's literature into Latin for educational purposes. Exploring Avellanus and his proposed schemes for the revival of Latin worldwide (a Latin-only school; an international academy of Latin) reveals an international network of enthusiasts of Latin connected through his periodical; through *Præco Latinus* and its correspondents (especially Jacques Tasset from Paris) Latin represented itself also in other internationalist movements like pacifism. The fact that he managed to get funding for various projects by lobbying various American industrialists shows the still-present prestige of Latin in the society. Avellanus was apparently also the first one to found a *circulus Latinus*, a society of amateurs meeting fortnightly to speak Latin for two decades.

Besides these three connections – the Neo-Latin tradition, the international language question, the reform of the teaching of Latin – there was also the Catholic Church connection. *Vox Urbis* (1898-1913), later continued as *Alma Roma* (1914-1942), by the Catholic architect Aristide Leonori and the lawyer Latinist Giuseppe Fornari, followed in footsteps of the three mentioned journals and tried to provide a general purpose literary journal in Latin. The popes read and supported the journal. Italy had an ongoing tradition of writing poetry and various ceremonial inscriptions in Latin – for example, Giovanni Pascoli (1855-1912), then one of the most prominent Italian poets, was known for his Latin poetry just as much as for his Italian one. The journal was rather successful and, having gathered a quite large and learned team of contributors, including numerous university professors, it strived to make Rome the centre of Latin language culture.

Because Rome still had a close connection with the Latin literary tradition, the elegant language employed was considered not modern enough by *Præco Latinus* and, later, by *Societas Latina* (1932-1944, 1947-1955) in Munich.

So this early period of Living Latin – the end of the 19th century and the beginning of the 20th – already contains many elements of the later movements: journals of different styles, international language advocacy, networking of the Living Latin community, translations into Latin of modern literature, attempts to reform the teaching of Latin, even a (one-day) conference in Rome advocating for the restoration of Latin.

The Interwar period saw the growth of various national movements for the restoration of Latin; Latin now was even involved in national politics. The first years in the 1920s saw attempts by Latin to insert itself in the new international organisations as an official language; even if they led nowhere, some of the support they obtained shows that these ideas still had an audience.

The 1930s were singular for the optimism and growth of the Latin movement – new Latin organisations appeared in Poland, Spain, Germany; this optimism was felt in the Hungarian periodical *Juventus*, the Rome *Alma Roma*. But the most important event was an attempt by the Institute of Roman Studies and its leader Carlo Galassi Paluzzi to implement a programme for restoring Latin as an international language. This is the only time when an institution with close ties with the government has commenced such a programme; in the time when Mussolini's Fascist government was increasingly using the Roman symbols and the Latin language itself (even teaching it as a living language), it was possible that the Duce himself would approve of this project, which he did. The project consisted from composing a new Latin-Italian school dictionary (appropriately noting that it will be bigger than the foreign ones), composing a set of Italian-Latin dictionaries of modern terms approved both by the Latinists and the respective scientific communities, organising a nationwide competition of Latin prose, translating summaries of scientific and scholarly production into Latin (the true international language) and, finally, from an organisation to coordinate the worldwide movement of Living Latin. All of these projects were proceeding; the worldwide coordination project was proceeding, with a journal being published. The outbreak of World War 2 prevented the first universal congress of Living Latin from happening. The Fascist-supported Italo-centric movement of Living Latin would have been much different from what happened in the postwar years, when Latin was now a symbol of European integration rather than a symbol of Italian superiority.

The post-war Living Latin movement was started by Jean Capelle and his movement starting from the 1956 Avignon congress *for Living Latin (pour le latin vivant)*. From here, an official organisation *Vita Latina* arose which continued until 1975 the series of Latin congresses

which used to be concluded with resolutions for the restoration of Latin language. The second official movement was the *Academia Latinitati Fovendae* created by the same Institute of Roman Studies that tried to coordinate the worldwide Latin movement in the 1930s. However, the deteriorating position of Latin made the hopes of its officially restored international use void.

While the institutional positions of Latin were deteriorating, the enthusiast movement practised Latin as a world language. Latin was taught as a living language in the summer schools since 1973, which also served as a hub for international communication and community-building. This, coupled with the fact that regular congresses were being celebrated in Latin (including those organised by the two official universal movements) and that the Latin journals were being published, various local organisations being founded, made the Latin community increasingly real and tangible in times when the Latin has been increasingly disappearing from its traditional positions. The supporters of Latin from many countries became acquainted with each other through the medium of Latin as their language of communication and formed an informal network and a lasting community united by a shared conviction of the universality of Latin.

This is a short summary of the history of the phenomenon, a map to a very wide tradition spanning the globe that still awaits exploration.⁹⁵⁴ This thesis is an important step in this direction.

⁹⁵⁴ I have estimated the number of pages published in the Latin periodicals to easily exceed 100 000. I have been trying to make this paper universe accessible, starting from scanning the whole of *Vox Urbis* and *Alma Roma*, much of *Iuventus* and most of *Melissa* and putting them online in my website *Arx Latina* (<https://arxlatina.org>), which will gradually become the primary gateway for accessing the various written legacy of the Living Latin movement.

Appendix A. Selected notes

1. Translations of modern children's literature into Latin

Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe* (1719) and its derivatives were translated to Latin many times; Anonymus (2004) collects 20 editions of five main translations. One of these derivatives is *Robinson der Jüngere* (1779), an adaptation for children of *Robinson Crusoe* by Joachim Heinrich Campe (1746-1818), which was translated to Latin very soon after its publication (Lieberkühn and Campe 1785). It probably can be listed as the first example of modern children's literature (a genre that had recently been developed) translated into Latin for pedagogical purposes. The translators imagined their books being part of a bigger project of reforming the teaching of Latin by providing engaging introductory readers (in this way, e.g., Lieberkühn and Campe (1785); Gedike, Lieberkühnius and Campe (1802); Goffaux and Campe (1809); Newman (1862); Newman (1884) present their projects). Haaker (2011, 329-330) and Platzdasch (2018) mention these translations into Latin as the beginning of a tradition (Platzdasch (2018): "*Die lateinischen Übersetzungen von Campes »Robinson der Jüngere« stehen am Anfang einer langen Reihe von Übertragungen von Kinder- und Jugendbuchklassikern ins Lateinische.*"), while van Bommel (2015, 137-138) and Stroh (2016b, 257-262) treat them in their contemporary context. Arcadius Avellanus, beside his own translation of *Robinson Crusoe*, published a series of translations of such works as *Insula Thesauraria* (Stevenson's *Treasure Island*) in 1914-1928, while Alexander Lenard's 1958 translation *Winnie ille Pu* (A. A. Milne's *Winnie-the-Pooh*) became the only Latin book to be featured in *New York Times*' *Best seller list* (Lenard (1965) provides a lovely autobiography of the translator and the genesis of the book), demonstrating the viability of such endeavours. Many other translations soon appeared, such as *Regulus* (1961, Antoine de Saint-Exupéry's *Le Petit Prince*), *Alicia in terra mirabili* (1964, Lewis Carroll's *Alice in Wonderland*). Stroh (2016a) and Stroh (2016b) survey this field; Schubert (2020) assesses the linguistic quality of some of the recent titles.

2. Costantino Stauder

Costantino Stauder (1841-1913), a native of Arezzo, a Franciscan friar, lived several years in New York teaching Moral Theology, left the Catholic Church, married, was consecrated as an Episcopal priest, in 1890 settled down in London and, aside from serving the Italian Episcopal community, taught Latin privately. His life is described in Villani (2014), Cristelli (2009), Platt (2018). While in the USA, he contributed Latin verse to the journal *Latine* (see footnote 349). In October 1891, *David Nutt*, the same London publisher which published *Phaenix*, published a Latin

periodical authored by Stauder: *Post prandium. Pleasantries in colloquial Latin by Constantine Stauder. Published in order to show that Latin may be more easily and more pleasantly acquired by treating the language as if it were still a living tongue, than by methods now in use = Post prandium. Solatia, ad consuetudinem Latine loquendo colendam, studiumque Romanae linguae oculis et auribus jucundum reddendum, proposita*. Only one issue appeared. Richly illustrated, it was intended as a supplement to *Phœnix*.

3. Doctoral degree of Arcadius Avellanus

Avellanus' doctorate was a honorary one provided by a (very) obscure institution in 1902; Avellanus used the title from July 1902 in *Præco Latinus* and in subsequent publications (Avellanus (1900) still has a plain name, but Avellanus and Corderius (1904) has *Dr. Litt., Dr. Phil.*). *Præco Latinus* Iul. 1902 Vol. VIII No. 10 p. 224:

“– “ALBERTUS MAGNUS UNIVERSITY” est Institutum in oppido Wichita, Kansas, quod non modo novam ac probatissimam instituendi rationem in cunctis disciplinis adoptavit, inter alia l. Lñam secundum nostram *Palæstram* tradendo, <...> Rector Magnus Sc. Urstatis huius est Cl. MERWIN-MARIE SNELL, Dr. Phil., doctrina ac litteris commendatissimus. Senatus Instituti Clmum *F. Philips*, ob merita litteraria diplomate honestavit “Licentiati Litterarum,” nos autem gradu “Doctoris Litterarum” causa honoris, decoravit, atque Consultorem Latinum sui Consilii Gentium esse voluit. Nostram humilitatem obscuram tanto honore collustrari gratissimum munus nobis est, atque eo titulo honoris dehinc perpetuo utemur. Ex corde gratias!”.

This tiny “university” (*Report of the Commissioner of Education for the year 1900-1901. Volume 2*. Washington: Government printing office, 1902, pp. 1658-1659 shows that it was founded in 1900/1901 and in the academic year 1900-1901 it had 17 teachers and 67 students.) was headed by a certain Merwin-Marie Snell (1863-1921) better known for his mystical activities – an enthusiast of comparative religion studies, a convert to Catholicism (hence the name of the university), he believed in the unity of religions, participating in the organisation of the 1893 *World's Parliament of Religions* in Chicago, being a friend of Vivekananda, associating with Theosophy, various occult groupings and finally in 1907 creating his own esoteric organisation *Universal Brotherhood / Integral Fellowship / Great Circle / Mahacakra Society* still existing today. This *Albertus Magnus University* disappeared very soon. *The Wichita Daily Eagle* 23 Apr. 1909 p. 5: “Professor Snell had a scheme to build up the greatest university in the world here, and the faith he had in the undertaking would have done credit to the craziest genius in the famous Latin quarter of Paris.”.

4. Jacques Tasset

Thévoz (2022) provides a biography and portrait of Jacques Tasset (*Jacobus Tassetius*, 1868-1945) – he learned Chinese, Japanese, Sanskrit, studied comparative religion, travelled to Korea, Japan, Tunis, collected artworks, wrote on and practised Buddhism (even declaring to have converted), participated in the Theosophical movement. His Latin activism has also been extensive.

He is present in *Præco Latinus* at least since October 1898 (issues from Oct. 1897 to Sept. 1898 are inaccessible online) and gives a brief autobiography (attaching a photographic portrait) in Aug. 1899 Vol. V No. 11 pp. 161-163, and in *L'Étranger* since November 1898. Lombard had taught Tasset German in school (*Præco Latinus* Jul. 1901 Vol. VII No. 10 p. 225) – so there was a long personal connection.

He also contributed to other Latin journals: the German *Civis Romanus / Scriptor Latinus*, the Roman *Vox Urbis / Alma Roma*. He had a speech in the 1903 Latin congress in Rome; he is also reputed (I have not found any contemporary testimonies yet) to have edited his own Latin journal *Apis Romana* (IJsewijn-Jacobs (1961, 159); Sacré (1988, 101)).

Séchresee (1903, 156) provides an undated quote from *Concordia* by Tasset: “Depuis quatre ou cinq ans, je corresponds dans cette langue avec des hommes instruits de nationalité variée et cette expérience m’a démontré la valeur pratique du latin.”.

5. Published corpus of *Vox Urbis* and *Alma Roma*

Vox Urbis was published twice a month on Kalends and Ides from Kal. Nov. 1898 to Id. Dec. 1903, once a month from Jan. 1903 to Dec. 1913; *Alma Roma* was published once a month from May 1914 to Dec. 1941 (August and September were normally united to a single issue, except for 1914; 1916; 1917 when there were two issues), in 1942 in bimonthly intervals until Sept.-Oct.

Initially (until Dec. 1907) *Vox Urbis* was printed on a quite large newspaper-like format (39 × 28,5 cm; dimensions determined from scanned images, not in situ) until Dec. 1907 and each issue used to contain 8 pages (not including 4 pages of covers); later 16 pages and in a twice-smaller format (32 × 21,5 cm). *Alma Roma* continued this format (24 × 17 cm, 16 pages). So there were 172 bigger issues (containing roughly double the text) of *Vox Urbis* with 1380 pages (Kal. Jan. 1903 contains 4 extra pages) and 120 smaller issues with 1106 pages, totalling in 2486 pages and 292 issues. Including the covers (part of them were filled with regular text), which consist from 688 bigger and 288 smaller pages, the total comes to 3462. There were 312 issues of *Alma Roma* and 5528 numbered pages.

6. *Lingua Latina per se illustrata* – the Latin textbook by Hans H. Ørberg

Hans Henning Ørberg (1920-2010), a teacher of English in the *Nature Method Institute* (*Naturmetodens Sproginstitut*) in Copenhagen, decided to apply the style of *English by the Nature method*, a textbook by Arthur M. Jensen, the founder of the institute, to Latin; the resulting textbook was published in 1954 (Ørberg 1954). It uses a context-inductive approach – Ørberg crafted the Latin text in a special manner, aiming to gradually introduce new vocabulary and grammar in such a way that they would be immediately understandable from the context and without translation, helped by illustrations and paraphrases in Latin. It treats only Roman times and literature, so it is compatible with the usual Latin learning goals, while its Latin-only nature attracts favour of the Living Latin proponents.

After the first editions in the 1950s and 1960s his books gradually sank into oblivion, but since their rediscovery in the 1990s the movement of the Latin language teaching reform has consolidated around Ørberg's textbooks to a large extent. His books are now being used in schools and universities of many countries; the large number of advocates, teachers, editions, adaptations, imitations make this a growing movement of its own right.

7. Early use of the term “Nature method” by John Stuart Blackie (1809-1895)

Blackie (1845, 176): “If this be so, it may be assumed as a maxim in teaching languages, that the more near a method approaches to the method employed by Nature in this case, the more near does that method approach to perfection. What, then, are the elements of this natural method? 'Tis a simple affair. First : there is a direct appeal to the ear, the natural organs by which the language is acquired.” (cf. footnote 28). Blackie also argues against the notion that the conversational and grammarless teaching of languages is something new and original, that Heinrich Gottfried Ollendorff, language teaching methodologist famous in the 1840s, is the Euclid of language pedagogy – he goes back to the Flemish humanist Nicolaus Clenardus (*Nicolas Cleynaerts*, 1495-1542) who provided testimony about successfully teaching Latin in a festive, playful and conversational manner to a large group of students in Braga, Portugal who were not even literate (and became famous for that; a *New Method of quickly teaching illiterate children to speak Latin* was later published posthumously as Clenardus (1577)). Blackie took this detail from Morhof's *Polyhystor* (Morhofius 1688, 449-50), which contains an extensive quotation from a letter by Clenardus. Morhof was quite sympathetic of this method; above, in page 46, it can be seen that he even supported the idea of a *civitas Latina*. Blackie's article is also treated by Howatt (1984, 194 ff.).

8. Monument for Living Latin in Pau

Zamenhof imagined that his language will be an instrument of peace and equality between nations: “when the peoples will be able to understand each other easily, the mutual hate will cease”. Centassi and Masson (2006, 126) provide a facsimile of an undated manuscript by Zamenhof: “Kiam la popoloj povos libere sin kompreni, tiam ili ĉesos reciproke sin malami”. The same sentence (with a French translation: *quand les peuples pourront librement se comprendre, ils cesseront de se détester*) is inscribed in a 1983 monument for Zamenhof in Pau, France.

Even here Latin came to be a direct competitor of Esperanto! Geneviève Immè (*Genovefa Immè*, 1929-2012), local of Pau, Latin teacher and poet, Living Latin activist and the wife of Latin poet Antonino Immè (1909-1988) from Sicily, with whom they had a Latin-speaking marriage (!), disliked this new monument in the *Zamenhof square*. In 1986, she started to collect signatures from fellow Latin supporters to erect an analogous monument to *Latin*; in 1987, she had 327 signatures, enough to convince the mayor of Pau to erect this monument. In 1991 he inaugurated the monument in the *Beaumont* park. It was inscribed first in Latin “LATINE LOQUERE UT CIVIS TERRARUM HABERE” and then in French “{...} Latin la langue internationale”. The monument-related writings are Immè (1986), Immè (1987), Deraedt (2013), Licoppe (2014a, 253-254) and Neves (2018), a recent paper written in Ido (!); the biography is also given by van Dievoet (2014). Geneviève (initially together with her husband Antonio) also published a small Latin journal *M.A.S. (Memento Audere Semper)* since 1981 (Immè and Immè 1981) publishing 81 issues until 2011 when she lost her eyesight, (*Melissa* Dec. 2011 No. 165 p. 16).

9. Congresses of *Vita Latina*

The first congress *pour le latin vivant* was held on 3-6 September 1956 in Avignon (Meunier 1956), the second on 8-10 September 1959 in Lyon (Théodore-Aubanel 1960), the third on 2-4 September 1963 in Strasbourg (Théodore-Aubanel 1964), the fourth on 1-3 April 1969 in Avignon (Théodore-Aubanel 1970), the fifth and the last one on 1-5 April 1975 in Pau (Aubanel 1976). The 1959 congress had 158 participants from 19 countries (Théodore-Aubanel 1960, 37-41), the 1963 congress had 254 participants from 22 countries according to the proceedings (Théodore-Aubanel 1964, 17-23) or about 400 participants from 25 countries according to a participant (Jiménez Delgado 1963), the 1969 congress had 235 participants from 19 countries (Licoppe 2014a, 72), (Théodore-Aubanel 1970) while the last one in 1975 had only 89 participants with comparatively few guests from abroad (Licoppe 2014a, 118). This poor attendance is probably due to Aubanel’s death in 1970 – he used to publish *Vita Latina* and maybe to support the society itself.

10. Reception of the 1956 Avignon congress in schools

A letter in *Vita Latina* Mai. 1958 No. 4 pp. 86-87 by Melanie Isnenghi, participant of the 1956 Avignon congress and gymnasium teacher of Latin in Salzburg, is fascinating to read. The enthusiasm for the revival of Latin she got from the congress was accepted by her colleagues (they liked the ideas about the teaching methodology and the), but could not be communicated to her students – she believed that reading about modern subjects like Olympic games in Latin would interest teenage girls, but it turned out that they were in the class because they wanted to learn about the Roman culture.

Duobus fere annis transactis non facere possum, quin reminiscar illius conventus Avennici, et usque ad hoc tempus in meo labore tota inflata sum votis illis fervidissimis, quae concepimus pro restituenda lingua Latina in eum statum dignitatis et usus, in quo per multa saecula videri poterat. <...> Postquam disserui, quomodo vox Avennica a magistris reperienda esset, quomodo discipulae adversum novam quandam methodum se gesserint, exponere haud absurdum videtur esse. His ultimis annis superiores classes mihi lingua Latina instruendae erant. Quo factum est, ut nulla facultas assuefaciendi discipulas colloquiis Latinis mihi data sit. Sed scio collegam quandam jam a principio cum discipulis non sermone patrio, sed lingua Latina loqui. Permotam illo sermone, quem illustrissimus vir Godvinus Beach de eligendis operibus habuit, cum discipulis, quae jam quantum annum studio linguae Latinae dedunt, libellum illum, quem illustrissimus vir Carolus Egger de septimis Olympiis conscripsit, legere coepi. Sunt autem illae discipulae in arte lignearum solearum oblongarum optime versatae, ut earum e numero quandam palmam Olympicam postea relaturam esse speremus. Itaque mihi non dubium fuit, quin hunc libellum meliore voluntate ideoque fructu majore quam libros in usum scholarum admissos lecturae essent. Qua e spe dejecta sum. Et discipulae interrogatae, quae sit causa istius lentitudinis, se scriptores Romanos, quorum libris vitae et moribus Romanis initiarentur, praeferre non dissimulaverunt.

11. Alexander Lenard, *Winnie ille Pu* and the Republic of Letters

Lenard (1965) declares his motivation for publishing the Latin translation (Lenardus and Milneus 1958) of *Winnie the Pooh*. It is an example of thinking that publishing books in Latin does not only puts one in the contemporary community of the Latin writers, but also makes one a citizen in the perennial Republic of Letters:

“How should I have resisted the temptation to print my translation and see my name on the title page of a Latin book? I recalled the years in Roman libraries: reading Latin books only meant being a visitor in the Republic of Humanists. To have written a Latin book meant full citizenship. A stateless refugee is always longing for some sort of citizenship, even of a state which is not issuing passports. // Is the Republic of Humanists really unreal? The Knights of Malta have lost their island long ago, but still send ambassadors to courts of kings... A representative of Goa is still in Lisbon,

claiming the colony has not been lost. The difference between reality and fiction is a matter of definition.”

12. Living Greek and Living Latin in the Rugby Academy, Philadelphia

The Gazette (Montreal, Quebec, Canada) 6 Jan. 1894 p. 11:

Some time ago, it may be remembered, I gave a brief notice of *Tusculum: Periodicum Græco Latinum*, published by the Rugby Society of Greek and Latin Conversation. The *Societas Rugbiana* is associated with Rugby academy, Philadelphia, and by means of *Tusculum* is enabled to initiate other teaching institutions into its methods and to invite them to share its triumphs. I was so interested in the experiment that I took the liberty of writing to the principal for some information as to the working out of his idea, and was privileged by the receipt of a courteous and satisfying reply.

A

It was during a sojourn in Athens, he tells me, that the truth was brought home to him that Greek is a living tongue, and that, if it is worth learning at all, as a living tongue it should be learned. Nor should any other rule apply to Latin. Mr. Greenwood had the happiness to become acquainted with a thorough Latin scholar, Prof. Mogyorossy, and to his intercourse with that gentleman, while putting the *viva voce* system to a practical test in teaching, he attributes a higher value than to any previous effort to master the language of Cicero. But it is not Latin and Greek only that are thus taught at Rugby academy. English, French and German are studied on the same plan. It is, however, to the attempt to use Latin and Greek as “flexible, living instruments” that attention has been mainly directed because it is such a new thing under the cis-Atlantic sun, at least, north of the Gulf of Mexico. Mr. Greenwood has kindly described for me the working of the scheme from the pupils’ point of view and it is certainly in marked contrast to that of the old-fashioned system.

B

As the boys enter the class-room they give the greeting, *kalen hemeran* (good morning) or *ho kairos einai kalos* (it is fine weather). They say *ta mere tou logou* instead of “parts of speech,” and so on. As to the use of *einai* for *esti* and other Hellenisms, Mr. Greenwood explains that experience has taught him that, for wondrous variety, Greek is extremely like English, and that its constructions, as well as its phraseology have a range as great as that which divides “cowboy” or “pigeon” English from the speech of Shakespeare, Milton or Addison. While using *einai*, therefore, and other modernisms in conversation, pupils are taught to speak old Attic as well when occasion demands the change.

C

The numbers of *Tusculum* that Mr. Greenwood has sent me are intended to teach Latin and Greek (*pensum* answering in every instance to *mathema*) from the alphabet to reading of easy sentences which, in due course, will be succeeded by passages from the classical authors. After the *curriculum linguarum* has been concluded, *Tusculum* will be continued as a literary magazine.

13. Speaking Latin in the *Societas Gentium Latina*

School 12 Feb. 1914 p. 235 provides an enthusiastic testimony by Herbert C. de V. Cornwell who describes his swift break-through in Latin skills, attributing his success to the practice of spoken Latin in the fortnightly sessions of the *Societas Gentium Latina* led by Arcadius Avellanus:

Language is the agent of thought and writing is but the symbolism of language. Can anybody doubt that a tongue is more profitably taught by ear than by sight through symbolism? What Latin really meant I first realized when introduced to Dr. A. Avellanus who did not speak with me except in that tongue. In the beginning all was chaos though I faintly recognized that he was speaking Latin. In about an hour, however, I began to know words apart and after a few meetings understood quite clearly; before long I could also answer, my stored-away Latin hitherto lifeless, became living and, when one day I picked up my Cicero, I was amazed to find how easily I could read the great Roman orator at sight. Other members of our society have had the same experience. While I knew that much practical Latin may be learned from a good manual and the study of fables, still, the *viva vox*, which we seek to employ, the fluent speech is the most potent means available of imparting a practical knowledge of the language.

14. Lambert Sauveur

1. Introduction

Lambert Sauveur (1826-1911),⁹⁵⁵ an immigrant from France and a reformer of language innovation, commenced the series of *Summer College of Languages* dedicated to teaching languages according to the *Natural Method*. His summer schools had many names through the years: they were called the *Normal School of Modern Languages*, *Normal School of Languages*, *The Summer School of Languages*, *School of Languages*. See also section 3.4.5.5, p. 105.

Sauveur has been treated by Finotti (2010) (a dedicated study), Howatt and Widdowson (2004, 217 ff.), Wheeler (2013, 138-143), Germain (2020), López (2020), Ruyffelaert (2020).

He is regarded an important precursor of the language teaching reform, successfully promoting the *Natural Method* (developed together with Gottlieb Heness) in the USA since the late

⁹⁵⁵ Most of the secondary sources, including scholarly ones (e.g., Finotti (2010)), indicate 1907 as Sauveur's date of death, but the newspapers indicate 15 May 1911; e.g., *The Cambridge Tribune* 20 May 1911 Vol. 34 No. 12 p. 5 (accessible in <https://cambridge.dlconsulting.com/?a=d&d=Tribune19110520-01.2.50&e=-----en-20--1--txt-txIN----->, consulted 28.8.2023).

1860s. Maximilian Berlitz followed in Sauveur's footsteps, systematised the approach and found a way to make this teaching scalable nationally and internationally through a network of commercial schools. As Howatt and Widdowson (2004, 223) put it, "Without Sauveur, the Direct Method would not have happened when it did; without Berlitz, very few people would have benefited from it."

2. Contemporary praise of the innovative format

Willoughby (1895, 918):

This is the oldest school of this class in the country. "The Sauveur Summer College of Languages," writes Dr. Sauveur, "is the parent, the prototype of all the schools of the same order that have since been established. The first session was held at Plymouth, N. H., in 1876. At that time no summer school of this character was in existence. <...> The method of instruction is the natural method, the introduction of which in our schools Dr. Sauveur has done so much to forward.

3. The method used for teaching the ancient languages, especially Latin

Sauveur (1878a, iv):

<...> three years ago I opened a summer Normal School in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The second session was held at Amherst College, and one hundred and fifty teachers attended, in order to learn how to teach the modern languages. This year the third session will be held again at Amherst, and I have added to the course the ancient languages, Latin, Greek, Hebrew, and Sanskrit, which will be taught by the new method. <...> I trust that the teachers of ancient languages will be as eager to inform themselves of our mode of instruction, as the teachers of living languages have been.

Sauveur described his method in Sauveur (1878b), and published a textbook *Talks with Cæsar* (Sauveur 1878c) including question exercises. Various abridged editions: Sauveur (1878a), Sauveur (1878d), Sauveur (1878e). He also planned to publish *Talks with Epitome Historiae Sacrae*. Sauveur (1878b, 16-17) notes the primacy of the model author:

But what, then, is this Natural Method? // It is this. From the very first day, we place before our pupils a Latin or a Greek author: that author is our teacher. As we are at liberty to choose, we take the best, the most simple, the most natural, the most perfect in his language, and therefore the easiest to be understood. Were he living, it is he whom we would choose, out of all his fellow-citizens, to teach us by word of mouth. Our professors are Cæsar for the Latin, Xenophon for the Greek, and we who lead the classes are only there to introduce our pupils to those learned professors.

4. Teaching Ancient Greek: T. T. Timayenis

Sauveur had plans to write books similar to *Talks with Cæsar* for teaching Greek: *Talks with Æsop*, *Talks with Xenophon*.

Telemachus Thomas Timayenis (1853-1918), a Greek immigrant and a colleague of Sauveur (*Buffalo Courier Express* 3 May 1879 p. 6 presents him, the Greek teacher in *Chautauqua Normal School of Languages*, as “formerly Associate Director of Dr. Sauveur’s School of Languages in New-York”), undertook the Greek programme and published *Talks with Æsop* under his own name (Timayenis 1879).

But the project was Sauveur’s idea and he was involved. Timayenis’ announcements in newspapers stated that the *Talks* “were prepared with the assistance of Dr. L. Sauveur” and the 1879 programme of the *Normal School of Languages* indicated the authorship as “*L. Sauveur and T. T. Timayenis*”, so Sauveur might have been intentionally omitted from the authorship and left only as an acknowledgement in the preface. Timayenis had a history of plagiarism (see Seligman (2020)).

See also footnote 430 for Timayenis.

15. Nahida Sturmhöfel and Sylvia Pankhurst

A. Nahida Sturmhöfel

Nahida Sturmhöfel (1822-1889), a German poet and an early activist of the women’s emancipation movement, authored an interesting 24-page pamphlet (Sturmhöfel 1884) with an eloquent title “Neulatein als Weltsprache. Ein Vorschlag”. She meditates on the universal progress, on the pain of the lack of international understanding, and believes that Latin as a neutral international language could be *the* key to peace – she argues for Latin to be taught everywhere (also in the girls’ schools!) and that it could become a marvellous instrument for understanding each other (and how wonderful it is that in Latin one uses the second personal singular *tu* to address everyone regardless of the rank); and nobody would complain that it is a useless subject anymore. Finally, she attaches a letter by her cousin who criticises the undeserved success of Volapük, a very cumbersome language, and notes that Nahida had long been interested in the international language question.⁹⁵⁶

956 Sturmhöfel (1884, 22): “Nachdem Du im Jahre 1876 Deine Broschüre über Einführung der Weltsprache (Wien, b. Hügel) veröffentlicht und auf eigene Kosten in alle Welt geschickt – trotzdem Dir, so viel ich weiss, die Butter zum lieben täglichen Brod oft genug fehlte – ist die Idee mit Erfolg aufs Neue ins Leben getreten, das ist Dein Verdienst, obschon seine Konsequenzen, leider! allerdings fraglicher Natur sind, denn – höre und staune!”. Apparently she had published this pamphlet pseudonymously, as the contemporary press reported the existence of a booklet very much matching the description: “*Einführung der Weltsprache. Ein Versuch, herausgegeben vom Comité*, 1876; Wien: Commissionsverlag von E. Hügel Buchhandlung.”.

So this defence of Latin is a mix of progressive thought and a desire to lean on the classical education. The actual language she proposes is not exactly a classical Latin – it is imagined to be a simple language that could use any international words. An example is given in page 17:

Ueberhaupt dictirt der Gebrauch in Bezug auf Bezeichnung der Begriffe in absoluter Art. So weiss Jedermann, dass z. B. der Gesprächssatz „Er geht zur Bahn“ so viel bedeutet, als „Er geht zur Eisenbahn“. Ebenso sagt man in Italien „il vapore“ und alle Welt weiss, dass nicht der Dampf, sondern das Dampfschiff gemeint ist. Ebenso, wenn wir uns die lateinische Sprache als Verkehrssprache als angenommen vorstellen, würde ein Jeder verstehen, wenn gefragt würde: „Ubi est post?“ oder „Est ne tramway in loco?“ Ehbenso leicht wird Jeder verstehen: „Sum conductor tramviae?“

It seems that Sturmhöfel promoted this pamphlet by sending it out to the newspapers. *Neues Wiener Tageblatt* 11 Feb. 1884 p. 3 contains a derisive review; they received her booklet from Frascati – just as Ulrichs, she lived in Italy in her later years, dying there in 1889. It would be interesting to know if Ulrichs had ever read this essay – after all, they had a lot in common: they belonged to the same generation, both of them were poets, held liberal views and lived in Italy in the same time period.

The memory of her pamphlet survived in the artificial language scholarship. Couturat and Leau (1903, 517) mentioned it in the chapter about Latin and rejected it as not a serious project – after all, while it is ideologically developed, its linguistic part is lacking. Stojan (1929, 123) likewise classifies it together with other publications about international Latin. But Duličenko (1990, 103) classifies it as a separate language project. And indeed while from the title it seems to promote Latin as a world language and it does share many arguments with the defenders of Living Latin, the actual proposal is more similar to the many versions of simplified Latin.

B. Sylvia Pankhurst

Sturmhöfel was not the only women's rights activist promoting a Latin-based international language. The prominent political activist Sylvia Pankhurst (1882-1960), daughter of the women's suffrage movement leader Emmeline Pankhurst (1858-1928), for a while turned her attention to the international language question and published a book called *Delphos. The future of international language* (Pankhurst [1927]), reviewing the international language question, surveying the history of the proposed languages, and finally endorsing Peano's *Latino sine flexione* or, as it was then officially called, *Interlingua*.

The knowledge of Latin is seen as a liberating force and the adoption of a language based on Latin is seen both as most practical language and something that would help the society master this knowledge, improving their lives. So Pankhurst ([1927], 50) praises Latin's universality (just like a Living Latin supporter would), but also rejects the use of the parts of Latin that are not used in the terminology and the modern languages:

To give to everybody's children, all over the world, a language so much like Latin that whoever knows it can read Latin with little study would tremendously accelerate the spread of learning and the breaking down of social barriers. Latin, by international agreement, is the universal medium for the technical terms in medicine, anatomy, botany, and zoology. It is essential to the lawyer, and largely so to the historian. // *The Interlanguage is unlikely to incorporate Latin words which have passed out of current usage.* It will select those which, either as root-words or derivatives, have survived in modern speech or have been coined in modern times.

Aray (2017, 111) notes that her vision shows that the artificial language movement in the 1920s "was a modernist project grounded in progressive politics. It combined pacifism and cosmopolitanism with a very strong emphasis on science as a force of prime importance for global social progress." And indeed, in her vision the idea of a simplified Latin (*ibid.*, pp. 84-85) is called "the poor man's simplified Latin":

For the ideal of a world medium of understanding and utility, of pacification and fraternity, the work of the Esperantists has been unrivalled. It is a great monument of devotion and ability. The palm for linguistic excellence, amongst the existing interlanguages, must, on the other hand, be given to Peano's Interlingua, because it is the first systematic attempt to build up an inter-European vocabulary on a consistent scientific basis; because it goes furthest in the elimination of grammar, under the guidance of observed tendencies in natural language; above all, because it is a logical etymological attempt to create the poor man's simplified Latin, which will open to him the nomenclature of the sciences, and will enable him to understand the prescription of his doctor and the legal phrases contained in the lawyer's presentment of his case.

While Henderson based his own idea of a simplified Latin as a world language as something that would unite the *educated*, the *learned*, and Galssi Paluzzi also based his promotion of Latin as a language that can be *universally read*, Pankhurst turns the arguably elitist argument on its head and makes a democratic statement – the fact that Peano's *Latino sine flexione* can be read by an educated person (p. 71 "In the main, Interlingua can be read at first sight by people of fair education who do not know Latin.") does not mean that it is only for them, it means that encountering this easily learnable language would *provide* the education needed.

And the scientists themselves would be united by the language just as in the old *res publica litteraria* – Pankhurst is also under the spell of the memory of Latin's past universality; *ibid.*, p. 93:

Scientists have such vital need of co-operation that they will gladly clothe their thoughts in the language that will be common to their international fraternity, just as they did of old in Latin. Based on Latin, the main vehicle of their existing nomenclature, the Interlanguage will prove no difficult barrier to them.

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